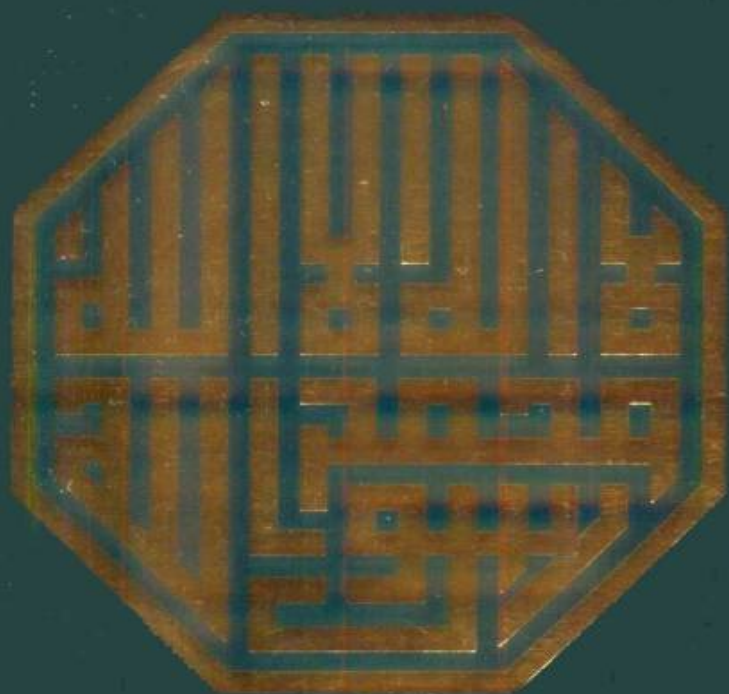


UNDERSTANDING DIWAN-I-FARID

TRANSLATION AND EXPLANATIONS



Shahzad Qaiser

Preface by
Seyyed Hossein Nasr

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A photograph of Khwaja Ghulam Farid

Khawaja Ghulam Farid [1845-1901] is the most celebrated 19th century Chishti–Nizami Sufi poet of the Saraiki language -spoken in the Indus valley in the border region of Punjab and Sindh in Pakistan. Born and died in Mithankot (also known as, Kot Mithan), coming from a noble Arab descent, tracing their ancestry back to Omar b. al-Khattab, the Second Caliph of Islam.

Khawaja wrote poems in Saraiki, Persian, Urdu, Punjabi, Sindhi and Braj Bhasha. He is best known for his Magnum Opus Divan-i-Farid, a wonderful collection of 272 Kafis celebrating the mystical experience of Oneness which are the fountain-head of his whole metaphysical thought and its realization. It speaks of the religion of the Heart that essentially takes one to the Heart of the religion. Divan-i-Farid is essentially symbolic. It gives us symbolic understanding of the ultimate nature of things, Expressed in a beautiful poetic imagery.

Contents

Appearance and Reality

Acknowledgment

Preface

Foreword

Prologue

Reflections

Introduction

Translation & Commentary

Dedicated to
My Revered Sprituial Master Hz.Baba Sufi Muhammad Tufayl
The embodiement of Primordial Wisdom

Appearance and Reality

وَوَهَبْنَا لِذَاوُدَ سُلَيْمَانَ ۖ نِعْمَ الْعَبْدُ ۚ إِنَّهُ أَوَّابٌ 30 ۚ إِذْ عَرَضَ عَلَيْهِ بِالْعَشيِّ الصُّوفُتُ الْجَبَدُ 31 ۚ فَقَالَ إِنِّي أَحْبَبْتُ حُبَّ الْخَيْرِ عَنْ ذِكْرِ رَبِّي ۖ حَتَّى تَوَارَتْ بِالْحِجَابِ 32 ۚ رُدُّوْهَا عَلَيَّ ۚ فطَفِقَ مَسْحًا بِالسُّوقِ وَالْأَعْلَقِ 33 ۚ وَلَقَدْ فَتَنَّا سُلَيْمَانَ ۖ وَأَلْقَيْنَا عَلَيَّ كُرْسِيَهُ جِئْسًا ۖ ثُمَّ آتَيْنَاهُ 34 ۚ قَالَ رَبِّ اغْفِرْ لِي وَهَبْ لِي مُلْكًا ۖ لَا يَنْبَغِي لِأَحَدٍ مِّنْ بَعْدِي ۖ إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ الْوَهَّابُ 35 ۚ

“And We gave unto David Solomon; how excellent a servant he was! He was a penitent. When in the evening were presented to him the standing steeds, he said, ‘Lo, I have loved the love of good things better than the remembrance of my Lord, until the sun was hidden behind the veil. Return them to me!’ And he began to stroke their shanks and necks. Certainly We tried Solomon, and We cast upon his throne a mere body; then he repented. He said, ‘My Lord, forgive me, and give me a kingdom such as may not befall any-one after me; surely Thou art the All-giver.’” (Surah Saad: 30-35)

قَالَ كَرُّوا لَهَا عَرْشَهَا نَنْظُرْ أَتَهْتَدِي أَمْ تَكُونُ مِنَ الَّذِينَ لَا يَهْتَدُونَ 41 ۚ فَلَمَّا جَاءَتْ قِيلَ أَهَكَذَا عَرْشُكَ ۖ قَالَتْ كَأَنَّهُ هُوَ ۖ وَأُوتِيَتْهُ الْعِلْمُ مِنْ قَبْلِهَا وَكُنَّا مُسْلِمِينَ 42 ۚ وَصَدَّهَا مَا كَانَتْ تَعْبُدُ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ ۖ إِنَّهَا كَانَتْ مِنْ قَوْمٍ كَافِرِينَ 43 ۚ قِيلَ لَهَا ادْخُلِي الصَّرْحَ ۖ فَلَمَّا رَأَتْهُ حَسِبَتْهُ لُجَّةً وَكَشَفَتْ عَنْ سَاقَيْهَا ۖ قَالَ إِنَّهُ صَرْحٌ مُّمَرَّدٌ مِّنْ قَوَارِيرَ ۖ بَلْ قَالَتْ رَبِّ إِنِّي ظَلَمْتُ نَفْسِي ۖ وَأَسْلَمْتُ مَعَ سُلَيْمَانَ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ 44 ۚ

“He said, ‘Disguise her throne for her, and we shall behold whether she is guided or if she is of those that are not guided.’ So, when she came, it was said, ‘Is thy throne like this?’ She said, ‘It seems the same.’ ‘And we were given the knowledge before her, and we were in surrender, but that she served, apart from God, barred her, for she was of a people of unbelievers.’ It was said to her, ‘Enter the pavilion.’ But when she saw it, she supposed it was a spreading water, and she bared her legs. He said, ‘It is a pavilion smoothed of crystal. She said, ‘My Lord, indeed I have wronged myself, and I surrender with Solomon to God, the Lord of all Being.’ (Surah An-Namal: the Ants: 41-44)

(The Koran Interpreted: translation by A. J. Arberry)

Acknowledgment

I owe my deepest gratitude to Seyyed Hossein Nasr, an original thinker in the world of Islam, who has kept the Light of Tradition shining against the strong billows of modernism. His writings are a source of great inspiration for us.

My thanks are due to Mr. William C. Chittick, an outstanding scholar on traditional literature, who has delved deep into Sufi Tradition and has made it understandable for the contemporary man.

I am grateful to late Mr. N.A. Baloch, an eminent Sindhi scholar, whose writings reflect a deeper understanding of the different facets of Language and Culture. My interaction with him had been highly educative for me. I am very grateful to Mr. Suheyl Umar, a profound scholar of Iqbal and traditional studies, who provided technical advice in the publication of my book.

I am obliged to Mr. Moeenuddin Koreja, a noble and hospitable person, who gave me full access to his Farid Museum at Kot Mithan, which is a repository of traditional Art and Culture.

I am thankful to Mr. Khalid Faisal Photographer, a dedicated soul, who accompanied me to Rohi/Cholistan for days and captured beautiful aspects of traditional life.

I am highly appreciative of Mr. Muhammad Tariq of Prime Minister's Secretariat and Mr. Mukhtar Ahmed of Iqbal Academy Pakistan for their efforts in processing the allied data with expertise, patience and perseverance.

Preface

Most part of the Indo-Pakistan-Bangladeshi Subcontinent, which became Islamic did so through the influence of Sufism, and during the past millennium this area has produced some of the most outstanding Sufi saints, metaphysicians, gnostics and poets. Unfortunately, many of these figures are not well known outside of the Subcontinent, especially those belonging to more recent times. Dr. Shahzad Qaiser has performed a great service in making available the work of one such figure, the Punjabi Sufi poet, gnostic and metaphysician Khawaja Ghulam Farid, who was almost our contemporary, having lived into the 20th century. In this volume, which complements his earlier volumes on the metaphysics of Khawaja Farid and his *Diwan*, Dr. Qaiser provides a complete and masterly commentary in English upon the gnostic and Sufi poems of this recent sage. The commentary uses the vocabulary of the traditionalist school and is thereby able to bring out succinctly in English the remarkable metaphysical depth of these precious poems.

In reading this work one not only encounters beautiful expressions of a wisdom that is perennial and becomes enriched by the depth of expression of so many aspects of the truth, but one also becomes startled to discover that such a figure as Khawaja Farid lived so recently during a period so often associated by the educated Muslim mind with so-called reformers who have often dealt with only the surface of things. We must all be grateful to Dr. Qaiser for making such a precious treasure available to the public at large and also for helping present day Muslims to remember the very rich intellectual and spiritual tradition that has survived in the Islamic world until now and that is of vital significance for Muslims today and in the future if they are to confront successfully the numerous intellectual, religious and spiritual challenges that they face now and will face in the years to come.

6th May 2011

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Foreword

Dr. Shahzad Qaiser, the author of this book, is one of the greatest authorities on the study of Khawaja Ghulam Farid, who is the most renowned poet of Saraiki language. Dr. Shahzad Qaiser has desired that I should write a Foreword of his new work which he has produced with the title: *Understanding Diwan-i-Farid*. I was really surprised at his desire because I know very little about the poetry of this great Sufi and the most popular poet of Saraiki language. In fact I had expressed my little knowledge about this great Sufi poet and his message in a couple of meetings in Multan and Bahawalpur, which seem to have prompted Dr. Shahzad Qaiser to have done so.

I confess that I am not a scholar at all, who could write a Foreword of such a scholarly research work contributed by Dr. Shahzad Qaiser, the most outstanding scholar of Farid Studies. I have, in front of me, the thought provoking masterpieces contributed by Dr. Shahzad Qaiser in the field of 'Khawaja Farid Studies'.

Dr. Qaiser has said: "Khawaja Ghulam Farid (1845-1901) is a Saraiki poet metaphysician par excellence. He has revived the traditional metaphysics in the modern world by embracing the universal elements of pure metaphysics. His learning and scholarship coupled with his spiritual experiences had added a glorious chapter on world spirituality. He is multilingual and has left a rich repository of prose and poetry."

Dr. Shahzad Qaiser further says:

"Diwan-i-Farid is the fountain-head of his whole metaphysical thought and its realization. It speaks of the religion of the heart that essentially takes one to the heart of the religion. Diwan-i-Farid is essentially symbolic. It gives us symbolic understanding of the ultimate nature of things, expressed in a beautiful poetic imagery."

In my opinion in Pakistan, after Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai, Sachal Sarmast and Allama Iqbal, Khawaja Farid is the only Sufi poet who has been thoroughly and critically studied by our scholars.

Dr. Shahzad Qaiser has already contributed his three masterpiece works on the life and work of this great poet:

1. *The Metaphysics of Khawaja Farid*
2. *Beyond the Manifest – Metaphysics, Tradition and Culture*
3. *The Message of Diwan-i-Farid*

It is really Nature's gift which is bestowed upon philosophers, thinkers, scientists, poets, writers and scholars as they are claimed to have been the only persons for such a gift. Dr. Shahzad Qaiser is one of those God-gifted scholars. This is evident from the masterpiece work contributed by him in the field of Farid Studies. I would say without any hesitation that he is a scholar in his own right along with being the son of Dr. Nazir Qaiser, a God-gifted and most renowned international scholar on Iqbalism. The learned author of the present scholarly work has thoroughly explained the metaphysical insights of Khawaja Farid. He has rightly said that this Sufi poet has uncovered the tracks of metaphysics, cosmology, tradition and symbolism in his poetry. He has demonstrated the possibility of looking beyond physics, has experienced the universe in cosmological terms, rooted his intellectual doctrine in the Islamic tradition and taught the language of symbolism. The author is hopeful that there is still time for the modern man to forsake the wrong tracks and move on to the primordial road that leads to destination. The learned author further opines that if this road is not taken then Man would certainly be lost in wilderness and would absolutely cease to be human. What a heavy price man has to pay for turning away from his own "Ideal Human Nature".

The author has explained all these points with the help of quotations from the verses of Khawaja Farid.

Primordial Beauty is present everywhere. Sufis understand it by witnessing it. Every Sufi believes that there is nothing resembling Him. Like other Sufis, Khawaja Farid also knows Him as All Reality. There is no dependence on anything except Allah. Nothing exists except Him. It is the way of our tradition. Farid advises the seeker to keep constant watchfulness.

He says:

بک دی دم دم سیک ہے	بک ہے بک ہے بک ہے
کیا اُچ ہے کیا چھک ہے	بک دے ہر ہر جا وچ دیرے
بیا سب کجھ بالک ہے	بک ہے ظاہر بک ہے باطن
ہوں ڈو دل دی چھک ہے	مقناطیس تے لوبے وانگن
او کافر مشرک ہے	جیڑھا بک کوں ڈوں کر جانے

Dr. Shahzad Qaiser has introduced the Kafis of Khawaja Farid to the people all over the globe, particularly to those who are interested in his message of mysticism.

Writing about the teaching of Sufism in our part of the world, Dr. Shahzad Qaiser, states:

“One of the primary manifestations of Islamic tradition has been in Sufi doctrines, methods and practices. It is reflected in Sufi adages, maxims and proverbs. The Sufis of Punjab, Sindh, Pakhtunkhwa, Balochistan, Azad Kashmir and Northern Areas are the most creative expression of this tradition. They have essentially communicated their doctrine to the common folk which, among other things, have been instrumental in preserving the traditional truths from corruption. They have happily embraced the votaries of different religions of the world and have included every one in the all encompassing reality of universal great love of humanity. The Sufis, in consonance with the Divine Message and the conduct of the Prophet of Islam, love humanity from the core of their heart. They are not interested in proving other people wrong just for the sake of it but use indirect methods to inspire rightness of ideas, sentiments and conduct. Their essential purpose is to save humanity from sufferings and help it to achieve happiness in different abodes. The Sufis, in all humility, without any

hidden pride, act as real benefactors of the down trodden mankind. They help every one and harm no one. This is the reason that all votaries of different religions and traditions come to the Sufis without any reservations. The Sufis have also creatively contributed in the flowering of the sacred art, which occupies a central place in traditional Islam”.

The learned author of this book has further explained the metaphysical thoughts of the great Sufi poet, Khawaja Farid. In his view:

“The Metaphysics of Khawaja Farid is essentially committed to that Reality which lies beyond all cosmic manifestation but in total perspective it conveys the message that the journey to the Absolute starts from the study of the cosmic book. His poetry is replete with study of cosmos both in its principal abstractions and concrete realities.”

He has quoted Dr. Mehr Abdul Haq, a renowned Saraiki scholar, to bring out Khawaja Farid’s love of Nature:

“Khawaja Farid loved the open vast sand-dunes of the Rohi desert, and spent many weeks there every year during summer and springs, winters and autumns and specially the rainy season in which nature is at its best, in picturesque panoramic scenes. His heart leaped up when he beheld a rainbow in the sky but, unlike Wordsworth, this rainbow transported his mind from the concrete to the abstract, from the contingent to the real, from the known to the unknown and from the physical to the metaphysical truths. He was delighted to see the after-rain clear blue skies, the vast silvery horizons, and around the muddy hatched huts, young girls drenched cap-a-pie the welcome showers. The sweet calls of the lonely bird perched on the leafless desert trees, the rhythmic tinkling of the bells of the home coming cattle, the echoing love song of the solitary camel driver, the sobs and sighs of the newly wed young girl whose paramour has been compelled to leave her in search of wages to far off cities, the churning sounds coupled with jingles of the glass-bangles worn up to elbows, the mysterious hissing sounds of the winds passing through the narrow phantom-line sandy mounts. All this bewitched Khawaja Farid with their every-fresh living message of the unity of creation, its inter-relationship and powerful ties of love, peace and tranquillity.”

Khawaja Farid depicts the said scenario in one of his Kafis. He says:

وہ سانون دے من بھانون دے	آنے مست ڈھاڑے ساون دے
کجلے بھورے سو سو وں دے	بدلے پورب ماڑ ٹکھن دے
سارے جوڑ وساون دے	چارے طرفوں زور پون دے
کوئل مور چچونے جیہے،	چکویاں چکویے اغن پیہے
شاغل گیت سنوان دے	سہنس چکور چنڈور پیہے
راتیں کھمنیں کھمن رنگیلیاں	ڈینہاں پینگھاں ساویاں پیلیاں
وقت سنگار سہاون دے	گج گج گاجاں گجن رسیلیاں
تھل چترانگ وی باغ بہاراں	روبی راوے تھیاں گلزاراں
چرچے دبانوں گانون دے	گھنڈ تنواراں بارش باراں
ٹھنڈیاں بیلان رمجھم مینہ بے	چاندنی رات ملہاری ڈینہ بے
گنے ویہلے غم کھانون وے	سوہنی موسم لگڑا نینہ بے
سالہوں سوہیے کیسر پھنڈے	مد مستانی تے خوش دینڈے
جھڑ گے لانگھے لانون دے	سہجوں مینہ برساتوں سنڈے
مال مویشی شاد تھیوسے	دیہہ فرید آباد تھیوسے
چولے انگ نہ مانوں وے	دل دردوں آزاد تھیوسے

The title of the book under reference is “*Understanding Diwan-i-Farid*”. As already stated, Khawaja Farid is one of the greatest Sufi poets, who is exponent of the social and cultural life of the people of ‘Rohi’. He is no, doubt, the poet of common people. He has described herdsmen, peasants and all other common inhabitants of ‘Rohi’ – the region which, is geographically known as ‘Cholistan’. He witnessed the sorrows and grief, pains and sufferings, and also joys and happiness of the people of Cholistan. He is an outstanding Sufi poet of Seraiki. He has conveyed the message of Sufism through his ‘Kafis’ and ‘Baits’ in Saraiki language.

In his present work, Dr. Shahzad Qaiser has, not only, translated two hundred and seventy two Kafis of the renowned poet, but he has also explained the metaphysical terms used by the poet. The author has also introduced and explained the theme by the poet which is in fact the original and scholarly contribution of the author.

I quite agree with the learned scholar who is of the opinion that:

“Diwan-i-Farid is the masterpiece of traditional literature. It reaches the heights of poetic excellence. It claims all the essential elements of traditional poetry. It thrives on vision, imagination and inwardness. It is replete with intellectuality and existentiality. His Kafis abound with symbols, allegories, similes, metaphors, analogies and images in its poetic diction. The Kafis of Khawaja Farid deal with a whole Saraiki world including the flora and fauna, ornaments and adornments, folk lore and folk takes, tradition and culture, customs and conventions and so on. His poetry reveals the whole world of symbolism. His Kafis manifest the infinite depths of love with the Almighty”.

Kafi is a classical form of Sufi poetry. It is composed by the Sufis of Sindh, Punjab including Saraiki belt and Kutch (a region of Indian Gujrat). Kafi is in fact very popular among the people, both literate and illiterate. The singing of a Kafi enralls the audience. It is intelligible to all. The Kafi from of poetry is lyrical in essence. Its theme is eternal love. Love songs have always had a wider field in appeal. Every nation possesses its own love songs, and Sindh, Punjab and Saraiki belt in Pakistan are not bit far behind them. The old sing them as acts of devotion, the young derive pleasure out of their contents, the pious consider them as sacred, while the profane will find in them many things from glory to power of achievements. These songs are the sacred hymns and are the lays of the Lord. (Wadhvani Tirathdas 1984:89)

To the form of Kafi, Khawaja Farid has also contributed considerably. The most important thing, for which Khawaja Farid, Shah Latif and Sachal Sarmast cannot be forgotten, is the fact that they gave music to their people as a path leading them to mysticism. The prosodic form of Kafi is generally based on musical notes and modes, composed according to the set rules of Ragas and Ragnis. It is sung in accompaniment of Harmonium, Yaktaro, Khartal, Pakhwaza, Surundo and Sarangi.

The earliest poets of Kafi form of poetry were Madhulal Shah Hussaini, Baba Bulhe Shah, Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai and Sachal Sarmast. It is worth to be mentioned here that the earliest form of Kafi form, is “Ginan” which was first composed in eleventh century A.D. by Pir Satgur Nur (d.1079) and after him by Pir Shams Sabzwari Multani, then his grand-son Pir Shahbuddin, followed by his great grand-son Pir Sadruddin, and his son Pir Hassan Kabiruddin of Uch Sharif from 12th to 15th century A.D. in Punjabi, Sindhi, Saraiki, Kutchi, Hindvi and Purbi languages. The Ginans of all these Sufi poets are available with the Ismaili community all over the globe, wherever they are settled. They recite them in congregation of the Jamat in their Jamat Khanas. Ginans are really very interesting form of literature in the local languages of the people, who accepted the Ismaili Tariqa under the hands of these Pirs.

It is a well-known fact that Khawaja Farid was very much influenced by the poetry of Sachal Sarmast, who composed his poetry in Sindhi, Punjabi, Saraiki, Urdu and Persian. Therefore, Sachal Sarmast is liked and loved in Punjab and in the Saraiki belt. Similarly, Khawaja Farid is also sung in Sindh along with Shah Latif and Sachal Sarmast. From the comparative study of the poetry of Sachal Sarmast and Khawaja Farid it is evident that Khawaja Farid has described almost the same themes which were commonly composed by Sachal Sarmast. For instance Sachal says in one of his Kafis:-

جی آنیں تون بھلی آنیں توں، کنہیں منزل مون پہچانیں توں

تھو موٹی سر وڈھانیں توں،

سرمد کہے ڈینی لت کہانی، سوریئے تے منصور چڑبائی

شیخ عطار جو سر وڈبائی، یوسف کہے منجہ کھوہ وجہائی

شمس ملن بتھوں مارائی، بلہے شاہ کہے ذبح کرائی

جعفر کہے وریا بوڑائی، تن کہے پار لنگھانیں توں

گھاتنتے میں بلال پیرائی، عنایت کہے میدان مارائی

کرمل کہے بن حکم بیلائی، موسیٰ کہے بے سہاگ وٹھائی

اکیداس تعزیر ڈوائی، سو اج ساگیو آہیں توں

سچو سندھ پندھ پچھائے گھوریو پنہنجو سر گھمائے

نیزہس واری گالہہ گالہائے، عاشق کہے فرمانیں توں

Khawaja Farid has described the same theme in one of his Kafis. For instance:-

تیڈی رمزاں شور مچایا	تیڈے نیناں تیر چلایا
لکھ عاشق مار گنوايا	المست بزار مرایا
بار برہوں سر چایا،	ابراہیم اڑاہ اڑایو
موسئی طور چلایا	صابر دے تن کیڑے بجھے
یحییٰ گھوٹ کواہیا	ذکریا کلوتر چرایو
نوح طوفان لڑبایا	یونس پیٹ مچھی دے پایو
زہر دا جام پلایا	شاہ حسن کوں شہر مدینے
ایڑبا کیس کرایا	کربلا وچ تیغ چلا کر
سرمہ سر کیوایا	شمس الحق دی کھل لہوایو
مستی سانگ رسایا	شاہ منصور چڑھایو سولی
سو سو ناز ڈکھایا	مجنوں کارن لیلیٰ ہو کر
شیریں نام دھرایا	خسرو تے فریاد دے خاطر
اپنا وقت نبھایا	درد دا بار اٹھایا ہر ہک
تیڈڑا وارا آیا	کر قربان فرید سر اپنا

After the through study of the renderings of Farid's Kafi in simple English prose, and the explanatory notes on the metaphysical thoughts and terms used by Khawaja Farid in his poetry, the learned author has successful proved with his explanation that Khawaja Farid was the most renowned mystic poet of Saraiki language, who has dealt with the entire human society of the world. The poet has, not only taught the lessons of the greatness of human beings but also of brotherhood and equality among the masses. The rendering of every couplet of every Kafi, and the terms used by the poet, will help the readers to understand the infinite depth of the poetry of the renowned poet.

For instance:-

بر عیب کنوں بے خالی	اے قبلہ اقدس عالی
جیں جو منگیا سو پایا	اتھ عبد عبید سوالی

**“The sacred and supreme House of God is free from all imperfections.
Here, God’s bondsmen of higher and lower ranks,
become recipients in consonance with their asking.”**

Then the learned author has explained the terms and metaphysical thoughts of the poet as under:-

“The House of God, symbolizing the spiritual is perfect. It is universal and thereby free from all social and cultural delimitations. The discriminations of sex, colour, class or caste are not there. It does not recognize even an iota of material differentiations, since it primarily addresses to the spiritual nature of humanity. It has a spiritual programme for the entire mankind to be realized by any one who chooses to become its votary in consonance with the ultimate nature of things. It admits both the virtuous and the sinners in its small and big gatherings....The ‘servant-Lord axis’ is the starting point of spiritual life. The postures of servanthood, nonbeing or nothingness imply the Lord, Being or the Essence itself respectively. The Divine blessings are infinite and no finite receptacle can exhaust them. Intention is the key to the Divine Treasure. Here, all the receptacles in consonance with their inner reach are blessed accordingly. A person who is merely outward remains at the periphery as compared to the one who absorbs the sea in the drop of his inwardness.”

Similarly the rendering of one line of the couplet of Kafi-13, along with its explanation is reproduced below:

زر و سری تے ور و سریا	عشق لگا گھر و سریا
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**“My falling in love has made me oblivious of my abode.
My spouse and wealth have fallen in oblivion.”**

After the translation of the above quoted line of the couplet, the learned scholar has explained the theme along with the metaphysical terms used in this line:

“It was not a conscious effort on my part to leave my abode, spouse and wealth but my falling in love made me oblivious of all these things. Religiosity purports the way of preaching, sermonizing and moralizing with a limited positive result. Spirituality, on the other hand, provides the possibility of a direct contact with God with immeasurable merits. Once the love of God takes roots in a person, it becomes his guide. His worldly love is burnt to ashes in the fire of Divine love. He goes beyond the need of anyone to tell him what to do. His love keeps freeing him from all worldly propensities of the lower self since his love of God makes them peter out accordingly. Religiosity uses the fear of God to smite the sinners. It ends up in instilling a psychological fear, which becomes highly counterproductive. But spirituality takes God as love. It does not talk of fearing God but enlightens man to be fearful of the drastic consequences of his evil actions. An element of genuine fear does remain during the course of spiritual journey but it is transposed in the fear of doing something, which makes one lose grace in the eye of one’s beloved. It is lovers’ hell.”

Another example of the translation of the couplet of Kafi-62 along with its explanation may be studied:-

عشق اسابنجی جا آبی انصاف
ظلم نبھانیندس، تاں بھی تہنجا تھورا گانیندس

This Kafi is composed in Sindhi language. It is translated as:

**“Do justice to my heightened love.
I harp on the tune of your name in spite of bearing your unjust behaviour.”**

Dr. Shahzad Qaiser explains the metaphysical thought expressed by the Sufi poet in these couplets as reproduced below:

“The lover’s consciousness is absorbed in pure objectivity but as against the objective it gives existential meaning to things. It is not possible to understand these meanings from the outside.

They have to be understood inwardly in their total context. The cardinal error of religiosity is to interpret the utterances of the lovers at their face value without bothering to decipher their real meanings. The contradictions between the clerics and the Sufis continue because they speak from different perspectives in different languages. The Sufis understand the clerics but the clerics do not understand the Sufis. How could a person stationed at lower echelon understand the higher one? Many Sufis including Mansur Hallaj, Baba Bulleh Shah and the martyr Sarmad had to suffer at the hands of the clerics. The accusations of the lover against the beloved cannot be interpreted on ordinary plane since she communicates at a higher level. Her words and their purport are only meant for her beloved who understands them fully. They are not meant for the ordinary folk to interpret them at their respective level. It is only the beloved, which has a right to check the lover and no one else. The self-styled custodians of religious, social and cultural values have played havoc with the lovers, symbolised in the tragic romantic tales of different parts of the world. They have not allowed love to prosper. The spiritual essence of love cannot be understood at the psychic plane. The contradiction between the psychic and the spiritual has destroyed so many great men and women. The lover and the beloved express two shades of rightness. It is not a conflict between right and wrong but a conflict between two shades of rightness. The lover is placed at a situation where she exercises rightness otherwise how could she be worthy of her beloved's love. Her ideas, feelings, words and actions are the expressions of righteousness. The beloved, on the other hand, rightfully places his lover in the heightened states of suffering because it makes the realisation of union possible, though his shade of rightness is differently perceived by the lover. Thus, the two shades of rightness come in open conflict with each other. This is the 'dialectics' of love, which ultimately leads to union of the lover and the beloved. The lover's seeking justice against the unjust behaviour of his beloved has to be understood in the total context."

I honestly believe that this kind of research work has been undertaken for the first time in the field of 'Farid Studies' by Dr. Shahzad Qaiser, whom I have credited as the best scholar of Saraiki language, which is spoken by a great number of people in Pakistan and outside world.

I, from the core of my heart, express my congratulations to Dr. Shahzad Qaiser, the author of this masterpiece work of metaphysical poetry of Khawaja Farid, and pray that Allah, the Almighty, may bestow his mercy upon him who has provided such an indispensable key for those who would like to open up their heart to the vast panorama of spiritual teachings and the spiritual core of Islamic tradition. Like the other works of the author, this is also his masterpiece work which is the result of his remarkable scholarly critical study of the poetry of the most renowned poet of Saraiki language, which will help the people at home and abroad to understand the infinite depths of his metaphysical poetry. The author deserves heartiest congratulations of all the readers.

27.8.2009

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S.I

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Prologue

It is a distinctive achievement on the part of Dr. Shahzad Qaiser to have produced an English translation of the text, with explanation, of the 'Kafi compositions' of Khwaja Ghulam Farid. The venerable poet scholar belonged to Chachran, District Rahimyar Khan, Pakistan, and flourished during the 2nd half of the 19th century. Dr. Qaiser's work is a standard one on all the essential counts: the translation is based on an authentic text, the meanings recorded convey the correct sense, and the expositions that follow lend insight into the feeling perceptions, philosophic connotations and Sufistic contemplations. The author's language power lends lustre to all. In his previous work entitled *The Message of Diwan-i-Farid* (covering the magnum corpus of the poet's two hundred and seventy two Kafis), Dr. Qaiser has clarified that his translation is based on an authentic text of the Kafis originally compiled by Maulavi Aziz-ur-Rehman and reedited recently by two scholars (*The Message*, pxxli).^{*} Thus, the publication of *The Message of Diwan-i-Farid* has for the first time placed on record the English translation of the complete text of the compositions of Khwaja Ghulam Farid

Before this, except for Allama Iqbal's works, a complete text of no other poet from Pakistan has been translated into English. Dr. Shahzad Qaiser has set an example by presenting to the reader the entire original contribution of Khwaja Ghulam Farid in English.^{*} This movement is likely to gain momentum hereafter.

Dr. Qaiser deserves credit that even though he himself was born and reared in Lahore, the cradle of the Punjabi language, he has been able to achieve a sound understanding of the Seraiki idiom of Khwaja Ghulam Farid. His grasp of the fine nuances of the poet's Seraiki expression has enabled him to produce a reliable translation. No doubt, Dr. Qaiser's contribution is an admirable attempt to mediate knowledge. His English rendering transcends the stage of 'literal meaning' and dips deep into the underlying thought process. Often he has presented us with an English 'version' instead of

an English 'translation', of the original. In the volume of Understanding *Diwan-i-Farid* wherein Kafis are translated and explained, the expositions which following the textual meanings, do not dilate upon any doctrines of the great poet. However, in his earlier work, Beyond the Manifest (2008), Dr. Qaiser has acknowledged that he was essentially inspired by the metaphysical thought of Khwaja Ghulam Farid. Therefore, he has discussed this doctrine in the first chapter and also devoted two chapters to the 'Doctrine of Oneness of Being (*Wahdat al-Wujud*) of Khwaja Ghulam Farid' in which he has explained the relevance of this doctrine in contemporary times as well as in its universal realization. According to the learned author, Khwaja Ghulam Farid is "the precursor of metaphysical thought of the contemporary times" (p.87), and that "his Doctrine of Oneness of Being (*Wahdat al-Wujud*) is the metaphysical ground of understanding the principle of unity in diversity" (p.99). These are important observations and will need further elaboration from him to highlight the contribution of Khwaja Ghulam Farid.

15.8.2009

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* The present writer was in contact with the late Maulavi Aziz-ur-Rehman of Bahawalpur in 1943 and he wrote back to inform that he had taken a good care to record the correct text of the Kafis; further that he had captioned the collection as 'Diwan' keeping close to the Persian terminology though Khwaja Farid had composed his Kafis mainly in the Seraiki language. As his family originally belonged to Sindh he had also composed some Kafis in Sindhi which were also included in the Diwan. (More recently a worthy scion of the family, Tahir Mahmud Koreja has reedited the Diwan with further clarifications).

* Diwan-i-Farid translated in English prose.

Reflections

Understanding Diwan-i-Farid is a notable addition to the growing body of textual and exegetical studies of Sufism or Islamic Spirituality as it unfolded in the Indian environment. A sequel to Dr. Shahzad Qaiser's earlier work of translating and studying Khawaja Ghulam Farid, an outstanding spiritual master of the school of Ibn 'Arabi in South East Asia in the late nineteenth century, it not only provides useful materials for an in-depth study of Sufism in general but also helps to dispel many ongoing misunderstandings about the history of Sufi thought and praxis. Western scholarship on Islam has often entertained the idea that, not unlike the case of Islamic philosophy, Islamic Spirituality also withered away after the great masters of classical Islam. In doing this it ignores the irrefutable historical record that testifies to the fact that Islamic philosophy is a living tradition in the Islamic lands and did not come to an end in the seventh/thirteenth century after Ibn Rushd. Neither did Islamic Spirituality cease to produce dazzling examples of spiritual excellence who personified the doctrinal and practical aspects of Sufism. Khawaja Ghulam Farid is one of these numerous figures whose spiritual radiation brought about a re-flowering of Sufism in South Punjab and beyond it.

Khawaja Ghulam Farid, whose mystical magnum opus has been translated and explained in *Understanding Diwan-i-Farid*, belongs to the long illustrious tradition of wisdom poetry or poetically mediated thought which has been a hallmark of the Sufi masters throughout the ages. Poetry, of course, holds the key, for it speaks a universal language. But, as in the case of Rumi, mysticism is added to poetry. This is a winning combination, for poetry and mysticism are both universal languages of the human soul and nowhere do they reinforce each other more than in the life and legacy of the Sufi masters.

Dr. Shahzad Qaiser has not simply given us a translation. He has endeavored to step backward from the text and delve into the point of view that informs it. It is a work which tries to pry open for its readers the door to the universe of discourse of Islamic Spirituality and the metaphysical perspective

in which it is squarely rooted and from which it draws its sap and life blood. He is not interested in evaluating Sufism and Islam from within those dominant perspectives of modern scholarship that make various contemporary modes of self-understanding the basis for judging the subject. Instead, he wants to portray Islamic Spirituality from the perspective of those great Muslims of the past who established the major modes of interpretation of the Sufi doctrine and Islamic understanding.

We are thankful to Dr. Shahzad Qaiser for making available to the English reading public the work of an important figure of the Sufi tradition of South East Asia who represents the incredibly rich intellectual and spiritual tradition that is still live and vibrant in the Islamic world.

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Introduction

The reality of Knowledge in metaphysics becomes a problem of knowledge in philosophy. The problem of the modern West is that it has restricted and constricted the universal dimension of knowledge and thereby the universal realm of being. Philosophy by becoming 'the handmaid of science' has done violence both to the spirit of philosophy and the spirit of science. Epistemology is considered as the 'science of knowledge'. The very word science reduces knowledge to a particular dimension of knowledge. The scientific method by mere use of reason cohere the data received from sense-experience. The scientific view of things, enjoys a certain form of legitimacy within certain parameters but when science transgresses its bounds in considering sense-experience as the only source of knowledge and thereby the scientific world as the only world, that it metamorphoses itself into scientism. Modern epistemology and modern ontology are oblivious of different degrees of knowledge and different levels of being, respectively. They have no inkling of the higher dimensions of knowledge and the supra-ontological levels of Reality. They are forgetful of the metaphysical truth that all the regions of consciousness or experience cannot be reduced merely to sense-experience or sense-perception and the whole cosmos cannot be reduced solely to the empirical world. The inspiring literature of the metaphysical and religious traditions of the world rightly belies the false claims of modernism, which has to realise that the traditional world with all its variations is essentially based on universal experience as against the modern world, which is based on a segment of experience, which frequently assumes a lower form of reasoning and at times fallacious one. The modern attempt to universalise its presuppositions of sense-experience is not only against the law of things but has led to the crises in the fields of sciences, arts and humanities. Philosophy of Science, which is itself a product of modernism, is lost in the morass of contradictions created by modern science in its interpretation of the scientific data. It has deepened the yawning chasm between knowledge and being. The Western critique of modern science by different schools of thought including postmodernism is merely a family affair and does not touch the core of the issue.

The crucial dividing line between the traditional and the modern world is in reference to knowledge and being. It boils down to the division between the Infinite and the finite or between intellectual intuition and sensory intuition. The problem with the modern West since its inception is that the dazzling success of sense-experience in the corresponding empirical world has deluded it into thinking that the method of science can be applied to arts and humanities as well. It has further erred in assuming that other levels of experience are neither possible nor desirable. It has not only misinterpreted the data received from higher levels of experience but has erroneously attempted to reduce it to a lower level of experience. It has to remember the traditional lesson that different levels of being are amenable to different levels of knowledge. Even in the case of physical sciences, the scientific method lacks the inner reach to get in touch with 'the permanent essences of things.' It has no method to reach 'the transparency of the phenomena'. This virtually creates a problem when the scientists attempt to interpret the data received from sense-perception. The difference amongst the scientists in interpreting the data is essentially due to its methodology, which is insulated from the metaphysical principles. The modern physicists understanding of light, for instance, bereft of the metaphysical principles of Light merely remains peripheral. One who has no idea of Light itself cannot fully understand its manifestation at the empirical level. Likewise, modern biology remains obliviousness of Life itself therefore it does not succeed in encompassing the phenomena of life. Facts and their interpretations divorced from metaphysical truths end up in erroneous views and distortions, which fail even to give a partial view of Reality. How is it possible to really understand the horizontal dimensions in obliviousness of the vertical ones? The crises of modern science cannot be resolved within the orbit of science itself. Science has to move outside its orbit in order to overcome these crises that, in a certain sense, are its own creation. The problem becomes compounded when the scientific method is applied to social sciences. It fails to give true understanding of human reality expressed in different aspects including religious, moral, economic, psychological, social, aesthetic, political and cultural. A plethora of pseudo-theories of knowledge in different realms has invaded the modern mentality, which glorifies Ignorance at the expense of Knowledge itself.

One of the dominant trends of the modern world is to consider opinion or personal view at par with knowledge. The relevance of personal opinion in everydayness of existence notwithstanding, the modern times have blown it out of proportion. The ghost of the Sophists still haunts humanity. An opinion bereft of real knowledge ultimately misleads human understanding. Man becomes habitual in remaining on the periphery without searching for the ultimate nature of things. The modern man

requires revisiting Plato's essential distinction between opinion and knowledge. A deeper study of the traditional world will further help him in becoming inconsequential in reference to truth. How could personal opinion or personal view substitute knowledge unless it is a perspective of knowledge?

The drama of the modern West is the drama of finitude. The modern world is orchestrated in such a way that it continuously harps the tune of finitude. The modern attempts to extend the boundaries of finitude end up in merely extending the frontiers of finitude but they remain enmeshed in finiteness. They have no knowledge of the Infinite and thereby have no access to it. Kant, the German philosopher, denied knowledge of the noumena, and it is this denial taking numerous forms of modernism and post modernism, which continues till today. He found metaphysics impossible on the basis of his ignorance of the higher realms of knowledge and being. He took his method as absolute and considered himself authorised to pass judgements on the realms, which could not fit in the strait jacket of his methodology. The problem of Method has haunted the philosophers since times immemorial and in our times we see Jean Paul Sartre struggling with the same. The methods of philosophy, with all their variations, are akin to the methods of science, which deal with certain segments of the Reality and that too in their respective imperfections. Philosophy and science have become so judgemental.

The basic trend of the modern man is to start from multiplicity and end up by denying unity. It tends to forge unity within multiplicity, which is nothing else than a philosophical forgery. The popular slogan of the modern world regarding the unity of sciences has proved to be counterproductive. It has brought forth the multiplicity of sciences as widower of unity. The same trend is visible in humanities and arts. The talk of unity of mankind, by de-linking it from the metaphysical principle of unity, has not only failed to realise unity but has brought forth further diversity impregnated with antagonistic contradictions. The modern man has to realise that the future of mankind is linked with the future of the metaphysical tradition. Freedom of thought does not mean freedom from thought. The conflict between thoughtfulness and thoughtlessness can be traced back to the times when the modern West destroyed its own tradition by rebelling against it in the forms of Renaissance, Reformation and Enlightenment. It became oblivious of its Greek tradition, the Latin roots of European languages, the Christian tradition and the metaphysical and religious traditions of the world. It ignorantly metamorphosed metaphysical truths into philosophical categories. Many pseudo-problems of philosophy arose due to the ignorance of the intellectual heritage of mankind.

The game of language and thought was narrowed down to the finite at the expense of the Infinite. The European languages became impoverished by remaining attuned to the poverty of thought. Language and thought intensified the paucity of each other.

The modern concept of Man, among other concepts, exhibits the weaklings of language and thought. Man is being studied by sciences, arts and humanities. Modern psychology, either in segregation or in conjunction with related and unrelated disciplines, has come to assume a special status in its study of Man. A plethora of schools of thought have sprung thoughtless of the essential reality of man. There are hundreds and hundreds of individual, existential, social and cultural theories of personality weaving fabrics of being in obliviousness of the metaphysical status of man. They have no method to reach the unmanifest dimensions of man. The discovery of the unconscious is again principally in the realm of the manifest and it has nothing to do with the metaphysical unmanifest. Even the study of the manifest remains superficial in being insulated from the unmanifest and in being subject to faltering methodologies. The psychologist remains enmeshed in the entrails of the human psyche. He may displace the concept of the psyche with the concept of the self or with the concept of behaviour, but his fundamental approach remains tied to the world of psyche. He has no method to differentiate the spiritual from the psychical. He debases the spiritual level to the level of human psyche. He has a delimited concept of normalcy and thereby a faltering concept of abnormality. Psychology does give a shade of instrumental knowledge of man but does not understand the essential dynamics of the individual and society. It is precluded in principle in revealing the essential understanding of Man. It errs in being oblivious, by dint of its methodology, of the wholeness of man. It does talk of wholeness, at times, but it is a wholeness that is within the bounds of finiteness bereft of the Infinite. Metaphysics teaches us that even the widest spread of the finite cannot reach the Infinite. The finite is the manifestation of the Infinite. One cannot fully understand the finite at the exclusion of the Infinite. Even the frontiers of parapsychology fall within the bounds of the finite and they have nothing to do with the realm of metaphysics. The philosophies, psychologies, anthropologies and sociologies of religion, for example, face the same delimitations in their study of man and his religion. Their persistence in following their respective methodologies removes them further from the metaphysical reality of man. They raise 'the dust of multiplicity' and fail to see the evident reality. How could veiled knowledge unveil the infinite depths of man's being or consciousness?

The Psychology of Religion can never come to terms with the real foundations of metaphysics and

religion unless it evolves a method to reach spirituality, which lies beyond the psychical realm. Religious experience has its source in the spiritual and not in the psychical. It is the obliviousness of this subtle distinction, which made Sigmund Freud propound pseudo-theories of the origin of religion, which have been carried through with certain variations in their subsequent development. His works including Totem and Taboo, Moses and Monotheism and The Future of an Illusion betrayed his understanding of the roots and fruits of religion. He initiated a major psychological trend in psychology against religion in the modern West, which taking different forms continues in the present times.

Modern psychology not only errs in knowing the origin of religion but it also errs in understanding religious behaviour, nay the whole behaviour of man. The concepts of psychology being fundamentally psychical are inherently incapable of portraying metaphysical and religious truths. The metaphysics of love, for example, is beyond the ken of psychology. It has no means to understand the lover's fear, anxiety, despair, pain, sorrow, distress, affliction, misery, torment, anguish, guilt and suffering etc, which he experiences in separation and disunion from his divine beloved. It cannot comprehend the state of peace, calmness and happiness of the lover while experiencing visions and unions of his friend and the ultimate state of 'deliverance and union.' Its failure mainly consists in attempting to interpret the spiritual as psychical. How the lover's attaining consciousness of his ontological nothingness could be understood by modern psychology? Won't modern psychology cease to exist as a specialised disciple in recognising pure objectivity of things and events outside the human psyche?

Traditional psychology has truly assigned the role of the psychical and the spiritual in its study of man and his behaviour. It has not confused the psychical with the spiritual. How could one even fully understand the psychical unless he understands the spiritual? The Sufi psychologists, for example, have always excelled in studying man in his wholeness. They have been conscious of separating the illusory from the genuine in the fold of religious experience. They have devised different methodologies to differentiate the divine from the satanic in order to bring to naught the showings and whisperings of the Satan. The modern psychologist needs to acquaint himself with the masterpieces of Sufi psychology in order to correct his errors and gain a deeper understanding of the realities of man.

The modern thinker frequently commits, which we have called elsewhere, the Delimitation Fallacy that mainly consists in delimiting the realms of knowledge and being by denying the Nondelimited

Knowledge and the Nondelimited Being. Science takes sense-experience as its source of knowledge and reason to cohere the data received by sense-perception and delimits the realm of knowledge and being, which does enjoy a certain form of legitimacy. But science commits the Delimitation Fallacy when it is metamorphosed into scientism by denying any other source of knowledge and any other level of being beyond the scientific one. Philosophy ultimately commits the same fallacy in considering Reason and sensory-intuition as final and all-pervasive and in denying the universality of Intellect and intellectual intuition. The lower fallaciously tends to usurp the place of the higher.

Man is called upon to study the symbols of God (*Ayāt*) in the universe, his own self and in the heavens. The Qur'an says: There are symbols on the earth for those with certainty, as also in your own selves: will you not then see? And your Sustenance is in the heavens, which is promised to you. (51: 20-22). The symbols of God (*Ayāt*) in the Qur'an, cosmos (*afaq*) and selves (*anfus*) are essentially identical. The Qur'an establishes an intimate bond between knowledge and the symbols of God (*Ayāt*). It is knowledge, which leads to deciphering the meanings enshrined in these symbols. Islamic tradition assigns primacy to knowledge itself. Adam's superiority to the angels is by virtue of knowledge grounded in freedom. Knowledge is the foundation of Man's cosmic vocation. It is not merely conceptual knowledge but doctrinal knowledge with corresponding means of realisation as well. The Qur'an says: He it is Who created your ears and eyes and hearts. You are so barely grateful. (23: 78). The Arabic word 'shukr' has a higher meaning than what is commonly understood in the sense of being grateful or thankful. It means, in the present context, the realisation of the possibilities of knowledge by virtue of sense-experience and heart-perception gifted to man by God. The failure to realise any of these possibilities is equated with the Arabic word 'kufr', which has a higher meaning than infidelity. It means either denying any one of the possibilities or failing to develop them. The Qur'an says: And the Day when We shall assemble from within every community (*ummat*), a host of those who gave lie to our Symbols (*Ayat*) and they will be lined up (according to the gravity of their wrong conceptions). When they are all assembled, He will say: You belied My Symbols (*Ayāt*) without encompassing them with knowledge, otherwise what else you were doing. And the Truth about their wrongness will be manifest concerning them and they will not be able to speak (justify themselves) (27: 83-85). Tradition further teaches us that those who belie the Symbols of God (*Ayat*) essentially belie themselves. The Qur'an says: It is an abhorrent example of those who belie Our Symbols and wrong their own selves (7: 177).

The traditional world, under the sway of modernism, is falling prey to the Delimitation Fallacy by

delimiting the categories of traditional thought and becoming oblivious of traditional symbolism. It is displacing the respective traditional languages and their categories with modern ones. Islamic tradition, for instance, is replete with metaphysical and religious categories enshrined in the traditional Arabic language of the Qur'an. But these have been divested from their symbolical, universal, and contextual meanings and displaced with literal, constrictive and out of context meanings. The fallacy consists in assigning finality to the latter in denial of the former. The Qur'anic text cannot be changed but its root meaning is being interpolated by subjective interpretations of the clerics, in flagrant violation of pure objectivity, who fail to realise the ever recurring possibility of experiencing God in the infinite depths of one's being as maintained by the mystics and the Sufis. They do not apprehend that mystic experience, as a source of knowledge, grows out of the infinite depths of one's heart. They are oblivious of the fact that it is the integration of sense-perception and heart-perception which makes man realise his true vocation of life.

Happily, the metaphysical and the religious traditions of the world have not become fully deadened by the onslaughts of modernism, thanks primarily to the intellectuals including metaphysicians, theosophists (hukma), mystics and Sufis, who have kept the vertical and horizontal dimensions of Knowledge alive, active and vibrant. One of the most enlightened figures among them, in the world of Islam, is Khawaja Ghulam Farid (1845-1901) belonging to the Saraiki tradition, who hails from South Punjab, Pakistan. He belongs to the intellectual tradition of Ibn Arabi, Mansur Hallaj and Bayazid Bistami. He is in the spiritual lineage of Baba Farid Masud Ganj Shakar. His prose and poetry reflect his profound knowledge of the intellectual heritage of mankind. His understanding of traditional symbolism hardly finds a parallel in our times. His being multi-lingual gives him direct access to the repositories of knowledge. His understanding of world spirituality deepens his own spiritual experience. He realises the levels of 'Shariah', 'Tariqah', 'Haqiqah' and 'Marifah' within the Islamic tradition at the hands of his elder brother Fakhruddin, his spiritual master and bequeaths wisdom of love and gnosis to humanity. It is by virtue of Providence that he anticipates the metaphysical and traditional thought of a galaxy of thinkers including Rene Guenon ('Abdul Wahid Yahya-1886-1951), Frithjof Schuon ('Isa Nur al-Din- 1907-1998), Titus Burckhardt (Ibrahim 'Izz ud Din- 1908-1984), Martin Lings (Abu Bakr Siraj ad Din-1909-2005) Seyyed Hossein Nasr and William C. Chittick, who have left a great impact in the revival of the Islamic metaphysical tradition in contemporary times. He, in a spiritual sense, has initiated the resurgence of Islamic Intellectuality both in the East and the West. It has led to the revivification the doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud), which is so close to the heart of our Sufi- poet, who has not only added certain creative

dimensions to the aforesaid doctrine and its realisation but has demonstrated the efficacy of traditional Saraiki language and culture in the understanding of metaphysics and tradition.

Khawaja Ghulam Farid structures his metaphysics and its realisation on the foundations of the Reality (Haq) understood as the Absolute, the Essence, the Infinite, 'the Metaphysical Whole' and 'the Universal Possibility', manifesting metaphysical, traditional, religious, philosophical, cosmological, cultural, political, socio-economical, psychosocial and symbolical levels of understanding things in his unique literary style. He mirrors a higher understanding of the Reality (God), Man and the Cosmos by virtue of his traditional and metaphysical perspectives. He goes beyond modern epistemology and ontology and demonstrates supra-forms of knowledge and being with their ensuing metaphysical identity. His intellectual intuition unfolds deeper layers of truth, which are beyond the ken of religiosity. Religiosity, bereft of love and gnosis, finds many things as stumbling blocks in his Diwan, which can only be removed at the plane of Intellectuality/Spirituality. His ecstatic utterances, for example, in his gnostic mode of poetry (*kafis*) seem outrageous to the religious psyche for it has never tasted the fruits of spirituality. It also has no ways to appreciate his direct contact with God, experience of the Prophetic Presence (*haduri*), and his unconditional commitment with his Spiritual Master (*murshid*), which are the fruits of deepest love and reverence. Likewise, at times, his going beyond the rituals is a dilemma for the religionists, who are condemned to measure spirituality on the level of mere religiosity. They also fail to recognize his Universal vision of finding the metaphysical and religious traditions of the world as manifestations of the identical Light, and thereby transcending the exclusivity of every religion in essentially conceiving their transcendent unity. Religiosity also does not understand his seeing the ontological unreality of everything except the Reality (God), which he attains by different spiritual methods including witnessing (*mushahida*) and unveiling (*kashf*). It finds it so difficult to agree with him when he apprehends the Reality (God), in the Attribute of Sovereign (Sultan) of the world, and in the form of labourer (*mazdur*) in simultaneity or when he witnesses the Reality (God), in the Attribute of Royal (*Hakim*), the issuer of royal decrees, simultaneously in the form of lowly (*miskeen*). It is completely at a loss to share his vision when, at times, he transcends the polarisations between Islam and infidelity (*kufir*); Truth (*Haq*) and falsehood (*batil*) ; Beautiful (*Sohna*) and ugly (*kojha*); Good (*Khayr*) and evil (*shar*) , Virtuous (Nek) and vicious (*bad*); Faithful (*Momin*) and heathen (*kafir*); Mindful of God (*Zakir*) and heedless (*nasi*) etc, and embraces them all by going to the root beyond these polarisations, which only arise out of the necessity of manifestation; thus, religious consciousness remaining opaque to his metaphysics of Light which teaches that Light essentially

remains Light in the state of reflection or deflection, unaffected by any of these states. Religiosity does not comprehend his transcending the individual mode of knowledge and action to the universal mode of Knowledge itself and nonaction respectively. It also has no inkling of his use of traditional symbolism and is condemned to remain stranded on the mere literal meanings of words. Religiosity utterly fails to understand his doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud), wherein the Reality (God) manifests in all forms in the simultaneity of its transcendence and immanence -- without the Reality being affected by any of these forms-- and his experiencing all these forms as essentially inviolable since there is no otherness and, thus his solely finding 'the Indivisible One-And-Only' as 'the One-And-All'. It is 'Seeing God Everywhere' and thereby loving God everywhere. It is going beyond the 'ontological unreality' of the mediums to the One who is 'the Most Real'. It is exceedingly imperative to realize Khawaja Ghulam Farid's higher levels of understanding, otherwise one is likely to miss his ultimate metaphysical vision and thereby falter in considering the most subtle portions of his poetry as blasphemous.

The Holy Tradition of 'Hidden Treasure' frequently quoted by different Sufis of the Path of Love and the Path of Knowledge is the starting point of reaching the heart of the Sufi tradition. 'I was a hidden treasure and I desired (ahabatu, loved)' to be known Accordingly, I created the creatures and thereby made Myself known to them. And they did come to know Me'. This tradition is fundamental in accounting for the original emergence of the principle of differentiation within the Reality. Self-Consciousness is the primordial and fundamental polarization within the Absolute. The otherness is not absolute for in case of divine Self-Consciousness the principle of otherness is essentially for Self-realization. 'The Reality wanted to see the essences of His Most Beautiful Names or, to put it another way, to see His own Essence, in an all-inclusive object encompassing the whole (divine) Command, which, qualified by existence, would reveal to Him His own mystery. For the seeing of a thing, itself by itself, is not the same as its seeing itself in another, as it were in a mirror; for it appears to itself in a form that is invested by the location of the vision by that which would only appear to it given the existence of the location and its (the location's) self disclosure to it. The Reality gave existence to the whole Cosmos (at first) as an undifferentiated thing without anything of the spirit in it, so that it was like an unpolished mirror...the (divine) Command required (by its very nature) the reflective characteristic of the mirror of the Cosmos, and Adam was the very principle of reflection for that mirror and the spirit of that form.' It is the birth of polarity leading to relationship, affinity, tension and conflict. This primordial and fundamental polarization within the Reality or the Self-polarization of the Reality leads to the distinction between the subject and object, knower and known. From the

standpoint of Self-polarization, the other is not absolute but is an occasion for Self-realization. 'Furthermore, because each of the poles is nothing other than the Reality, each must imply, potentially and latently, the other within itself. The process of Self-polarization is then one by which each projects onto the other what is latent of the other within itself. There is of course, at this stage, no real otherness, since it is a case of divine Self-consciousness for which the principle of otherness is simply for Self-realization, as is the case with human self-awareness.'

What is the place of love and knowledge in the attainment of gnosis? Love and knowledge are dialectically related to each other. Love deepens knowledge and knowledge enhances love. One does achieve mystical or individual realisation in the state of love. It is when the lover ceases to be that he finds no difference between him and his beloved. He becomes identical with the object of his love. But the experience of oneness realised by the lover remains temporary and incomplete and the lover does come to retain a certain sense of identity after his experience has passed away as stated by Iqbal, a religious metaphysician, in his Lecture: Knowledge and Religious Experience. It is very decisive to understand in this context that Khawaja Ghulam Farid's Diwan-i- Farid is saturated with love but it does not consider love as an end in itself. It is a means to realise Knowledge itself. It brings out the traditional truth that love paves the ground for gnosis. In other words, love ultimately leads to gnosis. The alchemy of suffering makes the lover deepen the sense of his own ontological nothingness in the Face of the Beloved. This mystic or individual realization makes him reach the threshold of the highest stage of metaphysical realization. It is by the Grace of the Lord that the possibility of transcending the lover-beloved axis opens up and becomes realised. Both the lover and the beloved cease to be in simultaneity since both are in reference to each other. 'I am the Truth,' 'All is Me' and 'All is My Splendid Face' washes away all dualities and polarizations. It is named as 'the Supreme Identity.'

Khawaja Ghulam Farid's metaphysics embraces aspects of both traditional metaphysics (mystic or individual) and pure metaphysics (metaphysical or universal) both in their aspects of doctrine and corresponding realisation. His traditional metaphysics of love essentially demonstrates the same metaphysical truths envisaged by pure metaphysics of contemplation but by a different route. The Path of Love ultimately plunges in the Path of Knowledge. Thus, it is at the higher stage of metaphysical or universal realisation that his experience attained, by virtue of intellectual intuition, becomes akin to the pure metaphysics of the Hindus and the transcendent metaphysics of the

Buddhists, nay with all the great metaphysical traditions of the world with all that it implies. It is very decisive to understand the subtle difference between the mystic and the metaphysical levels of his thought with their corresponding realisations in order to get to the heart of the matter.

Khawaja Ghulam Farid's doctrine of Oneness of Being (*wahdat al-wujud*), unveils the deeper layers of the principle of unity. It mirrors the principle of unity in diversity. His metaphysical understanding of the unity of God (*tawhid*), both in its reflective and contemplative aspects, takes its essential inspiration from the Qur'an. In order to achieve a doctrinal understanding of the unity of God (*tawhid*), one has to understand that the Reality (God) is manifests in all things. Everything is ontologically nothing. God manifests Himself in all forms, in the simultaneity of His transcendence and immanence, without any form whatsoever affecting Him. The essence of the idea is that the Divine takes all forms but none of these— ordinary or extraordinary— takes the Divine form. No human, for example, could ever take any form of the Divine. No one is with God but God is with everyone. 'God is. There is no thing with Him', says the tradition. Metaphysically speaking, all presence is the form of His Omnipresence. The Qur'an is replete with the essential message that no created being could ever be divinized. God says: 'They are unbelievers who say, 'God is the Messiah, Mary's son.' Say: 'Who then shall overrule God in any way if He desires to destroy the Messiah, Mary's son, and his mother, and all those who are on earth?' For to God belongs the kingdom of the heavens and of the earth, and all that is between them, creating what He will. God is powerful over everything (*Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 5:17*). God, for example, in His Attribute of Power (Omnipotence), manifests Himself in all forms of power including the ordinary, the charismatic and the miraculous. All receptacles are essentially characterized by their powerlessness including the angels, prophets and saints. They have no inherent powers and they only act by the powers vested in them by God and that too by His leave and accord. No one has ever ascribed power to himself for it tantamount to ascribing divinity (*ilah*) to his own created (manifested) self.

The Qur'an dispels ignorance of people about the true nature of their embodied selves (being) and possessions (having), which is one of the fundamentals in doctrinal understanding of the unity of God (*tawhid*): 'O men, you are the ones that have need of God; He is the All-sufficient, the All-laudable'. (*Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 35: 15*). Man's ontological and ontical needs have no self-subsistence, independence or autonomy since they wholly arise in reference to God, who is the Self-Sufficient (*Al-Ghani*). Man cannot consider himself ontologically in the state of nothingness on his own (*faqir*) since his nothingness is derived from Being itself (God). He is thus, essentially devoid

of his ontological nothingness. In other words, his 'ontological unreality' solely derives its credentials from the Real (God). Man is not even nothing. Otherwise, it tantamount to 'ascribing aught beside God' (*shirk*). The arrogance of the ones, who consider themselves as self-sufficient, on the other hand, is recorded by the Qur'an thus: 'God has heard the saying of those who said, 'Surely God is poor, and we are rich.' We shall write down what they have said, and their slaying the Prophets without right, and We shall say, 'Taste the chastisement of the burning- that, for what your hands have forwarded, and for that God is never unjust unto His servants.' (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 3:181-182). The same inimical attitude amongst the Jews is referred to by the Qur'an. 'The Jews have said, 'God's hand is fettered.' Fettered are their hands, and they are cursed for what they have said. Nay, but His hands are outspread; He expends how He will...' (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 5: 64). '....And when it is said to them, 'Expend of that God has provided you,' the unbelievers say to the believers, 'What, shall we feed such a one whom, if God willed, He would feed? You are only in manifest error!'' (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 36:47). The earlier followers of the prophet were reminded of not ascribing purity to themselves on their own. '....But for God's bounty to you and His mercy not one of you would have been pure ever; but God purifies whom He will; and God is All-hearing, All-knowing'. (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 24:21). Rather, the Qur'an cautions against the cardinal errors of ascribing being and having to oneself--- ordinarily or extraordinarily- 'And strike for them a similitude: two men. To one of them We assigned two gardens of vines, and surrounded them with palm-trees, and between them We set a sown field; each of the two gardens yielded its produce and failed naught in any wise; and We caused to gush amidst them a river. So he had fruit; and he said to his fellow, as he was conversing with him, 'I have more abundance of wealth than thou and am mightier in respect of men. And he entered his garden, wronging himself; he said, 'I do not think that this will ever perish; I do not think that the Hour is coming; and if I am indeed returned to my Lord, I shall surely find a better resort than this.' 18:35 Said his fellow, as he was conversing with him, 'What, disbelievest thou in Him who created thee of dust, then of a sperm-drop, then shaped thee as a man? But lo, He is God, my Lord, and I will not associate with my Lord any one. Why, when thou wentest into thy garden, didst thou not say, "As God will; there is no power except in God"? If thou seest me, that I am less than thou in wealth and children, yet it may be that my Lord will give me better than thy garden, and loose on it a thunderbolt out of heaven, so that in the morning it will be a slope of dust, or in the morning the water of it will be sunk into the earth, so that thou wilt not be able to seek it out.' 18:40 And his fruit was all encompassed, and in the morning he was wringing his hands for that he had expended upon it, and it was fallen down upon its trellises, and he was saying, 'Would I had not associated with my Lord any one!' But there was no host to help him, apart from God, and he was helpless. Thereover

protection belongs only to God the True; He is best rewarding, best in the issue. (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 18:32-44).

The denial of one's ontological nothingness could lead to ascribing divinity to one's own self, which is a Pharaonic sin. It is the sin of being. 'And Pharaoh said, 'Council, I know not that you have any god but me...' (Qur'an 28:38). Korah (Qar'un), on the other hand, committed the sin of having. 'Now Korah was of the people of Moses; he became insolent to them, for We had given him treasures such that the very keys of them were too heavy a burden for a company of men endowed with strength. When his people said to him, 'Do not exult; God loves not those that exult; but seek, amidst that which God has given thee, the Last Abode, and forget not thy portion of the present world; and do good, as God has been good to thee.' And seek not to work corruption in the earth; surely God loves not the workers of corruption.' He said, 'What I have been given is only because of a knowledge that is in me.' What, did he not know that God had destroyed before him generations of men stronger than he ill might, and more numerous in multitude? And yet the sinners shall not be questioned concerning their sins. So he went forth unto his people in his adornment. Those who desired the present life said, 'Would that we possessed the like of that Korah has been given! Surely he is a man of mighty fortune. But those to whom knowledge had been given said, 'Woe upon you! The reward of God is better for him who believes, and works righteousness; and none shall receive it except the steadfast.'

So We made the earth to swallow him and his dwelling and there was no host to help him, apart from God, and he was helpless; and in the morning those who had longed to be in his place the day before were saying, 'Ah, God outspreads and straitens His provision to whomsoever He will of His servants. Had God not been gracious to us, He would have made us to be swallowed too Ah, the unbelievers do not prosper, That is the Last Abode; We appoint it for those who desire not exorbitance in the earth, nor corruption. The issue ultimate is to the godfearing.' (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 28:76: 83). Thus, by dint of ascribing the amassed wealth to his knowledge, he wrought destruction at his own hands. He forgot that he essentially had no knowledge and it was God's Attribute of Knowledge (ilm), which was manifest in him. He falsely attributed God's Attribute of Knowledge to himself. He erred in failing to recognise the inhering of God and His Attributes within his own medium. The mode of prayers mentioned in the Qur'an, on the other hand, speaks volumes of man's consciousness of his ontological and ontical nothingness. The prayer of Moses is very significant in this context. '....and he said, 'O my Lord, surely I have need of whatever good Thou shalt have sent down upon me'. (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 28:24). It is precisely the reason that in consonance with the unity of God (tawhid), we say Masha'Allah (Allah has willed it), Insha'Allah (Allah willing), Alhamdulillah (All Praise is due to Allah), Subhan 'Allah (Glorious is Allah for being transcendent and immanent in simultaneity), wa maa tawfiqi 'ilaa bilaah (and my success

can come only from Allah) etc, which points towards the Omnipresent, Omniscient and Omnipotent Reality (God) working in our mediums. Everything is in the hands of God. All success (*nusrat*) and help (*madad*) comes from Him directly (outside the mediums) and indirectly (through the mediums). It takes place according to the Divine measures. Nothing happens without His leave either in the cosmos or in our selves. The attempt to hold even an atom, more or less, of one's being or having in one's own hands is spiritually self-defeating, which is tantamount to 'ascribing divinity to aught beside God.' Doesn't obedience (*bandagi*) essentially consist in divesting oneself- ontologically and ontically- of being (self) and having (possessions) that belong to Him? Realising the consciousness of one's ontological nothingness or ontological nonbeing (*faqir*) is as difficult as to fly without wings, says a Sufi. The reflective and contemplative aspects of the unity of God (*tawhid*) make one understand that God is Law itself, which is manifest in the Law of things. It assumes all forms of law. All things are subservient to His Law and thereby are reflections of His implicit Will. However, things in disobedience are deflections of His Will. But these deflections are ultimately in consonance with His implicit Will since He has willed freedom for Man. Man was granted freedom for without freedom goodness could not be created, which necessitated the possibility of evil. A man who starts actualizing the possibility of evil (committing wrongs), makes himself as a receptacle for God to start simultaneously manifesting Himself in His Attributes of *Al-Khafid* (The Abaser), *Al-Mudhill* (the Giver of Dishonour), *Al-Mumit* (The Destroyer), *Al-Muntaqim* (The Avenger), *Ad-Darr* (The Afflictor) and so forth since everything is 'locus of divine self-disclosure.' God is manifest in the simultaneity of His transcendence and immanence in man's whole activity including his ideas, feelings, words and acts.

The Qur'anic concept of the unity of God (*tawhid*) is realised in Man's submission to God (*bandagi*), which is constitutive of both worship and service. It is worshipping God in His transcendence and serving Him in His immanence. 'I have not created jinn and mankind except to serve Me. I desire of them no provision, neither do I desire that they should feed Me. Surely God is the All-provider, the Possessor of Strength, the Ever-Sure' (Qur'an 51:56-58). The ritualistic psyche of the religionists is more attuned to worship, and here even, without any inkling of a direct contact with God and, at times, even becoming oblivious of His service in the real sense. It considers relationships with the cosmos including man as merely ethical or moral. It is unmindful of the fact that there are no ethical or moral concerns as such. They are theomorphic since God is manifest in all mediums. Our essential commitment is not with these mediums but with the transcendent God who, in His immanence, is manifest in each one of them. They are real concerns of the Reality (God) since God contemplates

Himself in all forms. He desires no provision or feeding at our hands because of His transcendence, but He desires that we should serve Him in His immanence in forms of the requirements of the mediums in which He manifests Himself. A holy tradition (hadith qudsi), whose spiritual import essentially is realized by the friends of God, beautifully expresses the aforesaid point: "Allah will say on the Day of Resurrection: O son of Adam, I fell ill and you visited Me not. He will say: O Lord, and how should I visit You when You are the Lord of the worlds? He will say: Did you not know that My servant So-and-so had fallen ill and you visited him not? Did you not know that had you visited him you would have found Me with him? O son of Adam, I asked you for food and you fed Me not. He will say: O Lord, and how should I feed You when You are the Lord of the worlds? He will say: Did you not know that My servant So-and-so asked you for food and you fed him not? Did you not know that had you fed him you would surely have found that with Me? O son of Adam, I asked you to give Me to drink and you gave Me not to drink. He will say: O Lord, how should I give You to drink when You are the Lord of the worlds? He will say: My servant So-and-so asked you to give him to drink and you gave him not to drink. Had you given him to drink you would have surely found that with Me." Thus, there are no human rights. All rights are Divine, whether within the mediums or beyond the mediums. Giving charity to a poor person, for example, is not an ethical or moral act but essentially is a loving gift to God, who is cloaked in the form of need and poverty. It is an act of love. But how could one gift God when one is himself in the state of ontological nothingness or in the state of ontological nonbeing since Being wholly belongs to God? It is the Spirit gifting the Spirit. A person, who only sees the poor man, without recognising God in him, and simultaneously failing to recognise God in his own self, has no real and experiential understanding of the unity of God (tawhid). One has to constantly remember that it is the transcendent God who assumes all immanent forms and essentially acts within them. A man who dies does not act. It is because the Spirit (Ruh) of the Lord (Rabb) breathed in his medium is withdrawn. 'They will question thee concerning the Spirit. Say: 'The Spirit is of the bidding of my Lord (*qul al-ruh min amri Rabbi*). You have been given of knowledge nothing except a little.' (Qur'an 17:85). The Spirit inheres in every man. 'It is in him but is not his.' It is the Divine Essence, says the tradition. Essentially, the Spirit (Ruh) worships and serves in itself and for itself.

The one, who apprehends the subtle aspects of 'contemplative tawhid' in consonance with the teachings of the Qur'an, plainly exposes the error of ascribing divinity (ilah) to anything beside God ('shirk). 'God forgives not that aught should be with Him associated; less than that He forgives to

whomsoever He will. Whoso associates with God anything has indeed forged a mighty sin'. (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 4:48). 'And when Lokman said to his son, admonishing him, 'O my son, do not associate others with God; to associate others with God is a mighty wrong'. (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 31:13). It is called heinous transgression (*zulmun azeem*) because it tends to displace divinity with otherness. To ascribe divinity (ilah) to a thing: material, human, celestial, etc is placing divinity beside the Divine (*shirk*). Reality belongs to the Divine. It is a wrong idea to juxtapose the human and the Divine. 'And the most part of them believe not in God, but they associate other gods with Him' (Qur'an: translated by A. J. Arberry, 12:106). The attempt to 'ascribe divinity to aught beside God' consists in subtracting from the Reality (God) and correspondingly adding it to nothingness, which is not possible. It has to be recognized that One (*Ahad*) is not a quantitative number but is essentially qualitative. It is the symbol of Wholeness. It symbolises Unity, which manifests in multiplicity. It has been aptly said that the act of ascribing 'divinity to aught beside God' or otherness (*shirk*) is not denotative for there is nothing beside God, which could be pointed out, as such. One could only talk of pseudo-relations with 'divinity to aught beside God', which are merely connotative. The metaphysics of the unity of God (*tawhid*) essentially teaches us that God, 'the Indivisible One- and-Only is the One-And-All'. The clerics, however, under the spell of modernism, constrict the metaphysical concept of the unity of God (*tawhid*) and thereby falter in flattening the concept of 'ascribing divinity to aught beside God' (*shirk*), and irresponsibly apply it ignorantly or arrogantly to even those who do not associate or ascribe any parallel power to God in faltering forms of self-subsistence, independence and autonomy, and who, in fact, wholeheartedly ascribe the source of all power in wholesomeness to God. It is equally true of all the Divine Attributes, whose source they acknowledge as the Reality (God). God manifests in all the mediums and in all the worlds. Those who die in the Way of God, for example, are not dead but alive beyond the comprehension of (ordinary) consciousness (but within the ambit of knowledge) and they get their sustenance from their Lord. (Qur'an:2:154; 3: 169). God endows them with spiritual powers (components of sustenance) to establish linkages with the terrestrial world and act in consonance with His Will. The relevance of their life to the terrestrial beings is understood by the ones committed to the spiritual plane. Ordinary eye has no access to the spiritual realities. It is essentially 'eye of the heart', which witnesses the working of the Divine in the realms beyond the manifest. Thus, Spirituality manifests a higher and deeper understanding of the subtleties, perplexities, and antinomies of 'contemplative *tawhid*' than religiosity, which merely remains peripheral.

Khawaja Ghulam Farid's *Diwan-i-Farid*, a masterpiece of literature, is essentially gnostic in essence.

It principally mirrors the doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud) in poetic form. It fosters the principle of 'unity in diversity' by 'reflecting the Face of the Beloved' in all forms. Love and gnosis are its ever recurring themes. Search of transcendence, in order to realise vision and union, remains its foremost concern. It enlightens us on the cultural expressions of the metaphysical values of truth, knowledge, freedom, goodness, beauty and love. He considers knowledge as veiled unless transformed into gnosis by virtue of love. Love is suffering but the alchemy of suffering transmutes the base metal into gold. It leads to the realisation of 'the Supreme Identity'. Khawaja Ghulam Farid, poet-metaphysician, essentially chooses the gnostic mode of poetry (*kafi*) based on 'raags' and 'raginis' mainly, 'raag bahervi,' and many others including 'raag talang,' 'raag malkons,' 'raag jog', 'raag malhar', 'raag pahari' and 'raag jonepuri,' to express terrestrial and celestial truths. His understanding of musicology adds creative dimensions to traditional music. He unveils the multi-dimensional beauty and richness of the traditional Saraiki language. His subtle use of words, idioms and proverbs also manifests deeper understanding of his oral tradition, which he deepens to its infinite depths. His commitment with the oral tradition remains primordial in spite of its being reduced to writing. He also beautifies Saraiki culture, which is a fertile ground for nurturing different facets of traditional art. He understands his times and envisions a creative change in the lot of people. He points to the integration of the individual with the society. His poetry gives light of hope against the darkness of despair. He is deeply rooted in his own soil but the purport of his message is universal. He remains down to earth but simultaneously soars higher in the heavens. His linguistic and cultural contributions, among other things, are a great asset of the world culture. He is the world poet.

My trilogy on *Diwan-i-Farid* starts with *The Metaphysics of Khawaja Ghulam Farid* (Suhail Academy Lahore, 2009). The present work is a sequel to my earlier work of translating Khawaja Ghulam Farid's *Diwan-i-Farid* into English prose, titled: *The Message of Diwan-i-Farid* (Suhail Academy Lahore, 2009) whose original text and translation have been kept intact except for a few changes here and there. The expression lover has been understood at times in the feminine sense and at times in the masculine one. The verses of the Diwan, in my current work, have been explained for fostering a plain understanding of the doctrines without going deep into the technicalities of metaphysics and its realisation as done elsewhere in my works. It has essentially been one of my inmost concerns to facilitate an understanding of Khawaja Ghulam Farid's experience of 'love and gnosis' and thereby his attainment of 'deliverance and union' within the traditional matrix. It has been primarily written

for the searching souls who may feel inspired to walk in the tracks of the Sufi tradition, and contribute further in heightening and deepening the Gnostic consciousness through their intellectual and spiritual endeavours. It was by the Grace of God that after almost completing my work at hand, I experienced the holy presence of Khawaja Ghulam Farid in my dream/vision in continuation of my earlier dream/vision of him a few years back. He was amidst a few blessed souls. It was so enlightening to hear reference to one of his 'kafis' in the celestial spheres in an atmosphere saturated with Gnostic love. It has heightened my reverence for the great Sufi and deepened my commitment with his *Diwan-i-Farid*.

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Divan & Farid

Translation & Commentary

*272 Kafis Of
Khwaja Ghulam Farid
A Sufi-Mystic Poet*

Kafi-1

سر بارڈ کھاں دا چایا

اج سانو لڑے مکالمیا

“My charming beloved is bidding me farewell today. I
have taken the burden of sufferings on my head.”

Ka'bah symbolises God's Presence. The House is lively due to its inmate who is Life itself. The pilgrim develops a relationship of intimacy with the dweller otherwise without a dweller, a mere dwelling is desolation. The charming dwelling, personifying God, is bidding farewell to the pilgrim. A farewell at the hands of one's beloved creates immense suffering. It is a unique form of farewell with all its pathos, which is so burdensome. It is not mental pain of losing an object but suffering of parting from one's beloved. All suffering is essentially spiritual. The road to love is characterised by temporary separations and unions, which deepen love and prepares one to have an ultimate union with the beloved. A ritual is a bridge between the lover and the beloved. Rituals devoid of love are mechanical, perfunctory and lifeless leading to ritualism. A ritualistic behaviour is lost to outwardness at the expense of inwardness. Rituals are not ends in themselves but are means for the realisation of the beloved dwelling in the human heart. Heart essentially symbolises the House of God. The spiritual climax of every ritual is to initiate and foster a direct contact with the beloved, who resides in the inmost chambers of one's heart.

ہر عیب کنوں ہے خالی
جیں جو منگیا سو پایا

اے قبلہ اقدس عالی
اتھ عبد عبید سوا لی

“The sacred and supreme House of God is free from all imperfections. Here, God’s bondsmen of higher and lower ranks, become recipients in consonance with their asking.”

The House of God, symbolising the spiritual, is perfect. It is universal and thereby free from all social and cultural delimitations. The discriminations of sex, colour, class or castes are not there. It does not recognize even an iota of material differentiations since it primarily addresses to the spiritual nature of humanity. It has a spiritual programme for the entire mankind to be realised by any one who chooses to become its votary in consonance with ‘the ultimate nature of things’. It admits both the virtuous and the sinners in its small and big gatherings. The ‘servant-Lord axis’ is the starting point of spiritual life. The postures of servanthood, nonbeing or nothingness imply the Lord, Being or the Essence itself respectively. The Divine blessings are infinite and no finite receptacle can exhaust them. Intention is the key to the Divine Treasure. Here, all the receptacles in consonance with their inner reach are blessed accordingly. A person who is merely outward remains at the periphery as compared to the one who absorbs the sea in the drop of his inwardness.

وہ حرم اللہ محرم	وہ امن اللہ معظم
ہے رحمت داسرماہ	وہ بیت اللہ مکرم

“I laud the peace of Divine Majesty. I laud the sacred sanctuary of Allah. I laud the venerable House of Allah. It is the treasury of blessings.”

The majesty, sacredness and veneration of the House of God, both inward and outward, symbolises the absolute and the Infinite, which is a great blessing. There cannot be real universal peace unless the human accepts the Divine. The negation of the sacred tends to profane everything. Going beyond oneself creates the spirit of veneration hardly experienced by the modern man lost in the world of human finitude. There is no blessing greater than the one, which

shows the strife ridden humanity the way to principled, real and lasting peace on ‘the human planet’.

اے نور سیاہ مجسم ہے عین سوادِ الا عظم
تھیا بے شک آ من بے غم جو حرم احاطے آیا

“The light embodied in the black covering (of the House of God) demonstrates the unity of the entire Ummah (it symbolizes the principle of unity in diversity). Undoubtedly, the seeker of peace, who enters the compound of the sanctuary, becomes free from sorrow.”

The blackly embodied light symbolises the ‘abysmal darkness of the Essence itself’. It points to the Principle and its Manifestation. The principle of unity in diversity unifies the entire creation. It is the metaphysical principle of uniting mankind. The seeker of universal peace finds contentment in embracing the principle within, which guarantees world peace.

کر یاد حرم کوں رکھ پیش پُرانے غم کوں
دل آکھے کھانواں سم کوں ہے جیون کوڑا جیا

“My sense of primordial sorrow has heightened by remembering the compound of the House of God. My heart prompts me to take bane for (mere) life is false and meaningless.”

The dawning realisation of the pilgrim’s separation increases the sense of his primordial loss, which keeps him so sorrowful. The transcendent and immanent reality of the beloved is his existential truth grounded in pure objectivity. The beloved is his ‘ultimate concern’, which permeates his relative concerns. He considers his life false and meaningless unless it is spent in union with his beloved.

ہن واگاں وطن ولایاں لکھ مونیجھ مونجھاریاں آیاں

دل سچڑیاں پیتاں لایاں ول میلیں بار خدا یا

“Now, I am turning the reins toward my native town (returning back). I am in grip of countless states of anguishes. My heart has cultivated true ties of love. My God! Make me revisit the place.”

He is returning to his ordinary self filled with great anguish, after his spiritual sojourn. His heart has contracted true love. He prays to God to grant him recurring spiritual openings.

دل دلبر کیتے سکے گھر شہر بازار نہ ملے
وچ کھوسوں طوف دے دھکے ول جنیکر بخت بھڑایا

“My heart is desirous of my beloved. It does not find breathing space in the house, city or lane. I will again realise the strokes of circumambulation in case fortune smiles on me.”

His heart is so desirous of his beloved that it has ceased to have worldly ties. It will be very lucky if it gets an occasion to make spiritual effort in finding his beloved, who resides in the depths of his heart. His life is in inwardness.

بن یار ”فرید“ نجر سہاں رت رو رو آہیں کر سہاں
غم کھا کھا اوڑک مر سہاں ڈکھ ڈکھڑیں جیڑا تایا

“Farid! I will enervate without my beloved. I will heave sighs of distress, while crying bitterly. I will ultimately die by constantly bearing sorrowfulness. The sufferings have made my self fiery.”

He suffers tremendously and has overbearing sorrows without his friend because his whole life is attached to him. His beloved is not one of his many concerns but is his only concern. All attachments are shades of his real attachment. All his commitments have a meaning in reference to his inward commitment.

Kafi-2

انہد مرلی شور چایا

“The divine flute has created percussion.”

Human person is a flute in the hands of the Divine. Self-realisation points towards the infinite wealth buried beneath the ordinary human self. It is musical both in form and content. The modern man has lost the wherewithal of this ‘hidden treasure.’ One who knows how to play this flute is bewildered by the creativity and fineness of its musical its tunes.

عقل فکر سب فہم گمائے	گرنے پورے بید بتائے
سارا سفر عروج سمجھایا	مدہوشی و بچہ ہوش سکھائے

“My spiritual master communicated to me esoterism in fullness. He made my reason, reflection and entire understanding dwindle into insignificance. He taught me sobriety in drunkenness. He enlightened me on the ascending stages of spiritual journey.”

His murshid communicated to him the whole of esoterism both in its doctrinal aspects and the ways of realisation. He made him understand the entire way, so that he could be mentally prepared about encountering different stages during his spiritual voyage. He was taught the subtleties of intellectual intuition and the ultimate identity of knowledge and being. He was educated on the limitations of reason, reflection and ordinary understanding during the course of his spiritual journey. He learnt the lessons of sobriety in drunkenness from him. The light and love of God during the spiritual experience is so overwhelming that he made him

conscious of sifting the real from the illusory. He was cautioned regarding the need of making spiritual efforts in returning back to the domain of everyday experience in order to resume his normal activity. He had to rediscover his new being with a sublime sense of personal identity.

وحدت عین عیان ڈھوسے طمس حقیقی سمجھ لیوسے
مخفی کل اظہار تھیوسے ہر گن گیان دے گیت نوں پایا

“I have witnessed Oneness as openly manifest. I have understood the reality of annihilation. All hidden has become seeable. I have realised, each and every tune (degree) of virtuousness and gnosis.”

The doctrine of Oneness is not merely a theoretical truth but is undergone by virtue of spiritual experience. It is a genuine experience, which lends certainty, factualness and verifiableness to the metaphysical truth. Metaphysical truth is followed by a corresponding metaphysical realisation. He entirely realises the truth of Oneness in his inwardness. The hidden realities become manifest. The reality of annihilation lays bare before him. It is a process of re-creation wherein everything is annihilated and re-created in simultaneity. The movement is so swift that it gives the illusion of stability to things. Things are devoid of being and at every moment they plunge into nothingness. Everything perishes at each moment except the Face of God.

تھئے واضح مشہود د قائق تھئے لائح انوار حقائق
ظاہر گچھ سب کچھ دے لائق قُرب تے بُعد وافر ق اُٹھایا

“The subtleties of existence have opened up. The lights of realities have become perceptible. The visible and the Invisible are capable of being understood. The difference between proximity and remoteness has withered away.”

The mystery of existence is revealed to him. Ordinary existence is a veil to the metaphysics of existence. Spatio-

temporal order curtains real existence. The curtain has been lifted and the ordinary dimensions of space and time have vanished. The perception of near and far is not absolute. It is relative to a specific spatio-temporal order. His experience of Oneness has been from the absolute dimension, which has obliterated all the relative differentiations, which are essentially provisional in nature.

بنی خوب بتایاں باتاں لچھڑے راز انوکھیاں گھاتاں
گم تھیاں کوڑیاں ذات صفاتاں ”لمن الملک“ دادورہ آیا

“The flute has successfully unravelled the reality of deeper secrets and novel stations. The dawning realisation of His Omnipotence has led to the privation of false existents and their properties.”

It is by virtue of turning his being into a flute that the Reality unveils before him. The unveiling of the Omnipotent Reality leads him to directly experience the ephemeral nature of the world. Everything is powerless in Face of the Power itself. How could a powerless thing claim existence? There is no self-subsistent reality except the Absolute.

خمر طہوروں پی پیانے تھیوے عاشق مست ریگانے
بھل گئے صوم صلوٰۃ دو گانے رندی مشرب سانگ رسایا

“We have become matchless enraptured lovers after drinking from the cups of pure wine. We have transcended fasting and ritualistic prayer and adopted an inebriate mode of expression.”

Pure wine enraptures their love of the Divine to the extent that they transcend ritual modes of existence. They see the Real with the eye of the Real. They reach their destination. Farewell to the milestones. Farewell to the rituals. Their inebriate mode of existence is a scandal for the illusory eye. It is an ordinary eye, which cannot perceive the extra-ordinary. It lacks the perception of their spiritual state. Their inward

determines their outward. Only a spiritual eye perceives them in their own right.

جانے کون گنوار مقلد وہ وہ ریت مقدس جتید
تھی مطلق بے قید موحّد سبھ صورت وچ آپ سما یا

“How can an unenlightened person bereft of gnosis know the laudable, holy and powerful tradition (of Oneness of Being)? The One is identified with Freedom Itself without delimitation. He has descended in all forms.”

A person bereft of gnosis cannot understand the tradition of Oneness of Being. His perception, conception and imagination are delimited. He is constrained to perceive, conceive and imagine the Reality in reference to his own spatio-temporal apparatus ingrained in his mind. He is condemned to consider all provisional polarisations as final. He lacks the metaphysical perspective to perceive the One as identified with Freedom itself. He is a loss to understand that if the Reality were not delimited by descending in each form then it would have suffered delimitation by virtue of its being Pure Freedom. It is to exercise Pure and absolute freedom that the Reality has to delimit itself.

جب ہک رمز ملی توحیدوں دل آزاد ڈتھم تقلیدوں
تھی کر فرد، فرید! فریدوں سری روحی وعظ سنایا

“My heart was freed from merely following the letter of law after getting a clue of Oneness. Farid! The individual by ceasing to be— narrated the sermon: My essentiality is Spirit.”

He has been following the letter of law. His sense-perception and reason had delimited him. He was constrained to remain tied with the outward. His ideas, feelings, discourses and actions were all tied to the crust. He had no access to the inward. It was a spiritually decisive moment of his life that his heart was blessed with a clue of Oneness. It

was a spiritual blessing, which made him realise his own nothingness in the Face of God. The Spirit (Reality or God) within him had taken over his medium and declared that the Reality within his human overlay was essentially the Spirit. It was an experience, which not only led him to experience his own nonbeing but it also made him experience the Spirit, which is essentially in 'him' but is not his.

Kafi-3

بن دلبر شکل جهان آیا ہر صورت عین عیان آیا

“My beloved has manifested in the form of the outward. He has become openly manifest in each form.”

The doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud) with its corresponding realisation sees the universe including Man as the manifestation of the Absolute and the Infinite. It considers all polarisations as provisional and essentially devoid of being. The metaphysical reality of nothingness constitutes those Possibilities, which have not taken the form of Names or Attributes. To consider the world as absolutely cut off from the Absolute or God is erroneous and is the product of ordinary thinking, which creates an unbridgeable gulf between subject and object. It is metaphysical thought, which posits the possibility of identity between knowledge and being. The beloved has taken the shape of the world and openly manifests in every form.

کتھے آدمؑ تے کتھے شیثؑ نبی کتھے نوحؑ کتھاں طوفان آیا

“He has manifested in Adam at times and at times in the Prophet Sheesh. His manifestation has been at times in Nuh and at times in the Flood.”

He manifests in the form of the Prophets as well in the appearance of cosmic events like ‘the Great Flood.’ There are degrees of His manifestations. He manifests to a greater degree in Man and to much a higher in Perfect Man. His manifestation in any cosmic event is a truth dealt with traditional cosmologies. The universe does not stand in

opposition to Him as ‘other’ but reflects Him as if in a mirror.

کتھے ابراہیمؑ خلیل نبی کتھے یوسفؑ وچ کنعان آیا

“He has manifested at times in the Prophet Ibrahim, the friend of God, and at times in Yousaf of Canaan.”

He manifests Himself in forms of prophecy and friendship. He figures in knowledge, sentiment and human interactions.

کتھے عیسیٰؑ تے الیاس نبی کتھے پچھمن رام تے کان آیا

“He has manifested at times in Isa and the Prophet Ilyas and at times in Lachman Ram and Kaan.”

His manifestation is not restricted to any one tradition. He has manifested Himself in all traditions of the world including the Hindu tradition.

کتھے ذکر یا کتھے یحییٰؑ ہے کتھے موسیٰؑ بن عمران آیا

“He has manifested at times in Zachariah and at times in Younis. His manifestation has been at times in Musa bin Imran.”

His manifestation has been in the Prophets, their ancestors and their progeny in varying degrees.

بو بکرؓ عمرؓ عثمانؓ کتھاں کتھے اسد اللہؓ ذیشان آیا

“He has manifested at times in Abu Bakr, Umar and Uthman. His manifestation has been at times in the glorious lion of God.”

He has manifested in the form of the four friends of the Prophet. How one can detest any one of these forms where He has manifested Himself in such a high degree? The truthfulness of these friends has been verified by virtue of spiritual experience. The historical accounts regarding the conflict between the Household of the Prophet and his foremost Companions after the death of the Prophet lack

wider perspectives. It was not a conflict between good and evil but it was a divergence between different shades of rightness. They all deserve reverence. It is spiritually fatal to show disrespect to any one of them.

کتھے حسنؑ حسینؑ شہید بنے کتھے مرشد فخر جہان آیا

“He has manifested at times in the martyrs, Hasan and Husayn, and at times in Fakhr-e-Jehan, my spiritual master.”

It was for the time that a conflict between good and evil took place between Husayn and Yezid respectively. He ‘embraced martyrdom’ in the form of Hasan and Husayn. He is eternal but manifest in the temporal. He experiences transcendence and immanence in simultaneity. He cloaks in the form of his murshid Fakhr Jehan.

کتھے احمد شاہ رسولان دا محبوب سبھے مقبولان دا
استاد نفوس عقولان دا سلطاناں سرسلطان آیا

“He has manifested at times in Ahmad: the vanguard of the Messengers, the beloved of all the illustrious, the preceptor of selves and intellects and the sovereign of the sovereigns.”

His manifestation in the form of Ahmad has been of the highest degree. He has manifested Himself perfectly in the perfect form of Ahmad. He has contemplated Himself fully in Ahmad’s mirror of the heart. It is He who came in the form of Ahmad and did all wonders.

تنزیل کتھاں، جبریل کتھاں توریت زبور انجیل کتھاں
آیات کتھاں تزیل کتھاں حق باطل دا فرقان آیا

“He has manifested at times in Revelation and at times in Gabriel. His manifestation has been at times in Torah, David Psalms and New Testament. He has manifested at times in verses and at times in their recital. His manifestation has been at times in the discernment between truth and falsehood.”

It is His manifestation in the whole process of religious revelation including the Archangel Gabriel. It is His Divine Speech, which takes the form of Scriptures. It is His manifestation at a certain level, which discerns the true from the false.

کل شے وچ کل شے ظاہر ہے سوہنا ظاہر عین مظاہر ہے
کتھے ناز نیاز داماہر ہے کتھے درد کتھاں درمان آیا

“The Whole illuminates the individual aspects. The Beautiful has manifested itself and has assumed an open form of manifestation. He masterly manifests at times in priding and humility. His manifestation at times is in pain and at times in alleviation.”

The Whole lights up everything. It embraces totality. There is nothing outside it otherwise it cannot be metaphysically termed as ‘the Whole’. Beauty itself in its outward form is so openly manifest. He manifests in pride and humility and in pain and its alleviation. He manifests in all things and events---positive and negative--- and nothing can be excluded from it. If His manifestation is a mystery, then His supposed ‘non manifestation’ is a greater mystery because He is ‘the metaphysical Whole’ and nothing can be excluded from it.

کتھے ریت پریت داویس کرے کتھے عاشق تھی پردیس پھرے
کتھے گل وچ مارو کیس دھرے لٹ دھاری تھی مستان آیا

“He manifests at times in the tradition of love and at times as lover wandering in alien lands. His manifestation at times is in bewitching dishevelled locks around the neck and in the enraptured one with flowing hair.”

He is not partially inward or partially outward but He is absolutely the Inward and totally the Outward. Reason finds it so scandalous. It is the doctrine of Oneness and it is its

realisation, by virtue of Intellectual intuition, that makes the metaphysical truth dawn on the percipient.

کتھے پنڈت جوسی جوگی ہے کتھے سامی تے کتھے بھوگی ہے
کتھے مصربراگی روگی ہے کتھے بید بیاس گیان آیا

“He manifests at times as Hindu metaphysician, astrologer and ascetic and at times as religious and at times as worldly. His manifestation is at times as doctor, ascetic and sick and at times as Vedic, Brahman and Knowledge.”

He manifests in all forms including positive and negative. The religious consciousness may give a concession in accepting His manifestation in positive forms but finds it highly appalling in attributing His manifestation in negative forms. It fails to understand, for instance, that how could the One, who Himself bestows health manifest in the negative form of a sick person.

خاموش ”فرید“ اسرار کنوں چپ بیہودہ گفتار کنوں
پر غافل نہ تھی یار کنوں اہبولار بی فرمان آیا

“Farid! Remain silent and do not disclose these mysteries. You should desist from such outrageous discourse. But, never be oblivious of your friend. Such a (Divine) decree has been made beyond a shadow of a doubt.”

He stops short of disclosing these mysteries, which seem so outrageous to ordinary understanding. He reminds the votaries of their foremost duty of never being oblivious of their friend, which is a doubtless decree of the Qur'an. The possibility of friendship with God is readily realised by spiritual consciousness but seems abhorrent to the religious one. The religious psyche remains tied to the relative master-slave polarity and considers it as absolute. The question of a slave loving his master does not arise. The vocation of a slave is just to follow the commandments of his master out of fear

for the punishment inflicted upon him if he does otherwise. Friendship with God takes one to a realm where one stands before Him not 'in fear and trembling' but in love and poise. He only fears the disruption of his friendly relationship with God, which is qualitatively different from ordinary fear and the religious one. Good is, in the spiritual sense, what fosters friendship and evil is what severs it. Doctrines, rituals and morals essentially become lively in the situation of love and friendship.

Kafi-4

تھی تابع خلقت سب تاں وی کیا تھی پیا
ہئی گم تھیوں مطلب

“If the entire creation is subjected to you, then even what? The meaning lies in thy ceasing to be (the state of supreme identity or the realized consciousness of your ontological nothingness in the Face of the Absolute).”

What is the ultimate significance of even subjecting the entire creation to oneself? What is the meaning of life? It is not reflected in the power one has over things and events. It does not lie in outward achievements. The attainment of the cosmic purpose of existence lies in realising one's ontological nothingness in the 'Face of the Absolute' or God. It is the whole meaningful endeavour of life. Things could be meaningful on other criteria but anything short of it becomes meaningless on this absolute, supreme and ultimate criterion. It is the litmus test of the entire human activity.

٪ ارشدار شاد تو نہیں و خچ پہنتا عجم عرب
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“If you're intellectual discourse has made an impact on Arabia and Persia, then even what.”

If the impact of one's intellectual widespread discourse has no eternal bearing then what is its value? The earthly fame will fade away in contrast to one's ceaseless subsistence in the Divine Consciousness.

پڑھ پڑھ بید پران صحائف پیا سکھیوں علم ادب
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“If you have been seeking knowledge and reverential conduct by the study of Vedas, Puranas (sacred writings of Hindus) and Scriptures, then even what?”

Gaining of Scriptural knowledge, learning and reverential conduct are a nullity as compared to one's original vocation of union with the beloved.

سارے جگتے حکم چلانویں پاشاہی دام نصب
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“If you exercise sovereign authority, by virtue of you're royal status, then even what.”

A person gets possessed by the very thing he possess. There is no end to one's yearning for subjugation. One's achievements on the spectrum of time have no value unless they are transformed into eternity. How one's masterly gains could measure up to being a realised possibility of the Divine Essence?

دنیا دے وچ عزت پاتو گیوں عقیقی نال طرب
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“If you command respect in the temporal world and go happily to the eternal one, then even what.”

The religious consciousness is content with being happy in both the worlds. What is the significance of one's being happy in this world and the life hereafter without achieving the spiritual station of servanthood?

سنی پاکتے حنفی مذہب رکھیو صوفی دام شرب
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“If you are pure Sunni, belonging to the Hanifi tradition and committed to the Sufi Path, then even what.”

One's being pure Sunni and a Sufi only attains mystic realisation. The ultimate goal is to achieve metaphysical realisation.

وچ آثار، افعال، صفاتیں
جے یار گھدوئی لہجے
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“If your search of finding your friend manifest in forms of signs, activity and attributes has become fructuous, then even what.”

If one has discovered his friend in the outward, then even it has no significance as compared to uniting with the Being itself in the state of nonduality.

غوٹی قطبی، رتبہ پایو
تھیوں شیوخ لقب
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“If you have achieved the level of ‘Ghaus’ and Pole, entitled as Master of the Masters, then even what.”

The attainment of higher spiritual stations is nothing in front of gaining the paradise of the Essence.

شعر ”فرید“ ۛ اوج بلیا
ہند ماڑ ڈکھن پورب
تاں وی کیا تھی پیا

“Farid! If your poetry has become renowned in Hind, Marwar, South and East (all regions), then even what.”

He questions the value of the recognition of his poetry far and wide, when weighed against his realising the possibility of namelessness.

Kafi-5

تیرے نیناں تیر چلایا تیری رمزاں شور مچایا

“Your eyes shot arrows (prompted moves). Your expressions impregnated with mysteries made percussions.”

The Essence manifests itself in the form of the beloved to make love possible. His eyes have captured many a souls. His mysterious expressions have left a deep impact on the lovers.

المست ہزار مرایا لکھ عاشق مار گنوا یا

“You made numerous enraptured ones eliminated and got countless lovers wiped out.”

He has got countless enraptured lovers lose their lives for his sake. His love is so mesmerising that the lovers submit to him in fullness. They do not listen to the voice of reason. The ordinary considerations of the world have no meaning in their eyes. They are in such a state of intoxication that laying down their lives for their beloved does not matter.

ابراہیمؑ اڑا ہ اڑایو باربر ہوں سر چایا

“You flung Ibrahim -- whose being had been permeated by love -- in the blazing fire and made him bear the burden of love.”

He made the Prophet Ibrahim saturated with love. He made him carry the onerous burden of love and finally flung him in the blazing fire. He saved him from being torched by the physical fire by turning it into a garden but consumed him completely in the fire of love.

صابر دے تن کیڑے بچھے موسیٰ طور جلایا

“You made worms germinate in the body of Ayub and in front of Musa burnt the mount Tur (by the reflection of your Light).”

He tested the patience of the Prophet Ayub in different ways till his body was germinated with worms. He was not unmindful of him for a single moment when he was undergoing these ordeals for the sake of his beloved. He bestowed upon him countless blessings including reunion with his family but after he had undergone such spiritual tests. The Prophet Musa in a state of deep love wanted to see him. He made him fall down in a swoon after seeing the mount Tur burn with a reflection of his Light. The insatiable quest of seeing him with naked eye kept burning Musa till the end of his life. He kept quiet because of His Majesty, but his burning love kept on questioning the impossibility of his seeing the Reality with his physical eye.

زکریا کلو ترچر ایو یحییٰ گھوٹ کو ہایا

“You sawed Zechariah in the saw and slaughtered Yahya in the prime of his youth.”

He raised the status of the House of Imran by virtue of its purity and love. He sawed the Prophet Zechariah, who loved him from the core of his heart and had taken so much care of Maryam. He responded to his prayer and granted him a son. He named him as Yahya and also made him a Prophet. He slaughtered him when he was so young.

یونس پیٹ مچھی دے پایو نوح طوفان لڑھایا

“You caused Younis’ entry in the body of ‘the great fish’ and made Nuh face the torments of the Flood.”

He made the Prophet Younis enter body of ‘the great fish’ after he had left his community because it was not paying heed to his beloved. He saved him and sent him back and he won them on his side. Such are the ordeals of love. He made

the Prophet Nuh face constant hardships and sarcasm from his near and dear ones for such a long time and finally made him face the torments of flood. He did not accede to his request for pardoning his dead son for he was not from his spiritual progeny (Aal) since his actions were not virtuous (Ghair salih). The Prophet Nuh loved his son much and had deepest fatherly attachment with him but the Divine reprimand filled his heart with the overpowering love of the Divine to the extent that the love of his son faded away completely and he reiterated his resolve to act according to the Divine Will.

شاہ حسنؑ کوں شہر مدینے زہر داجام پلایا

“You made the regal Hasan drink the cup of poison in the city of Medina.”

The story of love does not end with the Prophets but embraces lovers from all eons and countries. He made Hasan, the grandson of the Prophet of Islam, die by administering him the cup of poison. Earlier, his love had made him abdicate the alienable Caliphate. If the oath of allegiance (bay’ah) had been imposed on him by Muawiyah, then, ‘Karbala’ would have occurred there and then.

کربلاؤچ تیغ چلا کر ایڑھا کیس کرایا

“You caused a colossal tragedy by demonstrating swordsmanship at Karbala.”

Yezid departed from the tradition of the earlier Caliphs of Islam and decided to impose the oath of allegiance (bay’ah) on Husayn in order to make the Imamate subaltern to the Caliphate. Husayn’s love for his beloved made him stand in ‘Karbala’ against it. The Divine caused a colossal tragedy in which, Husayn and those along with him underwent great sufferings and ultimately sacrificed their lives for him.

شمس الحق دی کھل کھلایو سرمد سر کپوایا

“You made Shams, the truthful one, skinned alive and Sarmad’s head chopped off.”

He made his intoxicated lovers Shams and Sarmad face such brutalities. When Shams addressed a dead boy and said ‘kumbe-iznil-lah’ (come to life by the order of Allah), the dead boy did not rise but when he said ‘kumbe-izni’ (come to life by my order) the dead boy came to life but Shams was skinned alive because of being blasphemous. It was the Divine who, to a higher degree in the medium of Shams, granted life to the dead boy. When Sarmad, the naked martyr, denied the physical ascension of the Prophet to the heavens on the ground that the heavens resided in him; remained nude for inviting people to search the naked truth within him; supported Dara Shikoh’s spirituality against Aurangzeb’s religiosity bereft of inwardness and frequently recited a portion of the first Shahadah, there is no ilah (self-subsistent reality) meaning thereby that one could not go to the stage of affirmation before realising negation; the Divine made the head of Sarmad chopped off by those who did not understand the reality of his God-intoxicated love and the deeper meanings of his acts.

مستی سانگ رسایا

شاہ منصور چڑھایو سولی

“You caused the enraptured state and crucified Mansur, the Master.”

He enraptured Mansur, who had attained the consciousness of his ontological nothingness, and crucified him. He had taken over his medium. It was the Divine who said ‘I am the Truth’ (Ana’l Haqq) from his tongue.

سو سوناڑ ڈکھایا

مجنوں کارن لیلیٰ ہو کر

“You became Layla and exhibited countless prides for the sake of Majnun.”

He is Love itself, which is polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved. It was His manifestation as lover in Majnun and as beloved in Layla. It was His prideful

expression in the form of Layla that bewitched Him in the form of Majnun.

خسرو تے فرہاد دے کارن شیریں نام دھرایا

“You named yourself Shireen for the sake of Khusru and Farhad.”

He took the beloved form of Shireen, which attracted Farhad to love. It was His presence in his form, which performed extraordinary feats beyond the human.

درد ابار اٹھایا ہرک اپنا وقت نبھایا

“The burden of pain was shared by every one during the course of his time (by remaining faithful to his vocation).”

He gave leave (izn) in His Almighty Wisdom to all those calamities that befell on each one of them. All His lovers underwent pains, anguishes and sufferings, in varying degrees, but remained steadfast and faithful to Him. They did not betray His love. The infinite capacity and immense strength of His love made it possible for them to face the vicissitudes of life.

کر قربان ”فرید“ سر اپنا %ژاوارہ آیا

“Farid! Sacrifice your head for it is now your turn.”

It is now his turn to sacrifice his life for the sake of his beloved. He has to bear pains and sufferings in the path of love. He is happy in being chosen by the beloved to realise union. One gain is worth many losses. What more does he need than realisation of the real purpose of his existence?

Kafi-6

چوڑا ناڈے جیسلمیر دا سوہارنگاڈے خاص اجمیر دا

“Do get me set of bangles from Jaisalmer and dyed
colourful dopatta especially from Ajmer.”

Beauty and love are intertwined. Love has stirred her
from within. She wants to bring out the finest sentiments,
which inhere in her self. She wants to beautify herself with
the best that exists in her culture.

ہووے اصلی خاص مڑپچ نہ نقلی ول پھیر دا

“It should be truly and specially from Marwar and not
a counterfeit to the original.”

Love elicits genuineness. Love and truth are intertwined.
Her colourful dopatta from Marwar ought to be real and not
a counterfeit to the real. Appearance and Reality should be
identical.

جلدی آوے ناں چرلاوے کم نہیں اتھ دیر دا

“These may be brought forth quickly without any
hold up for over here there is no margin of delay.”

Her heart longs for these belongings right away without
any hold-up. It is such a longing that cannot be measured on
the spectrum of serial time. It can only be fulfilled in pure
duration, which transcends the ordinary distinction of time in
series of past, present and future. It is time turning into
eternity.

برہوں دا چوڑا پریت داسوہا کاک ندی دے گھیر دا

“These bangles of affection and dyed colourful dopatta of love symbolise my stepping in the stream of love.”

Her bangles and dopatta symbolise her initiation in the fold of love. Love has transformed both her inward and the outward.

بچھوایا بیکانیری کھنساں سجرٹے کھڑے پیردا

“I would procure the Bikaner toe – rings for my right and left foot.”

Her desire to secure Bikaner toes for her feet symbolise the start of her journey from the earthly to the heavenly within her cultural matrix.

سہجوں پیساں پاتھمکیاں تھورا پیساں ڈیردا

“I shall fondly wear and display myself even if I have to take the obligations of my brother-in-law (who will fetch these things for me).”

She shall happily adorn herself and be presentable even if she has to take some obligation (outward help). Her love no bounds. It is a stream, which determines its own course. There is no family consideration refraining her from expressing her love in fullness.

یار ”فرید“ منیندم آکھیے کیا غم بے دے ویردا

“Farid! My friend is responsive to me. Why I should be sorrowful about the detestation of others?”

Love is an individual sentiment but with social and cultural upheavals. He loves his friend that makes others detest him. There is no point in his being sorrowful since his friend responds to him in love. Otherwise, love would have been so overbearing for him.

Kafi-7

حسن فتح سب مظہر ذاتی ہر رنگ میں بے رنگ پیارا

“Beauty and ugliness are the manifestations of the Essence. The lovely colourless is in each colour.”

All the possibilities inhere in the Divine Essence. It is the Universal Possibility. There cannot be any possibility outside it. The Essence in order to realise the possibilities, which inhere in him has to take the form of Names or Attributes. It manifests itself in one of its forms, Beauty. It is then Beauty itself, which manifests in all forms of beauty. It is in the process of this manifestation that the Beauty appears in the form of a given beauty, which implies the possibility of a given ugliness. There cannot be such manifestation unless it is in a ‘world of contrasts.’ But there is no ugliness in the Essence since it is free from all imperfections. The phenomenon of ugliness arises in the process of manifestation and passing through different cycles ultimately returns to its source as transformed beauty. Pure water, analogically speaking, is free from all impurity but impurity arises in the process and is recycled into purity. It is not a perfect analogy since it deals with another level of reality but it does give some inkling of the point in issue. However, both beauty and ugliness are manifestations of the Essence with the difference that beauty is directly manifested from the Essence whereas ugliness as a privation only arises in the course. Likewise, the lovely One is colourless but assumes different colours in the process of manifestation.

”حُسنُ اقْرَبُ“ راز انوکھا ”وَهُوَ مَعَكُمْ“ ملایا ہوکا
سمجھ سناؤ، عالم لوکا ہے ہر روپ میں عین نظارہ

“His being nearer to man than his neck vein is a novel secret. His ever presence with you has been proclaimed. O people! Do grasp and identify that it is His open manifestation in each form.”

The material percept and the rational concept of nearness break down in this case. He is more nearer to man than man is to himself. It is the nearness of the Spirit or Divine Essence (that is in man but is not his) with a person. The Spirit takes the form of a human body in order to express itself in relative fullness. It can roughly be likened to the nearness of His Essence with His own Names or Attributes. The metaphysical meaning of nearness is supreme identity or nonduality. His ever presence with human has been openly proclaimed. Metaphysical realisation finds Him openly manifest in each form.

”لوذَّيْتُمْ“ فاش گواہی

کیتانا ز داڈھنگ نیارا

”وَفِي أَنْفُسِكُمْ“ سرا الہی

ہر صورت وچ را خجھن مانی

“It is a divine secret that He dwells in the self. It is a divulged testimony to His Omnipresence. Ranjhan friend is in each form. His mode of pride is unique.”

His dwelling in the human self is a secret of God. He dwells as the Self in the human. It is the housing of the Spirit in each pore of a human being. Man in his wholeness and totality is an outward form the Inward takes to manifest itself. It is an irrefutable testimony to His Omnipresence. A thing can only exist at any level by virtue of His presence. He is Omnipresent. The beloved is immanent in every form with uniqueness of transcendence.

طرح لطیفے طرز غریبے

تھی دلبر جگ موہیں سارا

حسن ازل دی چال عجیبے

آپ ہے عاشق آپ رقیبے!

“The move of the Primordial Beauty is a mystery with subtle style and manner only one of its kind. He is

himself the lover and is himself the rival. He is the beloved, who has captivated the whole world.”

The manifestation of the Primordial Beauty is a mystery. It has polarised itself as the lover and the rival. It has no parallel in human relationship of love, where the lover and the rival are understood to have two distinct realities. He is the One, who is manifest in multiple forms. Since there is no one beside Him, therefore He has to assume the form of the ‘other’ (rival) in order to fan the contradictions of love that take love to incredible heights. His form as the beloved has capitulated His other form as the world.

کھے عابد کھے نفل دو گانہ کھے مطرب کھے تان ترانہ
کھے رنداں میں کرے اوتارا کھے صوفی سر مست یگانہ

“He is at times singer and at times musical songs. He is at times devout and at times prayer with two genuflexions. He is at times matchless highly enraptured Sufi and at times descends in the form of the inebriates.”

His Omnipresence is all-pervasive. It is not possible to understand His manifestations from ordinary religious perspectives, which thrive in the world of duality bereft of the metaphysical sense of oneness. The religious consciousness is a split consciousness and it finds it appalling to accept His presence in all modes including the contradictory worlds of musicians, devout and rituals, enraptured Sufis and inebriates. It attempts to save His transcendence at the cost of His immanence thus resulting in the idea of a limited God firmly enthroned in Heavens. It fails to understand that the transcendence of God is saved in spite of His immanence. He is immanent but simultaneously transcendent in any form He assumes. His immanence in the form of an inebriate, for example, also carries in simultaneity an equal dimension of transcendence, by virtue of which, He simply cannot be reduced to being an inebriate.

کیا افلاک، عقول، عناصر
کیا متکلم، غائب، حاضر
سب جا، نور حقیقی ظاہر
کون ”فرید“ غریب و چار

“What to talk of heavens, intellects and elements?
What to talk of the creation with faculty of speech,
visible and invisible beings? The essential Light is
manifest everywhere. Who is Farid, the poor and the
pathetic (to hold any place in the Face of the
Absolute)?”

The Essence or ‘the supra-formal Divinity’ is in ‘abysmal darkness’. It is, in a certain sense, even beyond light. It is when it assumes the form of personal Divinity (Allah) that He becomes the light of the Heavens and the earth. Light has both the individual and the universal elements. Light is both absolute and infinite. Light as the Absolute is identified with His Individuality and Light as the universal is identified with His aspect of the Infinite. There is no contradiction between these ‘two fundamental aspects of the Real’. His Omnipresence arises by virtue of His being the Infinite. Light itself is manifest in all forms. It is the inherent nature of light to manifest itself. Human medium has no self-subsistent reality and thereby is a mere shadow of light.

Kafi-8

درد اندردی پیڑ
دلاڈھا سخت ستایا
دل نوں، مار موٹھجایا
ہجر فراق دے تیر

“The inward excruciating pain has highly vexed me.
The arrows of disunion and separation have ravished
my heart with anguish.”

Religiosity has no means to transcend ‘servant-Lord axis’. It considers it as final. It does not explore the possibility of experiencing God. The mystics and Sufis have stepped forward and have shown the way to ‘deliverance and union’. A person who embarks on the road to experiencing God ultimately finds Him ‘within the infinite depths of his being’. Love opens the door to reach the inmost chambers of one’s consciousness. But love and suffering are inseparable. The lover is shot by the arrows of disunion and separation, which give him severe inward pains and anguishes.

عشق ہے دل دی شادی
عشق ہے رہبر مرشد ہادی
عشق ہے ساڈا پیر
جیں کل راڑ سجھایا

“Love is the delight of the suffering heart. Love is the mentor, spiritual master and guide. Love is our spiritual teacher, who has made us realise the whole secret.”

His suffering heart finds delight in love. The elixir of suffering removes the dross from his heart and makes it shine like ‘a polished mirror’ in which the beloved contemplates himself. He realises the dictum: I love, therefore I am. Love guides him in unravelling the entire secret of the way. Love itself has polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved.

It is by virtue of loving that he realises the possibility of uniting with his beloved.

اے دل مٹھڑی، گندڑی مندڑی جانوں لاوی، برہوں دی بندڑی
ازلوں تا نگھ دا تیر جانی، جوڑ چو نبھایا

“My heart is miserable, loathsome and vile. It is bondwoman of love ever since birth. The primordial arrow of longing has been perfectly pierced by my beloved.”

Her miserable heart turns unworthy of her beloved though it has been subjected to love since the primordial day when it was pierced by the arrow of longing. She cannot bear the primordial separation from her beloved. Her longing intensifies. Her heart becomes incapacitated to absorb the intense passion of love.

ناز تبسم لچھڑے ہا سے چالے، پیچ، فریب دلا سے
حسن دے چار امیر جنہاں چو گوٹھ نوایا

“The prideful smiles, deeper laughter, styles of pretension and deceitful consolations are the four scions of beauty that have subjugated the four corners of the world.”

The beloved armed with the scions of beauty completely subjugates the world. There is no way out for him except to bear all this in the hands of the beloved. It keeps him in a state of uncertainty about his self-image and the response of his beloved. It is a necessary stage in the ripening of love. Ordinary lover gets disheartened and is dismissed accordingly. Patience and steadfastness in adverse situations of love help in the game of the Divine hunt.

وٹھڑی پالی سد امتوالی مینہ و سراندتے والی آلی
روہی رشتک ملہیر واہند اہخت ولایا

“It has been continuous raining on the ground. The sand has moistened, by virtue of rain, to an extent that even Malheer is being envious of the desert. The once receding fortune has now started to smile.”

The desert is enlivened by rain to such an extent that even certain green areas have become envious of the desert. It is likened to his state of barrenness turning lively at the response of his beloved. His liveliness was so unique that other people became envious of him. His receding fortune of love did embrace him. There are certain stages in love where activity on the part of the lover is ‘neither possible nor desirable’. The desert of his self has to act as a conscious receptacle. He does not remain passive but in a state of receptivity awaiting heavenly response of his beloved.

تھیاں سرسبز ”فرید“ دیاں جھوکاں
سہجوں ختنکی چائی سوکاں
نند نہ مانوں کھیر
مولیٰ ماڑوسایا

“The dwellings of Farid have become all green. The dried ones have fondly become lively (due to an inner urge). The udders of cows and buffaloes are oozing out milk. God has brought the desert to life again.”

His inner and outer deadness has quickened to life. Love bestows thousands a deaths and thousands a rebirths. His being in a state of receptivity, has elicited the Divine response. His static feelings have turned dynamic. God has turned his inner desolation into a feeling of well-being and fulfilment.

Kafi-9

ساڈا دوست دلیندا نور محمد خواجہ ڈھولایا چہیندا نور محمد خواجہ

“Nur Muhammad Khawaja is our bosom friend. Nur Muhammad Khawaja is our intimate and favourite beloved.”

Nur Muhammad Khawaja is steeped in spirituality. He is the forbearer of Khawaja Ghulam Farid who considers him as his friend and beloved close to his heart. He has reverential love for him. The friends of God are the embodiments of beauty, truth and love. God dwells in their inner and outer forms. Revering them is revering God Himself.

ساری ساڈی شرم بھرم دا ڑے گل وچ لا جا

“You are the custodian of our whole honour and prestige.”

God has granted him immense spiritual powers. His contributions in strengthening his family and spiritual ties with him are manifold. He symbolises his entire honour and prestige.

عرب وی ڑی عجم وی ڑی ملک پنجاب دارا جا

“You are owned in Arab and Persia and you enjoy a royal status in the dominion of Punjab.”

The Arabs, Persians and people living in the area of Punjab hold him in high esteem. His spirituality and noble conduct has attracted them to him.

زمین زمن وچ وجد اگدا فیض ڑے داوا جا

“The tune of your blessings is being drummed in all parts of the world.”

His spiritual blessings know no bounds. He has blessed all parts of the world by his spirituality and graceful demeanour.

قدیم بے وجہ نون من بھاگے انگن میرے پوں پا جا

“Do step in my courtyard with your full boon steps.”

He beseeches him to grace his courtyard with boon. His stepping in the courtyard of his inner being shall elevate his spiritual status. It will add freshness to his life.

دلبر جانی یوسف ثانی موہن مکھ ڈکھلا جا

“O’ Yousaf like sweetheart! Do show me your beautiful countenance.”

He is his Yousaf like beloved friend. He is desirous of his inward and outward beauty.

نوشہ شہر مہار داہنرا سکدی کوں گل لا جا

“O’ bridegroom of the nuptial city of Mahar! Do come and embrace the one desirous of you.”

He is eagerly desirous of him. He beseeches him to come and fold him in his arms. His owning him will turn him into gold. It will satiate his quest for him.

نہین ”فرید“ دے درس پیاسے آ جاناں ترسا جا

“The eyes of Farid are thirsty of your vision. Do come and do not tantalise me.”

He is keen to meet him. He entreats him not to tantalise him by remaining away from him. His heart cherishes for him and shall be filled with joy in meeting him.

Kafi-10

ساڈے نال سدا توں وس پیا وس، ہس، رس، دل کھس پیا

“Do dwell with us everlastingly. Live in merriment
and grab my heart.”

Communication with one's beloved heightens love. It at times assumes the form of soliloquy. These soliloquies are great treasures of love. These are not mere talks, which one undergoes with oneself but they reflect the imaginative presence of one's beloved. He invites his beloved to dwell with him for all times. He wants him to be merry and captivate his heart. He presents himself with his whole being. He desires his happiness from the core of his heart.

سروچ درد، دماغ خماری تیلے رتڑے، ہنجرڑوں جاری
جیڑے جھور دل آزاری تن سولاں دے وس پیا

“I have headache and my mind is in a state of drunkenness. The tears are flowing from my reddened eyelids. My self is worrisome and my heart is distressed. My body has been infested with afflictions.”

Love and suffering are intimately linked with each to the extent that both weave the fabric of his being. The journey of love is replete with separations and disunions, visions and unions. The stage of love determines the nature and intensity of these experiences of love. He misses his beloved and as a consequence his body, self and heart are in a state of great distress.

بے پت دی بے پتڑی یاری ظلم اندھاری بے زواری

کچھے چوری نس بیا

پہلوں لٹ لٹا دل ساری

“The dubious friendship of the untrustworthy is cruel, oppressive and unjust. He looted (ransacked) my heart in the first case and then stealthily fled away.”

He usually holds his beloved responsible for his plight. He is at a loss to understand the queer moves of his beloved. The deepening of his love unties many knots but also creates others. He does not understand the oppressive behaviour of his beloved. He contracted love with him and then stealthily assumed transcendence by leaving him forlorn.

چوٹیاں لھتم حال و نجایم
نک گھر ٹینڈیں گھس پیا

ہجر سوا کوئی سود نہ پائیم
منتاں کیتم سیس نوائیم

“I have earned nothing except disunion. I have plucked my hair and worsened my condition. I have implored and bowed my head. I have rubbed my nose till it has reddened.”

The dividend of his love has been disunion. He inflicts pains on himself in order to bear the terrible state of separation from his beloved. He adopts extreme postures of humility in order to attract him but all in vain.

لیت لعل دی ار کھر کوں
عشق دی رہ وچ بھس پیا

پیش کیتا جیں فہم فکر کوں
کر کر شکر نہ ڈتڑس سر کوں

“The one who resorts to understanding, reflection, and the seductiveness of prevarication, instead of sacrificing his head with countless thanksgivings, shall be a failure in the path of love.”

The whole problem lies in trying to know the dynamics of love by dint of ordinary understanding. The tools of thinking, which otherwise are so effectual in different situations of life, become completely ineffectual. Any one who resorts to these supports, instead of offering his head with immense gratitude,

shall miserably fail in the path of love. He needs to be thankful to the beloved for agreeing to accept his head in return of love.

لانی پھوگ ”فرید“ سوہسیاں سٹ گھر بارتے باروسسیاں
کرڑی تے ونج جھوکاں لیاں انج کلھ ٹوبھاوس پیا

“Farid! I will rejoice in the company of desert plants and bushes. I will leave my household and dwell in the forest. I will have my habitation amongst the thorny shrubs. These days the pond is full of water.”

He resolves to leave the comfort of his abode and rejoice in wilderness in spite of its being so uncomfortable. The easiness of life tends to distract him from his original vocation. He wills to dwell in proximity to the pond, which symbolises the ‘spring of life.’

Kafi-11

سنانول پنل ول گھر ڈوسدھایا تن مونجھ ماریا سر سول تایا

“The charming Punnal has returned to his abode. My body is ravished by anguish and my head is fiery with afflictions.”

The romantic tales are cultural, which mirror the intensity of love and suffering. Punnal, the Baloch son of the ruler of Kech fell in love with Sassi and started living with her in Bhambore. His kinsmen took him away forcibly while Sassi remained sleeping. When she awoke, she underwent the greatest ordeals of her life. The psyche of the lover is very complex. It contains a sense of guilt, which is often projected to the beloved. The drama of love contains psychic meanings with a lot of ‘mysterious sensitivity’ in the folklore literature. An eye of the mystic transposes these psychic realities into spiritual forms. Love relationships are placed within the spiritual ambience. The earthly facts start mirroring celestial realities. The temporal is transformed into eternal. Time plunges into eternity. The game of love is transformed into a game of symbolism. The beloved becomes transcendent after contracting love with her. She experiences acute forms of sufferings, as a consequence.

ڈونگر ڈراون ڈکھڑے ستاون ڈینیں، بلانیں کر ٹول آون
بن ڈھول سکڑے سوڑے نہ بھاون گھر بار ڈوسد اسار اپرایا

“The mountains instil fear in me and the sufferings are so vexing. The witches and demons flock around me. The presence of my close relatives in the absence of my beloved is not appealing to me. My entire

household seems estranged to me (I have a feeling of homelessness).”

The outward is so dreadful. The mountains instead of giving her a sense of protection instil fear in her. Her psychic realities appear to her as flocks of witches and demons. They want to scare her away from the path of love. The absence of her beloved has wrought such changes in her that her close relatives who once were her psychological and social support seem distant to her. She becomes stranger to the social world, which once was so familiar to her.

مُٹھری موئی نوں خوشیاں نہ پھلڑیاں ڈوڑے ڈوڑاپے تا نگھاں او لڑیاں
جانی او یڑا، پیتاں کلڑیاں ہے ہے اڑایا اکھیاں اجایا

“Happiness has not been a boon for the spiritless and the miserable. There are instead multiple difficulties and intricate longings. My beloved is peculiar and ties of love are unintelligible. Oh! Oh! My eyes have been entangled meaninglessly.”

The dynamics of love are beyond her understanding. She becomes spiritless and miserable instead of being happy. She has yet to decipher the code of love. She does not understand the strange behaviour of her beloved. Her ties of love with him are equally unintelligible. Her eyes have entangled her in a meaningless relationship. She finds no meaning in her love.

تخفے ڈکھاندے غم دیاں سوغاتاں کیچوں سسی ڈوآیاں براتاں
برہوں بساٹاں او کھڑیاں گھاتاں جیڑا نہیڑے نیرڈا نہیایا

“The presents of sufferings and the rare gifts of sorrows are the fortunes of Sassi that have come from Kech. It is so difficult to be receptive to these fortunes of love, which have shaken me so rudely but still I have remained committed to my love.”

She receives the rare gifts of sorrows and sufferings at the hands of her beloved. It becomes so testing to accept these fortunes. She accepts them as blessings in disguise. She

reiterates her commitment to love. It strengthens her from within.

گُذرے وہاںے جو بن دے مانے سہرے کُمانے، اُجڑے ٹکانے
جُھر دی جُھورانے ڈھولن نہ جاٹے دلڑی مُسایا، بے وس رُلایا

“The vanity of youth has whisked away. My chaplets have lost their freshness and the dwellings have become deserted. My beloved does not care that worries have plunged me in an acute state of worrisomeness. My heart has beguiled me and made me wretchedly helpless.”

He has been so engrossed in love that his youth has faded away with all its vanity. His ordinary sense of serial time does not hold true for him. The past he lived just seems to him like a dream. It cannot be measured by clocks. Could one measure the sufferings of a lover whose moments of union with his beloved are lost? He experiences himself as a dried leaf. His beloved is least bothered about the state of his wretched existence. His heart has enticed him on the path of love. His sense of being perpetually dwindles into non-being.

آسں اُمیدیاں، سڑیاں پُجالیں اصلوں بروچل پیتاں نہ پالیاں
ماو، مہر دیاں دیداں نہ بھالیاں آئیم فریدا سختی داسایا

“My hopes and expectations have been burnt to ashes. My beloved has not truly nurtured love with me. He has not cast glances of affection and care on me. Farid! I am condemned to live in the shadow of hard times.”

He has no expectation and hope of a loving response from his beloved. His beloved has not returned his love. It is so difficult for him to live in a state of despair.

Kafi-12

سٹ سانول سجن سدھایا سر سجنڑے سول ستایا

“My charming beloved has left me forlorn. I am the damned one, who has been vexed by afflictions.”

A general feeling of being left out by an individual or group is not as agonising as being uncared for by one's beloved. It shatters one's ordinary self. She feels forlorn, damned and vexed by afflictions.

تپڑی کلہڑی تپڑی ملہڑی سانگ بجر دی رلڑی
جندڑی جلدی دلڑی گلڑی لکڑی اگ کلڑی
پیڑاؤلڑی نیڑے گلڑی پل پل پور پرایا

“I am burning in loneliness, while sitting on the worn out mat. The spear of disunion has pierced me. My life has burnt and my heart has rotten due to unintelligible fire. Love has made me undergo intricate pain. I am bothered about others at each and every moment.”

She burns in the fire of love without any internal or external support. It is an unintelligible fire beyond the ken of human reason. It eludes her rational grasp. The outer crust of her personality or her every day self starts petering. The transcendence of her beloved haunts her at every moment.

پر بت رو لے جکھڑ جھولے غم دے سانگ سن گولے
سوز سمو لے یار نہ کو لے جیڑا جل بل کو لے
سختی گولے سمجھم نہ او لے دم دم روگ سوایا

“I am wretchedly wandering in the mountains amidst strong winds. I am facing the arrows and hatchets of sorrows. My passion is getting hold of me in the absence of my friend. My self has been burnt to ashes. The hardships are on hunt for me and I cannot find a way out. My malaise is increasing every moment.”

The burning of the self to ashes fosters a sense of nonbeing in her. A feeling of helplessness envelops her, which increases the consciousness of her ontological nothingness.

ماری مونجھ مونجھاری	نیں باری منتاری باری
الٹا تروڑم یاری	درداں ماری کرم نہ کاری
جو لکھیا سو پایا	انگ ازاری اکھیاں جاری

“I know not how to swim across the deep and splashing waters. There is no remedy of my anguishes. I am abject but my friend does not shower his blessings on me. He is severing his friendly ties with me, instead. I am bodily distressed and tears are flowing from my eyes. I have got what was destined for me.”

There are different levels of knowledge and understanding. Knowledge of one level may not be of any avail at a different level. The ordinary degree of knowledge does not vouchsafe for the entire human understanding. Understanding a state of love requires a corresponding state of knowledge. She feels at times that her plight is destined from eternity. Isn't it the primordial separation of the lover and the beloved, which passing through the path of suffering ultimately leads to union?

تتڑی واقع گھالے	ڈونگر کالے پیریں چھالے
زخم جگر دے آلے	اکھاں نالے سوز پجالے
فکر فراق مونجھایا	پیت نہ پالے کردا چالے

“I am the inept one bearing hardships, while wandering in the black mountains with boils on feet. The eye streams have burnt my passions. My heart sores are all green. My beloved does not love me but plays tricks with me. The very idea of separation creates anguish in me.”

The anguish of separation from her beloved leaves deep imprints on her embodied self. The unrelenting ways of the beloved elude her grasp and she frequently experiences crises of understanding.

خوشیاں کھسدا بھیت نہ ڈسدا	ول ول ڈھولن نسدا
نیڑے وسدا سب کوئی ہسدا	جھیرا جھگڑا سدا
ڈوڑا ڈکھڑا جی بے وس دا	دلڑی مفت اڑایا

“He grabs my happiness without disclosing the secret. My beloved slips every now and then. He makes all nearby people laugh. There are brawls and wrangling with my mother-in-law. I am helplessly bearing multiple sufferings. My heart has got me entangled just for nothing.”

The beloved does not disclose the secret of treating her so brashly, thus making her a laughing stock for the passers by. She desperately wants to see the cards of the game of love but these can only be shown at their appointed time. Love cannot be taken at its face value since it has its hidden cost.

روہ کھنیرے راہ اوپرے	وسدا یا پر پرے
امڑی جھیرے ویر نہیرے	سس نان کہیرے
آوڑو پرے چھوڑ بکھیرے	سٹ گھٹ شور اجایا

“There are spread out mountain ranges and peculiar passages. My friend dwells at a far distance. The brawl of my mother, the rudely shakes of my brother, the provocations of my mother-in-law and my sister-in-law can end if you enter my courtyard leaving aside all incongruities. Discard the meaningless noisiness.”

She considers the transcendence of her beloved as the root cause of all her internal and external contradictions impregnated with sufferings.

نکلن آہیں سنجھ صبا حیں	برہوں دُکھیںد ا بھائیں
لگڑیاں چاہیں سنجھن نہ واہیں	رولدی بیلے کاہیں
سنجڑیاں جھوکاں اجڑیاں جاہیں	یار فرید نہ آیا

“I heave sighs in the mornings and in the evenings. The flame of love intensifies. I cannot find a way out of this impasse of love. I am wandering wretchedly in the riparian shrubbery and reeds. The dwellings are empty and the places are deserted. Farid! My friend has not come.”

He feels that awaiting his beloved may require a whole life-time. It is one of the greatest mysteries of love. There is no cause-effect relationship in love. It is not a mechanical relation. It is beyond control and prediction. One's love does not elicit an automatic response. There is no logical nexus between human emptiness and fulfilment. The relevance of the his striving and suffering in the way of love notwithstanding, the response of his beloved, is only by virtue of grace.

Kafi-13

زرو سرتے درو سرتا

عشق لگا گھر و سرتا

“My falling in love has made me oblivious of my abode. My spouse and wealth have fallen in oblivion.”

It was not a conscious effort on her part to leave her abode, spouse and wealth but her falling in love made her oblivious of all these things. Religiosity purports the way of preaching, sermonizing and moralizing with a limited positive result. Spirituality, on the other hand, posits the possibility of a direct contact with God with immeasurable merits. Once the love of God takes roots in a person, it becomes his guide. His worldly love is burnt to ashes in the fire of Divine love. He goes beyond the need of anyone to tell him what to do. His love keeps freeing him from all worldly attachments. He puts no fight against the propensities of the lower self since his love of God makes them peter out accordingly. Religiosity uses the fear of God to smite the sinners. It ends up in instilling a psychological fear, which becomes highly counterproductive. But spirituality takes God as love. It does not talk of fearing God but enlightens man to be fearful of the drastic consequences of his evil actions. An element of genuine fear does remain during the course of spiritual journey but it is transposed in the fear of doing something, which may not lead one to lose grace in the eye of one's beloved. It is lovers' hell.

زبور تر پور و سرتا

گزرے ناز حسن دے مانے

“My pride and vanity of beauty has passed away. My jewellery and apparel have fallen in oblivion.”

She did understand that pride, vanity of beauty, jewellery and apparel were transient. Her formal knowledge of these phenomena merely remained static at the rational level, and did not become existential or dynamic. It is by virtue of love that she realises the ephemeral and outward nature of these things and acts accordingly.

وسرے کچے سرخی میندیاں بولائیں سر و سریا

“I have become oblivious of collyrium, rouge, and henna. My nose ornaments have fallen in oblivion.”

Her state of love has made her forgetful of her adornments and ornamentations since these have not succeeded in attracting her beloved.

درد اندیشے دل دی موڑی بیا، کل، جوہر، و سریا

“Pain and anxiety are the fortunes of my heart. All other resources have fallen in oblivion.”

Love works wonders in detaching him from all internal resources except pain and anxiety, which purifies his self and make him worthy of his beloved.

دیر کنشت دواہ مندر مسجد منبر و سریا

“Idol temple, Church, Sikh place of worship, Temple, Mosque and Pulpit have fallen in oblivion.”

His love makes him transcend all formal places of religious worship. God is not housed there. He resides in the inmost chambers of his heart. He has an insatiable informal relationship with him.

ہک دے سانگے ہک دی سوں ہے خیر بھلی شر و سریا

“I swear by the One that for the sake of the One, I have become oblivious of both good and evil.”

The force of his love for the One makes him transcend the polarisation of good and evil. He lives beyond it. He identifies his self with Good itself.

ہوراماں ہر وسریا

ہرویلے ہر یاد اسانوں

“We constantly remember God. All other things, my mother, have fallen in oblivion.”

Love has soaked him in the constant remembrance of God. There ‘is no thing with Him’.

سج برداڈر وسریا

ویساں کچ فریدنہ مڑساں

“Farid! I am determined to go to Kech. The fright of wilderness has fallen in oblivion.”

He is blessed with resoluteness to meet his transcendent beloved. The courage of love overcomes his fear of wilderness. How could it be overcome otherwise?

Kafi-14

کوئی ماہنوں آنمیں یاردا ساتھی کھڑا سنہیرا ڈیندا

“Perhaps, an envoy has come to deliver message of my beloved.”

The process of communication between the lover and the beloved is the soul of love. The communication between the Divine and the human takes numerous direct and indirect forms. The finality of prophethood in Islam has set a seal to the prophetic mode of communication but has kept its mystic channels open. The door of love remains open both for the lover and the beloved.

عشق نہیں ہے تیر بلادا ظلمیں چوٹ چلیندا

“It is not love but a sharpened spear that cruelly causes hurt.”

It is the efficacy of love that appears as a sharpened spear causing hurt so cruelly.

نازادا کچھ کرے نہ ٹالا علمیں برہوں بچھیندا

“There is no escape from the pride and style of my beloved, which coerces love to keep track of me.”

The antics of his beloved coerce him in the tracks of love. It is a form of communication, which is so necessary for fructifying love.

رمز رموز تے لچھڑے ہا سے سب کچھ درد سمجھیندا

“Pain makes me understand all intricate clues and deeper laughter.”

Love is essentially existential with perceptual, conceptual and imaginative off shoots. His pain plays a crucial role in making him understand the intricacies of love. No pain, no understanding. It is pain, which takes him to a higher dimension, where he understands the valid cause of his beloved befooling him. He joins in this laughter.

سوز فراق تے درد اندیشے تن من پھوک جلیندا

“Passion and separation along with pain and anxieties are blowing (intensifying) fire of my embodied self.”

The passionate pains and anxieties caused by separation burn his embodied self. The purification process has to continue till all traces of his being are reduced to nothingness.

ہرگز سول نہ سہندی دلڑی یار اے بار سہیندا

“My heart would not have borne these afflictions but for my friend, who makes me bear this burden.”

The process of his reduction to nothingness was so heavy that he would not have bore it but his friend helps him in bearing such heaviness. His load becomes light when he realises that the burden of love that he carries is solely for the sake of his friend. It is, again the gracefulness of his friend, which lightens his burden.

ہجر فرید کیتی دل زخمی دوست نہ مرہم لیندا

“Farid! Disunion has hurt my heart but my friend does not apply balm on it (does no medication).”

His heart is hurt by disunion but his friend does not medicate it. The withholding of medication at the hands of one's beloved apparently seems an act of cruelty but it reflects deepest love since it leads to the ripening of the state of love. Any intervention by the beloved at this stage is more of a cruelty than love. Analogically speaking, if the inmates of hell are given a temporary respite from the blazing fire then the process of purification of their souls reverses back and they

ultimately cease to be purified, thus it is love and not cruelty that the intensity of fire is not reduced.

Kafi-15

کوئی محرم راز نہ ملدا

کیا حال سناواں دل دا

“How could I narrate the state of my heart for there is no one to share my secrets?”

Love is a strange sentiment. It prompts him to communicate with someone who could share his plight but he finds no one. It is uniqueness of individuality that the pains and happiness of an individual are so personal. One cannot experience even the pain of a toothache of the other. Love is a higher experience, which condemns him to remain in a state of solitude.

سارا ننگ نموز و نجایم

منہ دھوڑ مٹی سرپایم

ہتھوں اُٹا عالم کھلدا

کوئی پچھن نہ ویڑھے آیم

“There is dust covering on my face and ashes on my head. I have lost all my honour and prestige. No one has come to share the state of my being. Rather, the world is laughing at me.”

He comes in contradiction with society by virtue of his higher consciousness. A society governed by the law of averages promotes the average and the mediocre. It feels threatened by an individual who tends to challenge its norms. It takes different measures against him. He suffers for the sake of his beloved. He already loses his honour and prestige at the hands of people who instead of sharing his misery make fun of him. However, the non-responsiveness of his beloved and the hostile behaviour of people strengthen him from within.

گیاباربر ہوں سرباری لگی ہو ہو شہر خواری
روندیں عمر گزاریم ساری نہ پام ڈس منزل دا

“The burden of love has fallen on my head. I have earned infamy and notoriety. My whole life has been spent in crying. I have found no sign of my destination.

The society smites a lover with infamy and notoriety, which ultimately prove to be blessings. He is burdened with love. He finds no clue to reach his goal of uniting with his beloved. His destination of love ‘is not a line already drawn but it is a line in drawing’.

دل یار کیتے گرلاوے تڑپھاوے تے غم کھاوے
ڈکھ پاوے سول نبھاوے ایہو طور تیڈے بیدل دا

“My heart groans for my friend. It makes me restless and sorrowing. It is suffering and bearing afflictions. It is the condition of the one, who is deprived of your love.”

These groans, sorrowing, sufferings and afflictions do make him restless and ravish his heart but they eventually prove a boon for him.

کئی سہنس طبیب کماون سے پڑیاں جھول پلاون
میڈے دل دا بھید نہ پاون پوے فرق نہیں ہک تل دا

“There are countless therapists, who are diagnosing and administering medicines as remedial measures. They are far from understanding the mystery of my heart’s malady. There has not even been an iota of improvement in my state.”

The society is inimical to the lover but even that segment of society, which is friendly and wants to help him, is at a loss to understand the malady of his heart. Their diagnosis and medication are wide off the mark and thus, fail to restore his

wellbeing. They falter, in the very first instance, in considering his love as a disease. They consider it as 'sickness-unto-death' without realising that the sickness of love is many times better than so-called healthiness.

پنوں ہوت نہ کھڑ مکلا یا کلہڑی کچ سج سدا ہایا
سوہنے جان پچھان رولا یا کوڑا عذر نبھایم گھل دا

“My beloved Punnal went away without bidding me farewell. He left me alone and headed towards Kech. My sweet heart consciously made me wretched. I concocted the story that sleep had befallen me.”

Her beloved became transcendent without adieu with a conscious design to leave her wretchedly alone. It all happened in a dream-like state. She pretended to be fast asleep. Later, for the sake of his honour, she circulated the idea that sleep had befallen her and he had been forcibly taken away by his kinsmen.

سن لیلیٰ دھانہہ پکارے تیڈا مجنوں زار نزارے
سوہنا یار تو نے کوارے کڈیں چا پردہ محل دا

“O Layla! Listen to the imploring call of your Majnun, who is in a distressful state. My lovely friend! Do reveal thy self, at least once, by unveiling from the palanquin.”

The beloved is understood both in the masculine and feminine senses in different cultures and even within a culture. The beloved in the forms of Ranjha, Mahinwal, Punnal, Mahinder and Omar, for example, are taken in the masculine sense whereas the beloved Layla is considered in the feminine sense. It points to the masculine-feminine aspects of the Reality. It also refers to the reciprocity of love between the Divine and the human. The lover, in the form of Majnun, imploringly calls Layla (his lovely beloved) to at least lift for once the curtain of transcendence and become

immanent. His request is orchestrated with such a distress. It is so difficult to see the beloved hidden in one's own eye.

دل پریم نگر ڈوس تا نگھے جتھاں پنڈے سخت اڑا نگے
ناراه فرید نہ لا نگھے ہے پندھ بہوں مشکل دا

“My heart longs for the City of Love. The pathways leading to it are very hazardous. Farid! There are no passages or openings. It is an extremely difficult way.”

His heart longs for the city of love. There is no road map. There are no sign-posts. It is a hazardous journey within his self. It is so difficult.

Kafi-16

مارو مسٹھل ول مکھڑا چھپایا ڈکھڑیں ڈکھایا در دُیں منجھایا

“My overpowering sweet heart has again hidden his face. The sufferings have made me suffer and the pains have caused me anguishes.”

The suffering of separation stands in corresponding inversion to the joy of union. It is this inversion, which makes her fall in anguish and despair. One who tastes the best flavour of love cannot withstand his being divested of this savour. The attainment of union after severest suffering leads to the most intense joy. How could such intensity be experienced otherwise? After the end of this phase, she has to undergo the period of immense distress. The cycle of love, comprising continual unions and separations, moves on till the final union. The intermittent periods intensify both her joys and sufferings.

تا نگھیں تپایا مونجھیں مسایا سولیں ستایا نیڑے ہرایا

“My longings have burned me and the anguishes have beguiled me. My afflictions have vexed me and made me lose the game of love.”

The feeling of losing the game of love arises in her many a times but still the game continues. She is a key player but the master card is in the hands of her beloved. What she considers her loss is in reality her win. All losses in love are victories.

آتن نہ بھانواں سینگیں رُوایا دھوتیں داویڑھا ڈھولن پرایا

“I have become alienated from the place of spinning my wheel, in the company of my friends, who make

me cry. 'The place has become a courtyard of the slanderers and my beloved has become a stranger too.'

She experiences solitariness of love. Her friends cease to understand her, which is so terrible for her. The animosity of the world intensifies. The most awful thing is when her own beloved seems a stranger to her.

سنجڑی سسی نوں جہلیں رُلا یا ہے ہے پُئل ول پھیرانہ پایا

"Oh! Oh! Punna! You left the damned Sassi wretched in the mountains and did not turn up."

Her expectations keep growing in testing situations. The circumstances in which her Punna (beloved) became transcendent made Sassi (lover) roam in wilderness. Her expectation to see her beloved in immanent form did not fructify. Such are the ways of love.

پوریں پرانیں دڑی نوں تایا پیڑیں پرانیں سکھڑا ونجایا

"My worrying about others has made my heart fiery. It is the primordial pain that has made me lose peace."

The primordial game of love, on both sides, is to realise unity. The transcendence of the beloved makes her heart fiery. The primordial pain of love has made her lose peace.

خوشیاں وہانیاں سناول سدھایا گل گیا فریداجو بن اجایا

"My beloved has parted and my happiness has whisked away too. Farid! My youth has rotten just for nothing."

His entire happiness is linked to union with his beloved. The parting of his beloved (transcendence) is identical to the parting of his youth.

Kafi-17

ساڈے من بھانودا مان مہیندا چاک

“The adorable shepherd of the herd (Ranjha) appeals to my inner self.”

She loves the shepherd of the herd (fine sentiments). He is the shepherd of her being.

کر رکھاں دل پاک ہر دم ہوئیں کو لے میڈے

وتاں گلکڑی پانودا

“I wish you were with me all the times. I have kept my heart pure to be worthy of your embrace.”

The desire to have the ever presence of her beloved haunts her throughout her journey on the path of love. She keeps her heart pure of otherness. She does not defile herself with the thought of the other. She loves her beloved with sincerity, which consists in loving him whole-heartedly and in wholesomeness. It is this purity that makes her worthy of her beloved's embrace.

پھٹ گئی ہم باکھ راتیں روندیں تپیں کھپدیں

کیوں گل نہیں لانودا

“I have been crying, mourning and raising hue and cry during the whole night and now the white streak of dawn has emerged. Why don't you embrace me?”

She is in an acute state of suffering during ‘the dark night of the soul’ desiring to see its dawn, which consists in union with her beloved. She is dying for this union.

آئی ملن دی مد ساکھ سانوں سہجوں مینگھ ملہاراں

نیڑا جیڑا تانواد

“The sky has readily become overcast with thick clouds in the rainy season. The moment of union has dawned. Love is blazing my self.”

One of the most crucial moments in her love is when the inner and outer portents of union become visible. She experiences an isthmus between union and disunion.

دردوں ٹھڈڑیاں ساہیں کڈھدی روروڈیواں باک

ڈکھڑاگ نہ مانودا

“Pain makes me heave cold sighs. I groan while crying. My body cannot bear suffering any longer.”

She experiences sadness, groans and sufferings, which are so overbearing for her embodied self. Heaving cold sighs (‘icy cold darkness’) and groaning while crying in the state of pain (hell-fire) are the signs of the inmates of hell. They make suffering unbearable. But, it is within these that ultimately door to ‘deliverance and union’ is found. All fire is the fire of love.

نال فرید دے سچ نہ کیتو آنون دی گکیوں آکھ

سوہناول نہیں آوند

“You did not remain true to Farid. My beloved! You undertook to come but did not turn up.”

He accuses his beloved of not remaining true to his words. He promised to assume immanence but chose to remain in transcendence. The game of love is, in a certain sense, a blame game. The blame essentially is made from the lover’s side. The charges he levies as a lover, in a charged way, against his beloved arise from his human situation, which cannot comprehend the ways of the Divine. He has relative knowledge of love, which he considers as absolute. Though his understanding keeps on developing as he moves ahead yet love always remains a mystery for him. It is only at the highest stage of realisation or union that he understands the ways of the Almighty Wise.

Kafi-18

مساک ملیندیدا گذر گیا ڈینہ سارا سنگار کریندیدا گذر گیا ڈینہ سارا

“I have been using twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) but the whole day has passed. I kept doing makeup but the whole day has passed.”

Beautifying herself for the sake of her beloved is her great passion. This gradual awakening of love deepens the sentiments. But when the beloved does not appear, her green sentiments turn into dried leaves. The unfulfilled desires constitute hell for her.

کچہ پام سرخی لایم کیتم یاروسارا

“I applied collyrium and rouge but my friend forsook me.”

The very act of being forsaken at the hands of her friend for whom she has beautified herself adds insult to injury.

کانگ اوڈیندیں عمر وہانی آیانه یار پیارا

“My life has been spent in shoosing ravens but my lovely friend has not returned.”

The attempts to secure the return of her beloved to her abode at times become so desperate. The crowing of the raven on the wall of a house, considered as an omen for the visit of one's friend, is just a cultural consolation without being grounded in truth. But still she shoos ravens to make them fly far and wide with the expectation that they bring news of her friend's return. She has spent years of her life in

resorting to this practice but without any success, which is so disheartening.

روہ ڈونگر تے جنگل بیلا رو لیم شوق آوارا

“My wayward keenness has made me wander wretchedly in mountainous terrains, forests and riparian shrubbery.”

Her keenness to unite with her beloved makes her wretchedly wander in wilderness. Is it really wretchedness to suffer for the sake of one's beloved?

ہکدم عیش دی سیجھ نہ مانتریم بخت نہ ڈترم وارہ،

“My fortune did not let me have a single turn on the nuptial bed of enjoyment even for a moment.”

It was her misfortune to be deprived of even a moment of nuptial enjoyment. Doesn't dawn emerge from the bosom of night?

پڑھ بسم اللہ گھو لیم سرکوں چاتم عشق اجارا

“I sacrificed my head starting with recital of God's Name. I assumed the entire responsibility of love.”

She made the absolute choice of love with her whole being. It made her assume absolute responsibility of her choice. There can be no love without freedom. Love and freedom are identical. Her first step as lover is to barter her head for the sake of the Divine. Pure love is essentially divine.

رانجھن میڈا میں رانجھن دی روزا زل داکارا،

“Ranjhan is mine and I belong to Ranjhan. It is a pre-eternal covenant.”

The mutual belongingness of the lover and the beloved is by virtue of the pre-eternal covenant, which took place when the undifferentiated Reality (Love itself) assumed a differentiated form (lover and the beloved).

ہجر فرید النبی لائی

جل گیم مفت و چارا

“Farid! Disunion has enkindled the flame of love.
The pathetic one has been consumed in this fire for
nothing.”

Disunion is instrumental in enkindling the flame of love.
Disunion intensifies love. The intensity of love has to reach
the highest degree in him in order to qualify him for attaining
union with his beloved.

Kafi-19

نام اللہ دے پاندھیڑا میڈالے سنہڑا جا

“O’ envoy! Deliver my message for the sake of Allah’s name.”

It is the utmost state of desperation almost at the end of her tether that she beseeches the envoy in the name of God to deliver message to her beloved. It is an unusual message in which she accuses her beloved of transcendence and communicates to him the sufferings she is undergoing for his sake. However, it has not to be taken formally but understood in an informal context. It is an attempt to understand certain aspects of the Divine in the human context. The form and contents of this message symbolise further closeness of the Divine and the human.

آکھیں بٹھ گھت دروہ، پریت کوں یار نہ وٹڑالا

“Do ask my friend to cast aside deceitfulness and not to stigmatize love.”

The act of deceitfulness and stigmatising love cannot be levied to the perfect beloved but the levying of these charges, in the human context, simply show the delimitedness of the human. It implies the intricacies of judging the Divine by human standards. How could an aspect be studied in isolation from the whole?

جیویں جیویں کنڈھ ڈے گیاہیں اُونویں مُنہ ڈے آ،

“The way you have gone by turning your back, likewise come back by turning your face (towards me).”

She desires the return of her beloved (immanence) exactly from the point he became transcendent.

ہے ظالم نیت مراد کی تھولے کھوٹ کما،

“Oh! Oh! Cruel one! One gets in consonance with one’s intention. Do not be a counterfeiter.”

Intention gets primacy over all conduct. The cruel and counterfeit behaviour has been the product of the intention of the beloved who never wanted to respond to her.

چالیں پیچ فریبیں والی ڈھولن ریت وٹا،

“My beloved! Change your styles of pretence and deceit.”

The style of pretension and deceit has ensnared her in the path of love. She wants her beloved to be sincere in love.

کر کے سگت، سانگ بیگانے بیٹھوں من پرچا

“You have become rest contented by taking strangers as friends.”

She counsels her beloved against taking strangers as friends. She advises him in his own ultimate interest. But, actually she projects her own insecurity to him.

بیابانی کون کہیںدا تو ہیں ساڈے بار اٹھا

“Do carry the burden of owning me since no one is mine without you.”

She openly declares that she has no one except him to carry the onerous burden of owning her. She has banked her whole being and having in the game of love. She does not want any misunderstanding with her beloved. She does not want to lose the game of love by any intervention.

سس نیناناں مارم طعنے مہنیں ڈیوم ما،

“My mother taunts me and my mother-in-law and sister-in-law rebuke me.”

The taunts of her mother-in-law and the rebukes of her sister-in-law add fuel to the fire of separation, which engulfs her.

آکر ماہی دیدیں دیرے دل وچ جھوکاں لا،

“My beloved! Do become the vision of my eyes and dwell in my heart.”

She is dying to have vision and union with her beloved.

ناں کلھ گا، لہیں ناں ڈے مندڑے وا توں سمجھ آلا،

“Don’t hurl abuses at me and do not say anything vile to me. Do hold your tongue.”

The intermediate imaginal phases in the world of love, located between the self and the Spirit, give rise to her audition of being abused and degraded by her beloved. It demolishes a sense of hidden pride that she carries with her. It helps her in getting emancipated from the shackles of her self.

یاری لایو، لائے جا تو محض نہ آئیو ڈا،

“You contracted friendship but you did not know the art of friendship. You failed to remain steadfast.”

The art of friendship and steadfastness are the virtues of love. She essentially educates herself by critically examining the behaviour of her beloved.

جھور جھرانے چند دا جو کھوں ڈترس ماس سوکا

“It is very exacting to be worrisome in love. It has led to the contractions of my skin.”

The effects of suffering are visible on her embodied self.

ڈٹھڑے با جھوں کیوں جڑاں برہوں لگاھڑتا

“How can I live without witnessing you? Love has consumed me from within.”

Her love bereft of witnessing her beloved is self-defeating. Religiosity remains content with following the dictates of Divine law. Spirituality rises higher in demonstrating direct contact with the Law-giver in the form of the beloved. The fruit of love is witnessing the beloved in one's mirror of heart.

سکھڑیں نہ ڈے یار الانجے کر کجھ کان حیا،

“Do not accuse me, my friend. Do have some sense of shame.”

Her Imaginal world again exhibits the forms of accusations made by her beloved. It reflects the reality of communication between the lover and the beloved.

سوہنی نال نبھاوے ہر کوئی کو جھی نال نبھا،

“Every one honours his commitment with the one who is beautiful. Do honour your commitment with the ugly one.”

She realises that she has to perfect herself in order to attract her beloved. She does not deny the reality that love and beauty are inseparable but she beseeches her beloved to act beyond it and embrace her in her ugliness. She invokes the Divine principle that consists in the Mercy of Allah preceding His wrath.

جلدی آنویں نہ چرلاویں ساہ تے نہم وسا

“Do return quickly without any delay. There is no certainty attached to the breath of life.”

Life is threatened by the uncertainty of its end at any time. The moment of uniting with her beloved cannot be delayed.

ڈے کر ساڈی بانجھ سراندی سوہی سیچھ سہا

“Do adorn the nuptial bed by folding my arms under your head.”

The posture of meeting with her beloved symbolises unity.

تیں کن سانول د لڑی آپے
آویچم سرچا

“My charming beloved! I have chosen to pledge my heart to you on my own account.”

Love bereft of freedom, choice and responsibility is no love. She accepts this triplicity for the sake of love.

بیٹھائی گزراں نہ بھلی،
بٹھ پیا کوڑ نہیا

“Life of deviance is not noble. False commitment is utterly useless.”

Love strives for singleness of purpose and true commitment.

چاڑہیں توڑ نہ رہ وچ رو لیس
رکھناں یاد وفا

“Do take me along with you to the end and do not desert me in the way (don't make me wretched). Remember faithfulness (sincerity) of love.”

It is sincerity of love, which makes love prosper. She appeals to her beloved (Self) not to desert her in the way but to take her to the end. The primordial tradition of love can only fructify in union.

اگن فرید دے بھورل جانی
سہجوں آپوں پا

“O' my charming beloved! Do fondly step in the courtyard of Farid.”

He remains at the receiving end, in spite of levelling wild accusations against his beloved. His accusations do not arise by dint of his pride but due to his humility. He remains in such a precarious situation of love. He does not want his beloved to react to these accusations. He wants his spontaneous response of love in order to realise union.

Kafi-20

وَاہِ وَاہِ سوہنے داور تارہ
ہر صورت وچ کرے اوتارہ
ہک جاچا وے عشق اجارا
بئی جا ڈیوے حُسن ادہارا

“It is laudation to the conduct of the Beautiful. He descends in each form. He is love itself at times and at times He is Manifest Beauty.”

The Beautiful is manifest in each form. Love itself is polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved making beauty and love inseparable.

او مالک میں ادنیٰ سگ دا
ہر صورت وچ مٹھڑا لگدا
میں کیا موہ لئیں من جگ دا
مار لیں ہر جانا زفقارا

“I am canine and He is my Master. He looks sweet in each form. What to say of me, he has captivated the heart of the world. He has beaten the drum of his pride everywhere.”

He is completely at the command of his Master is sweet in every form. It is not he alone but the whole world, which is attracted to Him both in transcendence and immanence. He is the Individual and the Universal in simultaneity making it possible for every one to love him. His responsiveness to an individual's love does not deprive other individuals of his love. He is fully responsive to each individual in his or her own right.

میں بے آس امید دانا
ہر کس ناکس دے من بھانا
دوست اوڑا یار ایانا
ہر ہک دل کوں لگے پیارا

“I am bereft of any hope but He is the ground of my expectations. He is heartily appealing to the apt and the inept. My friend is peculiar and amateur in love but still every heart rules him lovable.”

He is the fundament of his expectations in spite of his falling in despair. He appeals to everyone. He is peculiar and amateurish in love (likened to the colour of water, which is due to the colour of the vassal). He is universally enchanting.

جو میں وانگ بجھارت بجھدا سو تھیا واقف ساری کجھ دا
ہر گز دخل نہیں کہیں کجھ دا جان نظارایا داسارا

“The one, who like me unravels the mystery, becomes acquainted with whole esoterism. There is absolutely no possibility of any thing. Do witness the total manifestation of the friend.”

Anyone who unravels the mystery understands esoterism in fullness. He sees the entire manifestation of his friend without otherness at any level. Being is there in all its plenitude without any trace of otherness. The unrealised possibilities of the Essence (nothingness) and its realised possibilities (Being) are identical. There is no duality, for example, between the colourless light and its manifestation in the form of colourful lights. The transcendence of light and its immanence enjoy a supreme identity. The Unmanifest, simultaneously keeps its transcendence intact, while manifesting in all forms of being and nothingness. There is no thing, which is not a manifestation and there is no manifestation that is not of the Unmanifest. It is love, which makes this manifestation possible and at the same time sustains it.

چرن گرو دے سیس نوائیں جو آکھے چم اکھیاں چائیں
جہد جہاد دابار اٹھائیں قرب کمال ہئی مطلب بارا

“Bow your head at the feet of your Master. Carry out his commands wholeheartedly. Bear the onerous

obligation of spiritual struggle. The meaning of this quest lies in achieving perfect proximity.”

The total receptivity to the instructions of spiritual master (guru or murshid) in struggling against one's baser self makes one realise the goal of union with the beloved.

تھی گر پیر و اچیلہ سچا نہ ہو قدم ہٹا کر کچا
برہوں کڑاہ چڑھیا مچ مچیا جل بل مارا نادانہ رے

“Be a true disciple of your spiritual Master. Do not become frail by faltering your steps. The cauldron of love is ablaze. Get burned in it completely by raising the cry: I am Truth.”

The sincerity with the spiritual master requires firmness of steps and getting oneself completely burned in the blazing cauldron of love. The resultant disappearance of being occasions the Self or the Reality to appear in one's human medium and proclaim: I am Truth.

جو کوئی رکھی اے گن چارے جو راتی جگ جوگ جگارے
ونج خوش و سسی شام دوارے رہی جنم جگت سوں نیارا

“The one who cultivates the four virtues of self-restraint, generosity, meditation and night watchfulness, shall enter and remain happy in the temple of the beloved detached from the cycles of decadence.”

The realisation of the possibility to happily enter and reside in the temple of the beloved by being detached from the cycle of decadence is by virtue of spiritual effort. The nature and degree of the effort varies from individual to individual. It is the beloved beneath his apparent effort, which does all the work.

جگرت سپن سکوپت ٹریا تیڈی سیر دے ساگے جڑیا
جیند اپیر سبناں تھڑیا پھر سی تھی چو گوٹھ آوارہ

“The one, who traverses the terrestrial world along with the world of imagination and the world of spirits, shall know that all this has been created for Self-realisation. But the one, whose steps falter in realising this truth, shall remain itinerant in the four corners of the world.”

It is by virtue of spiritual experience that the recipient realises that the terrestrial and the celestial worlds are instrumental in the achievement of Self-realisation. It is such realisation that ultimately leads to ‘deliverance and union’.

توں میں سمجھ، سنجان نہ چھوڑیں نرگن سرگن وچ جاجوڑیں
اپنے آپ توں مونہ نہ موڑیں سب ہے روپ سروپ تہارا

“Do not discard this Gnostic learning and understanding. Be in harmony with your Self. Never be oblivious of your essentiality. All is your splendid Face.”

One has not to discard the gnostic truth of attaining permanent harmony with one’s Self, which is ones essentiality. The mystery of Self-realisation dawns when one comes into contact with the roots of one’s being. He attains gnostic knowledge that everything is the expression of his Self within him. It is his essentiality as against his individual being, which is an illusion. Gnosis is ‘an inward journey from self to the Self.’

چاروں بید بید انت پکارن اوم برم نارائن دھارن
آتم اوتم روپ سدھارن دویت فرید ہے جو ٹھالارا

“The four Vedas and Hindu sacred tenets openly proclaim that the Nameless has been named as Om, Brahma and Vishnu. He has assumed the form of the Supreme Soul. Farid! Multiplicity is merely ephemeral.”

Hindu metaphysics or pure metaphysics intellectually demonstrates that the Nameless has assumed different Names in the process of manifestation. The transcendence of

the Nameless and the immanence of the Named are identical. The Supreme Soul or the universe has no duality. There is no otherness because there is no self-subsistent reality except the Reality. A thing that lacks self-subsistent reality has no being. Thus, multiplicity at any level is ephemeral. The metaphysical principle of unity in multiplicity explains this metaphysical truth.

Kafi-21

ہے! ہے! یار بروچل ہک تل ترس نہ کیتا

“Oh! Oh! My Balochi friend! You did not have a speck of pity on me.”

She entreats her beloved to have pity on her. She is so fond of having a union with him. Her being pitiable in love is something qualitatively different from being so in all other situations. Love is a free choice in which she chooses to remain in the situation otherwise she could freely walk away. But still she remains there and faces the testing times. One is essentially free in all human situations but in the situation of love one relatively manifests more freedom.

کر کے سخت نمائی اپنے نال نہ نیتا

“You did not take me along with you in spite of making me bereft of all vanity.”

She attempts to become a judge in her own case. Being bereft of all vanity does not logically imply a loving response from the beloved. She learns it in course of time and then she ceases to present her case to her beloved on merits. The grace of the beloved is beyond merits since it is essentially the grace, which confers merit on her.

ہجر پیالہ از لوں، میں مسٹری لو پیتا

“I am the miserable one, who has drunk the cup of disunion ever since the Primordial Day.”

The manifestation of the Reality led to polarisation of the lover and the beloved so that the unrealised possibilities in the Divine Essence could become realised. It had necessarily

to create primordial disunion in order to achieve final union.
The process of realisation makes her so miserable.

جیس ڈینھ سجن سدہائے دکھ آیا سکھ بیتا

“The day my beloved departed me, I am in sufferings
and peace has passed away.”

The possibilities were in a state of peace in the Divine
Essence but their forming in Attributes and thereby in
polarisations set off birth pangs of suffering.

سول کللڑا کو جھا لوں لوں رگ رگ سیتا

“The unintelligible hideous affliction has weaved the
fabric of my being.”

The characteristic affliction of love is not partial but it
totally affects her being.

اصلوں محض و ساریں لا کر پریم پلپیتا

“My beloved has absolutely become oblivious of me
after igniting the wick of love.”

Her beloved ignites the wick of love and then hides in
order to let love ripen in her heart. Isn't it so?

روہ فرید لتاڑاں شالا کھاوم چیتا

“Farid! I am tired of wilderness. I pray that the tiger
devours me.”

He faces such ordeals that he prays for the end of his life.
The greatest merit of piecemeal knowledge is that it provides
joy of gradual ‘inner growth and expansion’ but at times it
becomes so overbearing that he prefer death to life.
However, he has to carry out the decree of love even in the
utmost trying circumstances.

Kafi-22

اتھاں میں مٹھڑی نت جان بہ لب اوتاں خوش و سداوچ ملک عرب

“I am the miserable one, stranded here with last breaths of my life. And he is happily dwelling there in the ground of Arabia.”

He is miserably stranded here dying in love and his beloved Prophet is happily dwelling there in Arabia.

ہر ویلے یار دی تانگھ لگی سُنجے سینے سِک دی سانگ لگی
ڈکھی دلڑی دے ہتھ ٹانگھ لگی تھئے مل مل سول سمو لے سب

“I am longing for my friend at every moment. The spear of desire has pierced my desolate heart. All afflictions have rallied to lay the edifice of my suffering heart.”

The beloved Prophet is his friend and he perpetually longs for him. His desire for meeting him is so intense that it seems like a spear, which pierces his barren heart. His suffering heart has become the abode of all afflictions.

تتی تھی جو گن چودہار پھراں ہند، سندھ، پن جاب تے ماڑ پھراں
سُنج بارتے شہر بزار پھراں متاں یار لم کہیں سانگ سبب

“I am the inept roaming four corners of the world by becoming a yogi. I am wandering in Hind, Sindh, Punjab and Marwar. I am rambling in wilderness, cities and markets. I am making all out efforts, hoping that perchance I may meet my friend.”

He wanders with the mystical quest of possibly meeting his friend. His inward quest implies his presence both

inwardly and outwardly. He travels with a serious purpose of having contact with the Prophetic substance He is the living Prophet whom God has empowered to unveil himself at his will. The possibility of contacting him makes him seek for him.

جیس ڈینہہ دانینہہ دے شینہہ پھینٹا لگی نیش ڈکھاں دی عیش گھٹیا
سرجو بن جوش خروش ہٹیا سکھ سڑ گئے، مر گئی طرح طرب

“The day the lion of love wounded me, I have been bitten by sufferings and delights have become marginal. All my animation and liveliness has languished. Peace has been burnt to ashes and the modes of happiness have faded out.”

His seeking the Prophet is not a conceptual affair. It is an existential affair commencing from the day when the Prophet blessed him with a stroke of love. He is acutely suffering since then in order to be with him.

توڑے دھکڑے دھوڑے کھانڈریاں بڑے نام تے مفت دکانڈریاں
بڑی باندیاں دی میں بانڈریاں بے در دیاں کتیاں نال ادب

“Although I face violent strokes, yet I have been sold cost free in your name. I am handmaid of your slave girls. I hold reverence of the dogs at your gate.”

His intense attachment with the prophet makes him oblivious of any violence he undergoes for the sake of him. He reveres him so much that he considers himself a bond slave of his slave girls and holds in reverence even the dogs at his gate. He considers them all worthy since they enjoy nearness to him. Anyone who has the proximity of his physical or spiritual presence becomes worthy of being revered.

واہ سوہنا ڈھولن یار سجن واہ سانول ہوت ح جاز وطن
آ ڈیکھ فرید دا بیت حزن ہم روز ازل دی تا نگھ طلب

“It is laudation to the lovely bosom friend. It is laudation to the charming beloved belonging to the city of Hejaz. Do come and witness Farid’s house of angst. He is longing for you ever since the primordial day.”

He lauds his lovely bosom friend, the charming beloved of Medina. He begs him to visit his house of angst. His suffering heart longs for him ever since he, in the form of Ahmad, became the mode by which the undifferentiated Reality became differentiated and took the form of Muhammad. He seeks him from the core of his heart for the Reality manifests in fullness in his perfect medium. He is his beloved incarnate.

Kafi-23

سن سمجھ ڈے زاہد جاہد توں ہن عشق دے اے کلمات عجب

“The devout and the combative! Listen and understand that these spiritual statuses of love are mysteries.”

The devout striving in the way of God must listen and understand that the spiritual statuses of love are mysteries, which cannot be unravelled by dint of religiosity. The expressions of love cannot be comprehended at the rational level. The waves of the infinite ocean of love cannot be separated from the ocean itself. The Reality cannot be dissected in parts since all these are the aspects of ‘the single unanalysable Reality’. It is the ultimate stage of metaphysical realisation that opens the door to these mysteries. It is striving in one’s inwardness that one can realise the possibility of uniting with the beloved. It is when the human self withers away that he attains Self-realisation.

ہے گالھ عجب ہے حال عجب ہے چال عجب ہے گھات عجب

“The doctrine is a mystery. The state is a mystery. The transformation is a mystery. The station is a mystery.”

The metaphysical doctrine of the Essence and the Divinity is beyond the ken of human reason. It is apprehended by virtue of intellectual intuition. The states of metaphysical realisation, not being psychological, cannot be studied by psychology. The process of transformation of one state to the other and being stationed at a state for a period of time is also beyond the purview of scientific psychology. It is spiritual

psychology or the ‘Sufi science of the soul’, which deals with these metaphysical realities.

ہے ذوق عجب ہے شوق عجب ہے عین عجب ہے بین عجب

“The tasting is a mystery. The keenness is a mystery.
Union is a mystery. Disunion is a mystery.”

Sense-experience and reason cannot undergo the experience of tasting, which makes him experience the beloved in a state of frenzy intensifying his keenness for uniting with the beloved. It is a mystery to be united with the beloved in a state of nothingness and also to attain a fresh sense of his individuality in the state of nonduality.

ہے ذکر عجب ہے فکر عجب ہے نفی عجب اثبات عجب

“The contemplation is a mystery. The reflection is a mystery. The negation is a mystery. The affirmation is a mystery.”

Reason fails to understand the mystery of contemplation, which identifies the subject and the object. It leads to the identity of the Name and the Named. The mysterious power of reflection comes in play when the mystic after undergoing spiritual experience returns to his normal self and tries to conceptualise his experience. The demonstration of the first part of Shahadah in negating everything (la ilaha) by solely affirming Allah (illa’Llah) is beyond ordinary understanding. The first part of the Shahadah starts with the negation of ‘ilah’ or self-subsistent reality but there is no self-subsistent reality therefore this negation does not denote anything. It does not point to any reality since no such reality exists. It has only a connotative meaning. The purpose behind this negation is to affirm the reality of the Absolute or Allah. It expresses the transcendence of God. But a transcendent God is limited. The second part of the Shahadah (Muhammadur Rasulu’Llah) Muhammad is the manifestation of Allah affirms God as the Infinite. It demonstrates His immanence. He is the Absolute and the Infinite. However, the greater mystery

lies in the Reality being beyond the human perspectives of transcendence and immanence.

کل تا نگھ طلب مفقود کرن سبھ صورت حق مسجود کرن

“They do away with all longing and wants. They become witness to the Reality in all forms.”

They become detached from their having. They witness the Reality in all forms.

تھی باذل ترک وجود کرن سک صوم صلوٰۃ زکوٰۃ عجب

“Their generosity makes them shed their own being. Their desire for fasting, prayers and religious tax is a mystery.”

They generously discard their being in completely reducing themselves to nonbeing. They attain the ontological consciousness of their own nothingness. Religiosity fails to understand that their desire of rituals from the state of nonbeing and nothingness is qualitatively different from their earlier state and it is spiritually undertaken to affirm their individuality in nonduality.

حکمت عجب شہات عجب درجات عجب درکات عجب

“The certainties are a mystery. The uncertainties are a mystery. The up gradations are a mystery. The down gradations are a mystery.”

The certainties and uncertainties in the spiritual way find no parallel in the realms of sense-perception and reason. The certainties of intellectual intuition are absolute but in the process of interpreting these with the aid of reason uncertainties arise, which are eliminated by standards of pure objectivity. The spiritual upgradations and downgradations as high tides and low tides in the ocean of love follow mysterious outlines. The states and the stations of the soul have both recurring and non-recurring patterns. The

relationship of the human effort and Divine Grace is a deepening mystery.

آیات عجب طاعات عجب طاعتوں کے لات منات عجب

“The symbols are a mystery. The realisation is a mystery. The phenomena of the relative as absolute are a mystery.”

Symbols, unlike signs, partakes the reality they tend to symbolise. It is so mysterious that the reality is not hidden behind the symbols but is contained within them. The whole creation including the heavens and the earth and what is in between them, and what lies buried beneath the earth are subject to His law. All actions of obedience or disobedience are only possible by the necessity of this law. A disobedient act is an act of obedience to the Divine law of freedom though it is not in consonance with His Will. It is a mystery that even the disobedient one, in the very act of disobedience, obeys Him since he subjects himself to the law that makes disobedience possible. Thus, no disobedience to God, in principle, is possible. The entire creation obeys Him. The relative has no reality except the reality of the Absolute. The Absolute as the Power itself manifests in all forms of power. It is in the process of manifestation that the Power appears in the form of a given power (taghut), which implies the possibility of a given exploitation (corruption of power). God is worshipped in Himself. It is through the act of manifestation that God appears in the form of a given god, which implies the possibility of idolatry. God is worshipped in all forms.

ہک ذاتوں سہنس ذوات عجب اسماء افعال صفات عجب

“The rising forth of countless beings from the One Being is a mystery. The names, acts and attributes are a mystery.”

It is beyond ordinary understanding to understand the manifestation of countless beings along with their names, acts

and attributes from the Absolute Being. The Essence desired its possibilities to be realised in the forms of Names and Attributes. The Reality, by inner compulsion of love, wanted to see the essence of His own names. It wanted to see itself in the 'other' as if in a mirror. The plenitude of the Reality had no 'other'. It manifested Ahmad, the principle of creation, by virtue of which, the undifferentiated Reality assumed a differentiated form and the process or stages of manifestation continues. It leads to the manifestation of beings with their inward and outward characteristics. It gives individuality to every existent. The inherent nature of light, for instance, is to manifest itself and the One Being identical with the sheer light manifested itself. The colourless light in the process of reflection becomes colourful without compromising the unity of light. The principle of unity underlies all multiplicity. The transcendence of Reality remains intact in immanence. Reason cannot understand these mysteries.

خوش خضر دے فلسفیات عجب ظلمات تے آب حیات عجب

“The gnosis of the enlightened ‘Khidr’ is a mystery.
The water of life from the ocean of nothingness is a
mystery.”

Khidr, one of the servants of God enlightened with knowledge of events directly from God, made a hole in the boat after getting out of it, slew a young man, and rebuilt the crumbling wall of the two orphan boys without any imbursement. The prophet Moses who had accompanied him with the idea of attaining this knowledge could not keep patience regarding these unusual acts, the rationale of which was later explained to him. Rational knowledge being piecemeal leads to impatience as against ‘esoteric knowledge of spiritual truth’ (gnosis), which is complete and thereby fosters patience. The parting words of Khidr that he had not done all this on his own accord deepens the mystery. Khidr symbolises a servant of God whom God grants direct knowledge of events to carry out His instructions. Khidr is a

contemporaneous medium, in the hands of Divinity, to concretise His will into action both in the inner and the outer world. The ocean of nothingness symbolises the state of nonbeing or primordial darkness of humanity existing in the Essence as a possibility before entering the water of life of existence. The Spirit, inhering in every human individual, will never die. It is identical with the Divine Essence.

ٹھپ فقہ اصول عقائد نوں رکھ ملت ابن العربی دی

“Discard jurisprudence, principles and belief.
Cultivate the tradition of Ibn Arabi.”

The exoteric knowledge has to be left behind in one’s desire for the esoteric one. One should adopt the tradition of Ibn Arabi, master of gnosis, which teaches the doctrine of Oneness of Being and its metaphysical realisation.

ہے دلڑی غیروں پاک تری مصباح عجب مشکوٰۃ عجب

“Your heart is pure of otherness. The lamp is a mystery. The niche is a mystery.”

One’s heart as niche, housing the lamp symbolising the abode of the enlightened beloved, is free from darkness. The universal light individualised in the form of the beloved makes darkness or otherness vanish away.

حرکات عجب سکناات عجب اشغال عجب اوقات عجب

“The activity is a mystery. The receptivity is a mystery. The achievement is a mystery. The eternity is a mystery.”

The spiritual way is dynamic characterised by different points, which can be spiritually understood individually and in their creative totality. The activity at times comes to an apparent halt. It is not a passive state but a state of receptivity, which in a certain sense, is higher than activity. The receptacle of the lover absorbs the blessings of the beloved in the state of receptivity. These spiritual

engrossments unlike the worldly ones are achievements lending eternity to the moments of realisation. Reason is at a loss to witness the eternal in the temporal.

اورادِ عجب و دعواتِ عجب ساعاتِ عجب ڈینہہ راتِ عجب

“The recitals are a mystery. The supplications are a mystery. The pure duration is a mystery. The serial time is a mystery.”

The recitals with their characteristics including regularity and appointed timings play a vital role in the spiritual way. They create a recurring impact on the self, leading to harmony and cosmic equilibrium. The words become identified with the reality they express. The servant's supplications to advance in the spiritual way confirm his servanthood or nothingness. The servant in the course of recitals and supplications lives in the moment of pure duration without undermining the reality of serial time.

”لا یدرک الابصار“ عجب ”لا یحجب الاشکال“ عجب

“The fact that eyes cannot comprehend Him is a mystery. That the forms cannot hide Him is a mystery.”

The Omnipresent cannot be seen by eye is so mysterious. His being openly manifest and yet hidden from the physical eye is a mystery. Isn't He hidden in the eye? The greater mystery is that the forms cannot hide Him. He is not hidden behind the veil but is the veil Himself. He is witnessed in all forms by the eye of the heart.

ہے بحرِ عجب ہے لہرِ عجب ہے نہرِ عجب قطراتِ عجب

“The ocean is a mystery. The wave is a mystery. The stream is a mystery. The drops are a mystery.”

The ocean of love has infinite depths. There are no scales to measure it. The more one dives deep, the deeper it becomes. The wave arising out of this ocean is neither the

ocean nor something outside it. The moment it raises its head it falls down in the ocean.

The stream of love is running its course to be united with the infinite ocean of love. The inherent nature of love is to expand and attain totality. The drops shed their separateness to be united with the stream. But there is a unique wave, which absorbs the ocean and a unique drop that absorbs the stream. It is so mysterious to understand this metaphysical truth of uniqueness.

ہے بحر عجب ہے لہر عجب ہے نہر عجب قطرات عجب

“The calamities are a mystery. The apprehensions are a mystery. The blows are a mystery. The frustrations are a mystery.”

The calamities, apprehensions, blows and frustrations are the necessary milestones on the journey from the self to the Self. They are opaque to the consciousness of the ordinary man and at times even to the lover who undergoes them. All these are placed negatively in reference to the responsiveness of the beloved. The sense of calamities and blows arise at the stage when the lover perceives that the beloved has either forsaken him completely or has downgraded him to the lowest levels. The apprehensions arise when he apprehends a negative response from the beloved. The inability to win him on his side creates many a frustrations. All these things shake the fabric of his being. He does not understand that all these stages are necessary for the ripening of love and the love bereft of them is just reduced to an ordinary relationship.

واہ جذبہ من جذبات عجب راحت عجب لذات عجب

“The laudation of the passion of love amongst all passions is a mystery. The delights are a mystery. The tastes are a mystery.”

The passion of love stands out among other passions by virtue of its power of absorption. The lover gets delighted by

seeing the colours and hearing the sounds in his journey of love. He experiences and tastes different openings unto his beloved. These positive responses of the beloved, act as a rainfall in the barren desert. It reiterates his commitment to love and animates his desire for union.

ناسوت عجب ملكوت عجب جبروت عجب لاهوت عجب

“The terrestrial (physical) world is a mystery. The angelic (subtle) world is a mystery. The world of omnipotence (causal) is a mystery. The celestial world (the manifest Absolute) is a mystery.”

The terrestrial world, the angelic world, the world of omnipotence and the celestial world are the cosmological realities. Sufi cosmology understands them as the realm of the humans, the angelic realms, the realm of power and the realm of Divinity. Sufi psychology understands the realms as the body, soul, heart and spirit in the human self. It considers them as ‘the planes of consciousnesses.’ It requires a deeper knowledge to understand and traverse these realms of cosmology and psychology.

تلبیس عجب تائیس عجب تقدیس عجب سطوات عجب

“The manifestation is a mystery. The birth of love is a mystery. The sacredness is a mystery. The majesty is a mystery.”

The manifestation of the unmanifest in different forms is a mystery opaque to the ordinary consciousness. The inner compulsion of love leading to the creation of the whole universe is so mysterious. One does not ordinarily understand the purity of the Essence, which simultaneously remains apart in manifesting itself. It is a mystery to understand His transcendent Majesty in immanence.

اوہام عجب ابہام عجب اعلام عجب الہام عجب

“The illusions are a mystery. The satanic whisperings are a mystery. The awakenings are a mystery. The inspirations are a mystery.”

The spiritual way is qualified by pure objectivity but there arise optical illusions, which are removed by separating the alloy of illusion from genuine perception by Divine blessings. The auditory whisperings also take place, which are reduced to naught by the Grace of God. These illusions and satanic whisperings train the lover not to take his experience on its face value but to be watchful in differentiating the spurious from the genuine one. It is a clearing of the ground to genuinely experience the spiritual awakenings within the depths of one's soul or consciousness. They lead to Divine inspirations fraught with higher spiritual meanings.

ہمزات عجب خطرات عجب لمحات عجب شطحات عجب

“The suggestions are a mystery. The dangers are a mystery. The instants are a mystery. The ecstatic utterances are a mystery.”

The evil suggestions and the insinuations of the soul take place during one's journey to the Self. They provide an occasion to the lover to remain constantly watchful of his enemies and not to become oblivious of them even for a moment. The hazards of the way are also laid before him so that he is constantly aware of the negative and positive dangers while traversing the spiritual path. This spiritual preparedness helps him in capturing the instants of spiritual openings. The height of spiritual experience takes place when the lover under the heightened spell of love becomes completely incapacitated as a straw and his receptacle attains absolute receptivity. The ecstatic and antinomian utterances e.g. I am the Truth, are uttered by his tongue in this state. Religiosity does not understand that the Divine takes charge of the human medium and makes these utterances through the human tongue.

ہے قرب عجب ہے بعد عجب ہے وصل عجب ہے فصل عجب

“The nearness is a mystery. The remoteness is a mystery. The identity is a mystery. The difference is a mystery.”

The proximity and remoteness from the beloved is not spatial or measurable by serial time. It is the inward realisation of possibilities. The proximity is not static but goes on increasing with occasional phases of remoteness. The sense of remoteness heightens the consciousness of the lover and ripens him to attain union with the beloved. The identity of Being and nothingness is beyond the understanding of religious consciousness. It can only be witnessed by the spiritual consciousness, which transcends the subject and object structure of reality. The consciousness of identity in difference occurs when the lover retains his individuality in spite of his identity. It is qualitatively different from the sense of his individuality that he had before uniting with his beloved. This post-union sense of his individuality is a great mystery.

ہے قہر حجاب عتاب عجب ہے لطف نجات سبب عجب

“The wrath, veiling and afflictions are mysteries. The joy, deliverance and intoxication are mysteries.”

The lover has to encounter many negativities and positivities during the course of love. These unite to enlighten him for his final union. He at times suffers by experiencing testing situations of remoteness at the hand of his beloved. His beloved remains veiled. He desires his vision and union. His insatiable quest for his beloved ripens him to the extent that the beloved becomes fully responsive. The lover becomes intoxicated with joy and attains deliverance by transcending the polarity of the lover and the beloved. He unites with his beloved.

ابدال عجب او تاد عجب اقطاب عجب افراد عجب

“The replacements are a mystery. The pegs are a mystery. The poles are a mystery. The individuals are a mystery.”

The friends of God are found in every age and in every country. God chooses amongst them a number of persons who are deputed to run the affairs of the universe by the powers vested in them by God. They have no intrinsic powers but they derive all their powers directly from God. They do everything in accordance with His will. They do everything at his behest. The case of Khidr, for example, is pertinent when parting from the prophet Moses he said that he did not do the acts on his own accord. There is no question of the saints being peers or partners with God. A created being, in principle, cannot be a peer or a partner with the Creator. The question of being a peer or a partner only arises when any one of them claims as such or when any one of them claims that the powers, which he has, originally belong to him and that these are not conferred by God. No saint has ever claimed any such thing. The appointment of forty ‘Abdaal’ (replacements) at all times in the world, and replacing the one who has passed away with a new one, so that the number remains constant is a mystery. It is also beyond religiosity to understand their role in establishing Oneness of God and helping humanity. The presence of four ‘Awtad’ (pegs) to tent the four corners of the world for running the affairs smoothly are opaque to the religious consciousness. There are many ‘Aqtaab’ (poles) but the ‘Qutab al Aqtaab’ (head pole) heads the friends of God including the Abdaal, Awtad and Aqtaab. He is the axis who mediates between the Divine and the human and his presence is considered necessary for the existence of the world. The ‘Afraad’ (servants) achieve a higher station of servanthood by remaining engrossed in the theophany of the Essence.

تقلید عدول ثقات عجب

تحقیق عجب تصدیق عجب

“The verification is a mystery. The testifying is a mystery. The adherence, innovation and trustworthiness are mysteries.”

The processes of ‘tahqiq’ (verification) makes the ‘muhaqqiq’ (verifier) achieve ‘full possibilities of human knowledge and existence by divine grace and solicitude (inaya)’. He sees things as they are. He accepts the Haqq (Truth) in itself and its manifestation in every individual thing. He gives each thing its rightful place. The station of ‘tahqiq’ (verification) is also called ‘Muhammadan station.’ The identification of knowledge with the truth of things is understood as ‘tasdiq’ (testifying or certifying truth). It is realisation of the Truth in fullness. The act of ‘taqlid’ (adhering to the letter of law) nurtures within its bosom the reaction of innovation. It is very strange that the trustworthy words and deeds of the founders of schools of jurisprudence fall in oblivion when they are blindly followed and not understood creatively.

ہے قلب عجب ہے سر عجب ہے نفس عجب ہے روح عجب

“The heart is a mystery. The secret is a mystery. The soul is a mystery. The spirit is a mystery.”

The ‘qalb’ (heart) is the intuitive aspect of the mind. It is also named as the Intellect, which has direct knowledge of the Transcendent. It has innate knowledge. The heart directly perceives the ultimate Reality. Heart is the recipient of Divine revelation. The ‘lataif’ (subtleties) of heart include sirr (secret) ‘the inmost part of the heart in which God reveals Himself’. It is the meeting point of the Divine and the human. The ‘nafs’ (embodied self) has many degrees and it includes the whole world of psyche. The ‘ruh’ (Spirit) is identical with the Divine Essence. The heart stands between the self and the Spirit. The impurities of the self lead to the blindness or sickness of the heart.

ہے حرم عجب احرام عجب حجاج عجب عرفات عجب

“The House of God is a mystery. The pilgrim white-clad robe is a mystery. The pilgrims are mysteries. The mount Arafat is a mystery.”

The House of God symbolising His presence is a mystery. The white-clad pilgrims signify Man’s ontological nothingness in the face of God. The pilgrims performing Hajj manifest the unity of God and the unity of mankind. The mount Arafat stands for the human seeking forgiveness from the Divine. It is a symbol of man’s utter dependence on God for his deliverance or union.

جبریل عجب تنزیل عجب ترتیل عجب تعیل عجب

“The Gabriel is a mystery. The revelation is a mystery. The clear and distinct recitation of the Qur’an is a mystery. The subjection to the Divine law is a mystery.”

The Archangel Gabriel revealed the Qur’an on the heart of the Prophet. The occurrence of continual revelation within the infinite depths of the Prophet’s being is beyond the comprehension of religiosity. The recitation of the Qur’an in a measured way identifies it with the cosmic rhythm and opens up immeasurable possibilities. The subjection to Divine law or will brings forth blessings beyond the ken of human understanding.

ہے ظہر عجب تفسیر عجب ہے بطن تے تاویلات عجب

“The apparent meaning is a mystery. The exegesis is a mystery. The unmanifest and the return to the root meanings are mysteries.”

The Qur’an is a living reality with infinite dimensions. Its apparent meanings and exegesis do not tell the whole story. Its hidden and root meanings are beyond the ken of religiosity. The creative totality of the inward and the outward aspects of the Qur’an is a mystery.

ہے کبر تے فخر و غرور عجب ہے نار عجب ہے نور عجب

“The arrogance, conceitedness and pride are mysteries. The fire is a mystery. The light is a mystery.”

It is the light of the Truth, which makes one recognize that the states of arrogance, conceitedness and pride are the result of the fiery self. How could nothingness claim to be something?

ہے نخل عجب ہے طور عجب ہے موسیٰ تے میقات عجب

“The tree of Moses is a mystery. The mount Tur is a mystery. Moses is a mystery. The moments of his discourse with God are a mystery.”

The open manifestation of God through the tree of Moses and His assuming the Attribute of Speech on mount Tur shows the patterns of the Transcendent assuming immanent forms. The reality of the prophet Moses and the moments of his discourse with God demonstrate the inward human possibility of communicating with the Divine.

آغاز عجب انجام عجب ہے شام عجب پر بہات عجب

“The beginning is a mystery. The end is a mystery. The evening is a mystery. The morning is a mystery.”

When the eternal manifests in the temporal, it takes the forms of beginning and end. The phenomena of morning and evening takes place when eternity unfolds itself in time. The Essence is beyond these determinations.

ہے شمس تے مد اظلل عجب ہے عکس عجب ذرات عجب

“The sun and the lengthening of its shadows are mysteries. The shadow is a mystery. The particles are a mystery.”

The entire universe is the shadow of the Absolute. The relationship of the sun and its shadows gives some inkling of understanding the relationship of the relative with the Absolute. One could never see light unless it was mixed with darkness. Shadow is veiled light. It gives rise to multiplicity.

The sun symbolises unity with shadow as the world of multiplicity. It is unity in diversity.

ہے طرح قیام قعود عجب ہے وضع رکوع سجود عجب

“The postures of standing-up and short sittings are mysteries. The modes of bowing and prostration are mysteries.”

The posture of the body reflects the posture of the mind. The postures of standing –up, short sittings, bowing and prostration in a ritual prayer symbolise the perfect return of the theophanies to their source. They get aligned with both inward and outward cosmic rhythms. The act of prostration is the shortest point between the Divine and the human.

ہے شفع عجب ہے وتر عجب ارکان عجب رعات عجب

“The prayer with two genuflexions is a mystery. The prayer with three genuflexions is a mystery. The components are a mystery. The genuflexions are a mystery.”

The components or constituents of the ritual prayer with genuflexions of odd and even numberings are in consonance with the reality of numbers or the qualitative aspects of the numerical. Prayer creates inner and outer harmony.

نفعات عجب صدقات عجب خیرات عجب حسنات عجب

“Sharing is a mystery. Alms giving are a mystery. Charity is a mystery. Virtues are a mystery.”

The sharing of one’s wealth with the poor and the needy, leads to inward richness. The sharing of one’s being and having with others is virtuous since personality can only develop by acts of sharing. A man who does not share has no personality. The act of sharing is an act of gratitude to God.

ہے دنیا اصل احاد عجب ہے دین الوفات عجب

“The essential One as the foundation of the world is a mystery. The countless openings of the Way are a mystery.”

The essentiality of the One gives rise to multiple things with each thing being unique. The Way of unity gives rise to multiplicity in the physical and the social world. The world of multiplicity is grounded in the principle of unity.

ہے دوزخ طبیعات عجب ہے جنت سبع صفات عجب

“The strata of the hell are a mystery. The seven stratum heavens are a mystery.”

Hell-fire is the inner fire of one's evil actions. It is a process of curing of the soul (the period depending on the nature of the disease) so that it could achieve deliverance and union. The strata of the hell correspond to the categories of sins the inmate of hell has committed. It is beyond the understanding of religiosity to pierce through the essential nature of hell and its strata. It also fails to comprehend the inward and multiple stratums of heavens, which provide the corresponding inmates to realise with peace and joy the higher possibilities of their existence.

عصیان عجب عصات عجب ابرار تے باقیات عجب

“The sins are a mystery. The sinners are a mystery. The virtuous and their (beneficial) results are a mystery.”

Man has been bestowed with the gift of freedom. There could have been no goodness without freedom but a free being has the possibility of doing evil as well. All sins are committed against the Divine will. The essential nature of a sin is that it is committed against one's self. Man's personality has been structured in such a way that sins disintegrate it. The set of actions, which disintegrate it are termed as sins. The mystery of sins is further compounded by the fact that the sinners sin against their own 'ideal human nature', which is individualised in every person. Virtues integrate one's personality by being in consonance with the Divine Will and

the 'ideal human nature'. The inward and outward effects of virtues never terminate but keep on the increase both in the terrestrial and the celestial worlds. Hell burns sins but heavens makes the virtues bloom forth in their fullness.

واللیل ہے رمز بطون عجب والقلم عجب ہے نون عجب

“The Night has intricate secrets, which is a mystery. The Pen is a mystery. The Nun (symbolizing Qur’anic meaning) is a mystery.”

Night symbolises ‘the abysmal darkness’ of the Essence giving rise to Divinity. Pen is the ‘First Intellect’ or the principle of determination. It is by virtue of the medium of Ahmad that the undifferentiated Reality took a differentiated form. It is also called the reality of Muhammad. The symbol of ‘nun’ stands for the transcendent and the immanent world.

والشمس تے والصفات عجب والتین تے والزیتون عجب

“The fig and the olive are mysteries. The sun and the angels are mysteries.”

The fig and the olive symbolise the pure Intellect assuming the religious form of sentiment. It points to the fruitfulness of the religious tradition both in the inward and the outward. It consists in the sprouting of the inner Truth (Revelation) within the beings of the Prophets namely, Musa, Isa and Muhammad (monotheistic cycle). The symbolism of sun and angels enshrined in traditional cosmology and angelology helps one in gaining knowledge of the Absolute and different levels or degrees of its manifestations but the ordinary consciousness fails to understand these realities.

من عین الی این است عجب ما الحاصل فی البین است عجب

“The origin and the centre are mysteries. The ultimate realisation is a mystery.”

The Essence transformed itself into Divinity, which led to the origin of Man. Now, the vocation of Man is to find his

origin and centre by realising the possibilities inhering in him. The fruit of his realisation is the attainment of deliverance and union.

من علم الی العین است عجب اسرار رموز نکات عجب

“The stages of knowledge are mysteries. The intricacies, clues and points are mysteries.”

Knowledge is not static but is essentially a dynamic affair. Man passes through certain stages of knowledge and certainty till he attains perfect knowledge and absolute certainty by realising the identity of knowledge and being. The intricacies, clues and points involved in the process of gaining such sacred knowledge are so mysterious.

گھر بار ڈسے برابر اسماں گئے وسر سبھو کم کار اسماں

“My own dwellings seem desolate and deserted to me. All my preoccupations have dwindled into insignificance.”

The lover's inner and outer dwellings seem so deserted to him without his beloved. His only work is to be in contemplation of his friend. He has no other business. Love is not a part time affair. It is a whole time activity involving the lover's whole being wholeheartedly and wholesomely.

لاچار تے زار نزار اسماں واہ ڈتڑی برہوں برات عجب

“I am helpless and distressful. Thus, your rewarding my love is a mystery.”

He does not understand as to why his beloved has rewarded his love by making him helpless and distressed.

ہک پاسوں ناز نواز عجب پئے پاسوں عجز نیاز عجب

“The pride and elegance, on the one side is a mystery. Humility and humbleness, on the other side, is a mystery.”

He fails to understand the posture of pride and elegance of his beloved towards him, when he intensely suffers just because he is madly in love with him. It is equally a mystery for him when his beloved takes the form of humility and humbleness before him.

ہے سوزِ عجب ہے سازِ عجب ہے گھنڈِ عجب ہے جہاتِ عجب

“The heart burning is a mystery. The musicality is a mystery. The veil is a mystery. The gaze is a mystery.”

Heart burning in love, which removes the dross from the heart and purifies it as a mirror for the beloved to contemplate Himself, and the lover to have a simultaneous vision of the beloved is so mysterious. The musicality of love, refining the lover's sentiments to be worthy of communicating with the beloved, sound so strange. The beloved is hidden beneath ‘seventy thousand veils of light and darkness’. It is a mystery that how a lover could see Him in the presence of these veils? One cannot see light unless it is mixed with darkness; likewise one cannot see the beloved unless it is in veils. The mystery becomes deepened when in spite of the veils the lover has a gaze of the beloved.

وہ عالمِ حسن آبادِ عجب وہ سونہیاں دا بیدادِ عجب

“The lauded world of beauty is a mystery. The tyranny of the charming ones is a mystery.”

The manifestation of the world of beauty from the Beauty itself is very mysterious. Beauty is simply incomprehensible. Why the charming ones resort to tyranny in relationship with the ones who love them in wholesomeness?

لٹی دلڑی دی فریادِ عجب مٹھیاں اکھیاں دی برساتِ عجب

“The call of the ransacked heart is a mystery. The continuous flow of tears from the ruinous eyes is a mystery.”

It is so strange that the heart ransacked at the hands of the beloved still calls him for union and the ruinous eyes filled with tears still long for his vision.

ہر آن احد ڈول دھیان دھرو ہے بے شک دین ایمان ایہو

“Do concentrate on the One at all times. It is undoubtedly, the traditional way.”

It is the traditional way, without an iota of doubt, to fully concentrate on the One at all times. One should always seek the One behind multiple things. One must constantly keep in mind the principle of unity in the world of multiplicity.

دل نال فرید دا وعظ سنو سوبات دی ہے ہک بات عجب

“Listen to the sermon of Farid with receptivity of heart. It is a mystery that his discourse takes you to the crux of the matter.”

He invites his votaries to listen to his sermons with full receptivity. It takes one to the heart of the matter in making him fully concentrate on the One, which rids him of otherness. It makes him mindful of the principle of unity in diversity.

Kafi-24

قسم خدا دی قسم نبی دی عشق ہے چیز لذیذ عجیب

“I swear by God and I swear by the Prophet that the reality of love is a delectable mystery.”

The act of swearing brings home the idea that love is a delectable mystery that awakes a person from his ‘dogmatic slumbers.’ The joint swearing by God and the Prophet is something unusual and it conveys the message of the essential reality of love and its manifestations. The love of the Prophet is vital in Islamic gnosis. The obedience of the Prophet without loving him is not fraught with any higher meaning in spiritual life. The claim of loving him without obeying him also has no spiritual worth. The ideal is to love him and pay heed to what he has said. It does not mean to blindly follow the clerics who are oblivious of the vertical dimensions of his prophecy and merely remain restricted to the horizontal ones that too without understanding the real spirit. They deny the spiritual presence of the Prophet since they have not experienced him both inwardly and outwardly. Islamic Spirituality is unique in the sense that it makes the love of the Prophet crucial in the love of God. It also understands the metaphysical, universal, cosmological, traditional, symbolic, religious, and cultural aspects of the Arabian Prophet.

نفسی خلط ہے تو میں غالب پر مایوس نہ تھیویں طالب
پیر مغاں ہے خاص طبیب

“O’ seeker! Do not fall in despair even when sensuality has overpowered you. The cup bearer is a special therapist.”

‘The total integration of the personality achieved in Sufi training is the goal sought by much of psychotherapy and psychoanalysis, which, however, can never achieve this goal, for their methods as practised today are cut off from the grace of the Spirit which alone can integrate the psyche. As a result, they usually lead to its disintegration rather than to its integration.’ Spiritual psychology has perfect knowledge of the structure of human personality, the factors that integrate and disintegrate it, the aetiology of psychic and ‘heart’ diseases and the methods of cure. One of the main works of the murshid as a special spiritual therapist is to free the person of the overpowering sensuality. The carnal desires essentially arise due to powerlessness in which there are self-defeating attempts to turn the other into an object by forfeiting his or her freedom. The subject metamorphoses himself as an object in the attempts of treating a free being as an object. The fleshly desires become abnormal and lead to sexual perversions. These acts become dark screens between the sensualist and the Divine. The role of murshid is manifold and one of his roles is to free his disciple from the bondage of desire. He inspires in him the love of God, which when deeply rooted ultimately uproots all forms of bestiality. Light makes the darkness vanish as if it was not there. The spiritual psychology of sex at the hands of the spiritual therapist works wonders in understanding the reality of sex in the metaphysical perspectives. The legitimate sexual union of husband and wife bereft of spiritual union falls too short of realising the cosmic purpose of sex. The institution of marriage is essentially spiritual in nature. However, the seeker need not fall in despair since the spiritual therapist uproots all negativities and opens the door to seek union with the beloved.

لکھ لکھ سول ہزاراں ڈکھڑے سو سو شکر جو آیم بکھڑے
بیشک ضرب حبیب ذبیب

“There are countless afflictions and innumerable sufferings that have fallen to my lot. I am offering

numerous thanksgivings. There is no doubt that the blows from my beloved are gratifying.”

He offers thanksgivings to his beloved for the afflictions and sufferings he undergoes at his transcendence for they are in essence gratifying. They deepen the relationship of love and intensify the fire of love in his heart, which ultimately leads to union. The meaningfulness of suffering is a great boon since it does not make his life meaningless.

عمر نبھایم سڑ دیں دکھ دیں
تپ دیں کھپ دیں ڈکھ دیں جکھ دیں
پلڑے پیم نصیب نصیب

“I have spent my life flaming, burning without smoke or flame, blazing, raising hue and cry, suffering and bearing tribulations. I have got what was destined for me.”

His suffering for the sake of the beloved is his destiny. It is the primordial destiny of love.

نھی ان سوہاں منہ نہ لاوے
جے لک ڈیکھاں گھونکھٹ پاوے
تو نیں وسدم سخت قریب

“He behaves as a stranger and keeps me at arm’s length. When I stealthily look at him, He veils himself. He dwells in absolute proximity with me.”

The beloved resides in proximity to the lover but due to an act of veiling seems so far. It is not a physical distance to be measured by space but it is an inward distance, which is a symbol of farthest limit and is symbolic of nearness itself. It is the isthmus or veil of the sour waters of disunion or separation, and the sweet waters of deliverance or union, flowing in the same sea. He has to drink from both the sides. He is likened to a fish in the sea craving to witness the sea.

ہر دم اس دی پیاس اسیے
میں لوہا او مقناطیے
ان القلب الیہ ینیب

“I am ever thirsting for him with great attachment. I am iron and he is magnet. Certainly, my heart wholly draws towards him.”

His attraction to his beloved is that of the iron to the magnet. This magnetism of love is so forceful that his heart is wholly drawn towards his beloved. His beloved is the spiritual magnet and he has to transform his self in such a way that by an act of magnetic pull he attains identity or union with his beloved.

سر مکتوم معما جید دنیا توں خود چنیا سید
ذوق نماز نساء تے طیب

“It was a deep secret and a great enigma that the Syed (Prophet) chose from the world, the love of prayer, women and perfume.”

The Prophet chose the love of prayer, women and perfume, which are a deep secret and a great enigma. The three things chosen are from the world but are not worldly or do not exhibit worldliness. Prayer takes one to the realm of the unseen. It gives vision of the supernal world and creates a contact between the servant and the Lord. Women symbolises femininity, the principle of creation. Man beholds the Reality in both its passive and active aspects in the medium of women. The contemplation of the Reality in women is perfect. It points to the ultimate union of the lover and the beloved. Perfume symbolises the scent of breath in spreading the word of truth, beauty and love.

میں مسکین فرید نما دھوتا پاڑا یار ایانا
سو سوویڑھے وسم رقیب

“Farid! I am lowly and modest. My neighbour is a slanderer and my friend is amateur. There are countless rivals who dwell in my vicinity.”

He has no claim of being a self-subsistent reality or possessing anything of his own. His environment has become hostile. His concern is that there are slanderers and rivals here and there, who may take advantage of his amateur friend and

turn him against him. It is the ontological element of uncertainty in love, which makes him call his beloved as amateur. It is essentially the ambiguity of the situation, which makes him project his own insecurity to his perfect beloved. It is the mystery of love that he tends to draw the Divine into the realm of the human with all its limitations. Can love be judged by external standards? Isn't love its own standard?

Kafi-25

پیا عشق اساڈی آن سنگت گئی شد مد زیر زبردی بھت

“Love has absorbed us in such a way that the formal understanding of things has withered away.”

The absorption of love makes him transcend the realms of formal knowledge. The process continues till his religiosity fully transforms into spirituality.

سب و سرے علم علوم اساں کل بھل گئے رسم رسوم اساں
ہے باقی درد دی دھوم اساں بنی برہوں دی یاد رہیو سے گت

“We have gone beyond different forms of knowledge. We have transcended ritualistic patterns of behaviour. What remains is the display of pain on the tune of love.”

Formal knowledge is merely peripheral. An outward knowledge of God without existential relatedness or spiritual contact with Him, in one's inwardness, has no deeper significance. Rather, the consideration of formal knowledge as final proves an obstacle in traversing higher stages of religious life. It has a corresponding negative effect on religious behaviour. The light of love outshines the feeble light of formalism. The dichotomy between the subject and object of knowledge gets transcended, culminating in the identity of knowledge and being. The lover transcends the world of rituals by plunging in the ocean of love. The inward painful tune of love orchestrates its own song.

انہاں جو ٹھیاں غیراں ویریاں توں انہاں کوڑیاں کھڑیاں بھیڑیاں توں
انہاں کو جھیاں، گھڑیاں پیڑیاں توں ہر ویلھے یار کھنم ڈت پت

My beloved always confronts me about what he gathers from these liars- outsiders and adversaries - from these truthless and despicable 'Kheras' (in-laws of Heer), and from these ugly, quarrelsome and querulous people."

He is surrounded both by inner and outer inimical forces, which tend to disrupt his relationship with his beloved. His sense of insecurity in imagining that his beloved sees him through the hostile eyes of others gives him a vital glimpse of his own nothingness.

کر صبر تے شکر شکایت تے رکھ آس امید عنایت تے
پے فخر دی فقر ولایت تے ڈینہہ راتیں دلڑی ڈیوم مت

"My heart counsels me day and night to offer thanksgiving and remain steadfast in adversity and to keep hope and expectation in the efficacy of spiritual blessings of Fakhr."

The wisely attitude of gratefulness and steadfastness in adversity helps him in facing the testing times of love. An inward commitment with his murshid Fakhr Jehan builds hope and expectation in his spiritual blessings. Faith in his murshid helps him to weather all storms of despair.

مٹھی گلڑیں شہر وکھو ہیں دی تقی ملک ملامت ڈو ہیں دی
سجی روہی رواے رو ہیں دی ڈتی خلعت یار برو چل جت

"I am in miserable state facing complaints and wide accusations. I am the inept one, who has been openly reproached and censured. I am wandering in the desert of desolate 'rohi', rocky grounds and mountains. It is the investiture of robe from my Baloch friend."

The investiture of the robe of love from his beloved gives rise to inner and outer hostile environment. Love is not a static phenomenon. Its dynamism forces him to make an intense and continuous struggle to win his beloved.

نت کھاوان ڈکھڑیں توں مک لت ہاں آکھن! نیڑا لیسیں وت
کڈیں مئے توئے تے کڈیں کرن بہت ڈے دڑ کے خوب نیڑن ست

“I am roughed by sufferings and lost in wilderness.
The near and dear ones behave rudely towards me.
They threaten me to desist from love; otherwise they
will squeeze the last drop of my blood.”

The hostility of the near and dear ones makes him grow from within. It provides Him an occasion to actualise the hidden potentialities of his existence, which otherwise would have remained dormant. All these negativities have an overall positive context. A continuous struggle against the negative forces strengthens him in the path of love.

سٹ کلہڑی یار فرید گیا ایہو حال نمائی نال تھیا
فریاد کراں کریا دپیا ہتھ مل مل بیٹھی روواں رت

“Farid! My friend went away by leaving me forlorn. It was such a terrible thing that befell the modest one. I beseech in remembering my beloved. I am in a state of despondency with tears of blood flowing from my eyes.”

He becomes miserable in remembrance of his transcendent beloved. Isn't the state of misery in being forlorn at the hands of the beloved one of the nicest things that can happen to a person in the state of love since it saves him from the pettiness of life and intensifies his quest for his beloved?

Kafi-26

میڈا مسٹر امانھوں کاک جا شالارا نا اندیم رات

“My sweetheart of Kak! I pray that you enlighten me
with your presence, in the darkness of night.”

The princess Momal was living in Kak mahal, Ghotki. Mahendra (Rano), a prince, fulfilled the condition imposed by her of crossing the ‘magnetic field’ to marry her. Their love for each other was proverbial. One day she missed her husband so much that she requested her sister to sleep beside her. Mahendra returned unannounced and thought that his beloved was sleeping with her paramour. Due to this misunderstanding, he decided to leave quietly and never returned again. Both ultimately died in the fire of love. Momal was left in the lurch and was enveloped by the dark night of her life. She beseeches her sweet beloved to enlighten her with his presence in the darkness of night, which has enveloped her life.

ہی سک دے کان ستی ہم سومل کوں گھن سات

“I slept by the side of my sister Somal, while
anxiously desirous of you.”

The desire of her beloved was so overpowering that as a moral support she requested her sister Somal to sleep by her side, which created the tragic story. It was apparently a mix-up, but it is understandable that essentially love tolerates no associate. It is absolute with no room for otherness.

پھیر سوہائیں جیندیں ماڑیاں تو نہیں ڈینہہ چھ سات

“Do come again and dwell with me in the mansions,
may be just for a couple of days.”

Her ambiguity of love makes her strand between hope and uncertainty. There are no external standards to resolve the contradictions. They deepen the mystery of love. She desires her lover to shed his transcendence and dwell with her for some time in forms of immanence.

سچ ڈس جو کجھ کیتی ایہا ماڑی بہی مر جات

“Do tell me the truth that the way you have treated
me, does it mirror the hospitality of Marwar.”

She points to the hospitality of love, her essential cultural value, which does not warrant her beloved to treat her in such an inhospitable way.

کاک کندھن تے رل مل مانوں سانوں دی برسات

“Let us enjoy together, the rains of the season, at the
bank of Kak River.”

She invites her beloved to enjoy the heavenly blessings of love in togetherness at the bank of the stream of love.

کہیں وٹڑی ویہہ گیوہاں تے ول نہ پایو جھات

“What happened that you became stony and did not
cast a glance at me?”

She does not understand the reason of her beloved's silence regarding misgivings in his heart that have created a stone wall between them.

غم دا حال سانواں کیویں سوڈکھ تے ہک وات

“How can I narrate my sorrowful state and countless
sufferings with just one tongue?”

Her tongue cannot express the great magnitude of her sorrows and sufferings (what it expresses is like a tip of the iceberg).

کاکل کھنڈیاں چوریاں ڈیساں کرکئی ملن دی بات

“O’ ravens! I will give you crumbled bread rolled in sugar if you resort to crowing signifying (omen) union with my beloved.”

She misses her beloved so much that she readily honours the omen of his visit. Love is such a state that her rationality crumbles down. She resorts to omens like a drowning person catching at a straw to save his life.

پیت پٹھے نت درد کشالے واڈاتے وی ڈات

“Laudation to the bounties of the bountiful for love has been constantly bestowing pain and adversities on me.”

Isn’t it a bounty from the bountiful that love has been tied with pain and adversities?

ڈینہہ گھنے رورائیں کیتم راتیں کئی پر بھات

“I have rotated countless days and nights in crying.”

She has been sleeplessly crying in seeking her beloved.

مونجھ ملال فرید ملیوسے از لولوں برہوں برات

“Farid! Love has destined me for anguish and melancholy ever since the primordial day.”

Love is attached with anguish and melancholy since the primordial day. It was the primordial instant when the ‘birth pangs’ of love itself gave ‘birth’ to the lover and the beloved. The tribulations of love are the steps forward to unite with one’s beloved. The primordial polarisation can be ultimately withdrawn by the Grace of the Lord.

Kafi-27

پنل تھیوں پاندھی یارا 'کے کلہڑی بروچ
ہر دم و تاں درماندی یارا سے سے روگ اندر وچ

“My friend Punna! You have become vagrant by leaving me alone in wilderness. I am roaming dejectedly, my friend, with countless malaise within me.”

The possibility of friendship with God takes a person to the spiritual realm, which is higher than the religious one. The essence of religion is spirituality that opens a passage to the beloved that is likened to the eye of the needle. It is impossible for a twisted rope to pass through this passage. She has to ultimately thin herself inwardly to pass through the needle eye. Love initiates the process of thinning out leading to nothingness, which ultimately unites the lover with the beloved.

پیت نہ پالی سردے والی تول نہالی رو لیس خالی
دل در دوں کر لاندی یارا مونہہ پلڑو گھر گھر وچ

“The guardian of my being did not cultivate love with me. He left me by wretchedly demeaning the nuptial quilt and mattress. My heart is groaning with pain, my friend. I am wandering from door to door, while wrapping my face with shawl.”

Her state of being abandoned by her beloved is replete with the most difficult moments of her life.

رکھدی آس امید ہزاراں آخر ہک ڈینہہ موڑ مہاراں

“I am having hope and great expectations that at last my beloved will turn the reins towards me (return) to attend my funeral rites, my friend, and lead me to the grave.”

The elements of hope and expectations keep her alive in the face of great vicissitudes of love. Her dying in love could be recompensed if her beloved turns up even to attend her funeral and burial rites. Love is such an absolute commitment, which does not die with death.

سول دے سہرے سوز دے گانے مونجھ دے ہار ڈکھاں دے گہنے
دردی بانہہ سراندی یارا وسدی یاس نگر وچ

“I am wearing chaplets of afflictions and colourful threads of passion around my wrist (symbolising marital bond). I am garlanded with anguishes and ornamented with sufferings. My painful arm is folded under my head, my friend, while dwelling in the city of despair.”

She faces ordeals while living in the city of despair. All signs of nuptial happiness wear a cheerless look. The posture of intimacy comes to signify remoteness.

نہینہ اوڑا دشمن ویڑھا مایور کھم بکھیرا جھیرا
کیا بردی کیا باندی یارا کردیاں ٹوک ٹبر وچ

“My art of loving is so peculiar that it has created enmity in my surroundings. My parents develop incongruities and brawls with me. Whether they are my maidservants or are my bondmaids, my friend, they ridicule me in my family.”

The world is constitutive of her being. She faces hostility at the hands of her family members due to her being completely immersed in love. She faces great humiliation at being scorned by her maidservants and bondmaids. It is so

overbearing but the ablution of love helps her in peeling-off the layers of the self, which ultimately leads to nothingness.

مارو تھل دے ڈکھڑے گھاٹے گپ، کھڈ، کھڑ بن، کھوب، گپانے
رات ڈینہاں تڑپھاندی یارا رلدی روہ ڈونکروچ

“The difficult passes of the deadly desert are filled with sufferings. My feet stumble in mires, pits, cavities, quagmires and uneven patches of land. My day and night restiveness, my friend, makes me wretchedly wander in mountainous terrains.”

The path of love is characterised by inward and outward hazards. She negotiates her way through all odds. It is so easy to lose than to find.

برہوں بلانیں سنجھ صبا حیں دم دم آہیں نکلن دھائیں
سیجھ فرید نہ بھاندی یارا لگڑی چوٹ اندروچ

“The calamities of love accompany me from dusk to dawn. There are heaves of sighs and imploring at each and every moment. Farid! The nuptial bed has ceased to appeal me, my friend. I have been hurt in the inmost chambers of my being.”

His sufferings reach their climax when he is deeply hurt from within. The ordinary meaning of things starts fading away. It symbolises the withering away of his habitual self. It is a meaningful suffering leading to higher spiritual openings culminating in union.

Kafi-28

یار بروچل کان رلدی روہ ڈونگروچ
 لائیں جڑ کر بان دلڑی، جان، جگروچ

“My friend Barochall! I am wandering wretchedly in the mountainous terrains. He has perfectly cast the arrow of love in my heart and being.”

The arrow of love pierces her embodied self (whole being). The initiative of love comes from the side of the beloved. The seed of love germinates in the heart of the lover and fructifies in its fullness. Divine love ushers in a reciprocal relationship. Human love, on the other hand, at times may be ‘one-sided,’ and more or less a psychic affair being born in the human psyche and dying within it. It tries in vain to possess the other person as an object. Human love does not involve the whole being of a person because human psyche is just one of its aspects. It is, in a certain sense, misplaced love since all love is love of the divine. Love attains authenticity when psychical is transformed into the spiritual.

سینگیاں سرتیاں کنتھ رچھایا اپنے اپنے ڈھول کوں پایا
 میکوں میڈڑے مان رولیا سخرے بروچ

“My same age friends have cultivated love with their beloveds and each one of them has united with her beloved. My own vanity has wretched me in desolate and deserted places.”

Her friends have succeeded in realising union but the vanity of her individuality has stranded her in wilderness. The consciousness of her separative existence obstructs union with her beloved. She has to undergo sufferings in order to

realise that her individuality is not a thing but a series of relationships and it has no autonomous existence. The dawning of this metaphysical truth will ultimately lead her to attain identity with her beloved.

یار نہ پاواں بار اٹھاواں نیر وہانواں گاون گانواں
رکھ رکھ دین دی وان ہر کوچے گھر گھروچ

“I bear the burden of not finding my friend. My eyes are filled with tears, while singing songs in the tune of wailing in each and every street and house.”

The onerous burden of missing her friend is not merely conceptual but is existential, which shakes the fabric of her being.

ریت تتی بیاڈ کھڑے گھاٹے کھڑ بن کھوب گپاٹے گھاٹے
سٹ گیا نچا پچھان کانی مار اندروچ

“There is burning sand and passages of sufferings. There are cavities, quagmires and multiple uneven patches of land. He deserted me after piercing my being with the arrow of love.”

The arrows of love shooting her being result in painful realisation of love. How could love be realised otherwise?

حسن حقیقی نور حجازی کھیدے ناز نیاز دی بازی
صدقوں سمجھ سنجان آیا کوٹ شہروچ

“The essential Beauty in the form of Hejazi Light is playing the game of priding and humility. Truly understand and recognize that he has descended in the City of Kot.”

The Beauty of the Divine Essence, manifest in the enlightened form of Muhammad at Hejaz (Medina), is playing the game of transcendence and immanence. The colourless Light passing through the Muhammadan prism has assumed the colourful form of Fakhr Jehan (the spiritual master of Khawaja Ghulam Farid), who resides in Kot Mithan.

راہ اولڑے اوکھیاں گھائیاں
چبھدے کمرے کنڈڑے کاٹھیاں
مارم سول وڈان
آیم ظلم قہروچ

“The ways of difficult passes are intractable. My feet are being pricked with gravelling, thorns and wooden pieces. The afflictions are hammering me. I have become the victim of severe cruelty.”

The severities and cruelties in the hazardous way of love indicate that he is on the right path.

پہلے ڈینہہ دی قسمت پٹھری
جہریں ویلے امڑی مٹھری
ڈٹڑا ڈکھ داڈان
لوڑھیں برہوں بحر وچ

“My fortune has overturned ever since the primordial day. My miserable mother at the time of my birth gave me the dose of suffering. It plunged me into the ocean of love.”

The cosmic nature of love is realised in the terrestrial world by virtue of suffering. He suffers to realise the Divine purpose writ in the ultimate nature of things.

درد فرید ہمیشہ ہووے
سارے پاپ دوئی دے دھودے
رہندی تا نگھ تے تان
پہنچاں پریم نگر وچ

“Farid! I am having constant pain. It wipes out all the sins of duality. I have insatiable longing to reach the City of Love.”

He considers it a sin to hold consciousness of his separative existence. The constant pain of separation heals the scar of his being in order to do away with the illusory sense of duality from his mind between him and his beloved. He has an intense existential longing to attain identity with love itself. It is the supreme identity in which, he and his beloved cease to exist as such. The height of metaphysical love is achieved when polarisation is withdrawn by Love itself.

Kafi-29

بٹھ گھٹ کوڑ نکمڑیں ہک حق کوں کریاد

“Do cast aside the false and the valueless and remember the sole Reality.”

The remembrance of the sole Reality is the invaluable truth. All else is false having no value.

تھی کر گھلارت پوں تے کردیں دھانہہ فریاد

“Your insatiable cravings for worldliness are worthless and are essentially despicable like bloody watery substances oozing out from the body.”

The craving of worldliness is despicable. It seals the higher possibilities of the self and soils the person in the infernal diabolical mires of his being. The sensate or the hedonist self solely craves for the gratification of lower impulses and ends up in bestiality. It captives his freedom and reduces him to an object of no use.

باجھوں احد حقیقی محض خراب آباد

“All things are merely depraved without the essential One.”

Anything inconsonance with the Divine One is hideous.

حسن مجازی جوٹھا ہے فانی برباد

“The profane beauty is false. It is ephemeral and ruinous.”

The truth of sacred beauty is metamorphosed into the falsehood of profane beauty, which is both ephemeral and ruinous. The Divine Essence is Beauty itself manifest in all

forms of beauty. It is the presence of the Beautiful that lends beauty to things. However, divorcing permanence of beauty from its original source and considering it only as a terrestrial phenomenon, tantamount to declaring it to be autonomous and thus, degrading it to the level of the profane.

کھ مجنوں کھ لیلیٰ کھ شیریں فرہاد

“Where is Majnun? Where is Layla and where are Shireen and Farhad?”

The lovers and the beloveds, glorified in the cultural tales of love, have gone beneath the earth. The manifestations have no reality in themselves. Reality belongs only to the Divine Essence, which manifests itself in different forms.

کل شے غیر خدا دی ہالک بے بنیاد

“All things other than the Divine are perishable and devoid of being.”

All things are bound to perish except the Face of God. There is no thing, which has an independent, autonomous or self subsistent reality therefore it is bound to perish.

باجھ محبت ذاتی کو جھا شور فساد

“There is ugliness and mere loud chattering without divine love.”

The absence of Divine love makes everything meaningless.

مرشد فخر جہاں نے کیتم اے ارشاد

“Fakhr-i-Jehan, my spiritual master, has pontificated (solemnly declared).”

Fakhr-i-Jehan, his spiritual master, by virtue of realised knowledge has declared words of wisdom.

عارف ابن العربی ساڈا ہے استاد

“Ibn ‘Arabi, the gnostic, is our Master.”

Ibn Arabi, the gnostic, is his master who has taught him the doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud).

سجھ فرید، ہمیشہ رہو غیروں آزاد

“Farid! Understand it for all times. Remain free of otherness.”

The understanding of the doctrine taught by the master, both in its vertical and horizontal dimensions, has to be kept in view for all times. The reality of Divine Omnipresence leaves no room for the other. It is ‘seeing God everywhere.’ A person achieves real freedom in the act of metaphysical realisation, when he becomes free from otherness in all spheres including his own. He realises that there is nothing beside the Principle and its Manifestations. The question of otherness does not arise.

Kafi-30

حسن ازل داتھیا اظہار احدوں ویس وٹا تھی احمدؑ

“The essential Beauty became manifest. Ahad’s formlessness assumed Ahmad’s form.”

The Essence itself is the repository of infinite Possibilities. It desired, by virtue of love, to realise these Possibilities in the form of Attributes. The Nameless desired to be named. The undifferentiated Reality (Ahad) or the beauty of the Essence assumed the form of differentiated Reality through the Principle of Ahmad.

سلب ثبوت جتھاں مسلوبے اتھ نہ طالب نہ مطلوبے
ہے ”لایدر کہ الابصار“ بے حد مطلق، مطلق بے حد

“Being and nothingness are transcended and there is neither seeker nor the sought. The Reality is beyond sense perception. It is Nondelimited Freedom and Freedom without delimitation.”

Negativity (nothingness) implied in negation and positivity (being) understood as affirmation is both transcended to a degree in which there is neither the seeker nor the sought. The subject and object structure of reality is merely phenomenal and thereby ephemeral. The eye cannot perceive the Reality. How could sense-perception observe the supersensible Reality? The Essence is Nondelimited freedom and freedom without delimitation for there is no constraint, determination and limit in it.

غیب الغیب دے دیسوں آیا شہر شہادت دیر الایا
احدیّت دا گھنڈا تار تھیا اطلاقوں محض مقید

“He came from the Realm of the Most Invisible. He dwelled in the land of the visible. He unveiled himself. He was Freedom itself, who assumed delimitation (delimited freedom).”

The Essence assumed the form of Divinity in revealing its formlessness in manifested forms and became visible in the form of Being (world). Freedom itself has no opposite, constraint or delimitation but then it becomes delimited by being Nondelimited. Thus, pure Freedom warrants both Nondelimited freedom and the delimited one. Since there is no constraint in pure Freedom, therefore in the process of manifestation, Freedom appears in the form of a given freedom, which implies the possibility of a given constraint. Its remoteness from its primordial source is not absolute and thus it is ultimately brought back to its original source.

حق باطل، سبھ حق ہے حق ہے پر اے راز بہوں مغلق ہے
یار ہے یار ہے یار ہے یار سوہنا کو جھانیک اتے بد

“Truth and falsehood is essentially truth itself but it is a much profound secret. The beautiful, ugly, virtuous, and vicious are our friends, companions, comrades and intimates.”

The Absolute being Infinite is identical with ‘All-Possibility’ or ‘Universal Possibility.’ The inexpressible Infinite has to delimit itself and take a determinate form in order to express itself. It gives rise to communication, radiation and relativity resulting in differentiation, contrast, and privation. The Truth, the Beauty and the Good have no opposites in themselves but once each is reflected in the manifested order, it appears in a particular form and this necessitates the possibility of a given opposite. The Truth, the Beauty and the Good are pure of falsehood, ugliness and evil respectively. It is in the process of manifestation that the Truth appears in the form of a given truth, which necessitates the possibility of a given falsehood. The Beauty appears in the form of a given beauty necessitating the possibility of a given

ugliness. The Good appears in the form of a given good necessitating the possibility of a give evil. The negative entities, namely falsehood, ugliness and evil are not parts of the Infinite. They are privations for they have no being in themselves. They have 'a positive function of highlighting their counterparts a contrario'. The remoteness of each from its original source is not absolute, therefore it returns to it. The ugly and the vicious ones are considered as friends because they have all stemmed from the same roots. The purity of their essence is beyond defilement. Isn't relative ephemeral in comparison to the Absolute?

اودلبرے چون و چگونہ
تس داہے بے شک تقرار
ناہیں جیندا ادا مثل نمونہ
دنیا، عقبی مجلا مشہد

“The beloved Reality is beyond the questions of why and how. It has neither, any thing resembling it nor, any thing matching it. Undoubtedly, it is there in its recurring manifestations in this world, the next one and in the effulgence of the terrestrial / celestial realms.”

The origin of the Beloved's Essence cannot be questioned or challenged. It has nothing to resemble and no thing to match it. There is nothing beside Him. There is nothing outside 'the Metaphysical Whole.' The knowledge of the Essence is beyond human perception, conception and imagination. The entire worlds are constitutive of His recurring manifestations.

گئی تقلید آئی تحقیق
فاش مبین کل اسرار
تھے واضح مکشوف دقیق
برزخ زیر زبر شد مد

“The blind following has been displaced by eyeing witnessing. The subtleties by being unveiled have become absolutely clear. All mysteries of symbolic isthmus have become openly manifest.”

His religious stages of faith and reason have been surpassed. His eye of the heart has perceived the subtle realities. All the mysteries have become translucent to his consciousness. He has understood the mysteries of the isthmus couched in the language of symbolism. It has given him an understanding of the different layers or degrees of Reality.

کیتا ازلی لطف ظہور
تھیاد دل کوں تسکین قرار
سو سو شکر ملایا گر پورا
ہوئے خطرات شکوک سبھی رد

“The primordial subtlety became manifest. We offer countless thanksgivings for its manifestation in the form of the Most Perfect Man. My heart is filled with calmness and tranquillity. All dangers and doubts have been cast away.”

His heart is filled with gratitude to his Lord for manifesting His primordial subtlety in the form of the perfect Prophet. His blessings have cleansed his heart of all lurking dangers and doubts. His heart rests in peace.

پیرمغاں مسجود جتو سے
کیتا من کر من اقرار
فرض فرید نماز نیتو سے
ہے خود اصل حقیقی مقصد

“The submission to the will of the tavern-keeper is Farid’s standing for the obligatory ritualistic prayer. It is transforming faith into inward certainty. It is the true and real purpose (of submission to the spiritual master).”

His real purpose, in the spiritual way, is to completely submit to the will of his spiritual master, whose will is identical with the will of God. It has transformed his faith into inward certainty. The Divine mysteries have unfolded before him.

Kafi-31

عُن دو سہیلی سکھڑ سیانی برہوں دے پنڈھڑے سخت بعید

“Listen! My cultured and accomplishing friend! The paths of love are quite distant.”

It is equally a lesson for her intelligent friends that it is quite difficult to reach the destination of love.

نہ کل میکوں تیغ قضا دی نہ تقدیر دے تیر و غا دی
کیتم دوست دی دید شہید

“I was neither aware of the sword of fate nor of destiny’s arrow in warfare. The gaze of my friend has reduced me to nothing.”

He was oblivious of the cosmic and terrestrial realities. He only knows that the look of his beloved has slain him.

جے ڈینہ بھلڑے متروی بھلڑے قسمت جوڑے جوڑ کلڑے
یار شدید تے بخت عنید

“Good fortune brings good friends. Destiny ties unintelligible relationships. My friend is imperious and fate is hostile to me.”

Friendship is a boon from Heavens. His destiny has tied him to an imperious friend whose behaviour is so unintelligible. The development of love transforms unintelligible things into intelligible ones.

روون پٹن کوں سمجھوں شادی سنخ بر، جھر، جھنگ ڈسم آبادی
عشرہ محرم ساڈڑی عید

“I consider crying and mourning as my marriage (happiness). Wilderness and thick forests seem my dwellings. My Eid (festivity) is (analogical to) suffering of the first ten days of Muharram.”

The signs of his inner and outer environment have lost their ordinary meanings. His existentiality is conferring new meanings on things and events. He transposes these meanings in divinis. The act of crying and mourning is his marriage. He is happily tied to the bond of these states because it is all for the sake of his friend. The uneven places seem so even to him. He gets solace in thinking that he has left the comfort of his dwellings in order to meet his friend. The first ten days of Muharram in which, Imam Husayn faced the severest ordeals of his life along with his family and friends, and remained steadfast in love are a source of inspiration for him. It gives him happiness to know that oppression can never crush the soul of the lover.

سو سو چھانگاں لکھ لکھ چھیڑو دو ٹھڑے دی ووہ ڈیون پندھیڑو
روہی تھئی آباد جدید

“The travellers have brought the news of rain in the desert. There are countless lines of herds and numerous shepherds that are adding to the renewed freshness of the desert.”

Heavenly blessings refresh his feelings in the desert of his life.

جند اسیرے جور و جفادی دلڑی قیدی کرب و بلادی
ڈسم رقیب یزید پلید

“My life is captive of tyranny and oppression. My heart is locked in the narrow circuits of heightened pains and calamities. My rivals seem identical to the defiled Yezid.”

Imam Husayn, the grandson of the Prophet, underwent a great suffering in the way of love and finally embraced

martyrdom at the hands of Yezid. Likewise, his rivals are not desisting from their Yezid-like behaviour in tyrannising and oppressing him. His home ground has turned into a 'karbala'. But he remains steadfast in love by the blessings of his beloved.

بھن خرقہ بھٹ گھٹ سجادہ جامہ جاں شو پاک بہ بادہ
کردم پیر مغاں تاکید

“The cup bearer lays stress on throwing away the saintly attire, casting aside the prayer mat and purifying the embodied self with the wine of love.”

He questions his saintly attire and prayer mat if his embodied self is not purified with the wine of love. It is a recurring lesson of his murshid that he has to break the outer crust in order to reach the kernel. Love purifies the embodied self. Outwardness blocks inwardness.

سانول یار دے ناز نگہ دے مارو چال تے خال سیہ دے
تھیو سے مفت فرید خرید

“The prideful eyes of my charming friend, his ravishing gait and black mole, has bought Farid for nothing.”

The beautiful and charming friend buys him free of any cost. What else he wants?

Kafi-32

’ڈے یو معبود

یار کوں کر مسجود

“Offer prostration to your Friend (attain consciousness of your nothingness in Face of the Absolute) and discard otherness.”

The prostration to one’s friend in wholesomeness makes the lover deeply understand the reality of the Absolute or God (called as the beloved or friend in the language of love). Metaphysically speaking, the ‘self-existence’ of the Absolute and its reality or ‘range’ as the Infinite leaves no room for otherness. The entire cosmos is the manifestation of the Reality. All is His manifestation. Manifestation, by its very definition, cannot attain the status of (ilah) divinity beside the Divinity. It lacks self-subsistent reality. One can simply understand the meaning of otherness but cannot denote it since it does not exist. It is merely a mental concept without any corresponding reality. It is purely imaginary. The attempt to impute divinity to any thing except the Divinity is self-defeating.

غیر نہیں موجود

ہر صورت وچ یار کوں جائیں

“Discern your Friend in each form. There is no otherness (self-subsistent reality except the Reality).”

The friend is Omnipresent, not only in the spatial and temporal sense but, in all vertical and horizontal dimensions. The friend has to be discerned in every form. How could there be any other presence beside the all-pervasive presence of the friend. The metaphysical understanding of this reality becomes manifest in the state of ultimate realisation. The pseudo-concept of otherness vanishes like a mirage.

سبھ اعداد کوں سمجھیں واحد کثرت ہے مفقود

“Understand the essential unity of all numbers.
Plurality is impossibility.”

Mathematics, the science of numbers in its various dimensions, is generally understood in its quantitative aspects but it is qualitative in its nature. The Pythagorean understanding of numbers derives their quantity from their essential quality. It is unity, which holds the multiplicity of numbers. The phenomena of quantification and diversity are simply not there. It is only eye of the heart, which directly perceives the principle of unity in numbers and things. All multiplicity is attached to unity.

فخر الدین مٹھل دے شوقوں دم دم نکلم دود

“My each breath emits smoke in fondness of sweet
Fakharuddin.”

He reveres and loves Fakhruddin, his spiritual master, who is instrumental in guiding and helping him in attaining union with his beloved.

وصل فرید کوں حاصل ہو یا جب ہو گیا نابود

“Farid attained union (identity) by ceasing to be.”

The state of individual or mystic realisation leads to union. The lover loses his ordinary identity but still carries a sense of his individuality. The distinction between the lover and the beloved remains intact. However, at the higher level of metaphysical realization, he becomes fully consciousness of his ontological nothingness and thereby attains union. But he does carry with him a certain sense of individuality but that is qualitatively different from the one he had at the earlier stages. It has no parallel. The Divine fully takes over the human medium and acts through it. It is a stage of nonduality or the supreme identity. He ceases to exist as a lover but subsist in the Divine Consciousness of his beloved. “The supreme goal...is called moksha or mukti, that is to say

“Deliverance”, because the being who reaches it, whatever state he may belong to and whatever his rank within that state, is freed from the bonds of conditioned existence by perfect identification with the Universal: this is the realization of what Moslem esoterism calls the “Supreme Identity” and it is through this realization, and through it alone, that a man becomes a Yogi in the true sense of the word. The state of Yogi is not then analogous with any particular state, but it embraces all possible states as the principle embraces all its consequences’.

Kafi-33

اساں کنوں دل چا پو وے یار جا پے کتھاں ونج لا پو وے یار

“You have cast me away from your heart, my friend.
God knows, where you have established your
intimate relationships, my friend.”

Love is indivisible. Friendship is absolute without any parts. The feeling of being abandoned by the beloved casts a doubt that the beloved has contracted some new relationship. The lover has to undergo such mixed feelings in the state of love.

یار برو چل کیچ دا والی کیتو حال کنوں بے حالی

پر بت روہر لا پو وے یار

“My friend Barochall! Master of Kech! You have made my state deplorable. You have made me wretchedly wander in hills and mountains, my friend.”

Her transcendent beloved has made her condition worsen by stranding her in the wilderness of life. Love relationship is essentially existential, which unfolds the dynamics of the self in a situation.

ملک ملہیر وٹیونی جھوکاں میں کلہڑی وچ اوپر یاں لوکاں

ہک تل ترس نہ آ پو وے یار

“You have started dwelling in the city of Malheer. I am alone stranded amongst strangers. You did not care to have even an iota of pity on me, my friend.”

She considers herself stranded among people who appear as outsiders to her during the transcendence of her beloved. Love has transformed her social perception. Things and events remain but their meanings go on changing with her changing perception. She has reached such an intensified state of suffering that she invokes pity of her friend. But, if her wish is granted at this stage then her love will cease to ripen. Her beloved does not take pity on her because he wants her love to fructify. But in spite of this inkling, her hearts remains restless and finds no rest. She has no means to lift the curtain of transcendence.

میں کملی کیا جانناں نینہہ کوں ظلمی نہرتے قہری شینہہ کوں
آپے دید اڑا یوے یار

“How could I know about the cruel wolf and the wild lion of love, being so inexperienced myself? You entangled me with your gaze, my friend.”

Love is not a conceptual relationship. The existential metaphysics of love brings out the dynamics of love couched in existential categories. She finds herself thrown in the situation of love. She cannot free herself from the existential sufferings of love.

آپے اپناں سوہاں کیتو کرہوں قطار یوناں نہ نیتو
کیں دھوتی برما یوے یار

“You yourself familiarised with me but while lining your camels you did not take me along with you. I am at a loss to understand as to who is that backbiter, who has instigated you against me, my friend.”

She is at a loss to understand the reason for her beloved's transcendence after he initiated love in her heart. She does not find any cogent reason of his sudden departure. Has any backbiter instigated him against her?

یار مٹھی کوں ڈترو روا
ساڑیو کیتو کیری کولا

تتزی کوں کیوں تاہو وے یار

“You have wretched me, the hapless one, my friend.
You have burnt and reduced me to ashes. Why have
you made the inept fiery, my friend?”

She questions her beloved in making her suffer so much in
the states of separation and disunion.

آپے شہر بھنھور ڈو آویں
یاری لا کر چھوڑ سدھایوں

مفتا کوڑ کماہو وے یار

“You yourself came to the city of Bhambore and
after cultivating friendship with me just walked away.
You have earned unfaithfulness for nothing, my
friend.”

Her transcendent beloved assumed immanence in
consonance with his will. She could not force him to love her.
He nurtured friendship and then became transcendent. What
did he earn by being unfaithful to her? Doesn't imputing
human qualities, with all their delimitations, to the divine
intensify love and pave the way of lover's union with his
beloved.

یار فرید کڈایں سبھلیسی
سہجوں سڈ کر کول بلہیسی

جے وت بخت بھڑاہو وے یار

“Farid! When shall my friend take care of me and
fondly call me and make me sit beside him? It will
happen only when fortune starts smiling on me, my
friend.”

He remains stranded between hope and despair. But his
despair is different from the despair of the modern man,
which arises out of alienation and leads to depersonalization
and dehumanization of existence. Just as there is hidden light
even in darkness otherwise darkness would have been
imperceptible; likewise there is animated hope beneath his

despair, which keeps him traversing the road of love in spite of all odds.

Kafi-34

پر دیس ڈھوں دیدال اڑیاں وے یار سڈیاں وطن کنوں دیس سڑیاں وے یار

“You have gone to the remote land and my eyes are set there, my friend. My heart has become estranged to my native land, my friend.”

‘A bosom friend afar brings a distant land near’ but he feels afar in his native land. Love has its own spatio-temporal orders transcending the ordinary measures of space and time. The creative imagination of love works these miracles.

خبر نہیں انہاں کملیاں لوکاں تیغاں تیز برہوں دیاں نوکاں
درد مندال سر کھڑیاں وے یار

“These raw folk don’t know that the sharp edged swords of love are hanging on the heads of those who are the compassionate ones, my friend.”

The beloved is a hunter, who is constantly on the hunt. The naïve people do not realise that it is only a pure heart filled with compassion that gets hunted in the sanctuary of love.

جے تیں موت کر لیم ٹالا ڈیکھاں نال اکھیں دے شالا
شہر ارم شہ پریاں وے یار

“I pray that I witness the city of Garden and the **fairies** before death overtakes me, my friend.”

She prays to witness her friend, the king of the celestial world, before her death. She wishes to attain the highest metaphysical stage of Self-realisation falling to the lot of a few chosen ones.

ڈیکھ کے چالیں یار سجن دیاں ناز خراماں من موہن دیاں

کبکاں روہیں وڑیاں وے یار

“The pheasants have hidden themselves in the mountains after seeing the gait of my lovely friend and the prideful elegance of my beautiful beloved, my friend.”

The manifestation of beauty in the terrestrial sphere is no match for the manifestation of beauty in the celestial sphere. Beauty itself ‘deployed’ in the form of her beloved has sparked love in her heart. The intimate bond between beauty and love has unfolded itself before her.

میں جیہاں ٪یاں سو سٹھ سہیلیاں ناز پنیاں راج گہیلیاں

تھیاں دیوانیاں چریاں وے یار

“Your countless prideful and regal friends have become frantic and mad after you just like me, my friend.”

A lover on the plane of human psyche strives to possess the beloved as an object, which is not possible or desirable. He considers the ‘other’ as a threat to his love. The self-defeating effort on this score leads to frustration exhibiting in negative emotions including rage and jealousy. However, divine love is beyond such psychic negativities. It is contracted by heart and is universal in essence.

کشتی چایم نیہڑا لایم جندڑی مفت فرید گوایم

نبھ گیاں نکھ دیں گھڑیاں وے یار

“I was destined to fall in love. Farid! I have lost my life just for nothing. The moments of peace have fled away, my friend.”

The cosmic destiny of love unfolds itself in his life. He thinks that his life has been spent without achieving anything of real value. He had such a peaceful life, which he lost in contracting love with his beloved.

Kafi-35

بن دلبر آہیں کر کر کئی راتیں ڈتم سحر کر

“I have rotated many nights into dawns by constantly heaving sighs, without my beloved.”

Her yearning for the beloved is a whole time affair involving her whole self.

نت قدم قدم تے بھلدی روہ روہی راوے رلدی
کڈیں تھک بہندی کڈیں جلدی ہن سانول یاروہر کر

“I am wretchedly wandering in the mountains, deserts (rohi) and rocky grounds. I falter at each and every step. I sit down at times and at times I start walking. My charming beloved! Now, hasten to reach me.”

The road to love has both inner and outward hazards. The determination to traverse the path of love in spite of all odds has to be shown at every step and more so when she encounter difficulties in the way. The choice to abandon the path always remains with her. It is freedom, which makes love possible. Man has been granted freedom that makes him the epitome of creation. It is spiritual freedom transcending the psychic one that unfolds the possibility of love.

ڈوگھے ڈونگر کو جھیاں جاہیں ڈکھی ڈکھڑے سنج صباہیں
رچھ راخس بھجے ڈر کر جتھ ممیں غول بلائیں

“My mornings and evenings are filled with sufferings. There are infernal mountains and hideous places where even man-eaters, wild beasts, demons, bears and giants are scared to stay and thereby run away.”

The life threatening situations faced by her in the outer environment notwithstanding, she face the greatest threats from her psyche. Her self intimidates her. She understands that it is by constantly struggling against it that she will remain in the tracks of love.

بن عاشق اہل وفادے بن شائق ذوق لقادے
بن صاحب صدق و صفادے اتھ آوے کون گزر کر

“Who would cross these hazards and reach here without faithfulness in love, without fondness for the taste of witnessing and without the virtues of sincerity and purity?”

Faithfulness in love is the edifice of love relationship. It is faithfulness, which keeps the lover tied to the beloved. How could the lover win his beloved if he betrays love? The one, who is not fond of witnessing, resembles the one who has no desire to see the beloved. Religiosity is content without witnessing the ultimate Reality (the beloved) but spirituality does not rest content with it and rises higher to have a direct contact with the Reality. The virtues of sincerity and purity demonstrate the truth of Oneness of Being without any trace of otherness. The success story of love is characterised by such universal dynamics.

لڈ نیتو جھوک پریرے دل درداں لایم دیرے
ڈسے روٹی ہاں دے بیرے پیوں پانی خون جگر کر

“You took away the household belongings and made your dwellings far away. Pains have started dwelling in my heart. The loaf of bread seems to be made of pieces of my heart. I am drinking water as if it was my liver’s blood.”

Love shakes the fabric of one’s being. It is not merely a conceptual affair but it involves the whole man. The state of a lover’s heart at times is analogous to the rough sea.

تھی کنڈڑے تول نہالی گھر ڈیوم ڈین ڈکھالی
دل ہوت دلیں داوالی آ! سینے ساڈے گھر کر

“My nuptial quilt and mattress have become thorny.
My house has become haunted. The sovereign of my
heart Punna! Come back and set your dwellings in
my heart.”

Her heart is the abode of the beloved. The transcendence
of the beloved makes it deserted and haunted. It is only when
the beloved unveils that she has a homely feeling within
herself.

گیوں ویری کچھ سفر کر جی جالیو ظلم قہر کر
جکھ جکھدیں ویساں مر کر تھل مارو گور قبر کر

“You proceeded towards Kech by being inimical to
me. You have made my heart burn with severe
cruelty. I will die by rotting in suffering. My grave
shall be in the deadly desert.”

The intensity of suffering faced by her at the
transcendence of her beloved testifies to the fact that the
beloved has perfectly cast the arrow of love in her heart. It
indicates the ripening process of love. The toll of love is
nothing less than her sacrificial head.

سوہنا یار فرید ڈوں آوے گل لاوے سچھ سہاوے
آجرڑی جھوک وساوے ہے! ٹھڈڑی آہ اثر کر

“Farid! I wish my beloved friend comes to embrace
me and embellish the nuptial bed. His homecoming
may enliven the deserted house. O’ my cold sigh! Do
fructify.”

Love moves on the spectrum of hope and despair. In spite
of deadliest sufferings, the light of hope remains shining
beneath his despair. It is the element of creative hope that
confers meaning to his sufferings. Doesn’t ‘a light moth break
the spell of pitch-black night’?

Kafi-36

پنل کے کچھ سدہاویں دلڑی نمائی ہے زار نزار

“Punnal! You left me and went to Kech. My modest heart is in a distressful state.”

The state of separation after union or transcendence after immanence is so terrible for her. It is inversely proportional to union. Love embraces many a unions and separations before the ultimate union in which the lover and the beloved are in a supreme state of unison.

یاس پیاس نصیب اساڈے نہ کوئی ٹوبھے نہ کوئی تاڈے

نہ راہ ڈسدم کر ہوں قطار

“The despairing thirst has fallen to my lot. There is neither any pond nor are there any transitory dwellings to be seen. There is not even a line of camels signifying the way.”

The way of love both in its inward and outward dimensions is so testing. Her thirst of love can only be quenched by the presence of her beloved. Love like water sustains life. She feels being dried down from within. But this dry state is ultimately a harbinger of rain or heavenly blessings (responsiveness of the beloved). She finds herself as a lone traveller but unlike an alienated person, she remains in a state of solitude. She is not like an alienated person who is ‘lonely in crowd and crowded when alone’. She finds no indications of her beloved’s return but beneath this seemingly despair there is an element of hope. If the possibility of the beloved’s return was not there, then the drama of love would have finished there and then. Her constant expression of sufferings

is paradoxically the expression of her hope. She has freely chosen love. She is free from inner and outer compulsions. Her attachment with her beloved is not symbiotic since it does not stem from the psychical plane. It is purely a free relationship. She understands the game of love; otherwise she would have thrown her cards long ago.

درد گھنیرے ڈکھ ہزاراں سول تتی کوں تار متاراں
برہوں پچھیند اروز آزار

“I am bearing heavy pains and undergoing countless sufferings. I am the inept one, drowned in the river of afflictions. There are increasing distresses intensified by love everyday.”

The periods of ‘the dark night of the soul’ have to be borne till sudden illuminations start sprouting in her heart.

سٹ کر شاہی تھیاں باندی ٹھیک سوہیاں ریت غماں دی
کیجو کر رسم لوگ ویاں

“I shall abdicate the royal way and become a bondsman. I will live the tradition of sorrowfulness though people may detest me for that, my friend.”

Her perception is transformed in the state of love. Her ordinary understanding of things and events withers away. Things remain as such but their meanings go on changing. It is the spontaneity or creativity of love, which makes her abandon the royal way so readily and become a bondswoman, instead. Reason never agrees to such an arrangement because it is poised at a lower level. Her choice, at the plane of the Intellect, is not hard for her. Her new perception alters the customary meanings. Now, royalty signifies nothing for her. Her act of divesting herself of her being and having for the sake of her beloved is not at all difficult since her consciousness has been transposed to a higher level. How could she be termed mad in love, while she leaves the lower

for the sake of the higher? Is that person wise who leaves the higher for the sake of the lower? 'The lover is blessed with the wisdom of love.

سیچھ نہ بھوم پئی تڑپھاواں تارے گن گن رات نبھاواں
نہ کوئی ساتھی نہ غم خوار

“I am restless in the nuptial bed that is of no appeal to me. I am passing my night by counting the stars (doing the impossible and just whiling away the time). I have neither any companion nor any comforter.”

The nuptial bed symbolises union that has no meaning in a state of separation. Love is absolute and it has no relative concerns unless they manifest it in its absoluteness. Love is not a concern among other concerns. It is essentially 'the Ultimate Concern.' She suffers but there is no one to share her sufferings. Isn't the absence of any companion or comforter, in the ripening state of love, a boon from Heavens otherwise love could not ripen to its fullness?

ماپو ویرن مول نہ بھاندے مہنیں ڈیوم بردے باندے
سینگیاں سرتیاں کر دیاں عار

“My parents are my adversaries and they are absolutely not appealing to me. The bondsmen and pageboys rebuke me. My same age friends have started detesting me.”

Her parents have become her adversaries because they do not understand her being poised at a higher state. The rebuking attitude of the bondsmen and pageboys is also understandable since they are the passive vehicles of their times. Her same age friends detest her because they simply ply with worldly success. The animosity against her by different segments of society is primarily due to her rising higher than their ordinary individual, social and cultural consciousnesses. Unlike her contemporaries, who are chained in illusions, she has freed herself and seen the Reality. She is

similar to the one in Plato's 'Allegory of the Cave,' who sees the light and comes to share with his companions tied in darkness but everything falls deaf on their ears.

جس تن لکڑی سوئی تن نے جا
غیر فرید نہ ر مز پچھانے
نمجا سو ہنادلبریار

“The self, who is existentially involved in such situations, can only understand it. Farid! The outsider cannot have any clue to it. Only my beautiful beloved knows (the rationale of my suffering in love).”

The state of love is unique, which is opaque to ordinary consciousness. People tend to measure his inwardness by their outwardness. They cannot understand the lover because his love has placed him at a higher level. A higher state of consciousness can perceive the lower state but the lower state cannot perceive the higher one unless it itself achieves that state. This is precisely the reason that the creative persons have to pay a heavy price at the hands of their contemporaries who being outsiders fail to measure his intellectual heights. Love being the most creative act has the severest animosity. The only redeeming factor is that his beloved knows about his sufferings. It gives a meaning to his entire suffering, which he undergoes for his sake. The possibility of human and divine communication is a blessing, which falls to the lot of the lucky ones.

Kafi-37

بولا سسر کسنوں پاواں ڈھولن کیتم نامنظور

“Why I should wear nose ornaments, when my beloved has repudiated me?”

Love is not a static phenomenon but is highly dynamic. The ripening process of love undergoes many a stages, which have to be traversed by her. She feels no need of ornamentation after being renounced by her beloved. However, the beloved’s repudiation is temporary and it matures the lover in such trying and testing situations.

کھنوں پیناں مانگھ بناواں بجلا پاواں سرخی لاواں
یار تتی داوسدا دور

“I should wear my forehead ornaments, fill parting line of my hair with red-lead, and apply collyrium and rouge, for whom? The friend of the inept one dwells far away.”

What is the use of ornamenting when her beloved dwells far away? It is not a spatial distance as such since the beloved is nearer to her than her neck-vein. It is the veiling of the beloved, which is expressed in the form of distance. It is an existential distance that can be traversed in a single moment of union.

پیت پرانی کملا کیتا عشق او لڑالوں لوں سیتا
پودن تتی کوں پل پل پور

“The primordial love has made me wild. The intricate love has knitted each and every fibre of my

being. I am inept suffering from unintelligible (breath taking) fits at each moment.”

Love itself manifests in the form of primordial love polarised as the lover and the beloved. It is not psychic love but the spiritual one that fully knits her. She suffers love with her entire being.

طرز نیاز ساڈی موڑی قبلہ قد میں یاردی دھوڑی
حسن ازل دی چال غرور

“I adore the dust of my friend’s feet. I treasure the way of humility. The mode of the primordial beauty is so prideful.”

Beauty itself manifests in all forms of beauty. The primordial beauty is both transcendent and immanent. Beauty and love are intimately related. Beauty inspires love and love worships beauty. The lover is reduced to nothingness under the spell of awe-inspiring beauty.

سینگیاں سرتیاں سیجھ سہاؤن بانہہ چوڑیلی ور گل لاؤن
ہک میں مفت رہی مجبور

“My same age friends are laying their nuptial beds. They embrace their beloveds with their ornamental hands. I am the one, who has been forsaken for nothing.”

The realisation of love by her friends makes her experience an intense feeling of being forsaken by her beloved. It is a kind of despair but with a hidden hope of universal realisation.

وادی ایمن تھل دے چارے جتھاں بروچل کر ہوں قطارے
ککڑے ٹہڑے ہن کوہ طور

“The valley of Aiman is that part of the desert, where my beloved lines up the camels. Its yellow sand dunes are mount Tur.”

The desert and sand dunes in relationship to the beloved are likened to Aiman valley and mount Tur mentioned in the story of the prophet Musa. The subject-object structure of reality ushers in new meanings in his perceptive mind. Ordinary things become sacred in relationship to the divine.

ملاں مارن، سخت ستاؤن لچھڑے راز دا بھیت نہ پاؤن
بے وس شودے ہن معذور

“The clerics thrash me and are highly vexing. They are helpless, ineffective and disabled to unravel the deeper mysteries.”

Religiosity cannot fathom the deeper mysteries of spirituality. The clerics react because they cannot understand the mysteries of the way. They project their own incapacities to the men of understanding.

ملوانے دے وعظ نہ بھانے بیشک ساڈا دین ایمانے
ابن العربی دا دستور

“The sermons of the clerics do not touch us. Undoubtedly, our committed way is the tradition of Ibn’ Arabi.”

The sermons of the clerics do not touch the inner being of the ones who are committed to the metaphysical doctrines of Ibn Arabi. The clerics consider the religious phenomena as static. They have no concept of the stages of religious life. They are stranded at the first stage of faith and fail to move on to the highest stage of discovery where faith or ‘iman’ is transformed into the act of experiencing God. Their understanding is bereft of metaphysics, tradition, cosmology and symbolism. They have no doctrinal understanding of the Oneness of Being and its realisation. The tradition of Ibn Arabi takes one to the highest metaphysical stages by realising ontological nothingness in the ‘Face of the Absolute’

عاشق مست مدام ملای کہہ سبحانی بن بسطامی
آکھ انا الحق تھی منصور

“The entranced lover exists beyond disdain. Say: ‘Glory to me’ and become Bistami. Say: ‘I am the Truth’ and become Mansur.”

The entranced lover exists beyond the reproach of religiosity. He in the process of metaphysical realisation reaches a stage where the servant-Lord axis is withdrawn by the Self. The Divine fully takes over the human medium. The human becomes the receptacle for the expression of the Divine. The human tongue remains but whatever it utters is the Divine Speech. Do achieve the position of Bayazid Bistami so that the Divine utters the word ‘Glory to me’ through your medium. Do realise the metaphysical stage of Mansur Hallaj so that the Divine says ‘I am the Truth’ through your tongue.

حسن پرستی عین عبادت شاہد مستی صرف سعادت
غیبت غفلت محض حضور

“The adoration of Beauty is real worship. The intoxication of witnessing is felicity. Absence and forgetfulness are essentially modes of presence.”

The Reality is Beauty itself manifest in all forms of beauty. Adoring Beauty is worshipping the Most Real who is the Most Beautiful. The intoxication of witnessing the Beauty is felicity. All the beautiful things manifest or reflect the Beauty. One may be aware or not but he loves the Most beautiful in the objects of beauty. Loving a beautiful object as the manifestation of the Beauty is sacred but loving it for its own sake is profane. The transcendence and immanence of beauty has to be experienced in simultaneity in a beautiful object. The ontological mirror of nothingness (absence) reflects the beautiful face of the beloved (presence). The absence of the self is the presence of the Self.

ریت فریدی پٹھری ساری رہند اصوم صلواتاں عاری
رندی مشرب ہے مشہور

“The tradition of Farid is wholly overturned. He exists beyond ritualistic prayer and fasting. He is famous for his inebriated way of life.”

The whole Faridi tradition is counter to religiosity. It transcends ritualistic modes of worship. One no more needs the staircase after reaching the top. His inebriation has led to an encounter with his beloved. He has realised union.

Kafi-38

پئے ڈکھ گل، جے جمدے یار نہ رہ گیوسے کہیں کم دے یار

“The sufferings have become my lot ever since my birth, my friend. I have become worthless of any other work, my friend.”

The primordial love is absolute. It does not leave any room for worldliness.

باغ بہار اجاڑ کیتوسے ہار سنگار و سار ڈتوسے
دولت دنیا وار تھیوسے نوکر % ڈے دم دے یار

“I have deserted the blooming gardens. I have become oblivious of my makeup. I have sacrificed the treasures of the world for your sake. I am completely subjected to you, my friend.”

The beloved is not one of the objects amongst other objects, even if imputed the highest value. He is the sole Subject. The worldly possessions have no meaning in his eyes. His greatest treasure is his friend. He loves him in wholesomeness.

شرم شعور اسماں توں رُٹھڑے ننگ نمود دے سانگے تڑٹڑے
گھولے، صدقے کیتے مُٹھڑے آسیرے بھیم، بھرم دے یار

“My awareness and intelligence have cooled down towards me. The ties of honour and prestige have been severed. I have sacrificed for you all my destined supports, bearings and respects, my friend.”

The worldly intelligence along with ties of honour and prestige fall in oblivion in the state of love. He sacrifices his

individual, social and cultural supports and values at the altar of his beloved.

ہک ویلھے احرام حرم دے ہک ویلھے زنا دھرم دے
نہ پابند ہوں دین جرم دے بندڑے عشق دے غم دے یار

“We are dressed in the pilgrimage robe at times and at times we wear the sacred cross thread. We are not bound by the religious mode. We are only subjects of the sorrows of love, my friend.”

The religious modes no more remain binding on them. They transcend the phenomena of religiosity and enter the universal realm of love with all its sorrows.

ڈیکھو چال انوکھی پٹھری کئی ونج پہنتی کئی مر ہٹھری
ناز بے دی راند نہ کھٹھری گزرے وہ آدم دے یار

“Witness the novel and overturned move by virtue of, which numerous ones reached the destination and many got tired and perished. Many people have gone but the game of your pride has not ended, my friend.”

The die has been cast. The intricate game of love is being played by the prideful beloved. It is the game of contemplating Himself in the mirror of the lover’s heart. The one who polishes the mirror of his heart wins, but the one who tires down in the process and discontinues loses, but the game continues.

لانے، پھوگ اساؤ دے مانے ٹبرے، بھٹڑے، ڈہر، نکانے
ڈسدے سکڑے کھیتر کمانے ساگی باغ ارم دے یار

“We are proud of the desert plants and bushes. The dunes, the peaks of dunes and the areas between dunes have become our abode. The dried fields of melons are identical with those in the Garden of Eden, my friend.”

He is not alienated. He develops relatedness with the desert (self). He has left his beautiful mansions (worldly attachments) and delved in just for the sake of his beloved. He leaves the outward for the sake of the inward. It gives him a sense of belongingness. Love changes his perception of everything around him.

یار فرید ملیم گھر اندر پانواں بھاگ سہاگوں زیور
کھاؤں سہجوں بولے سینسر لچکے کل ٹر سمدے یار

“Farid! If I discover my friend in the infinite depths of my being, then I will wear jewellery with nuptial happiness. My nose ornaments would be readily moving with regularity, elegance and grace, my friend.”

He will be so happy in finding his friend in the inmost chambers of his being. His happiness will make him ornament himself in ecstasy.

Kafi-39

پیر پرانی بیشم کیتا نال نہ نیتم سانول یار

“The primordial pain has made me impatient. My charming beloved did not take me along with him, my friend.”

It requires great patience to bear the old pain of unresponsiveness.

پنل یار کوں چا بھر میونے زور ازوری پکڑ نیتونے
پوونے شالارب دی مار

“They again outwitted me by instigating my friend Punna against me. They overpowered him and took him away. I pray that the wrath of the Sustainer befall them.”

She invokes Divine help against the forces that separate her from her beloved.

پیر ہواڑاں کھوج نہ پاواں رور و کرڑ کنڈا گل لاناواں
نین سکیتے زار نزار

“I follow the footprints but I cannot find his clue. I embrace thorny shrubs and thorns in the state of crying. My thirst for his vision has impaired my eyes.”

It is a moment of great despair when the foot prints at a certain point disappear without giving any clue of the beloved. It is so difficult to bear the transcendence of the beloved.

تھی راہی تھل مارو جلساں لاندھی تے لس بیلہ زلساں
 سنج بر، بار، کیتیم گھر بار

“I will become a traveller and go in the deadly desert.
 I will wander wretchedly in Landi and Lasbela. I have
 made my dwellings in wilderness and forests.”

It is again the desire to unite with the beloved that makes
 her wander in wilderness.

پانی مول نہ مٹھڑے کھارے نہ کچھ پلڑے نہ کوئی چارے
 نہ رہ ڈسدم شتر سوار

“There is no water at all, whether sweet or alkaline.
 There is neither any stored rainwater nor any sign
 leading to water. I also can't find a camel rider.”

The absence of water that sustains life symbolises her utter
 dry state. There are no indications of the transcendent
 beloved assuming immanent form.

وسریاں رنگ رنگیلیاں جائیں باغ بغوچڑے ٹھڈریاں چھائیں
 سہرے گانے گہنے بار

“The colourful and beautiful places, gardens,
 orchards and cool shades, the chaplets, colour threads
 around wrist (symbolising marital bond), ornaments
 and necklaces, all have been renounced by me for
 your sake, my friend.”

The colours of life fade away when the friend ceases to
 respond. Things do have their objective existence but their
 meanings vary from state to state. Love provides an
 existential understanding of things, which rises higher than
 mere sensory or conceptual considerations.

نازک شوخ مزاج انوہاں یاری لا کر تھیوں آن سو نہاں
 کیڈے گل گئے قول قرار

“You are tender, amorously playful and carefree but after cultivating friendship with me you have become so indifferent. Why your lively commitment of love has deadened?”

The beloved's becoming indifferent in the course of time remains an enigma for her. She is at a loss to understand the lively commitment turned into deadness. Isn't it preparatory for a final encounter with her beloved?

کرم تنی دے ناؤکھ مڑے کرم نہ کیشتم مارو مسٹھڑے
جستری بازی ڈٹرس ہار

“The destined sufferings of the inept one have not ended. My ravishing sweetheart has not blessed me. I have lost the winning game of love.”

She feels that she has lost the game of love but still she goes on playing it. It is the element of hope, which keeps her dynamic when other things become static.

کچ ڈوتنساں جے تیں جیساں جے ول ولساں کافر تھسیاں
گل وچ پائی پریٹ مہار

“I will constantly make efforts to reach Kech till the last breath of my life. I will die in sinfulness if I turn back. I am wearing the thread of love round my neck.”

Her wearing the thread of love around her neck signifies her total commitment with her beloved. She considers it as a great sin to renounce her beloved in spite of great odds. She continuously resolves to keep in the tracks of love till the last breath of her life.

اوکھیاں گھائیاں گائیاں چائیاں لاہیاں چاڑھیاں سبھ اٹھ کاٹھیاں
سجڑوں کھڑوں سو سو غار

“There are arduous passes, rocks and blocks of stone, numerous downward and upward difficult paths and hundreds of caves at right and left sides to be found in the way.”

The path of love is not an easy path. It is an absolute commitment with the beloved. She has to face a number of physical, social and cultural hardships while sustaining love relationship.

بھپیا بھڑے واہن دا جماں شہر بھنبھوروی کوڑ نکماں
کچھ ہی وطن حقیقی وار

“Do cast aside the reverence of being born at a specific place (Bhuta Wain). The city of Bhambore is false and valueless. My real original abode is Kech.”

The abode of the beloved (heart) takes precedence over the lover's native place (self). Love is such a unique phenomenon that it requires total renouncement from her for the sake of her beloved. The act of renouncement is not externally imposed but arises from within her. She is not asked to obey any commandment. It is the subtlety of love that makes her renounce everything with such ease, which otherwise is so difficult. Religiosity remains stranded whereas spirituality works wonders.

یار فرید نہ کیتم گولی سرخی ڈسم بندوق دی گولی
دھار کجل دی تھنی تلوار

“Farid! My friend did not make me his bondmaid. The red pill (lipstick) seems to me gunshot. The black line of collyrium seems to me the edge of the sword.”

The state of love is so absolute that all things are measured in reference to his beloved. The beloved is the measure of all things. The ordinary meanings of things dwindle into insignificance. The only meaning of things is in their relatedness to his beloved.

Kafi-40

بے شک جانناں، بے شک جانناں سوہنیاں کوں ہے سخت غرور

“I am absolutely certain without any doubt that the beautiful ones are extremely proud.”

Love is a game of transcendence-immanence-transcendence. Love itself (transcendence) is polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved (immanence). The veiling of the beautiful beloved or his pride (transcendence) is the source of greatest sufferings for her for she desperately desires his unveiling. But she does not realise that a premature veiling is bound to destroy love. How could there be union without intensified suffering, which leads to the ripening of love?

مونہہ سر خاک سنگار اساڈے ہنجرڑوں ہارن ہار اساڈے
ہوت ہے کچھ تے کچھ ہے دور

“The dust on my face and head is my makeup. The continuous flowing tears are my garlands. My beloved is in Kech and Kech is far away.”

The beloved gives meaning to her world. The abode of the beloved (heart), in her eyes, makes her everything subaltern to it.

یار نویں نت یاری لاوے کیویں ساڈے سول سہاوے
دِڑی نازک نرم کرور

“My friend develops new intimacies. How could my tender, soft and delicate heart bear this terrible jealous visitation?”

Love is a continuous transformation from the plane of psyche to the plane of the Spirit. The reflections of negative emotions, like jealousy, are the vestiges from the psychic world. It is the intense heat of suffering, which ultimately succeeds in burning them out.

ڈینہ تتی ہڈاس کوں چردی رات نچردی آہیں بھردی
سٹر سٹر مردی صبح سحر

“I am the inept one who in the morning churns her flesh and bones and at night gets consumed by heaving sighs. I keep on dying by burns till the morning dawns.”

The state of neither living nor dying has to be perpetually faced by her. Can the raw meat be cooked without fire?

پڑھ بسم اللہ ڈکھڑے چیساں خوشیاں کر کر جھولی پیساں
جے وت تیکوں ہے منظور

“I shall bear all sufferings by starting with the name of Allah. I will own them with happiness if my plight is in accord with your will.”

She realises that her sufferings are in consonance with the will of her beloved. Love imparts a deeper understanding of the law of things, which remains opaque to the ordinary consciousness.

دور سے منظور دیں دا آوے موت نہ میلا تھیندا
فجریں، پیشیں تھر کلور

“My heart yearns for my friend who dwells far away. I neither die nor do I have union with him. I remain under immense severity from morning till evening.”

Her sole purpose is to have unison with her beloved. The goal becomes so ingrained in her embodied self that she reaches the state of either/or (either she unites with her

beloved or death overtakes her). But in spite of her existential either/or, she has to wait in receptivity for the final outcome.

اٹھدیں بہندیں وین ولاواں روواں کھانواں گاواں
ہر ہر گ ہے تار تنبور

“I wail every now and then. I cry and keep singing the sad song. My each and every nerve has become a string of the tambour (musical instrument).”

It is intensified suffering within the infinite depths of her consciousness that makes her nerves turn into strings of a musical instrument and thereby lead to wailing and sad songs.

جیس ڈینہ دیاں ول لکڑیاں تا نکھاں اُجڑیاں سرخیاں میندھیاں مانگاں
بولے بیئے سینسر چور

“The day my heart started longing for you, it led to the fading away of my rouge, henna, and the parting line of hair on my head. My nose and forehead ornaments have got crushed.”

The first signs of love appear when she becomes oblivious of her outwardness and concentrates on her inwardness.

یار فرید نوں ڈترے رودھے سچ آکھیا ہے قمر و شودے
بیدرداں نال نینہ لاون کوڑ

“Farid! My friend has bestowed hardships on me. It has been said by a wise man that it is not right to nurture love with someone who is heartless.”

When he looks at the hardships bestowed upon him by his friend, he realises the truth of a wise man who says that it is imprudent to contract love with someone who is heartless. However, the social and cultural wisdom fades away in face of the primordial wisdom. Isn't the so-called heartlessness of the beloved essentially a positive act to fructify love?

Kafi-41

توں باجھ تھئے سنج ویڑھے وویار دل وس وو سجن آئیڑے وویار

“My dwellings have become deserted without you, my friend. Do come and dwell with me and be near to me, my friend.”

The feeling of nothingness or desertedness can only be overcome when the Self unveils itself within her individual self.

قدسی گھروچ کول بلھا کے اپنا محرم راز بنا کے

کیتو سخت پریرے وویار

“You invited me to your blessed dwellings. You made me share your secrets. Why have you now greatly distanced yourself from me, my friend?”

The pure Essence transformed itself into Attributes and contracted the primordial covenant. She is at a loss to understand the mystery of separation and disunion.

توں بن سارا ملک اندھارا سینے تے چڑھ لیٹ پیارا

اکھیاں تے کر دیرے وویار

“My entire dominion is full of darkness, without you. My beloved! Ascend on me and lie on my chest. Remain dwelling in my eyes, my friend.”

The state of ontological nothingness is symbolised by darkness. She craves for the light of Being to shine in her eyes.

یار چہیندا چاک مہیندا وارث ساڈے درد دلیس دا

نہ کر کوڑے جھیرے وویار

“My beloved friend! The shepherd of the herd! You are the cause of my heart’s pain. Do not resort to false brawls with me, my friend.”

The existential contradictions between her and the beloved help her in achieving higher states of love. The contradiction between Being and nothingness ultimately leads to the fruition of love.

زبور، نیور، باہیں، تریور
کر ساں ٹوٹے پرزے بیور

پٹ پٹ سٹساں سہرے وویار

“I will render to pieces my jewellery, anklets, bracelets and apparel. I will tear and throw away the chaplet, my friend.”

She desperately crushes all things symbolising nuptial union or nuptial happiness, since they have no meaning without her beloved.

آپ سنبھالیں پیتاں پالیں
سو سو نظر کرم دی بھالیں

کردیں آپ بکھیڑے وویار

“Do take care of love and nurture it. Do cast countless glances of blessings on me. You yourself create incongruities, my friend.”

She beseeches her beloved to end all dissonances and respond with love, instead. The so-called incongruities are in fact the stepping stones to ultimate realisation.

عشق اولڑا، درد کلڑا
بخت نہ بھلڑا، سول سولڑا

یار فرید آ ویڑھے وویار
“Love is intricate with unintelligible pains. Fortune is not smiling on me and there are encompassing afflictions. Farid! My beloved! Do come and dwell in my courtyard, my friend.”

He does realise the intricacy of love leading to misfortunes and unintelligible pains and afflictions. It can only end once the beloved fortunes him with union.

Kafi-42

جتھ تھلڑا، جتھ دربوں ہے یار اتھ ہر ویلھے لدبوں ہے یار

“There is desert and green areas, my friend. It portrays a nomadic way of life, my friend.”

The green areas in the desert portraying a nomadic way of life notwithstanding, it symbolises his inner world.

تڈڑے چیکن، گیرے گھوکن جرکھاں ترکھاں لونبر کوکن
گوہیں شوکن، سانے پھوکن ناگلیں دی شوں شوں ہی یار

“The crickets cry, the doves call, the hyenas and foxes howl, the iguanas’ whiz, the lizards blow their nostrils and there is the hissing of the snakes, my friend.”

The varied expressions of the desert animals symbolise the animation within her being.

سونهیاں ٹھیریاں & بھڑے نازووالے ککڑے وٹڑے
باہیں ٹوہے پاڑے گھڑے ڈٹھڑیں ڈکھڑاواں ہے یار

“There are ruins, sand dunes and peaks of dunes in the desert of shining and soft sand with different shapes and surroundings of gravelling and pebbles. There are low lands flooded with water, ponds, clefts and ditches. All my sufferings wither away by seeing the beauty of the desert, my friend.”

The beauty of the inner and the outer desert makes the sufferings wither away. Love is essentially suffering but it also opens one’s eyes to the beauty of the world. The whole cosmos belongs to the beloved.

کنڈڑیں کا ٹھیس نشتر ماری سمجھوں یاری تے غم خواری
الڑیں بھتریں توں رت جاری خاص سہاگ دی پوں ہے یار

“The thorns and the wooden pieces prick me. I feel that they are being friendly with me by sharing my sorrows. The blood oozes out of my tender wounds. I equate it with the colourful special wedding occasion, my friend.”

Her distresses do not alienate her from the environment. She develops an existential relatedness with the things that inflict pain on her. Her suffering becomes meaningful because it is for the sake of achieving or realising unison with her beloved.

ہن کھل ہا سے ساڈے پیشے سول سڑاپے درد اندیشے
زیرے زخم تے زخمیں ریشے سب ڈکھ ڈٹڑا توں ہے یار

“It was our vocation to smile and laugh. There are afflictions, burnings, pains and anxieties. The vital wounds have become sore. All these sufferings have been bestowed by you, my friend.”

The sufferings even in their most intense forms make her smile and laugh. They are not considered as meaningless. The bestowal of the beloved is her treasury. The bunch of afflictions, burnings, pains and anxieties are transposed to higher reality and thereby lose their sting; nay, they become an occasion of rejoice. She experiences spiritual joy even in an acute state of suffering.

روہی محض بشارت درسوں مرسوں بھرسوں مول نہ ڈرسوں
بیدرداں دی دلڑی ترسوں ڈینہہ راتیں گھوں موں ہے یار

“I will be blessed with vision in the desert. I will not be afraid at all but die and be reduced to bits and pieces. Only the hearts devoid of love are afraid. It makes them oscillate day and night, my friend.”

It is in the desert of one's inner being that one is blessed with the vision of one's beloved. She is not afraid of the difficulties, which she has to encounter in the path of love. The secret of her steadfastness in love is that her heart becomes free from fear and instils courage in her to face the vicissitudes of love in a state of creative hope.

جیس ڈینہہ ہوت نیت پٹ دیرے شہر بھنجوروں سخت پریرے
دل دیاں بوٹیاں ہاں دے بیرے کسی دی موں موں ہے یار

“The day Punnal pulled up his tents and took them far away from the city of Bhambore, the whole fabric of Sassi's being started shaking and the last throes of her death were audible, my friend.”

The act of Punnal's transcendence (beloved) destroyed the very being of Sassi (lover). She died in a state of great pain and shock.

توں بن یار فرید داجیون جیندیں جگ وچ ڈکھڑا تھیون
زہر ڈسیوے کھاؤن پیون بے سردی سوں ہے یار

“The life of Farid without you in this world amounts to suffering. His whole eating and drinking seem bane. I swear by you, my friend.”

His life is a continuous series of sufferings without his beloved, so much so, that the very acts of nourishment turn poisonous.

Kafi-43

چوریوں جاریوں استغفار بخشم شالارب غفار

“I seek forgiveness from stealing and swindling. My Sustainer! I pray for remission for you are the much forgiving.”

He seeks forgiveness from the Sustainer for moments of his forgetfulness in concentrating on the Real. He prays for remission of these acts keeping in view Divine Mercy, which overlooks human imperfections.

گندڑی عادت گندڑے فعلوں توبہ! توبہ! لکھ لکھ وار

“I offer my heightened repentance from bad habits and loathsome acts.”

He offers his pure repentance from the ephemeral modes of duality.

کر کر سخت گنہ پر تاپیم توں میں خاوند بخشن ہار

“I am extremely regretful of committing grave sins. My husband! Forgive me for you are the all – remissive.”

He regrets the consciousness of his personal existence, which is a great sin in the Divine eyes. It even includes his desperation in reacting to his overbearing situations of love and acts committed in a state of frenzy. He beseeches the All-remissive - to forgive his existential sinfulness.

پیر پیغمبر %۷۰ با نہیں توں مالک توں کل مختار

“The saints and the prophets are completely subject to you. You are the Omnipotent and you have full authority.”

The saints and the prophets are subject to His Divine will. He is the Omnipotent and the Sovereign of the whole universe. He in His Almighty Wisdom can absolve any sinner from his sins.

میں بد عملی تے کر رحمت جیں ڈینہ یاروی یار نہ یار

“I am filled with bad deeds. Do shower mercy on me on the Day of Reckoning, when even the friendship of a bosom friend will be of no avail.”

He begs to be pardoned of everything committed by him in the spirit of duality. He beseeches His Sustainer to be showered mercy on the Day of Reckoning when no friendship would be of any avail.

او گن ہاری ناکس کم دی کو جھی کملی بد کردار

“I am sinful and valueless. I am ugly and weak with deficiencies in character.”

He confesses the consciousness of his separate selfhood as a sin and thereby of no value since it leads to ugliness, weakness and deficiencies in character as against Divine Beauty, Power and Perfection.

% اشان ہے فضل کرم دا میں وچ ڈوہ تے عیب ہزار

“Your Majesty shines forth in your Bounteousness and Generosity. I am engulfed in sinfulness and have countless faltering.”

He admits his existential sinfulness and imperfection. He invokes Divine Majesty, which shines forth in His Attributes of Bounteousness and Generosity.

آون یاد گناہ پرانے پٹ پٹ روواں زار و زار

“I am remembering anew my past sins. I am mourning and crying profusely.”

He deeply regrets at the sight of his past sins of duality.

رات قبر دی ڈینہہ حشر دا سر پر کڑ کم بارے بار

“The heavy burden of the Night of the Grave and the Day of Resurrection has fallen over my head.”

He is heavily burdened by the very idea of dying and appearing before his Lord to account for his ideas, feelings, words and acts in both their commissions and omissions.

میں مسکین فرید ہاں %۱ توں بن کون اتارم پار

“I am lowly Farid belonging to you. Who will ferry me across the waters except you?”

He is aware of his own ontological nothingness. He completely belongs to God. Who can steer him across the testing situations of metaphysical realisation except the Divine?

Kafi-44

جیون ڈینہہ اڈھائی وویار سٹ گھت فخر وڈائی وویار

“Life is of a short span, my friend. Cast aside self-conceitedness, my friend.”

There is no meaning in being proud and self-conceited, when life on this planet is so short. These transient affairs are negligible in reference to eternal life. The disvalues of pride and self-conceit rob Man of his inherent invaluable dignity. They engage him till the final moment of his exit from the terrestrial world arrives and he sees with his eyes their momentary nature.

کھ اوینگھ پیل مکانے ناز حسن کھ راج بیانے
کھ ما بھینس بھائی وویار

“Where is that swing on the oak tree, the pride of beauty and the royal status of the ancestors? Where mother, sisters and brothers have gone, my friend?”

Life moves ‘onward and upward’ by leaving behind playfulness of childhood, the beauty of regal youth, one’s parents and siblings. There is no permanence in change.

کھ رانجن کھ کھیڑے بھیڑے کھ رہ گئے اوہ جھگڑے جھیڑے
کھ چوچک دی جانی وویار

“Where is the beloved and where are the despicable Kheras? What has remained of those wrangling and brawls (which existed between them)? Where is now to be seen the daughter of Choochak, my friend?”

Ranjha is no more there. The wrangling and brawls with the despicable Kheras are not on the face of the earth. Heer is nowhere to be seen. All have been cut by the sword of time. Dheedo or Ranjha belonged to the village 'Takht Hazara' on the banks of the river Chenab (Punjab). He did not till the soil like his brothers but preferred a life of playing the flute for the sake of it. His family members and foremost among them the wives of his brothers criticised him for such a leisure activity and even refused him food. He left his village and his insatiable soul made him travel to different places. He finally reached a village where he fell in love with Heer, a very beautiful woman belonging to a rich family of the Sayyal clan in Jhang (Punjab). Her father appointed him as shepherd of his flock. Heer started loving him and their love deepened with the passage of time. He turned into the shepherd of her heart. Kaido, the uncle of Heer, ultimately came to know about it and he reacted by joining hands with Heer's father Choochak and her mother Malki by marrying her forcibly with Saida Khera in connivance with the local cleric. Ranjha left the place and in his journeying met an ascetic at 'Tilla Jogian' (Mound of Ascetics in Punjab) and became a Yogi. He, in due course, reached the village where he found Heer. Heer returned with him to her native village where her parents agreed to solemnise their marriage. Her uncle, Kaido, poisoned her to death on her wedding day before Ranjha could save her. Ranjha took a piece from the left out poisonous sweet, which Heer had eaten and died by her side.

The love tale of Punjab is impregnated with higher symbolism. It is the drama of love unfolding in the inner being of the lover and the beloved. The polarisation between the lover and the beloved or in the instant case the polarisation between Heer and Ranjha is transcended or withdrawn by the Self and ultimately comes to reside in nonduality. The inimical forces to love, in the figures of Kaido and others, play their destined role in purifying and intensifying love. If Heer ceases to exist, then Ranjha also

ceases to exist. The polarisation of the lover and the beloved, bound to the spectrum of serial time, has necessarily to be withdrawn by the love itself.

کھ او مکر فریب دا چالا کھ او جو گی مندر راں والا
پر م جڑی جیس لائی وویار

“What about the game of cunningness and deceit?
Where is the yogi with earrings who ignited the spark
of love, my friend?”

Ranjha became Yogi with earrings and sparked love in the heart of Heer (transcendence assumed immanence). He resorted to this mode only for the sake of finding and effectuating union with her. He played the game of cunningness and defeat (transcendence) for achieving all this in human medium (immanence) but time did not grant permanence to his medium. It too was swept away by the tide of time.

ماہی، منجھیاں، ہیر سلہیٹی عطروں بھنڑی مشک لپیٹی
گئے سب جھوک لڈائی وویار

“The lover, his herd and Heer Sial - soaked with
perfume and immersed in musk-all have moved away
from here, my friend.”

Ranjha, his herd and the fragrant Heer have left this world, which was only a temporary abode.

جو بن سا تھی چار ڈینہاں دا جھٹ پٹ ضعف بڈھیا آندا
کوڑی آس پرانی وویار

“Youth is short lived. Infirmary and old age quickens
to appear. False hope of otherness holds no ground,
my friend.”

Youth passes away in such a short span of time. Infirmary and old age quicken to displace it. One's hope in otherness is so false. It has no permanence like the passing youth. Make your moments of life momentous by striving to unite with the beloved. Try to capture changelessness in change.

ہے ہے ڈھڑی کہیں نہ ویندی کجل مساک تے سرخی مہندی
سر مہ، سیندھ سلائی وویار

“Oh! Oh! No one has seen the flying away of youth with its collyrium, twig (of walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects), rouge and henna along with staining (eyes) with antimony and hair parting line on head (hair dressing), my friend.”

Youth with all its embellishments (beautifications) flies away so quietly. One remains oblivious of its fading away. One needs to realise inwardness.

موسم رل پھرول گھر آئی و نجن نہ وقت نراس اجائی
آنون دی کرکائی وویار

“The cyclic spring season has come back. Do not waste your time in hopeless pursuits. Make efforts to return, my friend.”

It is height of obliviousness to waste one's time in hopeless pursuits. The cyclic moments of opportunity are again knocking at the door. Do realise the possibility of unison between the lover and the beloved.

کوڑی صحبت کوڑی سنگت کوڑے نخرے کوڑی رنگت
لپ دھوڑی بک چھائی وویار

“The false human ambience and ephemeral ties are characterized by pseudo blandishments and illusory colours. They are not worth more than a handful of dust, my friend.”

The ephemeral world with its different shades and colours is worthless. Beware lest it ensnares.

چھلیں پینگیں لاسوں تاریں چنکیں گھنڈڑیں ہونگ تواریں
سہجوں راند رسائی وویار

“It is a primordial play (bridging of the heavens and the earth) whereby the fish like patterns in the sky are integrated with the sound of music on earth exhibited by the twinkling of bells in the herd and the calls of the herdsman, my friend.”

The fish like patterns of the raining clouds in the sky and the sound of music on earth symbolise the primordial play within an uncertain limited period of time. It is the act of bridging the heavens and the earth. Man has to keep the sense of the eternal while dealing with the temporal. It will lead to light and music in his life. He will become enlightened and musical.

تھیاں سر سبز فریدیاں جھوکاں مہروں سبز تھیاں ول سوکاں
بخیں واگ ولائی وویار

“The dwellings of Farid have become all green. Graciousness has transformed deadness into liveliness. Fortune has turned its reins towards fructifying the quest, my friend.”

The responsiveness of the beloved has turned the desert (self) into a dwelling (self-fulfilment or self-Realisation). Divine Grace has transformed deadness into liveliness. It is not simply the result of his efforts. The element of Heavenly Blessings or good fortune has been decisive in the fruition of his love.

Kafi-45

دل دردوں ہن ہاری وویار دل کریں ہاکاری وویار

“My heart has lost at the hands of pain, my friend. Well, make some fructifying effort (to retrieve me from this situation), my friend.”

The heart's losing at the hands of pain is correspondingly winning at the hands of love. How could any effort fructify in relieving pain in the absence of ripened love?

زلف سیہ تھی نانگ واردھے ڈنگ مریندے کاری وویار

لوں لوں سیڑھاں جاری وویار

“The black lock of your hair in the form of snake bites me so severely, my friend. The fountain of blood gushes forth from my each and every pore, my friend.”

Beauty and love supplement each other. The bewitching beauty of the beloved squeezes her completely. ‘Beauty is deployment’ and love is employment.

سنانول آویں نہ ترساویں موسم چیتز بہاری وویار

گھر گھر تھنی گلزاری وویار

“My beloved! Do come and do not tantalise me. The month of spring has set forth, my friend. There is blooming happiness in each and every household, my friend.”

The spring season both inwardly and outwardly is setting the stage for union with the beloved.

یاری لا کر یار نہ کیتو جنڈری مفت ازاری وویار

ڈٹھڑی ڈڑی یاری وویار

“You did not remember after cultivating friendship with me. My life is distressful for nothing, my friend. I have come to know the real worth of your friendship, my friend.”

The beloved is being tested on the values of friendship. However, the apparent behaviour of the beloved has a deeper rationale oblivious from the eye of the lover, which makes her judgemental.

سٹ کر کلہڑی تے بے واہی کیتو کچ تیاری وویار
ہے ہے بے زواری وویار

“You left me alone without any shelter and made preparations to leave for Kech, my friend. Oh! Oh! It is being so unjust, my friend.”

The beloved's assuming transcendence makes her forlorn. She considers it as unjust. Doesn't love transcend all values for it is value itself?

شاہ برہوں دے ڈتزم عہدہ گالھیں دی سرداری وویار
خلعت شہر خواری وویار

“Love itself has honoured me with the station. It is the dominion of madness, my friend. It is investiture of notoriety, my friend.”

Love cannot be measured by ordinary standards. Madness in love defies normal understanding. People do not understand it and as a consequence the lover is relegated to the realm of notoriety.

سک مہینوال دی لہر لڑھایم میں مسٹھڑی من تاری وویار
کو جھی رات اندھاری وویار

“The desire of my beloved has swept me in waves. I am the miserable one who does not know the art of swimming, my friend. This hideous night is so dark, my friend.”

Who knows the art of swimming in the infinite sea of love
with its surging waves in the hideous dark night of the soul?

ڈے کر دلے کو ڈلا سے لٹ نیتوول ساری وویار
میں واری لکھ واری وویار

“You have captivated my whole being by treachery
and false consolations, my friend. I waive my head
over you countless times, my friend.”

The intensity of love is so great that she sacrifices herself
on the altar of beloved's seductiveness.

تھل بر روی روہیں راویں رولدی ڈکھڑی ماری وویار
بار برہوں سر باری وویار

“I am wretchedly suffering, while wandering in
deserts, forests, desolate ‘rohi’, mountains and rocky
grounds, my friend. I am bearing the burden of love
on my head, my friend.”

He suffers inwardly in shouldering the burden of love. It is a
process by virtue of which the self is transformed in to the Self.

یار فرید نہ آیم ویڑھے ہر دم مونجھ مونجھاری وویار
روندیں عمر گزاری وویار

“Farid! My friend has not visited my courtyard. My
life is constantly in anguish, my friend. I have spent
my whole life in crying, my friend.”

Love is not one of the activities among other activities. It
is the sole activity, which permeates all activities. It engages
him wholeheartedly and in a wholesome way. Love is not a
duty but it rises higher than duty. The fullest expression of
freedom is found in love. Religiosity can never understand
the dynamics of divine love. Loving the beloved solely for the
sake of the beloved is an expression of love. A life of struggle
leads to fruition only when there is union with the beloved.
Spiritual consciousness cannot stop short of this supreme
identity.

Kafi-46

ڈکھ تھئے بانھ بلی وویار ہتھیں آیم اکیلی وویار

“The sufferings have given me a friendly hand, my friend. I have been solely clutched, my friend.”

The grip of love is such that at times only sufferings are one's friend for they always remain with him.

توں بن ڈیوم کون دلا سے تھی نہ سانول آ سے پاسے
مانیں انگن حویلی وویار

“Who will offer me consolations without you? My beloved! Do not be away from my sight. Dwell in my mansions and courtyard, my friend.”

She witnesses the collapse of her ordinary world. The internal and the external worlds are relative to the state of the lover. The relative worlds, in a certain sense, are absolute. All inward and outward things and events are interpreted by her in reference to the state with her beloved. Her beloved is the axis of her life. No consolation has any meaning unless it comes from her beloved. No dwelling has any meaning unless it is the dwelling with her beloved.

عالی، ادنی جو جگ جیوے میں وانگن بئی کئی ناتھیوے
ڈکھڑی! وانڈھی! ویلیھی! وویار

“I wish that the condition of anyone living in this world, whether possessing higher or lower station, should not be like me. I am sufferer, lonely and useless, my friend.”

Love is not an ordinary affair. It requires great steadfastness to sustain love. How could love fructify without suffering? Love shatters one habitual self-image. One becomes incapacitated as a straw even in his own eyes. The act of traversing the road of nothingness is not an ordinary act. It leads to the loss of self at every milestone and when she reaches the destination, she is completely bereft of her selfhood.

نہ ماہی نہ منجھیاں ڈسڈیاں اکھیاں وسڈیاں دلڑیاں پھسڈیاں
جندڑی تھئی بھاں بلی وویار

“I can neither witness the shepherd nor the herd. My heart is enslaved to the deceptive vision. My life has fallen in a vicious circle, my friend.”

The absence of the beloved disrupts her habitual world. The game of love is culturally likened to the game two girls play by circling their hands with each other and then leaving them in dizziness and thereby in a state of loss.

سوں ہے ناز نگہ دی میکوں جے تیں ول نہ ڈیکھاں تیکوں
رہساں میل کچلی وویار

“I sever by the pride of your vision; I will remain unkempt unless I see you, my friend.”

The whole idea of taking care of oneself loses its meaning unless she witnesses her beloved. Her well-being is conditional to the response of her beloved.

کھ او آساں کھ او مانے نہ ماہی نہ راج بمانے
جیساں ڈکھ ڈوہیلی وویار

“Where have withered those hopes and where have gone those vanities? There is neither my beloved nor my ancestral regal status. I shall pass my life in sombre sufferings, my friend.”

The external meaning of hope, vanity and royalty dwindles into insignificance in her eyes in separation from her beloved. The facticity is impregnated with infinite meanings and she chooses the primordial one. It is her consciousness, which gives meaning to her facticity in a situation. The colourless facts are given colours by her consciousness. The subject-object structure of reality transcends the world of rationality.

بھاگ سہاگ سنجیں توں رٹھڑے ہار، حمیلاں، گانے ترٹڑے
ٹوٹے بانجھ چوڑیلی وویار

“I am the destitute one who has been deserted by nuptial fortunes. The necklace, neck ornaments and colour threads around wrist (symbolising marital bond) have been turned into bits. My whole set of bangles stands broken too, my friend.”

The nuptial rites, adornments and ornamentations have no meaning without nuptial union.

ہک میں درد اندوہ وچالے نئی سبھ ناز نوازیں جالے
ترے سو سٹھ سہیلی وویار

“I am the one who is stranded in the midst of pain and grief. Hundreds of my companions are spending their time in priding and elegance, my friend.”

There is no comparison between her pain and grief at the separation and disunion from her beloved and the priding and elegance of her countless friends who have realised vision and union. Love cannot be realised without suffering. This is the absolute law of things or the absolute law of love.

باجھوں یار فرید دا حیلہ کجڑا، کو جھاء، تے رنگ پیلا
سیندھ دھڑی تھئی میلی وویار

“The appearance of Farid has become dusty, ugly and pale without his friend. The hair parting line on

head and the braided hair has become dusty too, my friend.”

The greatest blessings of love are that it turns a person inward. His inward state is reflected in his appearance. His state of separation and disunion from his beloved makes him appear as unfastidious, unkempt and uncombed. Those who are lost in reality are seldom found in appearance. Love takes its toll on the embodied self. The lover’s redness turns into paleness. Doesn’t it help in strengthening the inward as against the outward?

Kafi-47

رتھ دھیمیں دھیمیں ٹور

“Ride the chariot at a slow pace.”

She addresses her beloved charioteer to ride the chariot of love at a slow pace so that she may grasp the subtleties of the path from self to the Self and thereby avoid pitfalls and illusions of the way and also taste the stages of love.

میڈا دستہ ہے کروڑا متاں ونگیں لکم ٹکور

“My set (of bangles) is made of glass lest my bangles get banged.”

She is just novice in love and fears that her glass-like sprouting love may not withstand the pressure of love and get broken in return.

رتھ تے بہندی دڑگ نہ سہندی ہم طبع کم زور

“I cannot bear jolts, while sitting in the chariot. My disposition is fragile.”

She has a fragile disposition. She cannot bear jolts on the hazardous journey of love. How can she bear the tremendous quake of her being?

روز ازل دی پاتم گل دی برہوں بے دی ڈور

“I am wearing the thread of your love round my neck ever since the primordial day.”

She has a pre-eternal covenant of love with her friend since love itself polarised into the forms of the lover and the beloved.

رہو چ لڑدن چور

شالا مولہ سلامت نیواں

“I pray to God that I may safely carry my belongings (the trust of personality). I may not be violently robbed in the way.”

She prays for Divine Grace in realising ultimate union or supreme identity with her beloved. The forces inimical to her spiritual vocation may not rob her in the path of union. She is apprehensive of being overpowered by otherness.

گھوڑا کھنساں بور

جیکر رتھ بیٹھیں تھک پوساں

“I will get another fine horse, in case I get tired of riding in the chariot.”

She resolves to change the mode of her journey according to the law of things (ground realities of love) and continue travelling on the road to love. She affirms to take the reins of love in her own hands and continue her journey to the Self.

نہ اوکھا سر زور

سوکھا، تیز، لغام دا کولا

“I will take a simple, swift and easily reined horse, which is not difficult and uncontrollable.”

She is hopeful that her disciplined self will swiftly make her realise union with her beloved.

جوڑ جوڑ پند اجوڑ

رانجھن تے میں جوڑ کوں جوڑوں

“Ranjhan and I will unite in oneness. It is the One that makes the realisation of unity possible.”

The lover and the beloved will reach the meeting point. It is the One who makes the realisation of the supreme identity possible. The ‘Hidden Treasure’ becomes manifest. The Possibilities of the Essence are realised in the Attributes of the Divine. The Reality witnesses itself in the mirror of nothingness.

روزِ نواں ہم شور

سک تے طلبِ ملن دی سینے

“The desire and craving of union characterizes my whole being. There are creative percussions each day.”

Her whole being in wholesomeness is craving and desiring union with her beloved. The responsiveness of her beloved is creating perpetual percussions in her being.

جلد پہنچاویں توڑ

پندھ اڑانگے د لڑی تا نگھے

“The journey is hazardous and my heart is in intense longing. Make me reach the destination soon.”

Her heart has intense longing for the beloved but the journey to the abode of her beloved is so hazardous. She wants to unite with her beloved in the shortest possible time but it is possible only when the moment gets transformed into an instant and the serial time changes into pure duration. It is when time turns into eternity. She can't bear separation and disunion from her beloved any more.

رل مل، شہر بھنبھور

میں تے یار فرید مینسوں

“Farid! I and my friend will enjoy togetherness (identity) in the city of Bhambore.”

He will enjoy the bliss of the supreme identity with his beloved who resides in the inmost chambers of his being.

Kafi-48

سپاہیڑا! نہ مار نیناں دے تیر

“O’ Combative! Do not shoot swift glances at me.”

The initiation of love, by virtue of the eyes of the beloved, captivates her being. Divine beauty sparks love. The degree of the unravelling of beauty corresponds to the degree of love. The force of beauty forces love.

پل پل پھلڑے چہن کلڑے تن من، سیس سریر

“The heads (spears) of the arrows are constantly making unintelligible prickling in my body, soul and spirit.”

Love has no partial effect. It completely affects his body, soul and spirit. The prickling of love is unintelligible because it is qualitatively different and he is at a loss to understand its rationale.

گوڑھیاں اکھیاں رت دیاں بکھیاں زلف سیر بے پیر

“The dark eyes are thirsty of blood. The black tress is unruly.”

The unravelling beauty of the beloved heightens the intensity of love.

کجہ جنگی، ظالم زنگی کو ہند بے تقصیر

“The aggressive, cruel and black collyrium brutalises me without any fault of mine.”

Beauty is so overpowering that it is essentially irresistible.

نیش ڈکھندے ریش ڈکھی دے رگ رگ لکھ لکھ پیڑ

“The pricks make me suffer and intensify the sufferings of my wounds. There are countless pains in my each and every vein.”

Love is not an ordinary emotion, passion or sentiment and therefore its pain and suffering is of the highest intensity. But it is not hellish because it has the heavenly possibility of beatific vision. The possibility of union with the beloved creates hope, which animates love in spite of all odds.

سینگیاں سرتیاں کھڑے درتیاں ویری مایہو ویر

“My intimate companions are dyed in hostility. My parents and brothers have become my adversaries.”

A state of separation and disunion with the beloved separates him from his internal and external world. The humanly environment turns hostile and adverse. He is considered as a rebel and his behaviour deviant. He is adjudged on social and cultural standards of the time and therefore the society finds fault with him. He becomes socially isolated but remains inwardly committed with his beloved.

لگڑیاں تانگھاں اُجڑیاں مانگھاں مارو وسم ملہیر

“The hair parting line on my head has lost its distinctness (hair has fallen in disarray) due to my longings. My cruel beloved dwells in Malheer.”

The longing of the beloved is so overwhelming that he becomes oblivious of his appearance. The disappearance of his beloved makes all appearances meaningless.

یار کراڑا ڈھوتا پاڑا کیا کیجئے تدبیر

“My friend is heartless and my neighbour is a backbiter? What strategy should I evolve?”

He is at a loss to face the 'heartlessness' of his beloved and the dicey behaviour of his neighbour. It is one of the recurrent themes in love that the lover thinks that someone has turned his beloved against him.

دل غم دی جاگیر جندڑی چھدی نوک غضب دی

“My life is essentially characterized by ruthless sharp pricking (of love). My heart has become an abode of sorrows.”

There can be suffering without love but there can be no love without suffering. How could love ripen without suffering?

عمر فرید نہایم / روندیں متھڑے دی تحریر

“Farid! I have spent my life in crying. It has been written on my forehead.”

He undergoes primordial suffering at the hands of primordial love throughout his life. How lucky are those who are destined to suffer but ultimately realise union?

Kafi-49

سدا جی بچلے دل جے دویار لگیاں دلاں کون کون جھلے دویار

“My heart is set on fire and is being reduced to ashes,
my friend. Who can bear the loving pangs of the
heart, my friend?”

The alchemy of suffering paves the way to union with the
beloved. The loving pangs of the heart have to be borne by
the lover herself.

ڈسم نہ راول رانجھن سائیں رنگ پور سارا جڑیاں جائیں
کو جھے قہر کلے دویار

“My majestic Rawal Ranjhan is nowhere to be seen.
The whole of Rangpur has become deserted with
hideous, imposing and unattractive dwellings, my
friend.”

Heer being forcibly married in Rangpur finds the place
deserted and ugly since Ranjha does not dwell there with her.
Facts exist in facticity but their meanings are provided by the
human consciousness. The freedom of human consciousness
can never be ensnared. Rangpur does exist but the
consciousness of Heer gives it an existential meaning or
significance. The act of giving meaning, in a certain sense,
takes precedence over the fact. Man may not be responsible
for a certain fact but he is absolutely responsible for giving
meaning to that fact by act of his consciousness in pure
freedom.

درد اندوہ تے سول ہزاراں سے سے، سول کلور دیاں ماراں
جند جکھ جکھ پئی گلے دویار

“I am facing pain, grief and numerous hardships. There are countless imposing afflictions. My life is rotting in suffering, my friend.”

She experiences pains and sufferings in the path of love. But the process of suffering in love is so meaningful that unless there is steady burning there cannot be union with the beloved.

راتیں ڈینہاں مونجھ مونجھاری اگیا ڈھولا یار آزاری
نبھ گئے سکھ دے رے دو یار

“I am in anguish at all the times. My beloved has left me in distress. The times of peace have flown away, my friend.”

The constant anguish of love bakes her heart for feasting the beloved. Don't the presence of distress and the absence of peace indicate that she is on the right track?

رل مل سینگیاں ماروں ڈھالا من گوں دعائیں میں ول شالا
ہوت پنل ول ولے دو یار

“My friends get together and resort to omens. I pray to God that my intimate Punnal returns to me (reunites with me), my friend.”

Love goes beyond rationality. It dwells on the planes of imagination, intellect and Spirit. But she becomes so desperate for the return of her beloved that she resorts to omens. Her beseeching the Divine Grace for granting her supreme identity with her beloved is the prayer of love.

یار نہ آئے سچ نہ بھاوے ویڑھا کھاوے، گھر اگ لاوے
گزرے وقت سوئے دو یار

“My friend does not pay me visit and the nuptial bed does not appeal to me. My courtyard haunts and the house burns me. The times of ease have passed away, my friend.”

How could the nuptial bed have any meaning without her beloved? The objective meaning of courtyard and house signifying dwelling, undergoes a change and she imputes existential meanings to them. Existentially speaking, the courtyard haunts and the house burns. Love changes the objective meanings of things and events into existential ones. Ordinary meanings give way to existential meanings. But all meanings-objectivistic existential or existentially objective-have to correspond to the law of things or pure objectivity.

رانجھن ماہی، مرلی واہی پریم جڑی جڑ لائیں جاہی
ڈکھ ڈکھڑے پئے پلے دو یار

“My beloved Ranjhan did harp the tune on flute. It enkindled the great flame of love in me. Sufferings have fallen to my lot, my friend.”

Love is reciprocity. The beloved harps the tune and ignites the wick of love. The lover falls in love and ferrying across the stream of suffering unites with the beloved. Isn't love so simple?

آتش عشق رنجھئے والی ہوش فکر دی پاڑ پچالی
ڈہانڈھ اندر وچ بے دو یار

“The Ranjhan's fire of love has burnt the roots of my reflective understanding. The great fire is ablaze within me, my friend.”

Love burns the roots of reflective understanding. It is clearing of the way without which the goal of union can never be realised. Psychic love demeans whereas spiritual love elevates. Love soars to the higher levels of understanding.

آتن، آنگن، حویلیاں، جاہیں خواجہ جانہ ڈیوم کتھاپیں
کوئی جامیکوں نہ جھلے دو یار

“The weaving site, courtyard, mansions and areas do not provide any space to me. There is no place that is bearing for me, my friend.”

It is not only the time that is against her but space too becomes so constricted. Space provides her no space. The objectivity of time and space here, again undergo existential transformations in her eyes. There is an objective space but it is not friendly, thus there is no existential space left for the lover in spite of the objective space.

کھیڈن، کڈن فرید گیوسے پَند ملامت مفت چتوسے
ڈٹھڑے عشق بھلے دویار

“Farid! The times of playfulness have gone. I have taken upon myself the load of reproach for nothing. I have witnessed the (so-called) blessings of love, my friend.”

His times of easiness fly away. He is burdened with reproaches without being guilty of any thing. His beloved's blessings are so overbearing. Isn't the path of love so difficult?

Kafi-50

سبھ سنجائیں غیر نہ جائیں سبھ صورت ہے عین ظہور

“Do understand and identify and do not consider it as otherness. It is his open manifestation in all forms.”

The ordinary understanding is in step with the ordinary level of Reality and the empirical or scientific understanding is geared to the world of phenomena. Likewise, the spiritual understanding is attuned to the spiritual level of Reality. It is the metaphysical, intellectual or spiritual understanding that demonstrates different levels of understandings corresponding to different levels of Reality. One has to attain this understanding to understand that the Reality is openly manifest in all forms and there is no room of otherness in the scheme of things. The Reality is ‘the Absolute’ and ‘the Infinite’. It is ‘the Universal Possibility’. It is ‘the metaphysical Whole’ meaning thereby that there is nothing outside this Whole otherwise it would not be the Whole. It has the capacity and strength to assume all forms. The Reality is all-pervasive leaving no room for otherness. Even nothingness essentially means no thing and it is a fallacy to reduce it to a thing. “The Indivisible One-And-Only is the One-And-All.” The metaphysical understanding of the Reality teaches us that the Reality is both transcendent and immanent in simultaneity without any trace of otherness. The axiom of ‘He/ not He’ helps in understanding the dynamics of the Reality.

رکھ تصدیق نہ بھی آوارہ کعبہ، قبلہ، دیر، دوارہ
مسجد، مندر، کٹڑونور

“Do verify and do not remain on the periphery. The House of God, the direction of prayer, the idol-

temple, and the Sikh place of worship, the mosque and the temple manifest the same (essential) Light.”

Religiosity cannot understand the principle of unity in diversity or the reality of unity and divisiveness in the scheme of things as against metaphysics, which understands the Nondelimited Being taking a delimited form in the process of its manifestation and the colourless light manifesting in all forms of colour. The metaphysical understanding of verification (tasdiq), demonstrates ‘the transcendent unity of religions’. Different forms of religious worship manifest the same essential Light. Allah is the light of the heavens and the earth. Darkness has no self-subsistent reality. Light is veiled in darkness otherwise darkness could not be perceived. ‘A feeble light is still light’. Light may reflect or deflect but it essentially remains light.

حسن ازل تھیا فاش مبین ہر ہر گھاٹی وادی ایمن
ہر ہر پتھر ہے کوہ طور

“The Primordial Beauty became openly manifest. Here, each and every pass is Aiman valley. Here, each and every stone is mount Tur.”

Aiman valley and mount Tur are associated with the Prophet Musa who had the moments of communication with the Lord of the worlds and spread the message of God to Bani Israel. The open manifestation of the primordial Beauty both in the inward and the outward turns every pass into Aiman valley and every stone into mount Tur. ‘All things are sacred at their roots’.

تھئے ظاہر اسرار قدیمی ہر ہر شاخ ہے غل کلیسی
زیر، زبر، چپ، راست حضور

“The ancient mysteries were unravelled. Here, each and every branch of the tree of Moses and all directions whether up and down, right and left imbibe His presence.”

Metaphysical realisation leads to the unravelling of ancient mysteries pertaining to Oneness of Being. The branch of every tree is identical to the tree where the prophet Musa witnessed theophanies. The degree of the unveiling of the Reality determines the status of everything accordingly. Divine presence is all-pervasive.

ویرانہ آباد سیجے جنگل بیلہ شادو سیجے

دوزخ نظرم حور قصور

“The desolate places look inhabited. The forests and shrubbery look joyful. Hell seems as heavens to me (characterized by houries and palaces).”

The Reality unveils itself to the gnostic by making the gnostic consciousness experience ordinary things at higher planes. Wilderness gets transformed into dwellings; forests and shrubbery pulsate with life and hell seems as heavens.

عاری پھر دے حج، زکوٰۃ صوم صلوٰۃ ذات صفاتوں

رند السوتوں بن مخمور

“They wander being liberated from pilgrimage, alms giving, fasting, ritualistic prayer, essence and attributes. The inebriates are intoxicated ever since the primordial day.”

The inebriates are intoxicated with love since the primordial day. They attain full consciousness of their ontological nothingness and thereby become free not only from their essence and attributes but transcend all forms of ritual behaviour. If Heer was asked to pray, she will only pray to Ranjha. Religiosity cannot understand the heights and depths of gnostic consciousness.

کشف حقائق محض محالے جے تیں مرشد نظر نہ بھالے

پیوکل کوڑ، فریب، تے زور

“The illumination of realities is hardly possible unless the spiritual master casts his glance. All else is absolute falsehood, deception and illusion.”

The grace of the spiritual master towards his disciple works all wonders. He is the axis of the disciple's whole activity. It his tendering care of the disciple, which makes the latter receive the illuminations of realities by virtue of the Spirit inhering in him. If disconnected from the spiritual master, then the disciple gets lost in the psychic world and mistakes falsehood as truth, deception as genuineness and illusion as reality. It is the spiritual master who differentiates between the psychic and the spiritual. The chain of transmission (silsilah) is of vital importance. One can earn Heavens (Jannah) without a spiritual master but one cannot realise ontological nothingness (faqr) without him.

فقہ، اصول، کلام، معانی منطق، نحو، صرف مہانی
ٹھپ رکھ ہے توحید غیور

“Shelve jurisprudence, principles, kalam (theology), lexicon, logic, syntax and accident. The doctrine of unity is high minded (transcends to higher planes).”

The doctrine of unity is so simple that it does not require any complexity. It does not content with theoretical knowledge but puts it into practice. The four stages of religion, namely ‘Shariah’, ‘Tariqah’, ‘Haqiqah’ and ‘Marifah’, for example, in Islamic spirituality become meaningful only at the fourth stage, which is the stage of realisation. It is at this stage that the contemplative aspects of ‘tawhid’ become openly manifest. The metaphysical truth of Oneness of Being is realised.

ملا پٹھڑے معنی کر دے آیت درس حدیث خبر دے
صرف صدائے تھے مغرور

“The clerics impute contrary meanings to the messages entailed in the verses, teachings and sayings of the Prophet. They take pride in playing the mere game of words.”

The clerics misinterpret the Qur'an, Hadith and Sunnah. They project their own psychic contradictions in understanding spiritual realities. They fail to reach the heart of the matter.

ملاویری سخت ڈسیندے بے شک ہن استاد دلیس دے
ابن العربی تے منصور

“The clerics seem hardened adversaries. Undoubtedly, Ibn' Arabi and Mansur impart heart-knowledge.”

The clerics are hardened adversaries of the spiritual dimension of religion. Ibn Arabi and Mansur Hallaj primarily concentrate on heart-knowledge, which opens the way to identity with Knowledge itself. The clerics are stranded on a plane without any inkling of the higher planes of metaphysics, tradition and religion.

شاہد، واحد اصل فرع وچ راز طریقت رسم شرع وچ
ہے مشہود نہیں مستور

“The manifest Unity is there in substance and accidents. It is in secret of esoterism and mode of exoterism. It is apparent and not hidden.”

Unity of Being or Oneness of Being is a metaphysical truth valid at all planes or degrees of Reality. It is not hidden but is as clear and broad as day light. All diversity is attached to unity.

بٹھ گھٹ ریت روش تقلیدی رہ تحقیقی، سلک فریدی
کر منظور تے تھی مسرور

“Discard the customs and conventions of blind following (servility). The way of witnessing is the Faridian tradition. Accept it and experience spiritual joy.”

Blind following of religious authority (taqlid) has to be discarded for it cannot reach the spiritual plane. The Faridian tradition is to witness the Reality by the ‘eye of the heart’. It has to be accepted for experiencing spiritual joy of union and deliverance.

Kafi-51

سمجھ فرید ابرہوں بہوں سر زور

“Farid! Understand the tremendous might of love.”

Love is emotional, passionate and sentimental at the psychic plane but it attains tremendous strength at the spiritual level.

اکھائیں ابللیاں دل لڑیاں اکھیاں
سینے پئے شر شور

“My eyes are burning and my heart is sizzling. My chest has become rowdy.”

Love existentially involves a person’s whole being. Love quakes one’s being.

غمرے رہن ملک مرلیے
ناز نگاہ ہے چور

“The enticements are robbing my whole self. The pride of the eye is so stealthy.”

He is bewitched by the beauty of the beloved. There is no deterrence against the prideful eye of the beloved.

لور سراں وچ ڈور کناں وچہ
روندیں اکھیاں کور

“My head is confused with deafness in ears. My crying eyes have turned blind.”

Love is such an extra-ordinary experience that it overturns the embodied self.

لا کر یاری کرن نہ کاری
محض نہ چاڑھن توڑ

“They (beloveds) do not care after contracting friendship. They do not remain committed till the end.”

The greatest trial of the lover consists in capturing the transcendence of the beloved in immanence.

ناز نہورے دلیاں لٹ کر اولٹا تھندے تور

“The pride and coquetries ransack the hearts. The beloveds, on the opposite, become offended (when pointed out).”

The pride and coquetries of the beloved are the means to stir love in the heart of the lover. The lover instead of being grateful holds it against his beloved. The beloved responds in love by getting offended at deepening of love ties.

سکڑے چھڑے سانگے تر ٹڑے عشق پیا گل ڈور

“My blood relations have been repudiated and my intimate relationships have been severed. The thread of love has been cast round my neck.”

The first signs of love consist in the repudiation of blood relations and severing of all other intimacies because the absoluteness of love leaves no room for any close relationship except that of the beloved.

میں اڑ چکڑی پیچ ڈکھاں وچ شالانہ پھاسن ہور

“I am already caught in the web of sufferings. I pray that others are not ensnared (like me).”

No ordinary mortal can undergo the sufferings of love. How could religiosity be transformed into spirituality without suffering?

Kafi-52

سوہنے یار پُئل دا ہر جا عین ظہور

“My lovely friend Punnal is openly manifest.”

The Reality in the form of the beloved is Omnipresent

اول، آخر، ظاہر، باطن اس دا جان حضور

“Witness his presence in the first, the last, the outward and the inward (in all dimensions).”

His presence is all-pervasive. He is the Absolute but in the process of manifestation by virtue of His being the Infinite, He becomes the origin and end of everything whether manifest or unmanifest. He is completely the outward and the inward. The attempt of religiosity to ascribe partial outwardness or partial inwardness to Him (both in the spatial and non spatial sense) is the negation of the principle of unity (tawhid).

آپ بنے سلطان جہاں دا آپ بنے مزدور

“He himself assumes the form of the sovereign of the world and He himself assumes the form of a labourer.”

His being completely outward and the inward imply that He is manifest in all forms whether as sovereign of the world or as labourer. Religiosity considers it as sacrilege to ascribe the form of labourer to Him but spirituality considers it more sacrilegious to delimit His Omnipresence.

تھی مشتاق پھرے وجہ غمے واصل تھی مہجور

“He becomes ardent and remains drowned in sorrows. He manifests identity yet remains in separation (Identity in Difference).”

His presence is in thoughts, sentiments, words and actions. His being ardent and sorrowful is the outcome of His assuming the human form. However, there is a qualitative difference between the divine and the human in experiencing the same thing. The Divine unlike the human, in the very act of experiencing (immanence), maintains His distinctness (transcendence) in simultaneity. His experience is not psychic but spiritual. The Knowledge of God regarding human states implies His experiencing these states in contemplation.

تھی معشوقِ دلِ لٹ نیوے جان کرے رنجور

“He becomes beloved by ransacking my heart. He saddens me.”

The divine initiative to love the human shakes the fabric of the lover's being. It is necessitated by the logic of the situation.

گل لانون پھر مار تڑھاؤں ایہو نہیں دستور

“It is not fair to embrace and then violently pushing one away.”

The human interpretation of divine love is limited to the human sphere and thereby considers it unfair on part of the beloved to embrace the lover and then push him away.

چشماںِ فخر الدینِ مسٹھل دیاں تن من کیٹا چور

“The eyes of sweet Fakharuddin have pierced my embodied self.”

The loving glance of the spiritual master pierces his embodied self. It is an indication of the great heights scaled by him.

گھول گھتاں میں فخر جہاں توں جنت، حور، قصور

“I hereby sacrifice paradise, houries and palaces for the sake of Fakhr-e-Jehan.”

The love of his spiritual master takes precedence over all earthly and celestial delights. It is such an absolute commitment that it helps him in attaining 'deliverance and union'.

یار فرید کوں ایویں ساڑیو جیویں جلیا کوہ طور

"My friend has consumed Farid in flames like the way
mount Tur was burnt."

His spiritual master, in a friendly way, has consumed him in flames, by casting his spiritual light on him, and thereby burning him analogous to mount Tur (which was burnt by the lightening of God and the prophet Musa fell in a swoon). The tremendous powers of his murshid has reduced him to the state of ontological nothingness, and polished the mirror of his heart for the Reality to contemplate itself.

Kafi-53

کہاں پاؤں کہاں پاؤں یار

“Where should I find and seek you, my friend?”

The Essence itself cannot be found because it is beyond the human quest. One cannot shed the ontological cloak of servanthood in order to find Him.

کیا سگلا سنسار
مستغرق سرشار

جن انسان ملائک سارے
حیرت دے قلزم وچ کل تھے

“All the fiery creatures, human beings, cosmic forces and the entire world are amazingly drowned in the sea of bewilderment.”

The Essence and the Divinity are the two fundamental aspects of the Real. It is by virtue of the Infinite or Divinity that the Reality manifests itself in the forms of the Creator and the created. It is impossible for creation to find the essence of the Creator. The more one nears the threshold of the essence, the more one is drowned in the sea of bewilderment. How is it possible to reach the essence in the state of polarity?

گئے اوڑک سب ہار
روون زار و زار

صوفی شاغل گیانی دھیانی
عرشی تے بسطامی گل لگ

“The Sufis, devotees, men of wisdom and those who meditate have ultimately lost. Arshi and Bistami cry profusely with folded arms.”

Those traversing the spiritual path have ultimately surrendered the search for reaching the essence of the Reality.

The great Sufis have also not found the essence in spite of their best efforts.

بطلموس تے فیثاغورث
کھوج سراغ نہ پایا پتہ
کر کر سوچ بچار
تھک بیٹھے تن مار

“Ptolemy and Pythagoras did a lot of thinking and reasoning but found no trace. It made them resign to the human limitation (of not finding the Absolute in its absoluteness).”

Ptolemy and Pythagoras have resorted to thinking and reasoning but have found no clue of the essence. They have resigned to the limitations of the human faculties in finding ‘the Absolute in its absoluteness’

بدھ مجوس یہود نصارا
آکھن پاک منزہ ہے
ہندو تے دیندار
بے انت الکھ اپار

“The Buddhists, Zoroastrians, Jews, Christians, Hindus and the People of Book say that He (the Absolute) is Pure, Perfect, Unlimited, Transcendent and Infinite.”

The votaries of great metaphysical and religious traditions of the world consider the nature of the Essence itself beyond the human quest. ‘He transcends transcendence itself.’

پیر پیہر غوث قطب
کرن منادی رورو کے
کیا مرسل کیا اوتار
لا یدر کہ الالبصار

“The Mystics, Prophets, Ghaus (Saints), Poles, Messengers and spiritually incarnate proclaim, while crying that no eye can see Him (He is beyond the reach of human perception).”

The Prophets and those occupying different higher spiritual stations, in their quest for the essence, ultimately proclaim that no eye can perceive Him. He is beyond the reach of sense perception.

عجز کینا اقرار
عالم فاضل عارف کامل

“The knowledgeable, erudite, gnostics and perfectionists have admitted in all humilities (their limitation of not finding the Absolute in its absoluteness). Ask Farid, modest and simple, where do you stand? (It is not possible for you to find Him in His Essence).”

It is not possible either for the elevated souls or for the inept and the simple ones to find the Essence itself. But isn't the absolute transcendence of the Essence itself a delimitation that delimits it? It is certainly a delimitation delimiting the Essence itself and in order to transcend this delimitation the Essence itself assumes the form of the Divinity. It manifests itself in 'the servant-Lord axis'. God still remains beyond human perception, conception and imagination but is experienced within 'the infinite depths of one's being or consciousness.' 'The servant –Lord axis' by virtue of Divine Grace is withdrawn by the Self. Man, as such, ceases to exist. Being itself contemplates in the mirror of ontological nothingness.

Kafi-54

متاں من ماندہ تھیوے پنل نا تھی دھار

“Punnal! Do not separate from me lest my self becomes weary.”

The self becomes weary in separation and disunion from the beloved. It is in the state of love that the lover realises that his self is not atomic or autonomous. It is not simply ‘being-in-the-world’ but is completely being-with-the-beloved. The pains and sufferings of atomic individualism perpetually surface till the lover and the beloved gradually form mutual selfhood.

سانون ڈینھ سہاگ دے ہر دم مینگھ ملہار

“The rainy season is the period of nuptial happiness (union). The sky remains overcast with rainy clouds.”

The atmosphere of rainy season symbolises the oncoming period of union with the beloved.

رل کر ساتھ گزاروں جو بن دے دن چار

“Let’s spend these four days (short span) of youthfulness in togetherness.”

She yearns for realising union with her beloved within the short span of youthfulness.

موت سنیدی سولی ونجناں وار ووار

“The hum of death is audible. We have to depart this world one by one.”

The imminent possibility of death creates an existential awareness to fructify quest for uniting with her beloved.

چیتز بہار سُہاؤں کر کر ہاں سنگار

“Let’s enjoy the month of spring by embellishing ourselves.”

The month of spring heralds the blooming of inner being leading to embellishing her self.

پلہر پانی پیووں تھیا تھل باغ بہار

“Let’s drink water from ponds. The desert has blossomed.”

The water of life makes herself blossom from within.

خوش تھی نینہ نہاؤں رُس ناسانول یار

“Let’s happily realise the possibilities of love. Do not cool down with me, my beloved friend.”

She yearns for realising the possibility of love and desires that her beloved should not withdraw but must become fully responsive (the transcendent beloved to become immanent). But how could the behaviour of the beloved go against the ultimate law of things?

توں بن جیون اوکھا ڈکھڑے تار و تار

“My life is hard without you. I am drowning in the waters of sufferings.”

Life is really hard for him without his beloved. He is drowned in the waters of sufferings with no way to reach the shore.

یار فرید نہ دسرے دل کیشم لاچار

“Farid! My friend may not fall in oblivion. My heart has reduced me to naught.”

His heart reduces him to a state where he is at a loss to find his self. He worries at the possibility of becoming oblivious of his friend, as a consequence.

Kafi-55

ناکرے پرواہی وویار آمل سانول ماہی وویار

“Discard indifference, my friend. My charming beloved! Do come and meet me, my friend.”

She desperately desires union with her beloved and is at a loss to understand the indifference of her friend.

بٹھ پیارنگ پور دا پر نیون توں بن جیون ڈکھڑا تھیون
سمجھاں موت و سہائی وویار

“My marriage at Rangpur has no significance. My life is characterized by sufferings without you. I consider death as a remedial measure, my friend.”

The village of Rangpur (symbolising the world) has no meaning for Heer (the lover) who has been forcibly married and compelled to live there. Living without Ranjha (the beloved) is ‘a tale of woe and misery’. The intensity of love reaches such sublime heights that death is considered as a remedial measure.

باجھوں ڑے باجھ اجائی امڑی بابل بھینیں بھائی
پھر دی دل توں لاہی وویار

“The support of my mother, father or siblings is meaningless without you. I am wandering by emptying them from my heart, my friend.”

The absoluteness and totality of love leaves no room for any other support even that of parents and siblings. Love makes this distancing possible in order to bank upon the sole support of the beloved.

کیونیس پیکس تننیں ولدی توڑ اصل دی روزا زل دی
ہیر را نجن دی آہی وویار

“How could she return to her parental home and the native abode, when Heer essentially belonged to Ranjhan ever since the primordial day, my friend?”

It was not only meaningless for Heer to stay in Rangpur but it was equally meaningless for her to return to her parents in her native abode since she belonged to Ranjhan from the primordial day. The wholesomeness of love leaves no space and time for any one except the beloved. The cognitive aspect of love makes one understand the doctrine of tawhid or unity of God, which has no trace of otherness.

چائی جائی عشق دہنوائی پیٹ سوائی ریت نہ کائی
بے واہی بے ٹھائی وویار

“Love gave me birth, bathed me and nurtured me in her lap. There was no other tradition except the tradition of love. I am bereft of support and shelter, my friend.”

Heer was born and nurtured in the tradition of love. She was bound to live beyond support and shelter of any one except her beloved, Ranjha.

وسریارنگ محل چچکانہ جھنگ سیالیں تے مکھیانہ
لایو کبر جائی وویار

“I have forgotten the colourful mansions of Choochak (my father) and Jhang and Maghiana of Sial. You have shot the arrow of love so perfectly, my friend.”

Ranjha made Heer love him so deeply that she forgot her royal comforts. She had to make no efforts in leaving the worldly treasures. It is the intensity of love, which makes these wonders happen with such ease. Love makes no

rational choice between the world and the beloved since Love itself is the fundamental choice. All things follow accordingly. Rational consciousness weighs all things whereas love consciousness outweighs everything.

دھوڑ مہیں دی نور اکھیں دا پاہنباہ ہے مان مہیندا

ڈیوم حال گواہی وویار

“The dust of the flock is the light of my eyes. The dung of the flock and its heaps are my honour. They stand as testimony to my state (of devotion), my friend.”

The meanest thing in the world attached to love becomes the highest and the highest thing bereft of love becomes the meanest. The miracle of love changes meanings so miraculously.

سہجوں سُرخِ میندی لیاں کجلہ پیساں مانگھ بنیاں

جے تھیوں میں ڈوراہی وویار

“I will readily apply rouge, henna, collyrium and set my hair, if you pay a visit to me, my friend.”

It is the inward that readily manifests in the outward. How could beautification have any meaning except for the sake of one's friend?

آپے تخت ہزاروں آیا ہیرے کارن چاک سڈایا

سٹ کر شوکت شاہی وویار

“He himself came from ‘takht Hazara’ (the native place of Ranjha). He chose to be called a herdsman for the sake of Heer. He renounced splendour and royalty, my friend.”

Heer sacrificed her native abode and royal mansions for Ranjha, but Ranjha too sacrificed his splendid abode and renounced his splendour and royalty and became a herdsman

for Heer's sake. Metaphysically speaking, the Absolute became the Infinite. The Transcendent became Immanent. The Reality itself in the state of ontological love resorted to the ontological descent. The Nondelimited Being assumed the form of the Delimited Being. The 'Hidden Treasure' became manifest. The Nameless became named. The Signless provided signs. The Divine became cloaked in the human. The Unity embraced diversity. Love itself polarised in the form of the lover and the beloved making the lover and the beloved inter-dependent. These 'sacrifices' the Reality gave in love of Muhammad and thereby with the whole creation. Man cannot become God but God has to 'become Man' in order to make love possible. Isn't it a great sacrifice? Love continues and the 'sacrifices' continue. Love is essentially sacrificial in nature. The Creator loves His creation for, among other things, it is by virtue of the medium of creation that His Possibilities are realised in the forms of His Attributes. How could He have become the Creator if He had not created?

برہوں فرید تھیو سے ساتھی جیس ڈینھ راول پاکر جھاتی
جادو مرلی واہی وویار

“Farid! Love has become my companion. It is ever since the day my beloved cast a glance at me, while playing on the enchanting flute, my friend.”

Love manifests in historicity but is essentially trans-historical. The Divine initiative of love and responsiveness sets the stage of earthly love. The eternal love has manifested itself in the temporality of his human medium. The beloved has attracted him by playing on the enchanting flute of love.

Kafi-56

نہ کر کچھ و نجن دی رہو برو چل یار

“Do not contrive to go to Kech. My friend Baloch!
Do stay with me.”

The situation of separation or disunion from her beloved is so overbearing that she desires her beloved to always remain with her.

عشق لیو سے پھڑا بُھل گیا کل کم کار

“I have fallen in overturned love. It has made me
oblivious of all my activities.”

Love drastically changes the ordinary meanings of life. The act of love is her only activity whereas all other activities have fallen in oblivion.

جان جگروچ ڈکھڑے سینے سول ہزار

“My being is suffering. My chest is an abode of
countless afflictions.”

Her embodied self is drowned in afflictions and sufferings.

باجھوں مارو مٹھڑے بارڈ سے گھر بار

“My dwellings without the presence of my sweet
beloved seem wilderness.”

It is the presence or the absence of the beloved, which gives respective meanings to dwellings or wilderness. The objectivity of space remains but it is given existential meaning by the consciousness of love. Love gives birth to creative meanings.

سیچھ تھئی گل خار

توں بن ہوت پیارا

“My beloved Punna! The nuptial bed has become all thorny without you.”

How could the nuptial bed become a bed of roses without the beloved?

مانو چیتز بہار

رل مل یار ہمیشہ

“My friend! Let’s sustain togetherness forever and enjoy the blossoming of spring.”

The season of spring symbolises the heralding of union. The atomic individualism craves for mutual selfhood. It also desires the temporal to become eternal. Love turns time into eternity.

اکھیاں زار و زار

نینہ نہاؤن اوکھا

“It is so difficult to achieve steadfastness in love. My eyes are weeping profusely.”

She has to remain steadfast in love in spite of internal and external contradictions. The very act of bearing the onerous burden of love is a great challenge for her.

ساری عمر گزار

ڈھول فرید دے کو لھوں

“My beloved! Do spend your whole life with Farid.”

He desires that his beloved remains with him forever. The process of change opposes him as the other. He wishes permanence of his beloved’s immanence. His love consciousness ultimately identifies itself with changelessness in change. Don’t the sufferings of change make the lover correspondingly experience the joys of permanence?

Kafi-57

نہیہ اولڑی چونک لائی تن من کیتس چکنا چور

“Love has struck me an intricate blow. It has crushed my body and soul.”

The intricate blow strikes her embodied self in fullness.

ماہی باجھوں کینویں گزاراں سوز گھنیرے ڈکھ ہزاراں

پوون تی کوں پل پل پور

“How should I spend my life without my beloved? There are heavy passions and countless sufferings. I am the inept one, who is constantly undergoing fits.”

The period spent in separation from her beloved crushes her embodied self. The pains and sufferings melt her individual self for onward formation of mutual selfhood.

سیجھ، ستی نیماں ندر نہ آندی کیکر گزرے رین ڈکھاں دی

دل دا ڈھولا گیا دور

“I cannot sleep, while lying on the nuptial bed. How will I pass the night of sufferings? The beloved of my heart has deserted me and gone far away.”

The feeling of being deserted and left forlorn by her beloved is construed as the period of night, which turns into dawn with the vision and union of her beloved.

تپدیاں، کھپدیاں عمر نبھاوے سوہنے باجھ آرام نہ آوے

درد و سایا تھر کھور

“My life is ebbing out in great tumult. I have no peace without my beloved. I have been hit hard by terrible severity.”

The act of dying of the self for the birth of the Self is a perpetual painful process. There are no sedatives for this pain. The birth pangs of union are terribly severe. There can be peace only with the beloved.

گمراہی سبھ زہد عبادت شاہد مستی عین ہدایت
جس جا کیتا عشق ظہور

“When love manifests itself, then misguidance is total asceticism and worship and inebriation with profane beauty is guidance itself.”

The manifestation of love construes misguidance as total piety and worship and inebriation with profane beauty as guidance itself essentially in reference to the Principle. There is no substantial continuity between guidance and misguidance but essential continuity of the Principle. Love is the ultimate criterion and all things are measured on it. Any idea, feeling, word or action devoid of love has no value. Religiosity bereft of love has no spiritual meaning. The realm of disvalues is irrelevant to the absoluteness of love since it is only the miraculous power of love, which confers value on things. Love is value itself. It is not derived from any other value. It is the transvaluation of values. The tremendous force of love determines its own course.

نور حقیقی گھونگھٹ کھولے اُوٹھ گئے اُولے بھج پئے بھولے
ہر جا ایمن ہر جا طور

“The ultimate Light has unveiled itself. Hidden has become unhidden and doubts have fled away. Here, every place is Aiman and every place is Tur.”

The unveiling of the ultimate Light leads to the openness of the hidden in both the inner and the outer worlds. The psychic doubts are removed. All things are rooted in the

sacred. Profanity is merely ephemeral. Light leaves no room for darkness.

فخر جہاں ہک ریت سجائی ارضی تھی ایک بار سائی
ظلمت بن گئی نور و نور

“Fakhr Jehan made me realise a metaphysical tradition. The terrestrial became celestial and darkness turned into lighting upon light.”

The spiritual master made him realise a metaphysical tradition wherein the terrestrial becomes celestial and darkness turned into radiating light. The privation or ‘lack of what is needed for existence’ characterises all negativities. The nature of evil, wrongness, crookedness, profanity, immorality, wickedness, ignorance, imperfection, bondage, ugliness, hate, etc is unreal (lacking in substantial reality). These negativities or privations are not ingrained in the nature of things but arise in the process of manifestation and ultimately return to their source. They are merely relationships in the terrestrial world. This is precisely the reason that the good vanishes evil, the straight vanishes crookedness, the sacred vanishes profanity, the moral vanishes immorality, the virtuous vanishes wickedness, the knowledge vanishes ignorance, the perfection vanishes imperfection, the freedom vanishes bondage, the beauty vanishes ugliness, the love vanishes hatred and the light vanishes darkness. If darkness, for instance, was not a privation and had any self-subsistent reality instead, then it would have maintained it in spite of light. But the miracle of light makes darkness vanish like a phantom.

نیت فرید نماز شہودی ہر شے میں ہے رمز وجودی
سٹ ٹوانے جو مذکور

“Farid! Resolve to offer the prayer of witnessing. Being itself is manifest in everything. Discard the talk of the clerics.”

The clerics cannot understand the metaphysical truth and its realisation. Being itself is manifest in everything and thereby the prayer of witnessing is the only mode of true prayer. The ordinary ritual prayer worships God without seeing Him but the prayer of the heart worships the living God while witnessing Him in all forms. How could a lover prostrate unless he witnesses his beloved?

Kafi-58

ول کہیں ڈکھڑے وے ڈیندیں سانول دلڑی برماگیوں (سوہنا یار)

“Why do you bestow sufferings upon me after stealthily captivating my heart, my beloved friend?”

She constantly raises the question of her suffering, in the wake of her beloved's instilling love himself in the first instance. It is a question that is raised by her so often but she finds no answer during her existential suffering. It is at the stage of union that the lover completely understands the rationale of the beloved's behaviour that was essentially meant to fructify love in fullness. She understands the process of baking heart in the oven of love.

کئے کئے بُندے گل جھپمالاں انہد بین بجاگیوں (سوہنا یار)

“There are earrings and thread of counting beads around your neck. You played the divine flute, my beloved friend.”

The Essence assumes the forms of the Divinity to make love possible.

راول جوگی شاہ حسن دا پر م جڑی جڑلاگیوں (سوہنا یار)

“My Rawal Yogi is the crown of beauty. You perfectly ignited the spark of love in my being, my beloved friend.”

The beloved is beauty personified that ignites the spark of love in her heart. Beauty and love complement each other.

اکھیاں سحری سحر کماون جادو چوٹ چلاگیوں (سوہنا یار)

“Your entrancing eyes are spellbinding. You have played a magical game, my beloved friend.”

The irresistible Beauty plays the magical game of love.

سوز تپش موجود ہمیشہ بھابھ ہوں بھڑکا گیوں (سوہنا یار)

“The animated passion is ever present with me. You have intensified the flame of loving, my beloved friend.”

Love is not conceptual but existential involving her whole being. It is not static but dynamic. It keeps on intensifying in varying situations.

لا کر یاری یار و ساریو کھوٹ فریب کما گیوں (سوہنا یار)

“You became oblivious of your friend after cultivating friendship with him. You have earned counterfeits and deceit, my beloved friend.”

She considers the behaviour of her beloved as deceitful. She fails to understand as to why her beloved after initiating love has turned unresponsive or has assumed transcendence.

کلہڑی کے کچھ سدھائیوں پر بھت روہ رو لا گیوں (سوہنا یار)

“You went to Kech and left me forlorn. You left me wandering, wretchedly in hills and mountains, my beloved friend.”

The beloved's return to his abode symbolises his transcendence. She is lost in wilderness because she cannot find him. He can only be found in immanence.

توں بن یار فرید ڈکھاں وچ سو لیں جان اڑا گیوں (سوہنا یار)

“Farid is suffering without you, my friend. You have nailed me on the cross, my beloved friend.”

He suffers in being nailed on the cross of love. Religiosity cannot understand the sentiment of love for it has never undergone such an experience. It has only the experience of nailing the lovers on the cross.

Kafi-59

وے توں سانولا نہ مارنیاں دے تیر

“O’ my charming beloved! Don’t cast piercing glances at me.”

Eye symbolises the meeting point between beauty and love.

اکھیاں شرکارن نت بکھیاں ہن پاپی بے پیر

“Your eyes are bent upon creating mischief. They are fallen (sinful) and unruly.”

The captivating eyes of the beloved are bent upon hunting the lover.

زلفاں مشکیں بدھ بدھ ڈیون دلڑی کوں تعزیر

“The locks of your hair severely chastise my heart by enchaining it.”

The beauty of the locks of hair enchains her and ravishes her befallen heart.

اے نال ہے سانول سوہنا دل لانون تقصیر

“It was my mistake to have fallen in love with you, my charming beloved.”

The act of her falling in love seems to be a mistake for it becomes impossible to endure.

ناز نہورے غمزے %ے مصحف دی تفسیر

“Your pride, coquetries and enticements are the exegesis of the Holy Scriptures.”

Perfect beauty intertwined with love is the exegesis of holiness. It manifests dimensions of beauty and love.

کا کل پیناں ناگ وار دہا ڈٹھڑیں چڑھم سریر

“The complex locks of your hair emerge as a deadly snake whereby the small hair of my body stands on their ends.”

The striking beauty becomes so terrific that it creates dread. She is completely overpowered by it. The rising waters of beauty have no spill channel.

جھوکاں آن سوڑیاں سیگا نین لڑھیندے نیر

“My age companion! Do make your temporary dwellings close to me. My eyes are crying profusely.”

She desperately desires the immanence of her beloved. The closeness of her beloved transforms wilderness into dwelling.

پاہ، ہنباہ، اوگار، گئیں دی میں لکھے اکسیر

“The dung with its heaps and the fodder of the herd is my elixir (for they make me remember my beloved herdsman).”

The ordinary meanings of things undergo radical transformation in love and even the meanest things assume lofty meanings. The dung with its heaps and the fodder of the herd becomes elixir for her since it has relevance with Ranjha, the shepherd of the herd who, in fact, is the shepherd of her heart. Love is an absolute and complete commitment with the beloved. All things are measured in reference to it. Things have no independent and autonomous status. Their independent meanings become fluid and thereby existential.

ووٹھ کنوں تھنی دھرتی تھلڑی ساگی ملک ملہیر

“The desert land by virtue of rainfall has exactly become the land of Malheer.”

The divine blessings turn wilderness into dwellings. The inner desert of the self starts blooming with happiness at the signs of her beloved's responsiveness.

رلڑے سجن سہاؤں تھلڑے کارو کئی کیر

“My friend! Let us get together and enjoy different places of the desert.”

She yearns for the company of her beloved to enjoy the beauty of the desert.

جیسلمیر زہائی مانوں تھی ڈوہیں کھنڈ کھیر

“Let's mix our selves like sugar in milk and attain togetherness in Jaisalmer without any fear.”

The fearless desire of union with the beloved is akin to mixing sugar with milk. It is realisable when the transcendent (beloved) becomes immanent and the self (lover) dwindles into nothingness.

تھل چترانگ اندر میں سسی بلیس میٹیں ہیر

“I am like Sassi in the plains of the desert and Heer in riparian shrubbery and marshes.”

Sassi and Heer (forms of the lover) had to undergo tremendous sufferings in love for the sake of Punnal and Ranjha (forms of the beloved), respectively.

روز ازل دا ساڈا مال مویشی سیر

“Your and mine, wealth and flock is common ever since the primordial day.”

Love itself manifests in the forms of the lover and the beloved. There is no otherness. There is absolute and complete commonality in love.

جانوں لادامک تساڈا تن من سیں سریر

“My body, soul and spirit belong to your dominion
ever since the day I was born.”

The whole embodied being of the lover (body, soul and spirit) belongs to the beloved since primordial times.

کو جھی کملی ۛے ناں دی نہ کریا کریر

“I am ugly and simple belonging to you. My friend!
Do not detest me.”

Speaking ontologically, the Essence assumes the forms of Names and Attributes to make love possible and it is in the process of manifestation that ugliness and human deficiencies are born and therefore they cannot be detested.

مونجھاں دوست تے خوشیاں دشمن شکھ ویری ڈکھ ویر

“My anguishes are my friends and the joys are my
enemies. Peace has become my adversary and
sufferings have established fraternal ties with me.”

The anguishes of love keep company with her but the joys keep away. Peace turns war like and sufferings attain nearness.

جانی جوڑ چلا یو کانی سَندھ سَندھ دے وچ پیڑ

“My intimate friend! You have shot the arrow of love
so perfectly that there is pain in each and every joint
of my body.”

The beloved initiates love so perfectly that the lover's embodied self experiences the jolts of love in fullness.

بٹھ چو چک، بٹھ کھیرے، بھیرے توں نہ تھی دلگیر

“Just become unmindful of Choochak and cast aside
the despicable ‘Kheras’. Do not have any grief.”

Heer, in the state of love, had no grief in becoming unmindful of her father and her despicable in-laws. Love makes her concentrate absolutely and completely on the beloved.

ڈینہو ڈینہہ گراڑا تھیوے واہ سک دی تاثیر

“The hardness of his heart is perpetually on the increase. I laud the effects of the desire.”

Her desire for her beloved makes her beloved more unresponsive, which is attributed as hardness of heart by her. The law of causality or probability holds no ground in love. There is no logical nexus between the lover's desire and the responsiveness of the beloved. She ultimately realises it during the hazardous march unto nothingness.

رورو تسلیں پیاں ناسوراں دل وچ سو سوچیر

“The corners of my eyes have become a sore by constant crying. My heart has been cut to countless pieces.”

The very medium of vision becomes impaired by crying. Heart, the abode of the beloved, is cut to pieces. Isn't it the precise moment for vision and union with the beloved?

عریانی دی خلعت ملّری سنج بردی جاگیر

“I have been invested with the robe of nudity and the dominion of wilderness.”

Love invests him with the robe of nudity by stripping him of everything and reducing him to nothingness. His internal and external dwellings are displaced with the dominion of wilderness. He is ultimately left with no being or having.

ہو ہو پھکڑی شہر خواری ساڈی ہے توقیر

“It is our veneration to have infamy, ill-repute and notoriety (for the sake of love).”

He does not see himself through the eye of the other. He sees himself through the eye of his beloved. He does not weaken in face of infamy, ill-repute and notoriety but venerates them, instead. It is the force of love, which makes

him transcend the sting of public opinion. The miracle of love works such wonders.

نموت قطب سب توں توں صدقے کون فرید فقیر

“All Ghaus (Saints) and Poles have sacrificed themselves to you. Where does Farid, conscious of his ontological nothingness, figure in?”

‘Ghaus’ is a friend of God who, in Sufi terminology, occupies the station of ‘the spiritual helper’. He is empowered by God to help those in need. He has no inherent powers or any power over and above God to help himself or others. All his powers are derived from God, the Omnipotent. Metaphysically speaking, the Reality is Power itself manifest in all forms of power. The Creator has inherent powers, which He manifests in His creation. The ontological powerfulness of the Creator and the ontological powerlessness of the creation are indubitable facts of Islamic spirituality. The power to help found in ‘the spiritual helper’ is essentially God’s Attribute of Power manifest in human medium. It is the immanent aspect of His transcendent power. God responds to the needs of the people through his medium. There is no question of placing any divinity beside Allah? How could the lover, in all humility, compare himself with ‘the spiritual helpers’ (mediums of Divine Succour) and Poles who have been so sacrificial in love of God?

Kafi-60

ہر صورت وچ آوے یار کر کے ناز ادا لکھ وار

“My friend descends in each form by making
countless prideful charming moves.”

The beloved pridefully and stylishly descends in every form.

حسن ملاحت برہوں بچھائے رمز نراکت بھابھڑکائے
عشوہ غمزہ تیر چلائے بیدل پھر دے زار نزار

“The charming beauty intensifies love. The delicate
expressions intensify the flames of love. The amorous
glances filled with enticements shoot arrows. The
disheartened lovers wander in distressful states.”

The immanence of beauty in varied expressions intensifies
love. The lovers become disheartened in the face of
transcendent beauty.

سوہنیاں طرزاں موہنیاں گاہیں دلڑی خوب اجاڑن چالیں
ہوش قرار بھلاون بھالیں پکاں کردیاں خون ہزار

“The lovely indications and the captivating discourses
are great heart ravishing. The sprightly eyes make
sense and sensibility vanish. The eyelashes make
countless ravishing.”

There is no escape from the captivating power of beauty. The
lover is condemned to surrender before the onslaught of beauty.

ہک جا روپ سنگار ڈکھاوے ہک جا عاشق بن بن آوے
ہر مظہر وچ آپ سماوے اپناں آپ کرے دیدار

“He exhibits ornamental beauty at times and at times
recurs as lover. He dwells in each manifestation. He
contemplates Himself.”

The Essence assumes the form of the Divinity in order to witness itself in the mirror of the universe. The Possibilities inhering in the Essence are realised as Names or Attributes. The Reality manifests itself in the form of the beautiful and in the form of the dynamic lover in simultaneity. It demonstrates the primordial intimacy of beauty and love. The Reality dwells in every form in order to contemplate itself. The polished mirror of the heart reflects the face of the beloved. The Reality contemplates itself perfectly in the perfect mirror of the Prophet's heart in different spatio-temporal orders. Good and evil is in reference to the purity or impurity of heart. Good purifies heart and evil creates impurities of heart. A pure heart reflects the beloved's face whereas an impure heart deflects the vision of the beloved. It obstructs the contemplation of the Reality in that particular medium. The Reality has chosen to contemplate itself in every medium and witness itself in the mirror of every heart without a single exception. A person with a pure heart experiences spiritual joy in the process and shall be blessed with perpetual beatific vision in the next world. But a person who dies with an impure heart (blind or rusted) in this world would undergo a process of cleansing in hell, so that the mirror of his heart could become pure in order to reflect the face of the Reality. The programme of the Reality will not end even after the day of Reckoning. The Infinite Possibilities of the Essence itself implying infinite Names and Attributes would require infinite spatio-temporal orders for their realisation thus, the act of the Reality in contemplating itself in every medium will never end. How could the Infinite be ever exhausted?

کڈیں گدا مسکین سڈاوے	کڈیں شہانہ حکم چلاوے
سب بد مست پھرن سرشار	اوسدا بھیت کوئی نہ پاوے

“He issues royal decrees at times and at times is in the forms of the beggar and the lowly. No one has the

access to his mystery. All wander in the states of inebriety and drunkenness.”

He manifests in the Attribute of Majesty while issuing royal decrees. He also manifests in the forms of the beggar and the lowly. Religiosity considers such manifestation as scandalous because it has no realisation of the metaphysical truth that the manifestation of the Reality is in all forms. How could there be anything outside ‘the Metaphysical Whole’. Metaphysics teaches us that the Reality is not defiled by being manifest in any form or medium, how much poor and lowly, because it transcends its immanent forms in simultaneity. The king essentially remains the king even in the form of a beggar. However, it is not possible to unravel the mystery of His Essence. His lovers are wandering in the state of inebriety and drunkenness.

فخر جہان قبول کیے تو سے	واقف کل اسرار تھیو سے
ہر جانور جمال ڈٹھو سے	مخفی راز تھے اظہار

“I have been accepted by Fakhr-e-Jehan in a wholesome way. He has acquainted me with all mysteries. I am witnessing radiant beauty everywhere. The hidden secrets have opened up.”

The spiritual master accepts him and acquaints him with all mysteries. He helps him attain metaphysical realisation and thereby witness the Omnipresence of radiant beauty. The hidden secrets become openly disclosed. Religiosity is bereft of the spiritual taste of witnessing. It has no inkling of spirituality.

یار فرید عیان بیانے	نخن اقرب وچ فرقانے
ایہو عقیدہ دین ایمانے	توڑے پکڑ چڑھاؤن دار

“Farid! My friend is openly manifest. His being nearer to man than his neck vein entails the entire holy discernment (Furqan). It is our doctrine imbibed in

the religion of the heart. It may end up in captivation or crucifixion.”

The Reality is openly manifest. The entire holy discernment points to the nearness of God to Man than his own neck vein. The Reality is more nearer to Man than Man is to himself. It is not merely a spatial nearness but a metaphysical one by virtue of which, the Reality assumes the human form. Metaphysically speaking, the Reality's being nearer to Man than his neck-vein means 'Identity in Difference' or the 'Supreme Identity'. The lover adheres to this doctrine of traditional metaphysics at the cost of being captivated and crucified.

Kafi-61

ہن وطن بیگانے دل نہیں آؤنا یاد کیتم دلدار

“I will never return to my native place since it has become alien to me. My beloved has called me.”

A call from the beloved (Self) - provisional or final-changes the perspectives of the lover's native place (self) and turns it into an alien territory.

کو لے رہساں مول نہ سہساں ہجر داباری بار

“I will dwell in proximity with him. I will never bear the heavy burden of disunion.”

A call of proximity saves her from the heavy burden of disunion.

وسریساں راج بہانہ وسر گیا گھر بار

“My sovereignty and regal status have fallen in oblivion. I have become oblivious of my household.”

She becomes oblivious of everything by solely concentrating on her beloved.

بھان منسیاں مان نبھسیاں گھولے عارویار

“I will happily spend my life in the backyard. I will not be ashamed of the public opinion.”

Heer (lover) orients her whole activity for the sake of Ranjha (beloved) without caring for others. She sees herself only through the eye of her beloved.

سرخی کجل مساک گیوسے بٹھ بیہار سنگار

“The desire to apply rouge, collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) has withered away. I do not care a fig for my makeup.”

The adornments and embellishments are for the sake of her beloved. They lose their meaning in separation or disunion. They are preparatory to union and have no other purpose.

پاروں ڈسدی جھوک سجن دی کیوں رہساں اُروار

“The dwellings of my beloved are visible on the other side. Why should I remain on this side?”

She resolves to peel off her self in order to realise the Self.

میں مَن تار تے نیں باری قادر نیسم پار

“It is a stream so full and I do not know how to swim. It is only the Almighty who will steer me across the waters.”

The spiritual path of union is to ferry across full stream without knowing the art of swimming. It is only possible with Divine Grace.

بٹھ پئی سندھڑی کیتم مولیٰ ملک ملہیر ملہار

“I have no inclination to stay in Sindh. I will go to Malheer, where God has showered His blessings.”

He casts away his everydayness of existence. He yearns for the life of love saturated with Divine blessings.

دیس عرب داملک طرب دا سارا باغ بہار

“The Arabian territory is the land of happiness that is fully blossoming.”

Arabia symbolising the presence of the Prophet is the land of happiness. It blossoms with the fragrance of the Prophet.

روہی راوے روہیں رو لیس نس گیا کر ہوں قطار

“He has left me wretchedly wandering in the desert (rohi), mountains and rocky grounds. My beloved has stealthily escaped with the caravan of camels.”

Sassi (lover) has to undergo the pangs of separation and disunion at the hands of Punnal (beloved). The alchemy of suffering turns her base metal into gold. How could it be otherwise?

ڈینہ ڈکھاں داڈونگر ڈسدا رات غماں دی غار

“My day seems a mountain of sufferings and the night a cave of sorrows.”

It is so overbearing for the lover to suffer in love.

سانون آیاروہی وٹھڑی بار تھئی گلزار

“The desert (rohi) has become lively with the advent of rainy season (savan). The dried ones are becoming ever green.”

The coming event of union brings inward and outward changes. Despair turns into hope.

دارمدار فرید ہے دل نوں ڈکھڑے تاروتار

“Farid! My heart has full faith in him. My sufferings will wither away.”

He has vital faith in realising the possibility of union with his beloved, which takes the sting out of his sufferings. It is the miracle of faith that keeps him on the path of love in spite of terrible severities encountered in the way.

Kafi-62

عشق اسماں ہے جا آہن انصاف
ظلم نبھائیں دس، تاں بھی تہن جا تھورا گائیں دس

“Do justice to my heightened love. I harp on the tune of your name in spite of bearing your unjust behaviour.”

The lover’s consciousness is absorbed in pure objectivity but as against the objective it gives existential meaning to things. It is not possible to understand these meanings from the outside. They have to be understood inwardly in their total context. The cardinal error of religiosity is to interpret the utterances of the lovers at their face value without bothering to decipher their real meanings. The contradictions between the clerics and the Sufis continue because they speak from different perspectives in different languages. The Sufis understand the clerics but the clerics do not understand the Sufis. How could a person stationed at lower echelon understand the higher one? Many Sufis including Mansur Hallaj, Baba Bulleh Shah and the martyr Sarmad had to suffer at the hands of the clerics. The accusations of the lover against the beloved cannot be interpreted on ordinary plane since she communicates at a higher level. Her words and their purport are only meant for her beloved who understands them fully. They are not meant for the ordinary folk to interpret them at their respective level. It is only the beloved, which has a right to check the lover and no one else. The self-styled custodians of religious, social and cultural values have played havoc with the lovers, symbolised in the tragic romantic tales of different parts of the world. They have not

allowed love to prosper. The spiritual essence of love cannot be understood at the psychic plane. The contradiction between the psychic and the spiritual has destroyed so many great men and women. The lover and the beloved express two shades of rightness. It is not a conflict between right and wrong but a conflict between two shades of rightness. The lover is placed at a situation where she exercises rightness otherwise how could she be worthy of her beloved's love. Her ideas, feelings, words and actions are the expressions of righteousness. The beloved, on the other hand, rightfully places his lover in the heightened states of suffering because it makes the realisation of union possible, though his shade of rightness is differently perceived by the lover. Thus, the two shades of rightness come in open conflict with each other. This is the 'dialectics' of love, which ultimately leads to union of the lover and the beloved. The lover's seeking justice against the unjust behaviour of his beloved has to be understood in the total context.

سجدہ جانب تہنجی، تہنجے گرد طواف
قدم قدم تے سیس نواہندس

“My prostration and circumambulation is for you. I will remain bowing my head at your each and every step.”

He submits to his beloved and makes him the axis of his life. Isn't the beloved measure of all things?

توہنجی سیرت، صورت سوہنی کیوں کیاں اوصاف
جندڑی توں تُوں گھول گھماہندس

“How can I express the inexpressible beauty of your face and conduct? I shall barter my head for your sake.”

It is not possible for the lover to describe the inexpressible beauty of his beloved. He exercises his freedom in love to sacrifice his being and having for the sake of his beloved.

تن من سوہنل ملک ہے آتہجہ سچ آہے نہ ہے لاف
قسم اوائجے سرجی کھائیںدس

“I swear by your honour and truthfully disclose that without an iota of exaggeration that my body and soul absolutely belong to you.”

He does his best to convince his beloved about the absolute sincerity of his love.

ذکراول فکر آتہجہ دم دم، چونکندس صاف جو صاف
عبد معبود میں تو کھے پائیںدس

“I existentially remember you at each and every moment. I state candidly that I witness you in the servant – Lord Axis.”

He constantly remembers his beloved (constantly concentrates on the Real). He willingly accepts the station of his servanthood.

باندی گولی یار جی آھیاں، نا ہے فرید خلاف
انہیں کھے بھائیںدس خواہ نہ بھائیںدس

“Farid! It is an indubitable fact that I am the maidservant and a slave girl of my friend. It does not matter, whether I am likable or dislikeable to him.”

His station of servanthood, symbolised in the forms of maidservant and slave girl, is unconditional. It exists beyond being liked or disliked by his master. The categorical nature of his love leaves no room for hypothetical imperatives.

Kafi-63

لڇ لوئي کين اتاريندس تهنجائمنل بھامیں باريندس

“I will not discard the coverlet of my honour but set
to fire your velvet shawl instead.”

Omar Marvi is a Sindhi folk tale of love, devotion and commitment. Marvi, a pretty village girl, lived in the village of Malir in the desert of Tharparkar. Phog, an orphan boy, was adopted by her family and he grew up with her in a traditional environment. He was enchanted by the beauty of Marvi and desired to marry her. She refused to give her hand in marriage to him since she had never nurtured the idea of marrying him. She yearned to marry Khet, her cousin, by reciprocating his love. Phog left Malir in utter disappointment, jealousy and frustration. He went to Umarkot and got access to Omar Soomro, the ruler. He revengefully mentioned to him about the superb beauty of Marvi and made him see her unaware. Her beauty was so captivating and her commitment with Khet was so absolute that Omar Soomro abducted her and kept her in his palace at Umarkot for one year but could not win her to marry him. His majestic grandeur and worldly treasures could not seduce Marvi in betraying her love. She exercised her existential freedom in spite of bondage. Omar Soomro finally realised that he could not capture the existential freedom of Marvi and he set her free. Marvi pledges not to discard the coverlet of her honour (her commitment of love with Khet) but set to fire the velvet shawl (the treasures of Omar Soomro), instead. The lover is existentially free to say no to everything. Love is not possible without freedom. Love is free choice. Love is beyond any form of seduction. Love freely gives meaning to things. Love

is not merchandise. It cannot be put on the market. The cosmos, in comparison with the beloved, is not even a speck of dust in the eye of the lover.

تہنجازور زل اوں مکرو دغا تہنجے ظلم جیاں گار ہیوں عمر ادا
ونجیں وہیڑ پچن ساں گار بندس

“My fraternal Omar! You have been cruel, dubious and deceitful. I shall narrate the tale of your oppression in my neighbourhood.”

The pure eye of Marvi sees Omar Soomro in the fraternal context. Her body, soul and spirit completely belong to Khet. The oppressor is subhuman. He is considered as mean in the eye of the people. Love is beyond all internal and external constraints. No physical coercion or seduction can capture the existential freedom of the lover.

تھر پنہوران جوڈیس وطن تھر آہے سنہ جامک وطن
خوش سینگیں ساں گزار بندس

“The desert is the native place of the Punwaras. The desert is my homeland. I shall happily spend my life amidst my friends.”

One is happy amidst friends in one's native place. Homeliness of the desert is preferable to the homelessness of the mansion. The choice of nothingness is superior to that of being.

ہن قید میں کیڑھو کام کیاں شالا مارن وارے وہن ونجاں
جاتھے وار او گار بوہار بندس

“How could I work in the state of captivity? I pray to reach the abode of Mar, where I would clean dung and heap with the broom.”

The work done under physical coercion has no worth. All menial work done in a spirit of freedom attains worthiness.

Love cannot be coerced. It is born of freedom. Freedom and love are identical.

ججے ہر دم ڈینھ ابانے مینہ
آہے سک سانجھ جی راتوں ڈینہ
وینٹھی دھانہ کنس ہنوں ہاریندس

“I am constantly longing for my beloved like the one yearning for rain. I am calling him with tearful eyes.”

The constant longing for the beloved is likened to the thirsty one dying for water. How could the lover survive without the beloved?

بٹھ ماڑیوں اوں محلات جاگھر
آہے مرک فرید جمارو تھر
وہن سانگے اڑن جے چاریندس

“The mansions, palaces and houses have no meaning for me. Farid wishes to go to the deadly desert and prefers to shepherd the herd of his beloved.”

The outward meaning has no existential relevance for the lover. All meaning lies in his inwardness. His love chooses inward sufferings to outward comforts. Love confers sense of belongingness on him.

Kafi-64

آہن قلندر روز و شب پہنچی خودی میں خود غرق

“The Qalandars, day and night, are themselves drowned in their own selves.”

The spiritual path has many wayfarers. There are different states, stations, ranks, levels and degrees of sainthood. The qalandars or “wandering anti-nomian Sufis” are much in spiritual elevation but less in number. They constantly delve ‘within the infinite depths of their being or consciousness.’

حاجت نہ صوم صلوٰۃ دی خواہش نہ حج زکوٰۃ دی
چاہت نہ ذات صفات دی ہک شان وحدت جی مرک

“They transcend fasting and prayer. They have no wish of the pilgrimage and alms giving. They have no keenness of essence and attributes. They simply yearn for the Majestic One.”

They are poised at the point where they transcend the need and wish to perform rituals. They are not keen in remaining tied to the polarisation of the essence and the attributes since they have attained the consciousness of their own ontological nothingness. They simply yearn for witnessing Being itself in the mirrors of their hearts.

نہ طلب ملک تے مال دی مستی خدائی خیال دی
نہ غرض جاہ و جلال دی پوئیں نہ آدم جئے تے تک

“They have no craving of dominion and wealth. They have no concern with rank and dignity. They are enraptured in contemplating Divinity. Their eyes don’t cast a glance on the human sphere.”

They are not simply divested of being but are also divested of having. They are enraptured by witnessing the Reality contemplating itself through their mediums. The human as such ceases to exist.

تو نے جو دریائے نوش بہن
پر جوش تھی خاموش بہن
اسرار دے سر پوش بہن
صامت رہن مارن نہ بک

“They remain composed, in spite of being heavily drunk and animated. They are the coverings of the mysteries. They remain quiet and do not prattle.”

They have drunk deep from the infinite oceans of spirituality. They breathe the Spirit but they remain composed. They have understood the mysteries but they do not disclose them. They have attained ‘knowledge of the ultimate nature of things’ and thereby they remain quiet and do not enter into arguments with their adversaries.

عاشق اے معشوق بہن
سابق اے مسبوق بہن
خود دُر اے صندوق بہن
ہر طور وچ رہندے اچھک

“They are themselves lovers and beloveds. They are themselves vanguards and rearguards. They are themselves pearls and caskets. They remain serene in all situations.”

They identify themselves with love itself and thereby transcend the polarisation of the lover and the beloved. They are the vanguards and rearguards of the spiritual way since they have knowledge of things and knowledge of events. Their inward and outward is drowned in Oneness. They attain serenity by surrendering their spatio-temporal dimension.

مسکین اے مظلوم بہن
محزون اے مغنوم بہن
ہر وقت کالمعدوم بہن
رکھ دے نہ دل وچ کئی امک

“They are themselves modest and oppressed. They are themselves sad and melancholy. They are

perpetually in a state of annihilation. They do not nurture any urge in their hearts.”

They are essentially devoid of being but they are oppressed by the presence of the traces of being in their consciousness. They become sad and melancholy in even having a fleeting consciousness of their being. They are perpetually in a state of annihilation where they experience their self, dying unto the Self. Their hearts have become free of all worldly attachments.

جواکھ ہے ظاہر بر ملا
مرشد تحقق و جوجا
جاناں میں کیوں ماسوا
ہمہ اوست داؤ ترا سبق

“All is obviously manifest. How can I acknowledge anyone except Him? My spiritual master, after full verification, imparted me instructions on Oneness of Being.”

The Inward manifests in the Outward. It is metaphysically impossible for any one to be there to acknowledge anything outside ‘the Metaphysical Whole.’ The spiritual master not only taught him the doctrine of Oneness of Being but made him realise its truth (metaphysical realisation) as well.

جانراں میں کیوں ماسوا
ہمہ اوست داؤ ترا سبق
ایہو وجد ہے ایہو حال ہے
ایہو سچ ہے ایہو سچ ہے نخت

“It is the reflection and it is the discourse. It is an ecstasy and it is the state. It is the taste that is constantly present. It is the Truth and every other thing is untrue.”

All lower and higher levels of knowledge converge on the point that the ever taste of witnessing is the sole truth and any denial of it renders that level untrue. The taste of witnessing is the measure of all truths.

بٹھو ہم خطرے دی ادا
اندرتے باہر ہے سدا
ڈوجھانو ہی ہے ہک خدا
موجود حق موجود حق

“Discard the style of apprehension and risk. There is nothing except One God. The Reality or Truth is everlastingly present in the interior and the exterior.”

Religiosity feels threatened in embracing the metaphysical doctrine of ‘Seeing God Everywhere’ fearing pantheism. It has to envision the Omnipresence of God by transcending to the spiritual plane. The Reality is not partially present but is fully, completely and everlastingly present in the inward and the outward. The attempt to constrict the inward and the outward dimensions of the Reality negate the concept of ‘tawhid’ or the unity of God. The religionist has to understand his own nothingness in the Face of God. He has to realise the doctrine of unity in diversity, otherwise he will be condemned to habitually constrict the dimensions of the Reality.

توں بن فقط بیا کو نہیں	منڈھوں غیر دی اتھ بو نہیں
ہے ہک سد اتے دو نہیں	ہک نال تھی ہک سٹ فرق

“There is no other except you. There is no odour of the profane at its roots. He is the Everlasting One without any duality. Be with the One and discard otherness.”

There is no reality except the Reality. The Essence is the root of everything since the ‘Hidden Treasure’ manifests itself. How could there be anything outside it. He is the One ever present in all forms. A person has to attain identity with the One without leaving any room for otherness.

اپنی حقیقت گول توں	بے کوں نہ اصلوں پھول توں
رکھ یاد اسٹا بول توں	آئیں نہ شک ہے محض پک

“Search your own reality. Do not bother about the other. Do remember my saying without doubting its veracity.”

Religiosity creates the problem of otherness. Spirituality resolves this problem by inviting Man to cast out all doubts

and accept the veracity of gnosis in delving deep within his own being and capturing the universal truth of Oneness. The doctrine of 'tawhid' or unity of God can only be understood by the method of realisation.

تھی رند مست مدام توں
واہ واہ کرے ساری خلق

پی کر فریدی جام توں
ڈینہو ددھار کھ گام توں

“Do attain inebriation and rapture after drinking from the Faridi cup. Keep advancing your steps on the spectrum of time. The entire folk may laud you.”

Drinking from the Faridi cup of gnosis makes one look within, and attains inebriation and rapture without which it is not possible to realise the doctrine of Oneness. Once one takes this drink, different layers of the Reality start unveiling before him. Then, people start lauding his doctrinal awareness.

Kafi-65

آسانوں رہن نہ ڈیندی لگی پنل دی تانگ

“The longing of Punnal does not let me remain in peace.”

How could she be peaceful in longing for her beloved?
Her peace is identical to vision and union with her beloved.

کٹڑیں دل دے روز ازل دے برہوں سنائی بانگ

“The primordial call of love is echoing in my ears.”

The call of ‘alast,’ signifying ‘pre-eternal Covenant’ between the lover and the beloved, echoes in her ears. She is singled out from the whole humanity in listening to this call. It is an ever perpetual call to realise the possibility of union with her beloved.

کٹھڑی مٹھڑی جاو لادی ڈنگڑی نیہہ دے تانگ

“I am butchered by miseries ever since my birth. The snake of love has bitten me.”

Hearkening to the primordial call of the beloved sets the stage of miseries. She has to divest herself from both her being and having in order to attain ‘deliverance and union.’

دلڑی دشمن سخت ستائے سینے چبھڑی سانگ

“My heart is my enemy that highly vexes me. The spear of love has pierced my chest.”

The heart is in Man but is not his. It vexes her because it does not listen to her but only listens to the call of her

beloved. The spear of love pierces her chest. She is victimised by her own embodied self.

یار برو چل کچ سدهایا جالاں کیندے سانگ

“My Baloch friend has moved to Kech. I should stay here for whom?”

The beloved is the measure of all things. The transcendence of her beloved makes the lover at a loss to do anything.

مارو تھل دی پڑی لمبڑی ڈسم فریدنہ ٹانگ

“The range of the deadly desert is so vast. Farid! No clue of destination is in the view.”

The immensity of the deadly transcendence gives no clue of the beloved. It is so mysterious to miss nearness itself. Isn't it more difficult to find nearness than distantness?

Kafi-66

ہوت پنل دے سانگ ماڈی دلڑی آڑی

“My heart is entangled with my beloved Punnal.”

Her heart becomes entangled with her beloved in such a way that it becomes impossible for her to disengage it.

سک سانول دے سانگ سٹ کر خوش قبیلڑے

“I have left my kith and kin and have become desirous of my beloved.”

The desire of the beloved nurturing in her heart makes her oblivious of her kith and kin. Isn't it a positive sign of love?

ناگ اجل دے سانگ رگ رگ زلف دے پیچڑے

“The locks of hair, like the deadly snake, tether my each and every vein.”

The affect of the beloved's beauty quakes her being. The locks of his hair likened to the deadly snake tether her every vein. It is nothing less than the tremendous might of love that transforms an ordinary person into a lover.

حسن ازل دے سانگ و سرے عشق مجازڑے

“The Primordial Beauty has made me transcend love of the ephemeral.”

The primordial beauty becomes instrumental in making him oblivious of ephemeral love. Religiosity miserably fails to do so. It merely sermonises. Love as vanguard pulls the lover and as rearguard pushes him in the lap of the beloved. Mere words cannot affect love. Reason has many arguments to stay

back but love has only one intuition to move forward. It has to effectuate unity of the lover and the beloved. Love never looks back.

مارو تھل دے سانگ

تا نگھ فرید کوں رولدی

“Longing turns Farid into the wretched of the deadly desert.”

The longing of the beloved makes him wretched in encountering the deadly reality of his transcendence. But isn't such wretchedness, in the way of the Real, worthy than the comforts of the ephemeral world?

Kafi-67

ماڈی دلڑی آڑی یار سجن دے سانگ

“My heart is entangled with my beloved friend.”

The entanglement of the heart with the beloved gives a message of an intimate involvement, which cannot be disengaged at any stage.

جیندیں میلارب کرم جوہ جتن دے سانگ

“I pray that my Gracious Sustainer fructifies my effort in my life time and unites me with my friend.”

The unity with the beloved or the stage of ‘the supreme identity’ is only possible by the Grace of God. It is when the Self draws from its polarity of servant-Lord axis.

ناز وڈھول دے نازوے ہر ون ون دے سانگ

“The prides of my tender beloved are manifest in each and every form.”

The prides of the beloved are manifest in every form. The Unmanifest manifests Himself in different styles and modes. There is no form that is bereft of the beloved.

بھلڑے سکڑے سوہڑے من موہن دے سانگ

“I have become oblivious of my blood relationships and in-laws for the sake of my enchanting beloved.”

The enchantment of the beloved is of such a magnitude that he becomes oblivious of his primary and secondary relationships. He has not to make conscious efforts to sever his ties. If it were so, then his efforts could not be fraught

with much positive results. It is the might of love, which carries him on its wings and makes him fly away from the ephemeral to the abode of the Real. Religiosity has to understand that the lover forsakes everything for the sake of his beloved so naturally, easily and spontaneously. He divests himself of his being and having and takes on the onerous burden of love, instead. The fear of hell or the cravings of paradise, the determinants of the religious psyche, do not enter the world of the lover. The enchantment of the beloved is the sole determinant of the lover's behaviour. Does love need sermonising to prosper? Rather, its roar silences all sermonising voices. Didn't the the loving heart of Rabia Basri storm the bastions of religiosity?

لانی پھوگ پھلاری سب پن پن دے سانگ

“The intensity of love has beautifully flowered the desert plants and bushes.”

The intensity of love sustains both the inner and the outer world. The cosmos is born out of love and remains sustained by it.

وقت ضعیف بڑھیں گے سن جو بھن دے سانگ

“The times of frailty and old age too are dynamic forms of life.”

The Spirit within the embodied self is unaffected by times of frailty and old age. The animation of love retains its youthfulness.

تا نگھ فرید کوں آکھدی بیت حزن دے سانگ

“Longing makes Farid listen to the encompassing tunes of angst.”

His state of longing for his beloved is housed in angst. Isn't it instrumental in opening up higher possibilities of his existence?

Kafi-68

میکوں کلہڑا چھوڑتے ویندیں کیندے سانگ

“You are leaving me forlorn. You are going away for
whose sake?”

He thinks that he has been deserted by his beloved for someone more worthy of love. Man's love of God does involve the psychic at the initial stages and thereby it projects the human to the Divine. He feels threatened by the presence of others. He considers them as his rivals in love. However, when the lover's consciousness gets transformed from the psychic level to the spiritual one, he ceases to feel threatened by others. He realises that the beloved's love is indivisible and he absolutely loves him in his own right. The beloved's responsiveness to the one is not at the cost of the other. Symbolically speaking, immanence need not be threatened by transcendence.

قطرہ محض کلکس نہ آئیو لایو ہجر دی سانگ

“You did not have even an iota of pity on me. You
have pierced the spear of disunion.”

The merciless piercing of the spear of disunion makes him suffer. It is so necessary for sprouting love to fruition.

تھل مارو داپنیڈ اسارا ہسیم ہک بلہانگ

“My single step will make me leap across the whole
deadly desert.”

He remains in a state of hope and courage and constantly fights against the psychic states of despair and cowardice. Love deepens knowledge and sharpens the will. It is his single

step that would make him leap across the deadly desert of pains, adversities and sufferings in order to unite with the beloved. It turns serial time into pure duration. It is a moment, which makes time plunge in eternity.

جے تیں ناسیں دے وج ساہم رہم ہڑی تاہم

“I shall keep longing for you till my nostrils breathe.”

It is his total commitment to remain sincere to his beloved.

جاون لادی برہوں سناہم کنیں ڈکھاں دی بانگ

“Love made the call of sufferings in my ears, the day I was born.”

It is ontological love impregnated with sufferings, which is manifest in his medium.

صدقہ کیتے ہیں نینہہ کو لہوں کھاوم کا لڑاناہم

“The biting of the black snake would have been better than these propitiatory offerings of love.”

The propitiatory offerings of love are more terrible than the severe biting of the black snake.

چھوٹے وقت کو ارے ویلھے لگزم ہڑادانگ

“Your love marked me in my tender age and maidenhood.”

A pure heart is hunted in the sanctuary of love.

میں ہاں کیڑھے باغ دی مولی کئی رُل گئے میں وانگ

“Where do I stand? When so many in my style were wretchedly lost in wilderness.”

He feels that he stands no where amongst countless lovers wretchedly roaming in wilderness in search of transcendence. It gives him inner strength to realise that he is not alone but

there is a 'community of selves', which is traversing the arduous path of love.

لکھمر گھیر فرید کیر دے نہ تڑو سمن نہ ٹانگ

“Farid! I am engulfed in the whirlpools of love. I find no possibility of ferrying across the waters.”

He finds himself engulfed in the whirlpools of love finding no way to ferry across the waters. It is a very decisive stage creating absolute dependence on his beloved. He realises the ineffectiveness of his efforts, which helps him in attaining consciousness of his own ontological nothingness. It is only his beloved, who can save him. Love absolutely and totally makes him surrender to the Divine.

Kafi-69

آنون دی کرکئی سانول مفت نہ جانوم جو بھن ڈھل

“My charming beloved! Do come back to me lest my youthfulness fades away for nothing.”

There is an element of uncertainty in love, which remains throughout with her and is expressed in different ways. It is uncertainty that makes her rely absolutely on the beloved. She yearns for meeting with her beloved in the prime of her youth. She fears that the spirit of youthfulness in love may not fade away without union. If the bird (who lives only on rain water) dies thirsting for a rain drop, then what avail is the sea to her, says a friend of God.

سانون وقت سہاگ دے رم جھم برسن بادل

“The days of Savan herald the days of union. It is raining with pattering sounds.”

Rainy season heralds the moments of union with her beloved. The pattering sounds of rain symbolise the footsteps of her beloved becoming audible (transcendence assuming immanence).

بٹھ پئے ہجر دے ڈینہہڑے عمر گزاروں رل رل

“Let’s forget the days of disunion and spend our lives in togetherness.”

She relegates her past to nothingness and desires togetherness with her beloved in the present. It is the present that gives meaning to the past and the future. All possibilities are realised in the present.

آویں رانا جکل

ناہیں پیت لجاونی

“Do not debase the tradition of loving. Do come these days, my beloved Rana (Mandhera).”

She is desirous to unite with her beloved. The non-responsiveness of the beloved is equated with debasing the tradition of love. Her perspectives go on changing with the development of her love. They do seem absolute at different stages of love but are essentially relative to the Absolute. The conflicting perspectives of the lover and the beloved are ultimately resolved when the lover attains union with the beloved.

ول کتھ لبھسیا مومل

پرسوں ترسوں مر سہ تے

“She will be lying asleep in the lap of death within a day or two. Then, where will you find Momal?”

She has a deep faith that her beloved loves her. This faith may get clouded at times but it never ceases to be. It is its light that saves her in ‘the dark night of the soul.’ The allusion to the beloved in seeking his lover speaks of this faith. The sense of time is intensely acute in the consciousness of the lover. What is the use of beloved’s responsiveness when the lover is dead?

بٹھ گھت راجر دا تھل

یار لڈ آویں آوسیں

“Do come here and dwell with me by leaving the desert of Rajar, my friend.”

The beloved has to descend from transcendence to immanence in order to make love possible.

واراں سادھاں سول

گھولاں راج خراج کوں

“I am sacrificing my regal status, tribute, Sadhan and Soma for your sake.”

She sacrifices her regality, royalty, friendship and sisterly ties for the sake of her beloved. She becomes oblivious of everything except her beloved.

جی کوں چاہ ملاپ دی دل کوں تا نگھ اتاول

“My self is yearning for union. My heart is longing for instantaneous identity with you.”

Her inner self yearns for union with her beloved. Her heart longs for this instant union. It wishes time to turn into eternity.

نہیں سکتے درس دے لانونِ سخت اباہل

“My eyes are thirsty of your vision. They are eagerly longing to see you instantly.”

Her eyes are so thirsty of vision that nothing but the sight of her beloved can quench their thirst. She desires love to be so miraculous as to envision her beloved within an instant. The intensity of thirst and its remaining unquenched is the greatest suffering of love.

ماروا کھیاں جادڑو نازو چالیں چنچل

“The ravishing eyes of my beloved are magical. They are prideful, stylish and playful.”

The expressive eye of the beloved creates magic, which ravishes her heart. How could she bear an eye contact with her beloved?

شوخی نگاہ میری ظلمیں زلف ولو ول

“The sprightly vision of my beloved is ravishing. The intricate locks of hair are so captivating.”

The sprightly vision and the captivating locks of hair of her beloved are enough to ravish her heart. The beauty of her beloved saturated with love becomes so irresistible. She becomes entangled in the intricacies of love.

گرک نہ پاپن کو نجرئی ڈال نہ ہاں کوں پل پل

“Heron! Do not sin by crying. Do not pierce my heart every now and then.”

She identifies herself with the heron who is crying for her mate. Her evergreen wounds become greener.

کوئل ساڑ پچا لیا کر کر کوکاں دل دل

“The Cuckoo by making repeated calls burns my heart to ashes.”

She terribly remembers her beloved in the repeated calls of Cuckoo calling her mate. Her suffering in love becomes more intensified.

واہ واہ یار دی یارڑی بھل بھل برہوں دی ال بھل

“I laud the friendship of my friend. I laud the conduct of love.”

She ironically lauds the friendship of her beloved and the conduct of her love, which has given her such magnitude of suffering.

جیرا بے کل اکھڑیاں بل بل دلڑی حرمل

“I am restless with tearful eyes. My self is burning like wild rue (noise produced by the burning of a seed).”

She intensely suffers from within and finds no way out of this impasse.

نینہ نہ بھایا کھوڑا نظریم سو کھا اول

“I remained tied to the counterfeit love. It seemed so simple in the beginning.”

She calls love as counterfeit. It seems so simple in the beginning but it becomes highly intricate beyond her imagination.

آخر اُوڑک تھکڑی محض معمالا حل

“I ultimately became tired. I considered it an intricate problem without any solution.”

She becomes tired and finds no way of finding her beloved. Love is an intricate problem having no solution. It is essentially mystery, which deepens with the passage of time. A problem can be solved from the outside but a mystery can only be resolved from within. She has to live with this mystery in the situation of ‘lived participation.’

مارو تھل دے پینڈڑے پیچ کھلڑے ول چھل

“The unintelligible paths of the deadly desert are replete with entanglements and complexities.”

Love is a highly complex affair and there is no royal road to love, either.

تھک تھک ہٹ ہٹ ہارڑی ہتھڑیں پیرڑیں کڑول

“I have been losing the game of love by utter tiredness and exhaustion. It has led to the disfiguring of my hands and feet.”

Love requires highest ‘patience in adversity’. It cripples the embodied self.

لھتھڑے لھتھڑے پریت دے ساڈے ڈورے ملے

“The worn out garments of love are my threading and muslin.”

The worn out garments of love are the finest apparels for her. They signify belongingness with her beloved.

اونی لوئی لاج دی اطلس مشروع مخمل

“The coarse woollen shawl of honour is my silky and velvet covering.”

The coarse woollen shawl of honour becomes her silky and velvet covering. Her honour solely lies in her beloved. Ordinary things become extra-ordinary on the touchstone of love.

جانى لہسم آكل

توں بن كون فرید دی

“Who will take care of Farid without you, my friend?”

Who will take care of him except his beloved? He communicates his deepest aspirations with his friend.

گال نہ ماہی لاگل

جیجھی نیجھی %یاں

“I am yours in spite of all my shortcomings. My beloved! Do not let me rot but let us embrace each other, instead.”

There is no denying the fact that he is imperfect in comparison with his perfect beloved. But the reality of belongingness overrides all distinctions. He beseeches his beloved not to let him rotten and effectuate union, instead.

Kafi-70

پندرہ رات میں کھیلے ہو ری شام دوارے میر ولال

“My beloved plays Holi in the temple of Krishan in Bindraban.”

His dearly loved Krishan Maharaj, a friend of God, plays ‘Holi’ in Bindraban: to rejoice colourfully the spring of mankind, which is fragrant with the ensuing victory of good over evil.

ادھر مدھر مون بنی باجے چوراسی لکھ ساج آواجے
بھولی کا یہ مایہ موڑی سن کے گیان انوکھے خیال

“The flute is harping on enchanting songs. There are eighty-four lacs musical tunes forming songs. I have absolutely forgotten wealth and myself after listening to the mystical and gnostic thoughts.”

The infinite depths of his inwardness are unfathomable. The flute of his inward being is harping on eighty-four lacs musical tunes. Listening to gnostic wisdom makes him oblivious of his embodied self and possessions.

ترکھٹ جمناتر پھٹ ناؤں دُرمیت دویت پاپ مٹاؤں
پی کے پی سنگ پریم کٹوری ناچت گاوت رنگ رس تال

“I bathe in the river Jamna (of triangular characteristics) to my heart’s fill. I wash myself of the sins of alienation and duality. I drink the cup of love in the company of my beloved, while dancing and singing on the tune of love.”

He bathes in the 'river Jamna' flowing within the 'infinite depths of his consciousness' till his heart attains fulfilment by washing the sins of alienation and duality. He drinks from the cup of love in togetherness with his beloved and become so ecstatic.

انہد گھور گنگن موں گاجے چنگ مردنگ لکھو لکھ باجے
لاگی جوری سبد ٹکورے برست گر پر تیت گلال

"The divine flute is harping clamorous tunes in the heavens. It seems as if thousands of harps and long tom-toms are sounding. The beat of words is striking the pair of drums. The love of the spiritual master is bestowing colourful blessings (likened to 'gulaal' that is red powder thrown on one another during the festival of Holi)."

The divine flute is harping clamorous and boisterous tunes in the higher levels of his being. The love of the spiritual master is conferring on his colourful blessings by making him envision the transcendent and colourless beloved in colourful forms of immanence.

برج موں دھوم پری دھن لاگے ابھماں ٹوٹے کبدھیا بھاگے
بانہہ مروڑے بنگری توڑے کنور کینے چنچل چال

"There is dawn of merriment in the world. Haughtiness, pride and ignorance have fled away. The charming beloved has made a playful move by twisting my arms and breaking my bangles."

Love fulfilment drives away haughtiness, pride and ignorance like light drives away darkness. All negativities are privations. Love ushers in real happiness.

داس فرید آکاس ہمارا دیس ایہو ابناں ہمارا
آتم سوں دل لاگی جوری ہوں میں سنسار ہت پتال

“Farid! Heavens is our original abode. The world (terrestrial) is ephemeral. Do heartedly realise your Spirit. Otherwise, you will be condemned to the infernal world.”

The original abode of Man is the ‘Heart’ and not the self, which is ephemeral. It is the spiritual vocation of Man to realise his ‘Spirit’ (residing in the ‘Heart’) otherwise he will be condemned to remain tied to the psychic as against the spiritual.

Kafi-71

دیس سہاسانول اج کل نہ تاں ویسائیں مر جل گل

“My charming beloved! Do come soon and beautify the city (by your presence), otherwise I will be burnt and reduced to ashes.”

The plight of the lover in the absence of the beloved is so precarious. She longs for the beloved to beautify her life by his presence

وہٹ میں وسدا میندھرا شہر لودروے مول

“Mandhera! You live in the place ‘waht’ and Momal dwells in the city of ‘loderwak’.”

The beloved and the lover are placed at different levels. The beloved has to descend and the lover has to ascend to reach a meeting point. Their ‘universe of discourse’ has also to reach a certain common ground of communication. The dynamics of love is to find a meeting ground between the Divine and the human.

برہوں دتی ست سبڑے عیش کوں سٹری لاگل

“The intensity of love has made her multiply the joys in the nuptial bed. She has been deeply immersed in the reality of love.”

The intensity of love develops her imagination of nuptial joys making her deeply immersed in the reality of love.

کنڑیں کھانوں سینگیاں کر کر کوڑی کل کل

“The meaningless prattle of my friends is deafening to my ears.”

The discourse of friends is so sweet that the ears yearn for it but when she falls in love then conversation of her friends becomes meaningless prattle deafening to her ears. Love essentially changes the perspectives and meanings of things.

تو بن نظر م اوپریاں تو نیں سادھاں سول

“Sadhan and Somal seem strangers to me without you.”

The ties with Sadhan (friend) and Somal (sister) fall in oblivion. She takes precedence over all forms of relationships.

سڑ گئی سیجھ سہاگڑی پھالے ڈوڑیئے مل مل

“My nuptial bed has been burnt to ashes. My threading and muslin have been torn apart.”

What is the significance of the nuptial bed without her beloved? The valuable adornments have been tattered and become valueless.

سرخ لہ گئی وہیہ گئے روروسرے کاجل

“My rouge has faded out. Profuse crying has washed away my antimony and collyrium.”

The disappearance of Reality mars appearance as well.

سک سرمارم ساگراں تانگھاں تانوم ول ول

“The desire of my beloved strikes spears on my head. My longings are perpetually burning me.”

The desire and longing of her beloved ravishes her embodied self.

سول اندوہ اندیشڑے مل مل آون پل پل

“The afflictions, grief and anxieties frequently encompass me in togetherness.”

She experiences sufferings in togetherness. The breadth and depths of sufferings combine in a single whole.

بھینس دایاں ڈرانیاں امڑی ویرن بابل

“I have my sisters, maids, sisters-in-law, mother, brothers and father.”

She has her primary and secondary ties but they are not of any avail to her.

کون ہے درد فریدا توں بن دارودرمل

“Farid! Who are my balm, medication and cure without you?”

It is only the beloved who is the balm, medication and cure for the malady of his sufferings.

Kafi-72

ذاتاً فعلاً کل شے باطل حق ہے فاعل بیو سبھ عاقل

“The things in their essence and existence are devoid of reality (existence). It is the Reality that is the animating force in all things and everything else is powerless.”

The cosmos is the shadow of the Absolute. All things in their essence and existence are devoid of reality. They are not self-existent. The Reality is the sole animating force or ‘active agent’ in things, which are otherwise absolutely powerless. No thing in itself has any power.

ذوق، ورا، ہے طور عقل دے بٹھ گھٹ کوڑے، بحث دلائل

“Tasting transcends the limits of the human reason. Cast aside the false mode of argumentation and proofs.”

Reason cohere the data received from the senses. It has no access to the higher echelons of Reality, which is only possible by virtue of tasting. It directly experiences God. The modes of argumentations and proofs are false when applied to the spiritual realm and hence have to be discarded. They obstruct the vision of God.

اٹھدیں ہندیں ٹردیں پھر دیں نہ ہو ذابل نہ تھی غافل

“Do not be unmindful or forgetful of Him in the postures of standing, sitting, walking or strolling.”

One has not to be unmindful or forgetful of God even for a moment. It is living one’s whole life in Divine presence. The presence of God is the forgetfulness of self. It makes one aware of his ontological nothingness. Light makes darkness vanish.

غیر محالے ویر خیالے ہر یک ڈوس رکھ رافت شامل

“The other is impossible and the adversary is a mere figment of our imagination. Embrace every one in the fold of love.”

The whole cosmos including Man is the manifestation of the Reality. The Reality is manifest in all forms. There is nothing outside ‘the Metaphysical Whole.’ Metaphysically speaking, the question of otherness does not arise. It is mere figment of one’s imagination. The corollary of this metaphysical truth is that the whole creation has to be embraced in the fold of love. It is ontological love, which precedes ordinary love. It transcends the ordinary distinction between love and hate. The ontology of love leaves no room for hatred. Metaphysics talks of ontological love, which in its cyclic process ultimately purifies hatred.

ساڈا ہے محبوب دلیں دا جو کوئی ہے توحید دا قائل

“The one who is committed to the doctrine of (contemplative) tawhid (Unity of God) is our heart’s beloved.”

How lovable that person is who is committed to the doctrine of tawhid without any trace of otherness. His own self even lacks self-existence. The realisation of tawhid gives him full consciousness of his own ontological nothingness. Oneness of God implies oneness of humanity.

علم حقائق دا ہے لائق نفس مڑ کی مادہ قابل

“The pure self is a receptacle to receive knowledge of realities.”

The ordinary self is bound to the subject and object structure of reality. It has no access to the higher realities. The purification of the self turns it into the mirror of the heart to reflect the Reality lying beneath its exterior.

باجھ محبت جان برابر کیا ناطق کیا ناہق صاہل

“A soul devoid of love is likened to the soul of an unruly ass or a wayward camel.”

A person devoid of love is likened to an unruly ass or a wayward camel. Love creates inner and outer equilibrium. Love is the measure of all things. Man attains higher self in proportionate to his capacity and strength of love.

ابن العربی دی رکھ ملت ٹھپ رکھ فقہ اصول مسائل

“Shelve jurisprudence, principles and issues. Remain committed to the tradition of Ibn Arabi.”

The tradition of Ibn Arabi pertains to the doctrine of Oneness of Being and its realisation. It leaves no room of otherness with all that it implies. The mode of jurisprudence and its principles and issues have to be shelved in order to reach a metaphysical understanding of things.

بہہ کر کلہڑیں رمز سجھائی پیر مکمل عارف کامل

“My perfect spiritual master, an adept in esoterism, secretly gave me a clue to the mystery.”

The spiritual master, adept in esoterism, has imparted clues to the mystery of Oneness.

وجہ اللہ فرید ہے باقی باقی ہالک زائغ زائل

“Farid! The Face of Allah is Permanent. All else is annihilating, dying and ephemeral.”

The Face of Allah symbolises Permanence amidst change pointing to the archetypal reality of things in Divine Consciousness, which is lasting and enduring but everything is annihilating and dying each moment and its being existent and non-existent is identical. The universe is ephemeral. The act of re-creation is so swift that the universe seems stable. It is an illusion. Its unreality is grounded in ontology. The theophany of the Absolute makes ontological descent and ontological ascent in simultaneity. The universe does not confront God as the ‘other’. ‘God is, and there is no thing with Him.’

Kafi-73

سب شے وہم خیال

سٹہک غیر خداوی

“Cast aside the desire of all those things that are not divine. All the existence is an illusion and imagination (cosmic illusion and imagination within imagination).”

Man has to purify his heart of things not divine since the existence of everything is an illusion and imagination. Things have no self-subsistent existence. They are not independent of the Reality and thereby they do not enjoy an autonomous status. The phenomenal ‘reality’ is devoid of being (wujud). It is an illusion to perceive ‘materialization’ and solidification’ of the world. ‘The world is an illusion; it has no real existence. And this is what is meant by ‘imagination’ (khayal). For you just imagine that it (i.e., the world) is an autonomous reality quite different from and independent of the absolute Reality, while it is nothing of the sort...Know that you yourself are an imagination. And everything that you perceive and say to yourself, ‘this is not me’, is also an imagination, so that the whole world of existence is imagination within imagination.’ However, ‘reality’ is not a subjective illusion but an objective one. It ‘is an unreality standing on a firm ontological basis.’ ‘The world is an imagination because it is ‘a symbolic reflection of something truly real.’

کھ سوہنی مہینوال

کھ لیلیٰ کھ مجنوں

“Where is Layla and where is Majnun? Where are Sohni and Mahinwal?”

It was the Real, which manifested in the forms of the lovers and the beloveds. Love itself reflected in the mediums of Layla Majnun and Sohni Mahinwal. They were not independent of the absolute Reality otherwise they would

have remained forever. They were bubbles on the sea and with the vanishing of their 'airy duality' they became essentially the same water.

کھ رانجھن کھ کھڑے کھ ہے ہیر سیال

“Where is Ranjhan and where are the Kheras? Where is Heer Sayyal?”

Heer Ranjha and their adversaries are no more on the face of the earth.

کھ سسی کھ پنوں کھ اودرد کشال

“Where is Sassi and where is Punnal? Where have those pains and adversities gone?”

Sassi Punnu are nowhere to be seen. The pains and adversities they experienced in the course of love have become bygone tales.

کھ سیفل کھ پریاں کھ او بھرو صال

“Where is Saifal and where are the fairies? Where are all disunion and union?”

The prince Saifal and fairies figuring prominently in Saif-ul-Muluk have passed away. The phenomenon of disunion and union was ephemeral.

باجھوں احد حقیقی کل شے عین زوال

“All the things are demonstrably perishable excepting the essential One.”

The essential One is Permanent. All things are changing, fleeting and ephemeral. Their relative existence is solely by virtue of the Absolute. How could theophanies claim permanence?

چار ڈھاڑے جیتزدے کڈے بکروال

“These are mere four days of the spring season, which make the shepherd dance with joy.”

The shepherd dances with joy at the advent of spring being oblivious of the fact that the season is so short-lived.

ما خلا اللہ باطل بے شک کوڑ پیال

“Anything beside God is devoid of reality.
Undoubtedly, it is false and illusory.”

‘God is, and there is no thing with Him.’ The perception of any thing with God is false and illusory. The universe does not confront Him as the ‘other.’ The attempt to place anything with Him is tantamount to positioning divinity beside God. If Allah is the light of the heavens and the earth, then how could there be anything beside light?

یار فرید نہ و سرم مشکل محض محال

“Farid! I cannot be oblivious of my friend. It is hard and simply impossible.”

The absolute spell of love makes it impossible for him to be oblivious of his beloved.

Kafi-74

سن یار پرانی پیڑو تھیاں اکھیاں چھل گئی دِلڑی جل

“My friend! Listen to my primordial suffering. My eyes are flooding with tears and my heart has been burnt.”

The primordial love grounded in suffering ravishes her embodied self.

کانھ کمانے اجڑیاں جھوکاں سخت سیالیں کر دیاں ٹوکاں
رہندی دل دِگیرو سرد رداٹل پئے روگ اچھل

“The reeds have dried and the dwellings have become deserted. The crude Sayyal women sneer at me. My heart is in grief. The pain in my head has intensified and the malaise has become unbearable.”

There is deadness and desolation without her beloved. The crude Sayyal women sneer at Heer since they do not understand her choice of bartering everything for the sake of love. Her life is imbued with suffering without her beloved.

لگڑا بندر بھیسے والا وِ سر یا فہم فکر دا چالا
ہیر گئی جھنگ چیرو سٹ سیجھ پنگ تے رنگ محل

“Ranjhan love has become the fabric of my being. The modes of understanding and reflection have fallen in oblivion. Heer has gone across the forests. She has left the nuptial bed and colourful mansions behind.”

Heer contracted sacrificial love in the manner of Ranjha who sacrificed his ordinary mode of reasoning and worldly

comforts for her. She too transcended the habitual mode of reflective understanding and chose the existential one for his sake. She left her abode and worldly enrichments to seek union with Ranjha. Love is not a one sided affair. Both the lover and the beloved have to step out of their levels in order to realise love. The lover has to ascend whereas the beloved has to descend in order to realise the possibility of union.

بھوگے مول نہ دشمن جائی جو جو سختی میں سر آئی
مارم مایو ویرو دل سینگیاں سرتیاں لہم نہ کل

“I have been bearing such hardships, which may not befall even to my enemy’s daughter. My parents and brothers thrash me. And my same age friends have ceased caring for me.”

The hardships of love are so severe that Heer does not wish these even for her enemy’s daughter. One has to undergo bashes at the hands of one’s parents and brothers. One’s fast friends become strangers. The hostility of the social and cultural environment poses a constant challenge for the lover. However, it helps in the long run by being detached from everything except the beloved.

چاک مہیں دا آؤڑ ویڑھے کھیڑے بھیڑے رکھن بکھیڑے
کپڑے لیر کتیرو گیاہار سنگار مساک کجل

“O! Shepherd of the flock! Do visit my courtyard. The despicable ‘Kheras’ are still keeping incongruities. My clothing has been torn to bits. My makeup, twig (of the walnut tree) for tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) and collyrium have faded out.”

Heer beseeches Ranjha, the shepherd of her heart, to be responsive in face of the despicable adversaries who are still incongruous with her. Her embellishments for Ranjha have faded too for they were only meant for him.

نازک نگاہ سجن دے عشوے غمزے من موہن دے
لگڑے کاری تیر وو سے سینے پلپل چبھدے پھل

“There is tendered and prideful gaze of my friend. The amorous glances and bewitching enticements have speared hundreds of piercing arrows in my chest, which are causing a perpetual ache.”

The beloved causes love and sustains it too. Love is not a dead passion but a vibrant sentiment, which storms her heart. Love is constant banging.

اوکھے لاگھے روہ جبل دے چھل چھل چھالے پیر پجھدے
رُلدی راہ ملہیر وو جتھ راخس ڈینیں پون دہل

“The mountainous terrains are hazardous. The oozing boils are burning my feet. I am wretchedly lost in the tracks of Malheer, where giants and witches fear to tread.”

The ‘weight’ of the Infinite becomes so overbearing for the finite that only a sincere heart can put up with the onerous load of love. God has invested Man with the trust of love. The greatest sin consists in betraying one’s beloved.

سسی شودی پیریادی ناں تڑتاڈے جھوک آبادی
مُٹھڑی بے تقصیر وو نہ خرچ پلے نہ گنڈھ سمل

“The poor ‘Sassi’ is wandering bare footed. There is neither any place of shelter nor any dwellings. She has encumbered misery without any wrong doing. She possesses no wealth or travel expenses.”

Sassi has lost her being and having for the sake of Punnal. She is engulfed in misery without any fault. Her misery has nothing to do with wrong doing since her misery is born of rightful conduct. The magnitude of her misery corresponds to the degree of her righteousness. Millions of fortunes can be sacrificed on the altar of misery of love.

ماہی باجھوں سول تہر دے ڈینہاں رات فرید نجر دے
نینائیں نیر و ہیر وو جھر جنگل یلے چھلو چھل

“There are terrible afflictions in the absence of my beloved that are enervating me day and night, Farid. The flows of tears from my eyes are inundating the thick forests and the riparian shrubbery.”

He has to face terrible afflictions, which constantly enervate him. His separation and disunion from the beloved make him tearful. A single tear of his eye absorbs the seven seas. It purifies his heart unto union with his beloved. The beloved resides in his tearful eye. How could he dwell otherwise? Isn't the throne of God still on waters?

Kafi-75

کل نہ لہڑ وسانول ول کچ گوں توں یار برو چل

“My Balochi friend! You have gone to Kech and never thought of me.”

The transcendence of the beloved (Punnal) becomes a source of suffering for the lover (Sassi). The beloved is placed within immanence but the eye cannot see Him since He is hidden in the eye itself. The veil of His nearness is one of His greatest mysteries.

مصری کھنڈ نبتیں ڈس دیاں زہر ہلاہل

“Sugar-candy, sugar and sweets seem deadly bane to me.”

She lives in the world of love. It is a real world as compared to the unreal world of everyday life. The sweetness of sugar of the everyday world turns into a deadly bane in the world of love. All sweetness is symbolised in the witnessing of the beloved. All tastes turn deadly banes in the absence of the beloved. It is only love, which distinguishes the deadness of life from its liveliness.

گھولے زیور بھاگے بٹھ پئے ڈورے کل کل

“I have thrown away my jewellery for your sake. I care a fig for my threading and muslin.”

The inner urge gives meaning to embellishments and adornments, which otherwise have no meaning for her. How could inner dryness exhibit outward greenness?

جو بھن جوش جو انڑی ناز نہورے گئے گل

“My animated youth, pride and coqueties have been rotten.”

How could animated youth, pride and coqueties manifest dynamism without her beloved?

کپڑے لیر کتیرے لنگڑیں جائی ملج

“My apparel has been torn to bits. The coat of mire has settled on my hands and feet.”

She becomes oblivious of her apparel and demeanour. She fully concentrates on her inwardness. Love is instrumental in keeping a respectable distance from things and events.

اکھیاں کجوں کالیاں پیچی زلف ولو ول

“The eyes are darkened with a collyrium. The curly locks of hair are knotted.”

The situation of love being multi-dimensional is knotted with intricacies.

او دل چوٹ چلاندیاں اے تھی پھای پئی گل

“These moves captivate my heart and tighten the noose round my neck.”

The responsiveness of the beloved makes her immerse more deeply in love. She gets deeply intoxicated with every cup of wine.

ڈٹھم ملک ملہیر ڈوں کالے کالے بادل

“I have seen darkening clouds move towards the city of Malheer.”

Love is inwardness. She has an insatiable desire to turn inward and find her beloved in the inmost chambers of her heart. She finds the signs of unveiling within her being.

سندھڑے رہن نہ ڈیندیاں لگڑیاں تا نگھاں پل پل

“The perpetual longings of the desert do not let me remain in Sindh.”

The perpetual longings to turn inward do not let her remain attached to the outward.

روہی مینگھ ملہارڑاں
کھمدیاں لکھنیاں اج کل

“These days the desert (rohi) is overcast with thick clouds and flashes of lightning.”

There are very affirmative indications of the unveiling of her beloved within her own being.

دلڑی سکدی ڈیس ڈوں
اکھڑیں ہنجنوں بل بل

“My heart is desirous of my native abode and tears are flowing from my eyes.”

Her heart becomes desirous of meeting the beloved within its infinite depths. She has to ferry across her tearful eyes.

ڈیکھاں باغ بغوچڑے
چیرا جانوم جل جل

“My heart burns in reminiscence (of my original abode) by seeing gardens and orchards.”

Her heart burns in reminiscence of the primordial unity with her lovely beloved

لانے پھوگ فرید دے
دردِ دل دے درمل

“Farid! The desert plants and bushes are balm for the pains of my heart.”

The sentiment of love growing inwardly acts as a balm to all his inward sufferings.

Kafi-76

کیوں توں فردتے جز سداویں توں کلی توں کل

“Why you consider yourself as an individual and a part? You are the unified and the whole.”

Does the consciousness of Man's ontological nothingness have negative consequences for the development of his personality? From the metaphysical point of view, the realisation of ontological nothingness in Face of the Absolute does not have any negative bearings but, instead leads to the fullest realisation of possibilities inhering in Man. The metaphysical concept of Man is there in the great traditions of the world including the Islamic tradition, which spells out the characteristics of 'the Universal Man' (Insan-i-Kamil). However, Man is not 'ilah' (self-subsistent reality or autonomous reality) as considered by 'humanism' in the modern West. But, he is theophany of the Absolute. He is manifestation of the Reality. The Reality sees itself through his eye as if, in 'a polished mirror'. The Reality contemplates itself through his medium. He is not individual or part since 'those discrete things and properties that have been diffused and scattered all over the immense universe become united and unified into a sharp focus in Man. The structure of the whole universe with all its complicated details is reflected in him in a clear and distinctly articulated miniature. This is the meaning of his being a Microcosm'. Man is the best formation for he is universal, embracing all the realities. Man synthesizes the forms of the Divine self-manifestation and has consciousness of this whole. He integrates in himself all cosmic realities and their individual manifestations. Man's 'humanity' lies in his 'comprehensiveness'. How could a

person cognizant of his metaphysical and cosmic purpose of existence fall victim to pseudo-mysticism by adopting a life-denying attitude? Rather, it is in following his inherent purpose that he transforms his inflated ego into real personality. The doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud) affirms life and restores hope in the despairing humanity.

باغ بہشت داتوں ہیں مالک خود بلبل خود گل

“You are the sovereign of the paradisaal garden. You are the nightingale and the rose.”

The higher possibilities of existence flower within his being and thereby turn it into the paradisaal garden. He loves and is loved.

عرش وی تیڈا فرش وی تیڈا توں عالی ان مل

“The empyrean and the earth belong to you. Your majesty is priceless.”

The cosmos has been created for the sake of Man. He is ‘the bridge between the heavens and the earth’. It gives him superiority over other beings.

چڑھ داریں منصور دے بھائی کرن عجب غل غل

“The Mansurians make strange ecstatic utterances on the scaffold.”

The followers of Mansur Hallaj, in the tradition of their master, who said ‘I am the Truth’, go to the scaffold with strange ecstatic utterances. It is the Reality, which speaks through ‘their’ tongues but the ordinary people understand them not.

روح مثال شہادت توں ہیں سمجھ سنجان نہ بھل

“You are the Spirit, Image and Witnessing. Never become oblivious of this experiential understanding.”

The Reality is identical with its Spirit. The Reality in the form of the Sustainer breathes His Spirit in Man. The Intellect or Spirit is in Man, containing all knowledge, but is not 'his'. The Spirit is universal but is 'individualised' in Man. The immanence of the Spirit in Man does not compromise its transcendence. It is universal and 'individual' in simultaneity. The blowing of the Spirit in Man accords him a higher status than other beings in the cosmos. The dimensions of Imagination are both 'cosmic and metacosmic'. The whole cosmos including Man 'are related to God as dream- images are related to a dreamer'. The world of imagination is constitutive of man's being and the cosmos. It is an intermediate world between spirit and body. It embodies the supra-sensory realities. The cosmos is the manifestation of the Reality. Man witnesses the terrestrial world as an opportunity to realise his macrocosmic and microcosmic realities in the given span of time.

دنیا عقیقی برزخ اندر نہیں تیڈا اتل

"No one equals you in the terrestrial world, in the isthmus or in the next world."

The metaphysical significance of Man confers him a unique status in the hierarchy of beings. The possibility of freedom inhering in him to attain deliverance and union makes him matchless in the world. He is unparallel in continuing his forward march in the next world making it possible for the Reality to contemplate its Infinite Attributes in the mirror of his heart. He is without equal in contemplating the perpetual images of his actions leading to fruition in the state of 'barzakh' or isthmus (an imaginal world of existence lying between this world and the Hereafter in which 'all human beings are pawns to what they have earned and imprisoned in the forms of their works until the day of resurrection. Then they are raised up from those forms and given over to the configuration of the next world')

یار فرید اسے کو لہڑے تیڈے نہ بے ہودہ رُل

“Farid! Your friend is with you (even nearer to you than you are to your own self). There is no point in your being wretched in the unwieldy search.”

Why to be wretched in search of God when God is within Man. He is more near to him than the oceanic sweet water is from its salty one with ‘barzakh’ or isthmus between them. He is nearer to Man than the reflected image is to the mirror. The proximity of God with Man can be understood by understanding the proximity of the Divine Essence with His Names or Attributes (Asma al Husna). He is closer to Man than Man is to himself. He is clothed in the attire of Man. God is veiled in Man. Man is His Image. Human consciousness is a manifestation of the Divine Consciousness. The provisional man-God polarity withers away in the transcendent consciousness of nonduality.

Kafi-77

ہر دل میں ہے %ڑی بھال مل مہینوالا مل مہینوال

“My beloved Mahinwal! Meet me. My beloved Mahinwal! Unite with me. All hearts beat for you.”

Mahiwal symbolising the beloved is the heartbeat of everyone yearning for union. Sohni Mahiwal is a tale of love impregnated with courage, steadfastness and fortitude. Sohni was born of a potter's family in a village on the banks of River Chenab, Gujarat. She was beauty personified. She helped her father, Tulla in designing the earthenware, which were sold like hot cakes. One of the traders, Izzat Beg of Bokhara, happened to stop at their workshop and was enchanted to see Sohni, busy helping her father. It was love at first sight. He frequently started visiting the workshop on pretext of buying pieces of pottery and deeply fell in love with her. His heart always yearned for her eye contact. He succeeded in stirring love in her heart and she went ahead in reciprocating his love with great sincerity. He was equally enamoured by her inward beauty. He did not return to his native place with the traders' caravan but instead chose an odd job of grazing cattle- buffaloes with Sohni's father. Her father came to know about their love affair, which like day light can never be hidden, and he hastened to forcibly marry her to one of the potters living across the river. Mahiwal was grief-stricken to know of Sohni's marriage and he became a wanderer and in the guise of a 'faqir' managed to meet her and tell her about his whereabouts. Sohni used to swim at night to the other side of the river with the help of a water pitcher to meet him and returned before the break of dawn and hid her pitcher. She met him daily but her quest of love

was insatiable. He was each day in a new glory. The secret of love like the fragrance of rose garden cannot be contained and it spreads with its own dynamism. Her sister-in-law came to know about it and she confiding in her mother changed the baked pitcher with a sun-dried one. Sohni realised the trick when she was already in the midst of the stormy waves of the flooded river. Sohni never looked back. She knew that love had no point of return. The passion of love within her was more mighty and tempestuous than the river Chenab. She could die but never be defeated. She chose love in the face of death. The pitcher started giving in to the tumultuous waves, and she drowned defending her love with inward light, in the pitch darkness of night. Sohni was not drowned in the river but the river was drowned in her, says the wisdom of love.

روز ازل دی سختی ماری ڈٹڑی مول نہ قسمت واری
ماپیو ویر نہ لہم سنجال

“I am in hardships ever since the primordial day. The destiny did not absolutely give me a fair chance. My parents and brothers do not take care of me.”

Primordial love ushers in sufferings to her hard luck. Her parents and brothers leave her forlorn. They do not understand the sincerity and depths of her love. They adjudge her on relative standards, which fail to measure the absoluteness of love. They do have a certain claim over her but she is not a pawn in their hands. Her whole being and having rightfully belong to her beloved.

فکر فراق تے مونجھ مونجھاری یاری لا کر مُٹھڑی ہاری
ڈسدم وصل وصال محال

“I am bearing pangs of separation and anguishes. My miserableness has made me lose the game of love. My togetherness and union with my beloved seem, impossible.”

How can she win the game of love when it is not possible to achieve togetherness and union with her beloved? Is there any suffering greater than that?

روندیں رڑدیں کوکاں کردی
آہیں بھری جگھ جگھ مردی
عشق اولڑاجی جنجال

“I am weeping, crying and shrieking. I heave cold sighs of distress and remain dying by rotting in suffering. The intricate love has encumbered my self.”

The intricacies of love are so cumbersome. She dies by inches and bears terrible sufferings in the path of love.

زورے تورے حسن دے مانے
سارے ہار سنگار وہانے
آئی اوڑک سولاں جال

“My radiant might, pride in beauty and my entire make up has gone away. Ultimately, I have been netted in afflictions.”

The colours of life fade away. She is caught in the whirlpool of sufferings.

ناز نزاکت نوکاں نخرے
سبجوں سکھ سہاگ دے بخرے
ساڈے پکھڑے کو جھڑا حال

“My pride, tenderness, a collyrium line and blandishments that are the elements of my inward peace and nuptial happiness have fallen to my lot and worsening my state.”

The very things, which gave meaning to her life, start worsening her condition in separation from her beloved. The tide of time drowns her happiness.

خویش قبیلہ دشمن سارا
ہر کوئی مارِ جان و چارا
برہوں اوڑا لٹی چال

“All my kith and kin is my enemy. I am considered as pathetic and smitten by everyone. Love is peculiar that makes overturned moves.”

The mystery of love cannot be resolved by rational modes. The peculiarity of love consists in mysterious moves. She faces hostility of her near and dear ones. The world considers her lowly and smites her.

ویڑھے یار فرید نہ آیا گل گیا جو بھن مفت اجایا
ڈھٹڑے ڈندے تے چٹڑے وال

“Farid! My friend did not visit me. My radiant youth has faded in vain. My teeth have fallen and my hair has whitened.”

His animated embodied self shows signs of rapid aging due to the vicissitudes of time. How can he sustain the radiance of his youth without his beloved?

Kafi-78

میں تان تیکوں منتاں کر دی سانول اساں ول بھال

“My charming beloved! I beseech you to take care of me.”

She beseeches her charming beloved to take care of her.
Who can nurture and tender her without her beloved?

واہ غمزے واہ ناز چبولے واہ نخرے واہ تلک تلولے

واہ زلفاں واہ خال

“I laud your enticements and I laud your prideful sweet discourse. I laud your blandishments and I laud your brow colour -mark and moles. I laud your locks of hair and I laud the coloured small spot on your face.”

The loveliness of the beautiful beloved, manifest in different expressions ignites love in her heart. There is nothing higher than the communication of love.

تھی کر دام دلیں نوں ونگن تھی کر نانگ جگر نوں ڈنگن

عطروں بھڑے وال

“The locks of hair of my beloved soaked in perfume, net my heart and give me a snake-like bite.”

The descending of the Reality from its abysmal darkness opens the possibility of love relationship. The intricate openness of her beloved spreads fragrance all around. But it becomes so overbearing for her.

جیں ڈینہہ یار اساں تور ٹھڑے بٹھ ڈورے بٹھ ملل پٹھڑے

جر جر بگھ آل

“I stopped wearing my traditional and ceremonial dresses ever since my friend turned his face from me.”

The attachment with the beloved determines the value of things. All beautiful attires lose their meaning in detachment from her beloved.

بھاؤن مول نہ باجھ سجن دے کپڑے نازک ونوون دے
زیور آلو آل

“All my fine dresses and the most precious jewellery have no meaning for me in the absence of my beloved.”

How could fine dresses and the most precious jewellery have any meaning for her when her beloved is not there? There is no meaning in outwardness bereft of inwardness.

درد فراق دی چال اساڈی سنجڑیں & یں جال اساڈی
بے واہی داحال

“Our way is to bear the pain of separation. Our abode is in desolate sandy dunes. The one without shelter is in such a (pitiable) condition.”

The pain of separation is the pang of rebirth. It gives birth to mutual selfhood. She is dependent on her beloved for everything.

اتنا ظلم مناسب نابیں رو رو پیٹ پیٹ کر کر دھائیں
گزر گئے سئے سال

“It is not fair to be so cruel to me. I have passed countless years in weeping, whining and crying.”

She at times reacts to the cruelty of the beloved and measures years of separation from her beloved. ‘And that each day is like a year: A year whose days are long’.

یار فرید نہ رولا ڈیسم اُوڑک سڈ کر کول ہیمسم

ہے سوہنا لچ پال

“Farid! My friend will not create difficulties for me.
At last, he will call me and make me sit beside him.
My beloved is the custodian of my honour.”

A streak of hope does remain lit in his heart even in times of darkest despair. And it is hope, which ferries him across the troubled waters. Love is not possible without hope. Hope gives birth to love and also sustains it. Despair makes it die. He hopes for union with his beloved. He has absolute faith in responsiveness of his beloved; although at times he calls him names. The modern man has lost hope for he has lost his beloved; nay, he never had one. He is imprisoned in the psychic world and experiences hope and despair on the psychological spectrum. He has no way to transcend to the spiritual realm, in order to experience the spiritual dimensions of hope, needed so much by the humanity in despair. How could humanity hope without love?

Kafi-79

یار سپاہیڑا! آؤس ماڈڑے کول

“My combative friend! Do come and be with me.”

The game of love is not all tenderness. The combative nature of love is exhibited in calling the beloved as combative and inviting him to dwell with her.

ہک لکھ ڈینڈیں ڈو لکھ ڈیساں ہک واری چا بول

“I will give you a hundred thousand nay two hundred thousands but do converse with me once.”

Is she ‘bribing’ the beloved for making him communicating with her at least once? It is one of the finest verses in the whole literature of love. Her desperation is evident in offering her beloved even money to make him responsive. The offer of doubling the money adds beauty to her desire of union. The offer symbolises the willingness of the lover to win her beloved at all cost.

پہلوں ڈے کر بانہہ سر اندی سانول یار نہ رول

“You folded your arm beneath my head. My charming beloved! Now, do not put me in a wretched state.”

The initial warmth of the beloved and then his becoming indifferent makes her fall in a state of wretchedness.

نیں سانون دی میں من تاری سئے چھولیاں لکھ جھول

“The rainy season has made the stream full and I do not know swimming. There are hundreds of stormy waves and countless whirlpools.”

She finds it impossible to ferry across the high tides in the ocean of love. All help comes from the beloved.

یار چہیندا مان مہیندا زل مل ساڈڑے ٹول

“My beloved friend! You are my pride. Do come and dwell in closeness with me.”

She beseeches her beloved to unveil himself within her being.

سانولیاں دے نین سلونے کجلے دے نک ٹول

“The eyes of the charming maidens are increasingly enchanted by the beauty of the collyrium.”

The seductiveness of beauty is enhanced by embellishments.

پاپن چکوی کر کر چیکاں آلہڑے زخم نہ چول

“O’ sinful partridge! Do not touch my fresh wounds by crying aloud.”

She identifies her sufferings with the partridge who cries aloud for her mate.

مرمر جاندی ریشک نہ سہندی دلڑی سخت مڑول

“My heart is burning severely. It is in a dire state but it refuses to bear envy.”

Her suffering heart wants to embrace her beloved in fullness and that creates envy. She, at times, becomes envious by the universality of her beloved. However, these psychic traces in the consciousness wither away with the ripening of love.

بینے بولے سینسر و سرے گئے نورے ر مجھول

“I have become oblivious of my forehead and nose ornaments and my anklets, too.”

How could ornaments have any meaning without her beloved?

نخرے ناز نہورے ہر دم بیایا کرن الہ

“The blandishments, pride and coquetries of my beloved increasingly tickle me anew.”

The responsiveness of the beloved makes her dance to the tune of love.

او گن ہاری ناکس کم دی سو ہنا عیب نہ پھول

“I am sinful devoid of any virtue. My beloved friend! Do not resort to fault-findings.”

She acknowledges her own imperfections in the face of the perfect beloved and wants him not to point them out. It is the dawning realisation of her ontological nothingness in relationship with the Divine Being.

سمجھ فرید نہ تھی غم واسو اللہ ملیسم ڈھول

“Farid! Understand and do not plunge in sorrows. Allah will cause you to meet your beloved (the transcendence from the servant-Lord axis is by the Grace of God).”

He understands that in order to ward of his sorrows, God will cause him to meet his beloved. The transcendence from the servant-Lord axis will be only possible by the Grace of God. It is by virtue of transcendence that he will realise union with his beloved.

Kafi-80

دستوں پیر مغاں دے پیتم عشق واجام

“I took the cup of love from the hands of the cup bearer.”

The cup of love works spiritual wonders when taken at the hands of the spiritual master.

وحدت کیتا غلبہ بھل گیا کفر اسلام

“The unity became so overpowering that I transcended infidelity and Islam.”

The wine of love makes the sense of unity so overpowering that the lover transcends the distinction between Islam and infidelity. He goes beyond the distinction of truth and falsehood. The distinction between truth and falsehood is relevant at a certain level of the self-determination of the Absolute. It remains so and is not obliterated at that stage. But it is relatively absolute and not absolute in absoluteness. Metaphysically speaking, the undifferentiated Reality manifests itself in differentiated forms of Names and Attributes. It is at the descending stages of manifestation that the Truth itself appears in the form of a given truth implying the possibility of a given falsehood. The wine of love takes him to the heights of gnosis, where he identifies himself with the Truth itself in obliviousness to a truth and a falsehood. Individual religiosity gets absolutely transformed in universal spirituality.

گزرے فرض فریضے سُنّت کو بھی سلام

“I went beyond the call of duties and imperatives. I took the leave from the Sunnah, too.”

He ascends to such gnostic heights that the religious imperatives or the imperatives of a truth remain far behind.

Religiosity gives way to 'the kernel of the kernel'. The formalities are no more required when a person finally presents himself before the King and remains in his continuous presence.

کشف حقیقی آئے گئے اضغاث احلام

“There has been true unveiling. My doubts and apprehensions have disappeared.”

Doubts and apprehensions are the bye-products of veiled knowledge tied to the subject and object structure of reality. All certainties at the veiled levels are relative characterised by probabilities and negativities. Many a time's even ignorance is considered as knowledge. Religiosity, for example, gives proofs of God's existence, which are hardly tenable at the rational level. There are different epistemological and logical fallacies contained in these religious arguments. It is only metaphysical realisation or unveiling, which grants absolute certainty. It provides absolute certitude leaving no room for any doubt or apprehension.

وحدت ذاتی سبھ دا ہے آغاز انجام

“Oneness is the alpha and omega of every thing.”

Oneness of Being not only demonstrates the Reality as the Inward and the Outward but also as the First and the Last. These four basic dimensions of the Reality are in their fullness. Any attempt to consider any one of these wholesome dimensions as partial tantamount to placing divinity beside Allah. The Reality is in its wholesomeness and it has no parts. Religiosity errs in delimiting God by making the universe confront Him. The universe does not confront God as the other. It is simply the manifestation of His Reality. He is the Origin of everything (The First) and everything returns to Him (the Last).

تکھڑی تیغ نفی دی غیر کینا قلام

“The sharpened sword of negation has obliterated otherness.”

The negation of everything except the One obliterates otherness. Metaphysically speaking, both negation and obliteration essentially do nothing. There is nothing to be negated and no otherness to be obliterated. There is no thing to be denoted and negated and there is no otherness to be acknowledged and obliterated. The act of negation and obliteration is only at the connotative level (conveying a certain meaning). The Reality is ‘the Metaphysical Whole’ with no thing outside it. The Absolute Reality is essentially or inherently ‘the Most Real’ and the cosmos including Man have no inherent reality or reality in itself. It is simply manifestation of the Reality. And no manifestation has any reality in itself. How could borrowed existence claim to have inherent reality? Anything not having inherent reality is considered as unreal in reference to the Absolutely Real or God. There is no reality except the Reality and Muhammad is the manifestation (Rasul) of the Reality--has been demonstrated so beautifully in the metaphysical truth enshrined in the ‘Shahadah’ of the Islamic tradition. The servant or ‘abd’ points to ontological unreality or ontological nothingness of the servant in face of the ontological Reality of God.

یو کل کوڑ تمام

باجھوں شغل حقیقی

“All things are absolutely meaningless without the realisation of the Oneness.”

Human activity has no meaning except engaging realisation of Oneness. Man’s Ultimate Concern is the Real or God. It is the measure of all his concerns. Any concern bereft of it is false and rubbish.

پٹھڑے برہوں پیام

کر توبہ اغیاروں

“Love has sent a message of absolute repentance of otherness.”

The spiritual vocation of Man is to absolutely concentrate on the Real or God. He has to repent of the time lost in illusory engagements with otherness. Love ultimately succeeds in uniting the lover with the beloved. Light does not see any darkness or otherness but the light; likewise the lover does not see any shadow or otherness but the beloved.

تھی آزاد تمام

ثرت فرید فریدوں

“Farid! Now, transcend your individuality (transcend delimitation). Have an Identity with Freedom itself (Nondelimitation).”

The Absolute has the aspect of the Infinite, by virtue of which, it manifests itself forming different planes of existence. He is the Origin of all manifestation till its last form. Man is theophany of the Absolute. The Reality, in the process of manifestation, clothes itself in the form of Man. Man has no self-subsistent reality. He comes to assume a relative reality, which is illusory in reference to the Absolute Reality. A person has a sense of individuality or individual consciousness but his sense is relative and not absolute and, in a certain sense, illusory since absolute consciousness only belongs to God. It is a delimited consciousness tied to relative freedom. He has been endowed with the possibility of freedom, to get rid of his delimited, relative or illusory consciousness, which gives him the idea of ego, self or individuality. It is his identity with Freedom itself or Absolute Freedom that his inner and outer perception is transformed and assumes a form of nondelimitation. It is at this level that one can speak of metaphysical realisation; attaining full consciousness of one's ontological nothingness; extinction (fana); self-effacement; to die before dying; being in contact with the roots of one's being; transcending man-God polarity; the Self withdrawing from the servant-Lord axis; Self-Realisation; realising union with the beloved; deliverance; living in the realm of nonduality; Oneness of Being or 'contemplative tawhid.'

Kafi-81

ڈکھڑیں کارن جائی ہم سولیں سانگ سمانی ہم

“I was born for the sake of bearing sufferings. I got absorbed with afflictions in this world.”

She feels that she was destined for sufferings and thereby got absorbed with afflictions in the world.

درد اندیشے سکڑے سوڑے بیانہ بھین نہ بھائی ہم

“Pains and anxieties are my close relatives. Besides, I have no brothers or sisters.”

She lives in the intimate company of pains and anxieties.

گہلی کملی سنجوی دُھردی پک غم دی سدھرائی ہم

“I was imprudent, simple and damned ever since the primordial day. I was only receptive to sorrows.”

She experiences the tragic aspects of love at the very outset.

جاون لادی پند بلا دی چم سراکھیاں چائی ہم

“I enthusiastically lifted the bundle of calamities on my head ever since my birth.”

The commitment of love was made with full animation since day one.

راحت و بندیں وداع نہ کیتم مئی ہم پر مَترائی ہم

“Comfort was my mother, nay stepmother for she did not bid me a goodbye, while going away.”

The days of comforts passed away leaving her in distress.

پیڑ پرانی امڑی سکڑی مونجھ منجھاری دائی ہم

“The primordial pain is my real mother. Anguish is my mid wife.”

It was cosmic design that she was born in pain and anguish.

سختی تے بد بختی تترئی حال وانڈاؤ ہمسائی ہم

“I am the inept one with hardships and misfortunes that are taking care of me like my neighbours.”

Hardships and misfortunes are always present with her who is so inept.

بے ٹھائی دی چولی پتھری پائی ہم پاٹھمکائی ہم

“I adorned and exhibited myself with garments of divergence.”

The garments of love worn by her are at variance with her.

سرتے جھترے چوٹیاں متھڑے تیں سنگ دلڑی لائی ہم

“I had small hair on my head and locks of hair moving on my forehead (a state of girlhood symbolising primordial covenant), when my heart contracted love with you.”

It was the primordial stage of the pre-eternal covenant when she contracted love with her beloved.

ہو ہو پھلڑی شہر خواری جاتی فخر وڈائی ہم

“I have accepted infamy, ill-repute and notoriety as my pride and elevation.”

Her world overturns. She is condemned by the force of love to consider infamy, ill-repute and notoriety as her pride and elevation. The retina of her eye completely overturns her social perception.

کینویں یار فرید و ساراں جیں کیتے اتھ آئی ہم

“Farid! How could I be oblivious of my friend for whom I came here?”

He is fully aware that in spite of all sufferings, he cannot be oblivious of his friend. The cosmic purpose of his existence can only be realised by dint of union with his beloved.

Kafi-82

ڈکھڑا نہیڑا لایم سے، سے، سول سڑاپے

“I have cultivated anguished love with countless afflictions and tribulations.”

She does not romanticise love. Her anguished love is full of afflictions and tribulations at the spiritual level.

ہاں داساڑاوے توں بن گھر وروے
ویڑھا کھانوں آیم سینے لکھ لکھ کاپے

“My household gives me heart-burning without you.
There are hundred thousands wounds in my chest.
My courtyard haunts me.”

The things closest to her that gave her peace and comfort, become a source of distress and discomfort without her beloved.

پور پنل دے دے پل پل دل نوں وے
دردیں مار منجھایم دل آوے تاں جاپے

“I am perpetually undergoing fits in the state of missing Punnaal. I will only believe once he comes.
Pains have crushed me with anguish.”

Her hope starts waning while facing the hardships of love. She wants her beloved to visit her so that she could revitalise her faith in him. It is a deepening crisis of hope and a very exacting time of love.

پیت نہ پالی وے یار دیس دے وے

کیونیس ڈیواں ڈوڑاپے یاری تروڑسدھایم

“My closest friend! You did not cultivate love with me. Whom should I complain about it? You went away by snapping friendly ties with me.”

She suffers the fact that her bosom friend has not been responsive and has snapped friendly ties with her without any rhyme or reason. She cannot communicate with any one about her beloved since everyone is an outsider. These facts shine forth so much in the existentiality of love.

کیونیس دل داوے لوک سبھے ڈوچاپے
حال سناواں وے سختی سخت ستایم

“How should I narrate the story of my heart? People resort to double-talk. My severities highly vex me.”

She desires to share her story of love with people but their insincerity makes her keep things to herself. The severity of not being able to communicate with people about her deepest aspirations is highly vexing.

یار اوڑے وے جی جگھ جگھ پرتاپے
توڑنہ نیتی وے مفتی جان گنوایم

“My peculiar friend! You did not take me to the end. My self is rotting in suffering. Life has been wasted just for nothing.”

She feels left out in the game of love. She suffers in thinking that her life has just been wasted.

رہن نہ ڈیندی وے جیندے ناز مسایم
رک ساجن دی وے جیں سنگ دلری اڑاپے

“The desire of my beloved does not let me live in peace. My heart is entangled with him and his pride has captivated me.”

The prideful beloved entangles her heart in such a way that the desire of union with him destroys her peace.

انگن فرید دے دے سانول او سی دے
کرم کر لیم آپے تا نکھیں آس ودھایم

“Farid! My beloved will visit my courtyard. He will himself shower his blessings on me. Longings have increased my hope.”

He is hopeful that one day his beloved will visit him and shower his blessings on him. Longing increases his hope. Longing is the secret of hope. Hope is not an empty posture of mind. It is filled with content. Longing is the content of hope. A person who has no longing has no hope. The ‘dialects’ of longing and hope teach that longing increases hope and hope increases longing.

Kafi-83

نہینہ او لڑا او کھالائیم سک پل پل دی مار منجھایم

“I have cultivated intricate and difficult love. My perpetual desire is putting me in crushing anguish.”

His perpetual desire of the beloved is filled with great anguish. It makes love so intricate and difficult for him.

پچھدی ملابا نہجن جو سی کیڑھا وقت ملن داہوسی
ڈھول آساڈے ویڑھے اوسی رنج ہجر دے سخت ستایم

“I am asking a cleric, Brahman and astrologer to divulge on the moment of union, when my beloved will visit my courtyard? The grief of disunion is highly vexing.”

He being dejected and highly vexed by the grief of disunion, resorts to non-rational modes when his rational endeavours become fruitless in realising the moment of union. His desperation is evident in the modes of his behaviour. It has been aptly said that if a person does not have an illusion of a pool of water in the scorching heat of the desert then it is not perfection of his sight but the imperfection of his thirst. Likewise, it is the intensity of love, which makes him recourse to hidden knowledge, which he thinks, could be instrumental in divulging the destined moment of union with his beloved.

روہی وٹھڑی مینگھ ملہاراں بوٹے بوٹے تھیاں گلزاراں
شالا موڑم دوست ملہاراں بھاگ سہاگ دی موسم آیم

“The desert (rohi) has become green and the rain-laden clouds are hovering on the sky. All plants are flowering. I pray that my friend turns the reins

towards me. The season of good fortunes and nuptial happiness has ushered in.”

The Reality manifests in the inward and the outward. The outward changes affect the inward and the inward changes transform the perception of the outward. It is the intensity of love, which makes him behave in different ways. There is a close relationship between the inner and the outer dimensions of the cosmos. The moment of unveiling can only be realised by the Grace of God. He prays for this nuptial union. The portents of spiritual union demonstrate the path of love. The tracks of love are true, absolute and universal making him realise union.

اکھیاں روون دل گرلاوے دلڑی جکھدی تن تڑپھاوے
رات ڈینہاں آرام نہ آوے دکھ ڈوہاگ دے بار اٹھایم

“My eyes are weeping and my heart is groaning. My heart is bearing tribulations and making my body restless. I have no peace, day and night. I am bearing the burden of sufferings and misfortunes.”

The ordinary sufferings of love at the plane of psyche do not match the higher sufferings at the plane of spirituality. The psychic love with all its infatuations, obsessions and symbiotic attachments does not engage human consciousness in fullness. It remains stranded on a certain level and keeps on flattening it out. But the spiritual love broadens, heightens and deepens consciousness and ushers in qualitatively different sufferings, which ultimately lead to the identity of knowledge and being. The sufferings of psychic love, in spite of all the hues and cries, do not touch the inmost chambers of one's being. The sufferings of the spiritual love, on the other hand, engage the person wholeheartedly and in a wholesome way. The alchemy of suffering transforms the base metal into gold and displaces misfortunes with good fortune.

عشق اویر اپیش پیو سے درد کشالے سیجھ ڈھیو سے
مونجھ منجھاری ہار پتو سے سہجوں دکھ ڈوہاگ سہایم

“Peculiar love has fallen to my lot. I got the nuptial bed of pain and adversities. I am wearing the necklace of anguishes. I have readily accepted sufferings and misfortunes.”

He readily accepts sufferings and misfortunes in the way of love because he has freely chosen to love his beloved. Love cannot be imposed by might. Love is born of freedom and lives in freedom. He understands the dynamics of love and acts accordingly.

حسن پرستی گھات اساڈی راز حقائق بات اساڈی
رمز حقیقی جھات اساڈی فخر جہاں ایہاریت سکھایم

“Our vocation is to be fully absorbed in beauty. Our activity is to delve on the secrets of Reality. Our looking within ourselves is clueing to the Reality. Fakhr Jehan has taught me this tradition.”

His spiritual master, Fakhr-i-Jehan makes him realise the metaphysics of Beauty. He reveals the secrets of the Reality to him by making him appreciate that the Reality is Beauty itself. He has to delve deep within his own being in order to encounter the Beauty and become its adorer in all inward and outward forms.

ملسم یار فرید کڈا ہیں دود دکھاواں کڈھ کڈھ آہیں
جان جگر تن بھڑکن بھاہیں سوز پنل دے صاف جلا ایم

“Farid! My friend will meet me one day. I am emitting smoke by continuously heaving sighs. My embodied self is flaming, fire. I have been completely burnt by the passion of Punnal.”

He hopes for union with his beloved. It is not a false hope but a true one arising from the ashes of his embodied self. He has knowledge of the path of love and is fully conscious of the fact that his effacement opens the door of subsistence with his beloved.

Kafi-84

ہر صورت وچہ دیدار ڈتھم کل یار اغیار کوں یار ڈتھم

“I have witnessed the unveiling in each form. I have witnessed all the intimates and strangers as friends.”

The ‘eye of heart’ witnesses the ultimate nature of things, which is opaque to the ordinary eye. The realised eye sees ‘the transparency of the phenomena.’ It goes to the roots of things. It is the gnostic consciousness, which sees the Reality manifest in all forms. It transcends all dualities and polarisations and witnesses the One in the states of nonduality and pre-polarisation. The ordinary distinction between intimates and strangers sprouts, in the process of manifestation and, in an act of transcendence, withers away and the Reality is witnessed as the Friend. The Reality is above the forms of the intimates and strangers (transcendence), but manifests in the forms of intimates and strangers (immanence). How could anything be excluded from the Reality or the Absolute? Metaphysics provides knowledge of the essential nature of things and their inter-relationships. It enlightens on the manifestations of the Reality in different forms, by integrating the fundamental dimensions of transcendence and immanence. There is no thing in the Heavens and the earth, which is not governed by the Law of things. The Law of things is ingrained in the ultimate nature of things. It is called the immanence of the Law. The law itself is simply what it is. It is neither purified nor defiled by being ingrained in the ultimate nature of a thing. It is understood as the transcendence of the Law. The transcendence and immanence of the Law is simultaneous and if the Reality is identified with the Law of things, then it

may help the ordinary understanding to understand that the One like the Law is ingrained in everything and, further manifests itself in all forms (immanence) without compromising its transcendence. A person, who succeeds in witnessing the ingrained Law of things, will witness Oneness in all things. Likewise, a person who succeeds in witnessing the Reality manifesting itself will equally witness Oneness in multiple forms. The law of things, in a miraculous way, determines the properties of things and these properties range from the material to the spiritual. The positive and negative properties, in different ranges, can be categorised as true and false; beautiful and ugly; right and wrong; good and evil; light and darkness and so on. The positive properties inhere in the ultimate nature of things but the negative ones exist relationally and have no being outside their relationships. They are negatively related to positive properties. The act of witnessing the Truth, manifest in all forms, for example, is in consonance with the ultimate nature of things. Ordinarily a truth has a falsehood as it's opposite but the absolute Truth has no falsehood as it's opposite. It is beyond the categories of true and false. The one who witnesses the Truth witnesses it in 'absoluteness' in all forms without a shadow of falsehood. He is akin to the one who witnesses the Light in 'absoluteness' in all forms without a shadow of darkness. Likewise, the absolute Friend has no stranger as it's opposite. The one who witnesses the Friend witnesses it in 'absoluteness' in all forms without there being shadow of a stranger.

کَہے جوہر تے کَہے عرض ڈٹھم کَہے سُنّت نفل تے فرض ڈٹھم
کَہے صحت ڈٹھم کَہے مرض ڈٹھم کَہے چُست اتے بیمار ڈٹھم

“I have witnessed at times the substance and at times the accident. I have witnessed at times Sunnah, supererogatory and obligatory rituals. I have witnessed at times health and have witnessed at times

sickness. I have witnessed at times activity and feebleness.”

The Reality at times is witnessed as the Substance (the Essence), which is self-subsistent, which requires no support for its subsistence or existence and at times accident (cosmos), which requires support for its subsistence or existence. He is essentially above Substance and accident (transcendence) but He manifests Himself in the form of Substance and in the form of accident (immanence). The Reality witnessed as accident is scandalous for religiosity. It fails to have a metaphysical understanding of things. Religiosity considers the cosmos absolutely distinct from God. It worships the God of transcendence. It has no inkling of the immanent aspects of God. It considers God absolutely over and above the cosmos. The Reality is ‘the Metaphysical Whole’ and there is nothing outside it. The whole cosmos is manifestation of the Reality. The accident is the manifestation of the Substance. It is utterly dependent on the Substance. The notion of an independent, autonomous and self-subsistent accident is a contradiction in terms. It is metaphysically absurd to impute the essential qualities of the Substance to the accident. However, witnessing the Reality as accident means witnessing the accident as manifestation of the Reality. It is witnessing its attachment to the Reality. ‘All things are attached to the Absolute’. How could it be otherwise? The Reality does manifest itself in all forms but, by virtue of its transcendence, it is not delimited, defiled or corrupted in any one of the forms. The transcendence and immanence of the Reality is in simultaneity in every form. It is the act of witnessing that unveils Reality in all its forms. He is manifest in the worshipped and the worshippers and thereby witnessed accordingly. His manifestations (ontological descent) worship Him (ontological ascent). He is essentially above worshipped and the worshippers (transcendence) but is manifest in the forms of the worshipped and the worshippers (immanence). He is essentially above health and sickness (transcendence) but

manifest in forms of health and sickness (immanence). He is essentially above being lively and feeble (transcendence) but manifest in forms of liveliness and feebleness (immanence). Religiosity considers it a blasphemy to talk of His manifestation in the cosmos and especially in the forms of the worshippers, the sick and the feeble because it has a delimited view of things. It is blasphemous itself in committing the Fallacy of Delimitation by delimiting 'the Nondelimited Being' or 'the Supra-Personal Divinity' and further delimiting Him to the Heavens. It also lacks the vision of witnessing Him in the cosmos. They are only the spiritual men of higher vision, who witness 'the One in multiple forms.'

کھڑے زاهد تے مخمور ڈھم کھڑے بطون ظہور ڈھم
کھڑے چوب رسن تے دار ڈھم کھڑے ملاں تے منصور ڈھم

"I have witnessed at times hidden, interiority and exteriority. I have witnessed at times ascetics and the drunkards. I have witnessed at times clergy and Mansur. I have witnessed at times a pole, rope and scaffold."

The Reality is witnessed in its aspects of the unmanifest and the manifest. It is witnessed in the forms of ascetics and drunkards that appear to be poles apart in their conduct. It is witnessed in the forms of the clerics and Mansur Hallaj, notwithstanding that the clerics did not understand the spiritual import of his ecstatic utterance: I am the Truth and hanged him. The Reality is witnessed in the forms of pole, rope and scaffold used in his hanging. The mode of witnessing offers metaphysical proof that there is nothing outside the Reality. How could a thing be divested of its essentiality? All things are attached to 'the Most Real.'

اے مشرب صاف صفیاں دا اے مذہب پاک نبیاں دا
آیات ڈھم اخبار ڈھم اے رُشد ارشاد و لیاں دا

“It is the religion of the sacred Prophets. It is the way of pure saints. It is the discernment and discourse of the friends of God. I have witnessed the symbols and I have witnessed the events.”

The prophets, saints and friends of God have attested by virtue of their witnessing that there is no reality except the Reality and everything is the manifestation of the Reality. There is no thing bereft of His Presence. The witnessing of the symbols, which partake of the Reality and the witnessing of the events, which disclose His recurring Will, there is a clear manifestation of the Reality in things and events. The Reality shines through symbols and His Will operates in all events-small or big.

کچھ بھل گل باغ بہار ڈٹھم
کچھ خس خاشاک تے غار ڈٹھم
کچھ بلبل زار زار ڈٹھم
ہک نور دے سبھ اطوار ڈٹھم

“I have witnessed at times flowers, roses, gardens and springs. I have witnessed at times nightingales in a distressful plight. I have witnessed at times straws, litters and thorns. I have witnessed all these manifestations of the essential Light.”

The Primordial light is the Absolute as the Essence. ‘The Real is sheer Light.’ The Essence of Allah is identified with Light itself. Absolute Reality or the Supreme Light is indefinable and is designated as ‘Haqq’ (Truth or Reality). The Primordial Light is unknowable in itself but it becomes manifest and knowable through existence and knowledge. The inherent nature of Light is to manifest itself. Light is the basic stuff out of which the cosmos has been created or manifested. All things are the manifestation of the essential Light. The cosmos constitutes ‘degrees of irradiation and effusion of this Primordial Light, which shines everywhere while remaining immutable and forever the same.’ Allah is the Light of the Heavens and the earth, says the Qur’an. It demonstrates His absoluteness and Omnipresence. The individuation of Light, in the Light verse of the Qur’an,

points towards the degrees of Light. 'Things are so many rays reflected from Light's substance.' The Light's substance is witnessed in flowers, roses, gardens and springs; in the distressful plight of the nightingales longing for their mates and in straws, litters and thorns spread in the garden. The metaphysics of Light accounts for the Light itself and the whole process of its manifestation. It is metaphysical realisation or witnessing, which makes the lover witness the manifestation of Light in every thing and in every event.

کھ برم نارائن نرنجن ہے کھ رام کنیا پنھن ہے
کھ بید بیاس برہمن ہے کھ راجس تے اوتار ڈھم

“He is Brahma, Narain and Naranjan at times. He is Ram, Kanaya and Lachman at times. He is Veda, Bias and Brahman at times. I have witnessed men of God in royal dresses and spiritually— incarnate at times.”

It is the Reality, which assumes many forms like Allah, Rahman and Rabb. It has different Names and Attributes in the Islamic tradition. Hindu metaphysics also deals with the Reality and the forms it assumes in the process of its manifestation. Brahman (‘the supreme principle; the ground of the universe, the source of all existence; declared as nondifferent from atman; described as unconditioned existence, self-luminous intelligence and unexcellable bliss’), Narain and Naranjan are different aspects of the Reality. He is manifest in Ram Chandar, Lachman and Krishan. He is manifest in Vedas (the Hindu Scriptures), in Bias (the Brahmin who collected the Vedas), and in Brahmin (‘the priestly class and the priestly functionary’). He is witnessed in holy men with royal attires and in avtar (the mediums of Divine descent). There are degrees of the manifestation of the Reality. It is the Reality, which manifests itself in all forms including the higher ones, namely the metaphysical, the spiritual and the religious.

ارواح نفوس عقول ڈھم انسان ظلوم جہول ڈھم

معقول ڈھمنقول ڈھمنقول
اقرار ڈھمنکار ڈھمنکار

“I have witnessed spirits, souls and intellects. I have witnessed men as cruel and ignorant. I have witnessed the rational sciences and I have witnessed the traditional sciences. I have witnessed affirmations and I have witnessed negations.”

The embodied self consists of spirit, soul and reason. The Spirit is identical with the Divine Essence and it is individualised in every human medium. The soul or self has the possibility of integration or disintegration by doing good deeds or bad ones respectively. Reason cohere the data received from the material and the spiritual worlds. The spirit, soul and reason are common to Man. Man wrongs his own soul in ignorance of the cosmic purpose of his existence but his essence remains universal. The Reality as the Knowledge itself appears in the forms of the rational sciences and the traditional ones. The negation of the reality is the affirmation of the Reality because there is no reality except the Reality.

کھ منطق نحو تے صرف ڈھمن
کھ اسم تے فعل تے حرف ڈھمن
ہک معنے ہر طرف ڈھمن
چو گوٹھ ڈھمن چودھار ڈھمن

“I have witnessed logic, syntax and accident at times. I have witnessed a name, verb and alphabetic letter at times. I have witnessed essential meaning everywhere. I have witnessed every nook and corner and I have witnessed the four sides.”

The language with its logic, syntax and accident and with its name, verb and alphabet has meaning in its essentiality. Likewise, the Reality is the essentiality in every form.

سب اعلیٰ اعلیٰ شان ڈھمن
ابو بکرؓ عمرؓ عثمانؓ ڈھمن
حسنین تے شاہ مردان ڈھمن
وہ پاک نبیؐ مختار ڈھمن

“I have witnessed all the majestic ones in supreme glory. I have witnessed Hasnayn (Hasan and Husayn) and Shah Mardan (Ali). I have witnessed Abu Bakr,

Umar and Uthman. I have witnessed the lauded pure prophet as sovereign.”

The Majesty and Glory of the Reality or God is witnessed in the grandsons and son-in-law of the Prophet and his foremost Companions. The Reality’s Attribute of Sovereignty is witnessed in the pure medium of the Prophet.

کے شاہ نظام الدین ڈٹھم کے فرد فرید الدین ڈٹھم
کے قطب معین الدین ڈٹھم کے فخر جہاں دلدار ڈٹھم

“I have witnessed Shah Nizam-ud-Din at times. I have witnessed the unique Farid-ud-Din at times. I have witnessed the pole Mueen-ud-Din at times. I have witnessed my friend Fakhr-e-Jehan at times.”

The Reality descends in all forms, which act as mirrors for the Reality to contemplate itself. The saintly hearts reflect the Face of the Beloved more perfectly. The Reality is witnessed in saintly forms. But how could Man witness anything unless the Reality in its Attribute of Witness (As Shahid) witnesses through him? And the matter does not end here. The Witness, the witnessing and the witnessed is essentially the same Reality. It appears in multiple forms in simultaneity but in reality it is the essential One. The same is true of all the Attributes of the Reality appearing in the total activity of Man including his ideas, feelings, words and actions. How could ontological nothingness claim any being or having?

Kafi-85

میں اگیانی کو گیان سناؤں

اپر م بید بتاؤں

“I am disclosing the supreme Veda. I am imparting knowledge to the ignorant.”

The Reality has manifested and appeared in different metaphysical and religious traditions of the world. The Veda is the pure metaphysics of the Hindus enshrined in different doctrines. The Supreme Principle manifests in different forms. Knowledge dispels ignorance like light dispels darkness. The oral Tradition is the repository of Knowledge passed on from one generation to the other by those who understand its teachings and are qualified to communicate it to the concerned. The search of the Reality or God in outer forms has destroyed the spiritual life of Man. He is caught in the outward as against the inward. The symbols have become for him as ends in themselves. He is lost in the pointers and has become oblivious of the inwardness they point to. The rituals are promoting religiosity at the cost of spirituality. The Heavenly truths have been corrupted on earth. The votaries have started idolising the spiritual realities. They are being far removed from the fountainhead of knowledge. They are leading their lives in ignorance caught in the snares of falsehood. It is a call to return back to the original and pure teachings of the Vedas, and for that matter to all the Scriptures so that the votaries of their respective traditions re-establish their contact with the Truth that lies within.

پریم کی تار بجاؤں

سرت سرندھ ہاتھ موں لے کر

“I take the violin of knowledge in my hands and play the tune of love.”

Knowledge and love enjoy a deeper intimacy. The supreme Knowledge or gnosis is inseparable from love. How could the lover attain union in ignorance of his beloved? The 'dialectic' of knowledge and love is operative at all levels. Knowledge deepens love and love deepens knowledge. How could a gnostic achieve heights in gnosis without achieving heights in love? Love opens up certain dimensions of higher knowledge, which remain veiled otherwise. The 'Hidden Treasure' loved to be known, which caused the entire cosmos.'

پانچ سکھی مل رام دوارے ست گر کی جس گاؤں

"I laud the Divinity by integrating five intimates (senses) in the temple of God."

The integrated senses in the embodied self perceive 'the transparency of the phenomena.' It opens the door to the non-sensuous aspects of the Reality. One delves within oneself to find the beloved.

کوئچ گلی میں شام سندر سنگ ہوری دھوم مچاؤں

"I celebrate 'Holi' in the beautiful streets with 'Krishan' (my beloved)."

The celebrations of 'Holi' (Hindu festival) symbolise the eventual victory of good over evil; rejoicing in love and spreading beautiful colours of the Colourless.

میت چیت پچکاری ماروں پریت گلال اڈاؤں

"I squirt the love laden and make the colour of love soar."

Life consists in spreading the colours of love from the earth to the Heavens, in order to attain spiritual happiness.

کہاں اجودھیا سنبل متھرا کہاں گوردھن جاؤں

"Why should I wander at Ajodhia, Sanbal, Mathra and Gurdhan (Hindu pilgrimage centres)?"

What the pilgrimage centres have to offer by remaining outward. They have even ceased to play their roles as pointers to the Inward.

پچھمن رام کنیا لگی اپنے آپ موں پاؤں

“(When) Lachman, Ram, Kanaya and Kalgi (deity incarnate) are within me.”

The whole world of spirituality lies within Man. Why it should be idealised in outer forms?

دیسوں کہاں بدیس کو دوڑوں جوگ براگ کماؤں

“Why should I leave my native abode, run to unfamiliar places and undergo hard spiritual exercises or become an ascetic?”

There is no need to displace inwardness with externality, undergo hard spiritual exercises and become an ascetic in search of God. One has to simply realise Him within ‘the infinite depths of one’s being.’

سورج چاند کو ستمکھ راکھوں سن سادھ لگاؤں

“Why should I keep the sun and moon opposite my face for concentrating on the focal point (ritual)?”

There is no need to adopt the practice of going within from the outside. He is near to Man than his neck-vein. It is in deepening one’s consciousness that one finds the beloved in the inmost chambers of one’s heart.

پپل تلسی کا ہے کو پوجوں کا ہے کو تیر تھ ناؤں

“Why should I worship (peepal) a tree and (tulsi) a shrub? And why should I go for a bath to the sacred place?”

Why worship His manifestations in trees and shrubs? Shouldn’t He be worshipped beyond His manifestations? Why to bathe in sacred places for purity, when the possibility of purifying one’s intention lies within.

اور سے کام فرید نہ میرو آتم دیو مناؤں

“Farid! I have no business with otherness. I am realising the Spirit within myself.”

He realises the Spirit within the infinite depths of his being or consciousness. He has no need of searching Him in the outward. Aren't external aids obstructions in the path of spiritual realisation?

Kafi-86

آج زیور پئے ٹھہندے ہن متاں ڈینھ سہاگ دے آندے ہن

“My jewellery is sounding pleasant to me. May be the days of union are drawing nigh.”

Her inward state changes her perception. Her pleasantness is a sign that the moments of union are drawing nigh.

کجلہ مارو دیداں بھالے سُرخِ مُسک مُسک غم ٹالے
بولے بینے تے کٹھمالے سہجوں لچکے کھاندے ہن

“The captivating collyrium is befitting my eyes. My rouge is smilingly shunning sorrows. My nose and forehead ornaments and a bead necklace are readily dancing with joy.”

Her embodied self enjoys inward happiness. It perceives everything as joyful.

باد شمالی لُر کے لُر کے بارشِ رم جھم بُر کے بُر کے
اکھیاں پھر کن لُوں لُوں مُر کے ٹھر گئے گوشے ہاں دے ہن

“The north wind is blowing very gently and there is drizzling. My eyes are winking (an omen of friend’s coming) and the pores of my body are smiling beneath. It is providing fulfilment to the spaces of my heart.”

The signs and omens of meeting her beloved make her so happy.

جیندیں عرب شریف ڈٹھوسے لہندیں سکدیں نہ مرگیو سے
سوہنے سانول یاد کیتو سے ہار سنگھار سہاندے ہن

“I have visited holy Arabia during my life time. I have not died merely desiring and wishing for it. My beloved friend has remembered me. My makeup seems so pleasant to me.”

Islamic spirituality demonstrates the inward dimension of Prophecy, which is realisable by spiritual men. It realises the possibility of direct contact with the Prophet, understood as presence (haduri). The visit of holy Arabia (inwardly and outwardly) during one's lifetime is spiritually so refreshing. These are moments of great rejoice for him that his desire and wish of visiting the place has been fulfilled before his death. However, it is not a religious visit but a spiritual one. The living Prophet desires to meet him. It stirs his heart and things appear pleasant to him. The efficacy of all rituals is to provide meeting or union. What is the use of going up and down the ladder without reaching one's friend or beloved? The house remains a house of brick and mortar without the dwelling of one's friend. Who would like to visit a house in the absence of its inmate? The House of God houses God while the Mausoleum of the Prophet houses the living Prophet, and the visit to these sacred places (inwardly and outwardly) is essentially to experience the Divine Presence and the Prophetic presence. The votaries communicate with God and His Prophet according to their respective spiritual levels. Religiosity being tied to the outward has no such experience. It has never smelt the fragrance of spirituality.

اُولے گھولے لکھ لکھ واری	صدقہ صدقہ واری واری
ملک میٹھے متراں دے بہن	سر قربان تے جان بناری

“I repeatedly make countless sacrifices in honour of his love. I sacrifice my head and my whole life is devoted to him. I am in the dominion of my sweet friend.”

He reaches the dominion of his friend and reiterates his absolute commitment with him. He offers his whole being and having to him. Love and reverence of the Prophet is

central in Islamic spirituality. The more one loves the Prophet, the more one is loved by God.

وادیں راہ مدینے والیاں ساگی باغ بہشتی چالیاں
ہر ہر آن سدا خوش حالیاں شکھ سہرے ڈکھ ماندے ہن

“The valleys on the way to Medina are identical to the paradisaal gardens. There are everlasting joys and affluence at each and every moment. Now, peace has overpowered the weary (weakling) sufferings.”

The valleys of Medina are identical to the paradisaal gardens with blissful vision of the beloved. There is happiness and peace all around without suffering.

عرب شریف دی سوہنی ریتے لاوے دل نوں پر م پلیتے
دسرے چاچڑ صدقے کیتے اصلوں محض نہ بھاندے ہن

“The tradition of holy Arabia is lovely. It kindles the wick of love in one’s heart. I have forgotten Chachar and sacrificed it (for the sake of my friend). It has ceased to truly appeal me.”

The beautiful tradition of the holy land stirs love in his heart. He becomes oblivious of the terrestrial for the sake of the celestial. He concentrates on the realisation of the higher possibilities of his existence.

حسن جمال دی دھرتی آئی سبھ شے چاہری طرز ڈکھائی
فرحت روز فرید سوائی ڈکھڑے ماندے ساندے ہن

“I have reached land of the radiant beauty. All things are manifesting freshness. Farid! Happiness is on the increase each day. Now, the sufferings have become weary (loosened their grips on me).”

He experiences the radiant beauty of the land of his friend. Things display spiritual freshness. His dwindling sufferings give way to increasing happiness.

Kafi-87

آج شبریاں شغوف بھاندے ہن متاں دیس پنل دے آندے ہن

“The caparisons and saddles (on camels) seem pleasant to me today. May be I am nearing the dwellings of Punnal.”

The inward journey of the self to the Self is essentially the realisation of the beloved in the inmost chambers of his heart. The symbolic journey is essentially within the infinite depths of his being or consciousness. The caparisons and saddles on the camel (ship of the desert) symbolise journey to the beloved.

ناز و جمل جمیل وطن دے راہی راہندے راہ سجن دے

ہر دم ہوؤن نال امن دے سا تھی درد منداں دے ہن

“The prideful and lovely camels of the native place are travellers to the dwelling place of my beloved. I wish them permanent peace. They are the companions of the compassionate ones.”

The camels or sublime feelings (ships of the inner desert of the being) seem so prideful and lovely unto their journey to union with the beloved. They are wished peace during the journey for they are compassionate to him.

لب مسکاون اکھیاں پھر کن رگ رگ بلکے دلڑیاں سر کن

غم غم کھاؤن ڈکھڑے کر کن سول سروں نس جانڈے ہن

“There is smiling on my lips and the eyes are winking (an omen of meeting one’s beloved). Each and every vein of my being is throbbing and my heart is tickling. The sorrows are sorrowful and the sufferings are grumbling (are being envious of happiness). The afflictions have been uprooted in a flash.”

He experiences the transformation of his being and the sudden end of his afflictions.

سوہنے جمل جمیل بد اوی شمس و قمر دے نال مساوی
سارے حسن جمال دے حاوی ساڈے گوشے ہاں دے ہن

“Handsome camel riders are riding the beautiful camels. They are similar to the sun and the moon. They dominate (the patterns of) beauty and loveliness. They are our dear ones.”

The Spirit is riding the self. The Spirit has original light like the sun and it is reflecting its light on the self or the moon. It creates patterns of beauty and loveliness. He considers them as dear because they are instrumental in realising union with his beloved.

بدلیں جڑ گھنگھور مچائی پھوگیں لائیں خنکی چائی
ناز کریندی لائی لائی عارف عبرت کھاندے ہن

“The sky is overcast with thickening and rainy clouds. The desert bushes and plants have attained freshness. Here, each and every riverine plant is dancing with priding. The gnostics are in the process of attaining realisation.”

His self is being transformed, by the Grace of God, and he is experiencing liveliness all around. He is in a state of awe in the act of attaining realisation.

آئے بھاگ سبھاگ سدھائے بھاگے بھاگ ڈوہاگ سدھائے
تن من ڈکھڑے جھاگ سدھائے جو چاہندے سو لہندے ہن

“The good fortunes have ushered in and the bad times and misfortunes have withered away. My embodied self has swum across the waters of sufferings. It gets whatever it wishes.”

The perplexing state of disunion and separation is over with the coming of good fortune. His embodied self has

ferried across the waters of suffering. His desire for perpetual vision of his beloved is fulfilled.

سینسر بولے بینے بھمکن والیاں والے جھمکے بھمکن
کڑیاں نورے پیریں گھمکن زیور ترپور ٹھہندے ہن

“My nose and forehead ornaments are looking beautiful. My ornamental earrings are dangling. My anklet ornaments are looking lovely. All my jewellery and apparel seem so pleasant to me.”

The ornamentations, jewellery and apparel are looking superb and making her so happy. The beauty and loveliness of her inner states endows all happiness.

زلفاں سہجوں سول پاؤں تلک تلوے لٹکے لاؤں
سرخیاں کجل مُساگ سہاؤں ہار سنگار سہاندے ہن

“The locks of hair are readily making countless furls. The brow colour- mark and moles are simply enchanting. My rouge, collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) are looking so good. My makeup is increasingly charming.”

The beauty and charm of her intricate embodied self is on the increase.

طالع بھلے بخت سولے آئے محض فرید دے ولے
پل پل یار سنیہرے گھلے ڈینہہ دکھاں تول واندے ہن

“The stars are favourable and the fortunes have started smiling. They have specially turned towards Farid. My friend is sending messages every now and then. My days have become free from sufferings.”

The responsiveness of the beloved ushers in happy times for him . His sufferings of disunion and separation wither away.

Kafi-88

اساں سو بد مست قلندر ہوں کڈیں مسجد ہوں کڈیں مندر ہوں

"We are heavily enraptured qalandars (spiritualists).
We are mosques at times and at times we are
temples."

Religiosity cannot understand the nature and significance of any spiritual state or station from the lowest to the highest. Many of the words and utterances of the Sufis cannot be taken literally or on their face value. The antagonism of the clerics with the Sufis is proverbial. The Sufis, unlike the clerics, experience God and express their experience accordingly. There are many states and stations of the spiritual path, which can only be understood by the men of spiritual vision. The Sufis, who achieve such spiritual heights of being 'qalandars,' do not commit any sin or evil. They are essentially beyond good and evil. They have the heightened consciousness of their ontological nothingness in the Face of Being itself (God). The Reality or God is Power itself (al-Qawi and al-Matin), manifest in all forms of power. It is the degree of His manifestation, in His Attribute of Power, which vests the mediums of angels, jinni and men with ordinary or extraordinary powers. The same is true of His other Attributes as well. The Qur'an is replete with instances of His Power manifesting in different mediums. No medium has ever claimed any power flowing from itself, but has always ascribed it to God. And all those human mediums that made any false claims like Pharaoh and Qarun were destroyed by their very claims. The human medium of a 'qalandar' by virtue of his receptivity becomes a spiritual receptacle for the Divine to manifest Himself to a greater degree than in other

mediums. He acts act under the spell of heightened intoxication or gargantuan rapture. In other words, the 'qalandars' are empowered by God to identify themselves with His manifestations assuming different forms. The Reality is the Infinite, the Perfect, the Love, the Beauty, the Good, the Light, the Freedom, and the Knowledge, so on. It has no limit, imperfection, hatred, ugliness, evil, darkness, constraint and ignorance respectively. These arise in the process of manifestation by individualising themselves and thereby creating their opposites. They are merely privations, which ultimately return to their source. Whatever forms the manifestations of the Reality assume, the qalandars come to assume the same. They identify themselves with the archetypal forms but they are not identical with them. Their identification with the manifestations in the forms of mosque and temple is understandable in this context.

کڈیں چور بنوں کڈیں چار بنوں
کڈیں توبہ استغفار بنوں
کڈیں فسق فجوریں اندر ہوں
کڈیں زہد عبادت کار بنوں

“We are thieving at times and at times we are swindlers. We are repentance and forgiveness at times. We are devout ascetics at times and at times we are engrossed in sinfulness and impiety.”

They identify themselves with the manifestations of the Reality in the forms of thieves and swindlers; repentance and forgiveness; devout ascetics and sinfulness and impiety.

کیتھاں درد کیتھاں درمان بنوں
کیتھاں مصر کیتھاں کنعان بنوں
کیتھاں کچ بھنبور داستان بنوں
کیتھاں واسی شہر جلندر ہوں

“We are pain at times and at times we are remedying. We are Egypt at times and at times we are Canaan. We are the glory of Kech and Bhambore at times and at times we are the dwellers of Jullunder (the city under water).”

Their identification with the manifestations of the Reality embraces ideas, feelings, words and actions both in serial time and in pure duration in the forms of pain and remedy; Egypt and Canaan; glory of Kech and Bhambore; and the dwellers of Jullunder.

کیتھ صومعہ دیر کنشت کیتھیں کیتھے دوزخ باغ بہشت کیتھیں
کیتھے عاصی نیک سرشت کیتھیں کیتھے مگرہ ہوں کیتھے رہبر ہوں

“We are Shrine at times and at times we are Monastery and Church. We are hell at times and at times we are gardens of Eden. We are sinners at times and at times we are of virtuous disposition. We are misguided at times and at times we are guides.”

They identify themselves with the manifestations of the Reality in the forms of shrine, monastery and church; hell and gardens of Eden; sinners and of virtuous disposition; guided and the misguided.

ہیوں اور قلاش تے رند اسماں پئی نودی ہے ہند سندھ اسماں
ہیوں بے شک عارف چند اسماں کل رازر موز دے دفتر ہوں

“Although we are penniless and inebriates yet Hindustan and Sindh are bowing before us. Undoubtedly, we are a few gnostics, the repository of all the secrets and mysteries.”

They are few in number divested of being and having. They aren't to be judged by their poor appearances. They are inwardly the repositories of Divine secrets and mysteries. It is by virtue of their inwardness that people in our part of the world hold them in high esteem.

ہن ناز نواز دے ٹول کڈیں ہے مونجھ منجھاری کول کڈیں
رے ڈھول کڈیں گیارول کڈیں کڈیں بردر ہوں کڈیں دربر ہوں

“We are in the company of priding and elegance at times and at times we are in proximity to anguishes.

Our beloved unites with us at times and at times wretchedly separates from us. We are at the doorsteps at times and at times we are inside (dwelling with our beloved)."

They identify themselves with the manifestations of the Reality in the forms of priding and elegance; anguishes; unity of the beloved and His wretched separation; nearness with the beloved and in unison with Him.

ولواتوں سمجھ فرید الا کر محض نہ شعر جدید ولا
ہے چالوں حال پدید بھلا تو نے کیجو سارے اتر ہوں

"Farid! Now take caution in uttering words from your mouth. Do not create such novel poetry again (for people will not understand it). Our inwardness manifests spirituality though outwardly we seem in a bad shape."

It is risky and difficult to give poetic expression to one's spirituality. One's poor outward does not match one's inward richness.

Kafi-89

آمل اچکل سوہناسائیں نہ تاں مفتی خون تھیسائیں
توں بن مول نہ سچھدیاں واپیں سن دل نال تاں گالھ اکھائیں

“My beautiful beloved! Do meet me these days.
Otherwise, I will die and my blood shall be on you.
Nothing occurs to me without you. I will narrate if
you listen by the ears of your heart.”

He submits to the beloved and anxiously waits for his response. He would consider him responsible in the event of his death. He beseeches him to heed to this forewarning with all seriousness.

پر بھت دہاراں روہ گھنیرے جتھ لاہنگے جتھ تھیوم وہیرے
پیشک درد منداں دے دیرے جتھ تھلڑا جتھ سنجڑیاں جاہیں

“There are hilly terrains and gigantic mountains. I wait there on the passages. Undoubtedly, the dwellings of the compassionate ones are there in sand dunes and desolate places.”

He awaits his beloved at different entry points of the desert. These desolate places are the dwellings of the men of Heart. These places turn into oases with the responsiveness of the beloved.

ہک پل عیش نہ پائیم گھر وچ گذری ساری عمر سفر وچ
پوندے سو سو پورا اندر وچ یار رب یار دے دیس و سائیں

“I have not found even a moment of enjoyment in my house. My entire life has been spent in the way (of

love). I experience lots of fits within me. My Sustainer! Make me dwell in the city of my friend.”

His plight manifests his state of love. He prays for union with his beloved. It is Divine Grace, which affects union.

جاں ڈیکھاں جھڑیہ کن من کوں روواں کر کر یاد سجن کوں
اکھیاں بلکن مونہہ ڈیکھن کوں گل لانون کوں پھٹکن بانہیں

“I constantly cry in remembering my beloved, the moment I see clouds, drizzling and rain. My eyes are anxiously waiting to see his face. My arms are quivering with fondness to embrace him.”

The signs leading to the beloved’s vision affect inward changes, which leave a deep impact on his embodied self.

واٹ نہاراں کانگ اڈاواں پنڈت جوسی دے کن کھاواں
سو پونج ہاراں فالان پاواں اوسی میڈا یار کڈاہیں

“I keep waiting and shooing the ravens. I make the pundit and astrologer fed-up by my queries. I make countless vows and take omens to know about the visit of my friend some day.”

He desperately tries to know, by all means, the destined moments of union with his beloved. The normal consciousness does not help in solacing his heart. He catches at a straw while drowning in the stream of love. The mystery of future cannot be resolved by rational modes.

میں بدنہ کہیں بھیم بھرم دا توہیں صاحب لاج شرم دا
زور فرید کوں تیدڑے دم دا لگڑی سانول توڑ نہ جائیں

“I am imperfect without any respect and reputation. You are the custodian of my honour and grace. Farid’s strength is solely due to you. My beloved! Remain with me till last.”

All said and done, he sustains hope in his beloved. He admits his imperfection in face of his perfect beloved. He

does not impute any honour or good reputation to himself. He totally considers his beloved as the custodian of his honour and grace. He is bereft of any might. It is his beloved, which grants him strength on the path of love. He beseeches his beloved for the ultimate union.

Kafi-90

آمل مارو ماڑرو تھل وچ کردیاں دھاہاں
ماراں ہنگلاں کو کڑیاں کر کر لنبڑیاں بانہاں

“The heartless dweller of Marwar! Do come and meet me. I keep beseeching in the desert. I cry and yelp for help by spreading my arms.”

Her plight in awaiting her heartless dweller of Marwar (beloved) speaks of the dynamics of love. He initiates love and she intensifies it with suffering in order to realise union.

بھل گیاں رساں ریتاں جیں ڈینہہ لکڑیاں پیتاں
بٹھ پئے خویش قبیلڑے پرہک تینوں چاہاں

“I have forgotten customs and traditions ever since I contracted love with you. I do not bother about my kith and kin. I love you solely.”

The possibility of love cannot be realised partially. It has to be realised in wholeness. It is in the process of realisation that she becomes oblivious of everything except her beloved. She does not discard all these things by any rational effort. She does not make conscious efforts to abandon the whole lot that hitherto gave meaning to her life. Reason teaches otherwise. It is the drive of love that steers her straight to her beloved. The force of love forces everything out of her for the sake of her beloved.

کینوئیں جیوے جاڑے سنجرڑی ہیر سلیڈی
رانجھن تخت ہزارڑے نسکیاں لایاں کاہاں

“How should the damned Heer live and spend her life, when Ranjha is at ‘takht Hazara’ and all the plants and shrubs have dried up?”

Love itself is polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved. There is no love without this polarisation. It is not possible for her to remain insulated from her beloved. Her existence would dry-up without inward nourishment of love. It is her ontological necessity to transcend and get united with her beloved. Love quickens the dead to life.

راول ڈترم رولا	ماپیو ویروساریم
چولی چنڑی لاہاں	پاواں لیرے میلڑے

“I have become oblivious of my parents and brothers. I have been wretched by my beloved. I wear untidy clothes. I have shed my fine clothing.”

It is a positive sign of love to become oblivious of one’s parents and fraternal ties. The experience of being wretched by one’s beloved is the sign of triumphing in love. The very act of wearing untidy clothes and shedding the fine ones speaks volumes of the conquering nature of love.

لا یولا ڈکھلا یو	جاہی چوٹ فریدنوں
سانول نازنگاہاں	مول نہ وسرم ہڑیاں

“You have targeted Farid so perfectly. My beloved! I will never forget the gracefulness of your eyes.”

He is targeted so perfectly with the graceful eye contact of his beloved that he constantly remembers his vocation of love in the vicissitudes of life. How could an imperfect move of the beloved fructify love?

Kafi-91

اے حسن حقیقی نور ازل تینوں واجب تے امکان کہوں

“O’ essential Beauty! The Primordial Light! May I describe you as the Necessity and the Possibility?”

In calling Him as the Essential Beauty and the Primordial Light, it seems a delimitation since these are manifestations or manifested forms. How could they describe the Unmanifest? But one has to take a reference point in attempting to describe Him. Otherwise, it is not possible to describe Him even provisionally. The very word ‘You’ speaks of delimitation. Notwithstanding, the initial delimitation, in describing Him as the Necessity and Possibility, the very word necessity cannot be understood without reference to possibility. If there were no possibility, then the question of necessity would not have arisen? How come necessity, in a certain sense, becomes dependent upon possibility for its explanation? In describing Him as Possibility, the question of impossibility arises. It is true that an impossibility being a pure and simple negation is nothing and cannot limit it, but, then the Possibility has to be necessarily unlimited. But in calling it unlimited, it has to be dependent upon the concept of the limited. If there were no idea of the limited, then the idea of unlimited won’t arise. How could the higher be described by the lower?

تینوں خالق ذات قدیم کہوں تینوں حادث خلق جہان کہوں

“May I describe you as you the Creator, the Beginningless Essence? May I describe you as the Originator of the created worlds?”

Can He be described as the Creator (Al-Khaliq) who created the whole creation? Can He be described as the Beginningless Essence since He has no beginning? The First (Al-Awwal) is His Attribute. Can He be described as the Originator of the created worlds at all levels?

تینوں مطلق محض وجود کہوں تینوں علمیه اعیان کہوں

“May I describe you as the Nondelimited and the Delimited Being? May I describe you as the three degrees of knowledge?”

Can He be described as the Nondelimited Being or Pure Freedom? Can He be described as the Delimited Being or relative freedom? Can He be described as the three ascending degrees of knowledge or certitude: ‘ilm al-yaqin, ‘ayn al-yaqin’ and ‘haqq al-yaqin’?

ارواح نفوس عقول مثال اشباح عیان نہان کہوں

“May I describe you as spirits, souls, intellects, ideas, and embodied existents visible and invisible?”

Can He be described as the spirits, which are the manifestations of the Spirit; the souls or the selves in between the body and the spirit; the rational faculties; the imaginal modes; and all the embodied existents whether visible or not.

تینوں عین حقیقت ماہیت تینوں عرض صفت تے شان کہوں

“May I describe you as the essential Reality and its quintessence? May I describe you as contingent, an attribute and glory?”

Can He be described as the Quintessence of the Reality? Can He be described as contingent being, an attribute or as glory.

انواع کہوں اوضاع کہوں اطوار کہوں اوزان کہوں

“May I describe you as species? May I describe you as types? May I describe you as modes? May I describe you as measures?”

Can He be described in quantitative terms as the species and their types, modes and measures?

تینوں عرش کہوں افلاک کہوں تینوں نازِ نعیم جنان کہوں

“May I describe you as empyrean? May I describe you as heavens? May I describe you as delicacies and graces of paradise?”

Can He be described in celestial terms beyond the terrestrial ones?

تینوں تت جہاد نبات کہوں حیوان کہوں انسان کہوں

“May I describe you as atom, matter and plant? May I describe you as living being? May I describe you as human?”

Can He be described in terms of different degrees of matter and life?

تینوں مسجد مندر دیر کہوں تینوں پوتھی تے قرآن کہوں

“May I describe you as Mosque, Temple and Church? May I describe you as Veda and Qur'an?”

Can He be described as different places of religious worship? Can He be described as Scriptures (sacred and authoritative)?

تسبیح کہوں زنا کہوں تینوں کفر کہوں ایمان کہوں

“May I describe you as rosary? May I describe you as cross thread? May I describe you as infidelity? May I describe you as faith?”

Can He be described as rosary of the Muslims and the cross thread of the Christians? Can He be described as the infidelity of the infidels and the faith of the faithful?

تینوں بادل برکھا گاج کہوں تینوں بجلی تے باران کہوں

“May I describe you as cloud, rain and thundering?
May I describe you as lightning and drizzling?”

Can He be described as the atmospheric changes?

تینوں آب کہوں تے خاک کہوں تینوں باد کہوں نیران کہوں

“May I describe you as water and may I describe you
as clay? May I describe you as air? May I describe you
as fire?”

Can He be described as elements of the universe?

تینوں دسرت کچھمن رام کہوں تینوں سیتا جی جانان کہوں

“May I describe you as Dasrat, Lachman and Ram?
May I describe you as my beloved Sita?”

Can He be described as different characters portrayed in the epic poem Ramayana namely, Dasrat (father of Ram Chandar), Lachman (brother of Ram Chandar) and Ram Chandar? Can He be described as the beloved Sita, who remained true to her husband Ram Chandar during his banishment in the forest?

بلدیو جسودانند کہوں تینوں کشن کنہیاکان کہوں

“May I describe you as Baldev, Jaswada and Nand?
May I describe you as Krishan, Kanaya and Kaan?”

Can He be described as characters portrayed in Bhagwat-Gita namely Baldev (elder brother of Krishan), Jaswada (adopted mother of Baldev) and Nand (adopted mother of Krishan)? Can He be described as Krishan, Kanaya and Kan (different names of Krishan)?

تینوں برما بشن گنیش کہوں مہادیو کہوں بھ گوان کہوں

“May I describe you as Barma, Bishan and Ganesh?
May I describe you as Mahadev? May I describe you
as Bhagwan?”

Can He be described as the Supreme Reality with its Attributes or forms namely, Barma (Creator of the world), Bishan (Vishnu, the Lord of the Heavens and the earth) and Ganesh (the Wise and the Succour Provider), Mahadev (the Supreme Lord) and Bhagwan God)?

تینوں گیت گر تھتے بید کہوں تینوں گیان کہوں اگیان کہوں

“May I describe you as Gita, Granth and Veda? May I describe you as knowledge? May I describe you as ignorance?”

Can He be described as the sacred and authoritative books of Hindus and Sikhs? Can He be described as Knowledge? Can He be described as ignorance (which does not arise as an opposite to absolute Knowledge but arises when knowledge creates its opposite in the form of ignorance in the process of manifestation)?

تینوں آدم حوا شیث کہوں تینوں نوحؑ کہوں طوفان کہوں

“May I describe you as Adam, Eve and Sheesh? May I describe you as Nuh? May I describe you as the storm?”

Can He be described as Adam (the prototype of mankind) and Eve (the symbol of feminine essence); the Prophets Sheesh and Nuh and the Great Flood in the times of the Prophet Nuh?

تینوں ابراہیمؑ خلیل کہوں تینوں موسیٰؑ بن عمران کہوں

“May I describe you as Ibrahim, the friend? May I describe you as Musa bin Imran (descendent from the House of Imran)?”

Can He be described as the Prophets Ibrahim and Musa?

تینوں ہر دل داد لدار کہوں تینوں احمدؑ عالی شان کہوں

“May I describe you as the beloved of every heart?
May I describe you as Ahmad, the majestic and the
splendid?”

Can He be described as the beloved of everyone? Can He
be described as the Prophet of Islam in his majesty and
splendour?

تینوں شہد ملک حجاز کہوں تینوں باعث کون مکان کہوں

“May I describe you as the witness in the city of
Hejaz? May I describe you as the raison d’etre of the
cosmos?”

Can He be described as the beloved Prophet for whom
the cosmos was created?

تینوں ناز کہوں انداز کہوں تینوں حور پری غلمان کہوں

“May I describe you as pride? May I describe you as
mode? May I describe you as houries, fairies and lads
in paradise?”

Can He be described as prideful and beautiful forms of
expression? Can He be described as the celestial inmates of
paradise?

تینوں نوک کہوں تینوں ٹوک کہوں تینوں سرخی بیڑا پان کہوں

“May I describe you as gambol? May I describe you
as playful? May I describe you as redness of lips and
colourful beetle leaf?”

Can He be described as enticements of the beloveds and
their embellishments?

تینوں طبلہ تے تنبور کہوں تینوں ڈھولک سرتے تان کہوں

“May I describe you as drum and tambourine? May I
describe you as small drum, tune and a melodious
voice?”

Can He be described as musical instruments, tunes and
songs?

تینوں حسن تے ہار سنگار کہوں تینوں عشوہ غمرہ آن کہوں

“May I describe you as beauty and embellishments?
May I describe you as amorous glance, enticement
and grace?”

Can He be described as beauty, beautification and bewitchment?

تینوں عشق کہوں تینوں علم کہوں تینوں وہم یقین گمان کہوں

“May I describe you as intuition? May I describe you
as knowledge? May I describe you as illusion,
certainty and vanity?”

Can He be described as intuition and other modes of knowledge? Can He be described as illusion, certainty and vanity?

تینوں حسن قوی ادراک کہوں تینوں ذوق کہوں وجدان کہوں

“May I describe you as beauty and power of
comprehension? May I describe you as tasting? May I
describe you as inspiration?”

Can He be described as the beauty of gaining knowledge of the ultimate nature of things? Can He be described as tasting, by virtue of witnessing? Can He be described as inspiration coming from within the depths of ones being or consciousness?

تینوں سکر کہوں سکران کہوں تینوں حیرت تے حیران کہوں

“May I describe you as intoxication? May I describe
you as the intoxicant? May I describe you as
bewilderment and amazement?”

Can He be described as the spiritual intoxication and the spiritual intoxicant of love? Can He be described as bewilderment and amazement experienced by the gnostic in the state of gnosis?

تسلیم کہوں تلوین کہوں تمکین کہوں عرفان کہوں

“May I describe you as agreeableness? May I describe you as fickleness? May I describe you as grandeur? May I describe you as gnosis?”

Can He be described as full and absolute submission to the ultimate nature of things? Can He be described as uncertainty? Can He be described as certainty? Can He be described as gnosis?

تینوں سنبل سوسن سرو کہوں تینوں نرگس نافرمان کہوں

“May I describe you as hyacinth, iris-coloured and cypress (trees)? May I describe you as form of a narcissus?”

Can He be described as different forms of flowers?

تینوں لالہ داغ تے باغ کہوں گلزار کہوں بستان کہوں

“May I describe you as tulip spot and garden? May I describe you as orchard and garden?”

Can He be described as tulip spot, orchards and gardens?

تینوں خنجر تیر تفنگ کہوں تینوں برچھابانک سنان کہوں

“May I describe you as dagger, arrow and musket? May I describe you as spear, curved dagger and spearhead?”

Can He be described as different weaponry?

تینوں تیر خدنگ کمان کہوں سوفار کہوں پیکان کہوں

“May I describe you as arrow, white poplar (whose wood is used in the making of arrows) and bow? May I describe you as notch of an arrow? May I describe you as arrowhead?”

Can He be described as different parts of weapons?

بے رنگ کہوں بے مثل کہوں بے صورت ہر ہر آن کہوں

“May I describe you as the Colourless? May I describe you as the Incomparable? May I describe you as the Formless, at each and every moment (transcendence in immanence or pure duration in serial time)?”

Can He be described as the Colourless, being devoid of all colours? Can He be described as the Incomparable since nothing can be compared to Him? Can He be described as the Formless recurring in the forms of things?

سبوح کہوں قدوس کہوں رحمان کہوں سبحان کہوں

“May I describe you as the Praised? May I describe you as the Pure? May I describe you as the Merciful? May I describe you as the Glory?”

Can He be described as the Attribute of Sabuh (the Praised)? Can He be described as the Attribute of Quddus (the Pure)? Can He be described as the Attribute Rahman (the Merciful)? Can He be described as Subhan (the Glorious)?

کر توبہ ترت فرید سدا ہر شے نوں پر نقصان کہوں

“Farid! Quicken to repent once for all. I consider each of the descriptions fraught with harmful implications (highly deficient in describing the Essence that transcends even transcendence).”

The attempts to describe the Essence have to be permanently discarded with repentance for all times. The Essence cannot be defined or described even by Names or Attributes. All the planes of existence are highly deficient in describing It. Even the categories of transcendence and immanence are human dimensions of describing ‘the Most Real’ and they miserably fail to describe It. Language and thought have inherent limitations in describing the Essence.

اسے پاک الکھ بے عیب کہوں اسے حق بے نام نشان کہوں

“I describe Him as the Pure and the Transcendent, without any imperfection. I describe Him as the Nameless Truth without signs.”

Can He be described as the Transcendent and Pure of all imperfections? Can He be described as the Nameless Truth without Signs? Isn't describing Him in these terms imperfect since it tantamount to delimiting Him as pure transcendence by the exclusion of His immanence? The Reality (God) is manifest in things (immanent) but at the same time remains apart from them (transcendent). It is transcendent and immanent in simultaneity. The distinction between the Essence and the Divinity does not help us here. He is beyond transcendence and immanence; nay, He is beyond every form of description. 'Glory is to your Lord, the Lord of Grandeur, beyond what they describe' (37: 180). It is an error to delimit Him in any descriptive form. The One, in principle, is beyond description. The Reality cannot be exhausted by the forms of its expressions or contained in the narrow circuits of its forms. Isn't silence the only legitimate human mode of describing the Essence? But again silence is relative to speech. He is beyond silence and speech. Only God knows Himself.

Kafi-92

اے ریت سیکھی ہئی کیں کنوں ڈھولا لگ چھپ بہندیں میں کنوں

“My beloved! You keep hiding from me. You have learned this manner from whom?”

He is at a loss to understand the transcendence of his beloved.

جڑ تیغ برہوں دی مارگیوں لکھس صبر آرام قرارگیوں
کیوں جھوک لڈا لکھ پارگیوں کوئی پیچھن والا، ہم تیں کنوں

“You have perfectly targeted me with the sword of love. You have grabbed my patience, comfort and tranquillity. Why did you take your dwellings and went across the river? Is there no one to take you to account?”

He considers his beloved responsible for his sufferings and therefore accountable.

ڈینہاں ڈوڑے ڈکھڑے پانودیاں رت رورورات نبھانودیاں
کروین ڈوہاگ سہانودیاں ونج حال گھنہ سائیں کنوں

“I bear intense sufferings in the day. My night is spent in awful crying. I wail and try to fashion my misfortunes. Go and verify my condition from my neighbours.”

He explains the plight of his love, which is known to everyone.

جندناں محبت جکڑی ہے لگی شہر ملامت پھکڑی ہے
دل منہوں سٹھنوں تکرڑی ہے نئے ڈردے مہنیں ویں کنوں

“My chain of love has led me earn wider reproaches and ill-repute. My heart is stout in facing these rebukes and satires. I am not afraid of these increasing rebukes.”

He faces numerous contradictions in love. The hostility of the environment does not deter him from the path of love.

اے روہی یار ملاوڑی وے شمالا ہو وے ہر دم ساوڑی وے
ونج پیسوں لَسڑی گاوڑی وے گھن اپنے سوہنے سیں کنوں

“The desert (rohi) is the meeting point of my beloved. I pray that it remains evergreen. I will go and have a drink of cow-diluted curd in the hands of my beloved master.”

The desert symbolises the meeting ground with his beloved. He prays that it always remain impregnated with the possibility of union. He desires to have instructions at the hands of his spiritual master, which freshen his being.

غم درد فراق دی روڑیاں گیاں ناز نوازیوں ٹوڑیاں
تھنی، گہلی کھلی بھوڑیاں دھک مار جھلاں جیں تیں کنوں

“I am wretched by sorrows and pain of separation. My communal pride and elegance has gone away. I am imprudent, naive and simple. I bear kicks from everyone, petty or superior.”

His sufferings multiply when the inner and outer forces reduce him to a non-entity.

دل جھر جنگل دی باندی ہے جتھاں جھوک میڈے متراں دی ہے
بو صدق وفادی آندی ہے انہیں ساوکیں سنہڑیں لیں کنوں

“I am subject to the thick forests, housing the dwellings of my fast friend. The fragrance of sincerity and faithfulness comes from these green and fresh plants.”

The dwelling of his beloved in the inmost chambers of his heart sprouts freshness with fragrance of truth and sincerity.

کچھ یاد نہالی تول نہیں کوئی سنگتی باجھوں سول نہیں
تڑپار و نجن دامول نہیں ہیں نینہ دی باری نین کنوں

“I have no memory of my mattresses and a nuptial quilt. I have no companion except affliction. There is absolutely no way to cross the stream of love. It is in such high currents.”

The magnitude of difficulties in the path of love is so high that it is not possible for him to surmount them without the help of his beloved.

بن یار فرید نہ جیواں میں کیوں ابجھیں اوکھی تھیواں میں
لو زہر پیالہ پیواں میں چھٹ پوساں سولیں سنیں کنوں

“Farid! I will not live without my friend. Why should I spend my life in such hazards? I will take the cup of dissolved poison and be free from countless afflictions.”

He dies by inches in bearing onerous sufferings for the sake of his beloved. He prefers death to his life spent in unresponsiveness of his friend.

Kafi-93

برى بيزار بن ذاتوں
صفاتوں مست جانانوں
محض آزاد بن ناموں
نشانوں دين ايمانوں

“We are now delivered and detached from the essences and attributes by being enraptured of the beloved. We are now free from names, signs and the ways of faith.”

The gnostics achieve gnosis by getting enraptured by the beloved. They get detached from their essences and attributes and achieve deliverance or union. They get freedom from determinates of names, signs and dynamics of faith. They become universal men.

جُھٹے اکروں لنگھے پھکروں
عبادتوں اتے فکروں
گذر کر ذکر اکروں ذکروں
نکل گئے کون امکانون

“We have been set free from speculations and arisen higher than trivialities, worships and reflections. We have transcended the reciters and recitals. We have gone beyond the spatio – temporal order.”

They become unconditional by transcending the conditional spheres of speculations, trivialities, worshipping, thinking, recitations of sacred texts and the spatio-temporal order. These are preparatory to the final stage of metaphysical realisation.

تھنی دل دور اغیاروں
بھری معمور دلداروں
پیو سے خبر آثاروں
تے اخباروں تے قرانوں

“My heart has distanced itself from otherness. It is full of love of my heart’s beloved. Knowledge has been gained by dint of symbols (knowledge of things that is symbolic understanding of the cosmos) events (knowledge of events pertaining to past, present and future) and the Qur’an (knowledge of the earthly Qur’an and the immanent Qur’an which is inscribed on the tablet of the heart).”

The heart of the gnosis in achieving the final stage of gnosis becomes absolutely free from otherness. It is completely filled by the love of the beloved. The intimacy of knowledge and love reaches its zenith. The knowledge of things and events gained by virtue of the cosmos, the Prophet and God become unified in a single whole. Doctrinal truths are metaphysically realised. Theoretical knowledge becomes realised knowledge.

جڈاں ڈوتریں توں غافل ہے تڈاں ہک نال واصل ہے
لدھا قرب النوافل ہے دل ایقانوں تے احسانوں

“A person, who discounts duality and trinity, has the realisation of the One. He achieves nearness (to God) by virtuous behaviour. His heart achieves absolute certainty and spiritual beauty.”

The gnostic realises the One by getting rid of the illusion of duality and the metaphysical absurdity of trinity. His virtuous behaviour leads him to contemplate the beloved in the mirror of his heart. His heart achieves absolute certitude and spiritual beauty. The ‘eye of the heart’ sees ‘God Everywhere.’

ڈتیاں استاد استادیاں ہمیشہ رات ڈینہہ شادیاں
تھیاں سنج برتے آبادیاں شہودوں ذوق وجدانوں

“My spiritual master gifted me with the art of unravelling mysteries leading to everlasting and perpetual joys. I got resurrection of my life by dint of witnessing, tasting and intuition.”

His spiritual master taught him the subtleties of gnosis leading to permanent blissfulness. His life got resurrected by experiencing the Reality through witnessing, tasting and intuition (higher modes of knowledge).

جہاں خود قرب ہے دوری اتھاں کیا وصل مہجوری
انانیت تھی پوری ہے انسانوں تے رحمانوں

“What place do identity and difference have, where nearness itself becomes remote? Man-Lord axis is finally withdrawn by the Self.”

The stage of metaphysical realisation makes nearness itself so remote. It transcends the reality of identity and difference. It is metaphysical Identity-in-Difference. The Divine ‘I amness,’ which manifests in the human ‘I amness,’ remains provisionally bound to the ‘servant-Lord axis,’ till it is finally withdrawn by the Self, by the Grace of God.

عجب مشرب تے ملت ہے سبھو وسعت نہ قلت ہے
نہ انیت دی علت ہے نہ حسناؤں نہ عصیانوں

“It is a strange way and mode, where there is no delimitation but all non delimitations. There is no problem of being delimited neither from the side of virtue nor from the side of sin.”

It is the supreme nondelimited way and mode beyond delimitation. There is no problem of being delimited either from the side of virtue or from the side of sin. Both virtue and sin belong to the conditioned states of existence or the contingent realm of action and thereby are delimited. The Nondelimited is the realm of the universal and the sphere of non-action. The Reality acts itself through the human medium.

فرید آئی ہے ہشیاری نچت گئی چت اندر ساری
پئی سدھ بدھ سچی ساری جگائی جوت تن جانوں

“Farid! Awareness has dawned upon me. It has led me to a complete inward realisation. All intellectual understandings have been renewed. There is an awakening of purpose from the infinite depths of my being.”

His dawning of gnostic awareness has led to his inward realisation in fullness. Intellect realises the identity of knowledge and being. The light of the ‘immanent Qur’an’ shines forth in the inmost chambers of his being.

Kafi-94

بن یار سانول بیو کو نہیں ہذا جنون العاشقین
بے اونہ آنست ونہ ایں ہذا جنون العاشقین

“There is no one except my charming beloved. This is the frenzy of the lovers. There is neither hither nor thither (except my beloved). This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

The frenzy of the lovers is not irrational but beyond rationality. It is a connotative negation of everyone except the beloved and finding him everywhere.

تھل برتی رلدی ہے کیوں سدھ واٹ توں بھلدی ہے کیوں
یار است ہدم ہمنشیں ہذا جنون العاشقین

“Why the inept one is wretchedly wandering in the deserts and forests? Why she has become oblivious of the straight path? My friend is always with me. This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

The lover being finite is not always with the beloved and therefore he becomes inept in wretchedly searching him in wilderness. The frenzy of love teaches him that the beloved being Infinite is always with him. The permanent presence of the beloved with the lover is the greatest miracle of love.

کیا نار کیا گلزاروے کیا یار کیا اغیاروے
اور ابد اں اور ابہ ہیں ہذا جنون العاشقین

“What is the meaning of fire and garden? What is the significance of friend and stranger? You see him in all

forms and remain always with Him. This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

The frenzy of love reveals to the lover that all forms are those of his beloved. The dawning of this realisation leaves no space for differentiating between hell and paradise or a friend and a stranger.

مذہب وجودی فرض ہے یوکل اجائی غرض ہے
دیدیم با چشم یقین ہذا جنون العاشقین

“The doctrine of Oneness of Being is mandatory. All else is meaningless prompted by selfishness. I have witnessed it with the eye of certainty. This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

The lover’s frenzy consists in witnessing the truth of Oneness of Being with the ‘eye of certainty.’ It dissolves the consciousness of one’s separate, independent and autonomous selfhood. It appears as meaningless to his gnostic consciousness.

ڈینہہ ہجر دے مٹا گئے ولھے وصال دے آگئے
جانم بجائناں شد قریں ہذا جنون العاشقین

“The days of separation have bid me farewell. The moments of union have arrived. My being has realised the Self. This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

The path of love, chosen by a few, is still a traversable path leading to destination even though it is narrower than the eye of a needle. The darkness of separation vanishes with the light of union. The frenzy of love succeeds in realising the Self. How could it be realised otherwise?

نہیں قال بیشک حال ہے پلپل اساڈے نال ہے
نازک مزاج نازنیں ہذا جنون العاشقین

“It is not merely an utterance but undoubtedly, it is our state that He is with us at each and every

moment. He is tender hearted and delicate. This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

The frenzied lover does not say something theoretical but doubtlessly experiences his beloved being with him at every moment. He describes the beauty and loveliness of his beloved in absolute certitude. He transcends the rational level to the level of intellectuality. It is absolutely his love cognizance that acknowledges his beloved. How could it be otherwise? Isn't it foolish to ask a frenzied lover to give arguments for the existence of his beloved? It is just like asking Heer to adduce arguments for the existence of Ranjha or asking Sohni to prove the existence of Mahiwal. The lover's whole life is an ample testimony to the fact that he is related with pure objectivity. The objectivity of his love is higher than any other levels of objectivity. He is more conscious than even a scientist in constantly purifying his experience. His style of life is superior to all the other styles of life. His acts of love are qualitatively unique than any other human acts. He is not bindingly stranded on the plane of psyche but freely soars to the spiritual level. The barren rationality cannot understand the fertility of intellectuality. The phenomenology of love (intentionality) grounded in intellectuality needs no rational proofs. Love is its own proof. Light is its own proof. Does sun require any other proof than itself? Rationality debases love and thereby debases itself.

تھی رات سبھ پر بھات ہے	واہ عشق ڈٹڑی ڈات ہے
ہذا جنون العاشقین	شد فرش دل عرش بریں

“Laudation to love that has bestowed this gift. The night has ended and now it is all daylight. My heart by traversing through the terrestrial realm has achieved celestial heights. This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

Love has to be lauded for bestowing the most precious gift to the frenzied lover. The night of separation dawns into the day of union. The heart of the lover bridges the heavens and the earth.

خلقت کوں جیندی گول ہے ہر دم فرید دے کول ہے
سو گند پیر فخر دیں ہذا جنون العاشقیں

“I swear by my spiritual master Fakhr-ud-Din that He is constantly with Farid whom people are trying to find. This is the frenzy of the lovers.”

He swears by his spiritual master that the beloved, who is sought after by people, is always present with him. How difficult it is to experience nearness itself. But once experienced, in the frenzy of love, the illusion of separation and disunion dwindles away.

Kafi-95

بیٹھی رورو عمر نہایاں سبھے خوشیاں عشق و نہایاں

“My life has been spent in crying. My love has lost all happiness of life.”

The suffering in love makes his worldly happiness dwindle into insignificance.

واہ سانول دی دھار کجل دی بے شک تیغ اجل دی
دید ایں تیر چلاون کاری پلکاں کرن لڑایاں

“I laud the collyrium line of my beloved. Undoubtedly, it is the sword of destiny. The eyes are shooting piercing arrows. The eyelids are in strife.”

The beloved's mighty initiation of ontological love with beautiful charms is so imposing that he has no way out of the impasse of love.

عشوے غمزے ناز نہورے نخرے نوکاں ٹوکاں
حسن ملاحت شکل شباہت ساریاں طرحیں سدھایاں

“The amorous glances, enticements, pride and coquetries, blandishments, gambols and playfulness, enchanting beauty and facial figures are all well trained forms (for captivating one in the yoke of love).”

The beauty of the beloved is perfectly captivating. The initial thrust of love is so powerful that he becomes powerless in the face of love.

ہنجڑوں جاری تتلے رترے پپلیاں اجڑیاں پچڑیاں

لوکاں لکھے اکھیں آیاں ظالم برہوں چو نبھایاں

“The tears are falling and the sockets of my eyes have reddened. The eyelids have been totally ravished. People consider my eyes to be a sore but they have been hurt by the cruelty of love.”

The inward sufferings in the path of love adversely affect his body. The inner states cramp his embodied self.

میںہیں سہنیں درد اندیشے ڈکھڑے پکھڑے آیم
دلڑی سختی ملڑی سنجڑی اوکھیاں یاریاں لایاں

“The rebukes, satires, pain, anxieties and sufferings have fallen to my lot. My ruinous heart has met hardships. I have contracted arduous friendship.”

His heart contracts arduous friendship and then suffers as a consequence. The hostility of the social environment increasingly constricts his social space and he is pushed to the wall. It is a miracle of love that he finds a ‘door in the wall’ at the most constricted point.

مفت ملامت سخت ندامت شہر شکایت چايم
ویڑھے یار فرید نہ آیم مستک لکھیاں پایاں

“I am deeply regretful of being reproached for nothing. I have been burdened by varied complaints. Farid! My friend has not visited my courtyard. I got what was destined for me.”

He suffers in noting that the public opinion has turned against him without any rhyme or reason. He is innocent but pronounced guilty. It is his cosmic fate to be deprived of union with his beloved.

Kafi-96

بے رنگ راول دے کیتے روندی وتاں رڑدی رہاں
دل سنگ سانول دے سوا سوسول لکھ سٹھنیں سہاں

“I keep on weeping and crying for my unique beloved. I bear hundreds of afflictions and countless satires for the sake of my heartless beloved.”

He suffers for his unique friend. He has to bear afflictions and satires for his heartless beloved. He owns his beloved in spite of all odds. It fosters a feeling of belongingness in him, which is so vital for the fruition of love.

سک سکھ سبھو سہی سچ کھسے ڈکھ رنج ویڑھے وچ دوسے
دشمن سجن ہرک بے ٹوکاں کرم سارا جہاں

“My desire has really snatched all my peace. Suffering and grief are dwelling in my courtyard. All my friends and enemies laugh at me. The whole world is sneering at me.”

Love upsets the peace of ordinary life and plunges him in the stream of grief and suffering. The whole world sneers and laughs at him. His self-image undergoes a radical transformation and he comes to see himself as a social and individual non-entity. The peeling of his social and individual self is instrumental in gracing him with the ontological consciousness of his nothingness.

کیٹو پنل واہ ویروے ونج کچ لایو دیروے
ڈکھڑے ڈتونی ڈھیروے سنج بر پھراں سر بھر ڈھاں

“My beloved! How adverse you have been with me?
You went to Kech and started dwelling there. You
gave me countless sufferings. I roam in wilderness
and keep falling headlong on the ground.”

The spiritual sufferings of love even at their heights keep him attached to the pure objectivity of love, unlike the psychic sufferings of love, which are purely psychological in nature and end up in being totally subjective. The psychic lover tries to possess his beloved as an object and as a consequence becomes possessed himself whereas the spiritual lover strives to unite with his beloved as Subject in exercise of his metaphysical freedom. All genuine love is spiritual in nature and is nurtured in freedom.

دِلّی غماں دی بھین ہے سولاں ڈکھاں داوین ہے
پر بھت جبل چٹ ڈین ہے چاڑھیاں چڑھاں لاہیاں لہاں

“My heart is the sister of sorrows (sorrows have such intimacy with me). The afflictions are tuning the wailing of suffering. I am wandering in hills, mountains and plain lands. I keep mounting and dismounting.”

The spiritual pains, sorrows and sufferings are not at the loss of anything terrestrial but arise in separation and disunion from the celestial beloved. How great love is at the higher plane.

سب آس ہو کئی یاس ہے ہر دم اداس ہر اس ہے
مونہس نہیں کوئی پاس ہے ہے دل کہاں دلبر کہاں

“All my hope has been turned into despair. I am sad and terror-stricken all the times. There is no one with me to share my sufferings. My heart is here but my beloved is elsewhere.”

He passes through certain states where his hope turns into despair. He feels sad, lonely and terror-stricken but these are not psychic states but spiritual ones.

آرد فرید ایں التجا
 وار دگدا امید ہا
 رحمت بحال بے نوا
 صد گونہ ز الطافِ شہاں

“Farid! I am the helpless one who has presented himself beseeching for mercy. The poor is hoping countless blessings of the king.”

His light of hope remains shining beneath the darkness of despair. It makes him helplessly present himself seeking mercy at the hands of his beloved. He being devoid of being and having hopefully counts on the infinite blessings of the king.

Kafi-97

کڑیں سانول موڑ مہاراں تتی روروواٹ نہاراں

“I am the inept who is on the look out for you, while crying. My beloved! Do turn your reins towards me.”

He wants nothing but the responsiveness of his beloved in order to end his state of suffering. He does not crave for possessing his beloved as an object but desires union with him.

پھراں ڈوہاگی دیس براگی جیں کارن سو سختی جھاگی
تھیواں باغ بہاراں جیندیں ڈیکھاں سانول ساگی

“I have accepted countless hardships for his sake. I am wandering like nomads with misfortunes. I wish to see my beloved face to face during my life time. I want to bloom forth (from within).”

He knows that it is only the vision of his beloved that can make him inwardly bloom with happiness.

جیندے سانگے مانیم تھلڑا یار بروچل وسم سولڑا
توں سنگ چانگے چاراں خان پنلڑا نا کر کلہڑا

“My Baloch friend! Dwell near me. I have chosen dwellings in the desert for your sake. Punna Khan! Never leave me forlorn. I wish to shepherd my herd with you.”

Love craves for nearness with beloved at all costs. It is the constant consciousness of his friend that keeps the flame of love burning.

جیں ڈینہہ یار اسماں تو نکھرے مہندی روپ ڈکھائے پھکڑے
ڈسے سرخی دے رنگ نکھرے وگھریاں کجل دیاں دھاراں

“The colour of my henna faded out ever since my friend parted from me. My rouge has become colourless. The lines of the collyrium have spread out.”

The colours of union fade out and become colourless in the periods of separation.

مَن مَن نتناں پیر مناواں ملا گول تعویذ لکھاواں
سڈ سڈ جو سی پھالاں پاواں کردی سون ہزاراں

“I go on making vows for the sake of making my master agreeable to me. I search the talisman for the writing of an amulet. I go on calling the astrologer for giving me omens. I do countless charming.”

He desperately resorts to vows, amulets and astrology in the hope of finding his friend. He goes beyond his ordinary consciousness in tracking his beloved.

خواجے پیر دے ڈیاں جھٹے ایسے ڈینہہ اتھائیں گھٹے
جیندیاں سبھ دل کیتیاں مٹے وسم سدا گھر باراں

“I shall give bowls in the name of Khawaja Pir in return of my beloved spending these days with me. He should lovingly accept the cravings of my heart and everlastingly dwell in my house.”

He makes up his mind to give bowl (‘crumbled bread rolled in sugar and butter oil’) in the name of the saint, in fulfilment of his vow, that his beloved spends his days with him with everlasting responsiveness.

بندڑے نال نہ کر سیں مندڑا تونیں کو جھاکلا گندڑا
لٹک سہائیں صحن سوہنداڑا پوں پوں توں چندواراں

“You will not despise your bondsman in spite of his being ugly, naive and defiled. You will step in his

courtyard in a majestic way and beautify it. I will sacrifice myself at your each and every step.”

He still has hope that in spite of his imperfections, he will be accepted by his perfect beloved who will unveil himself with majestic beauty. He is ready to sacrifice his whole being and having for the sake of the moment of union.

چھوڑ فرید نہ یار دادا من جنیں جی کیتا جڑ کر کا من
ڈوہاں جہانیاں ساڈا ما من کینویں دلوں و ساراں

“Farid! Do not cease to cling to your friend. He has enchanted your heart in fullness. This is our treasure in both the worlds. How can my heart be oblivious of him?”

He reiterates his choice to remain attached to his friend who has fully enchanted his heart. How can he be oblivious of his friend who is his support both in this world and the life hereafter?

Kafi-98

تتی نیہہ دے پندھ اڑانگے نیں ڈکھے ڈونگر اوکھے لانگھے نیں

“O’ the inept one! The paths of love are very difficult.
There are hard mountainous terrains and the passages
are hazardous.”

The paths of love are difficult and hazardous. The ideal of union is realised in exercising great patience in terrible adversity.

ڈنگے راہ او لڑے ولڑے دے بیاپندھڑے روہ جہلڑے دے
نہ سمجھیں مفت سہانگے نیں

“The turnings encountered in the way are winding
and circular. There are also mountainous terrains lest
you consider them as easy costing nothing.”

The straight path of love does not mean that it is not winding and circular. It simply means that it leads to destination. The novice in love has to understand the intricacy of the way. He has not to mistakenly think that the path is easy and free of cost. It is not romantic love merely thriving on romance. It is real love with real sufferings.

رکھ طرح طریق توکل نوں کر حوصلہ صبر تحمل نوں
دل وصل وصال مہانگے نیں

“Remain steadfast in the tradition of trust in your
Sustainer by manifesting guts, patience and
forbearance. The meeting and union (with beloved)
are of high value.”

He has to have constant trust in his beloved. He has to employ guts, patience and forbearance in face of separation and disunion coupled with inner and outer hostility. It is nothing less than bartering his head for the realisation of union.

سے دھکڑے دھوڑے سول بہوں لکھ خار آزار بول بہوں
سبھ سہندے یار دے لانگھے نیں

“There are numerous violent pushes, set backs and afflictions. There are countless thorns, distresses and thorny bushes. They all seem pleasant in reference to my beloved.”

His connectivity with his beloved makes the physical and mental onslaughts lose their sting in his eyes. He considers them as pleasantries in the course of love.

بن مارو اے تھل مارو ہے نہ جھوک نہ کوئی چارو ہے
نہ بھیداں بکریاں چانگے نیں

“The desert is deadly without Maroo (my beloved). There is no habitation or any shepherd to be seen. The sheep, goats and their calves are not grazing.”

He sees deadness all around in being separated from his beloved. The vibrant desert life seems so lifeless to him.

سنج برے ڈرے ڈرے ہے رچھ راخس مم دی گڑبڑ ہے
کئی سمجھم نہ اصلوں ٹانگے نیں

“The places are lonely, desolate and dreadful. The bears, giants and man eaters have created a great nuisance. I essentially cannot discern the marks and signs of the way.”

The transformation of the psychic into the spiritual is a dreadful experience. There are no given marks and signs in

the path of love. He draws them while traversing the path. He has to make his own drawings. Isn't it the uniqueness of love?

سر نہونڈے تے روح پھر دے ہن دل ڈکھدے تے ہاں گھر دے ہن
چم لیراں ماس وی گھاگھے نیں

“My head aches and I am feeling unwell. My heart is suffering and I am having a feeling of vertigo. My skin has worn out and my flesh has been cut to pieces.”

His embodied self faces quakes of love, which transform his being into nothingness.

غم محنت دی دل جوئی ہے سر گٹھڑی مونڈھے لوئی ہے
گئے چولے بوچھن لاگھے نیں

“Sorrow inspires my efforts. There is burden on my head and there is a shawl (of suffering) on my shoulders. I have become oblivious of my shirt, dopatta (head-covering) and leggings.”

He is not cowed down by sorrows, which inspire him instead of making him perspire. The alchemy of sorrow purifies his heart in order to make it worthy of his beloved.

گھر باروں برہوں بعید کیتا کم کاروں فرد فرید کیتا
دل پر م نگر ڈوں تاگھے نیں

“Love distanced me from my household. Farid! It detached me from worldliness. My heart is longing for the City of Love.”

He inwardly long for the City of Love. The light of his longing makes the darkness of his worldly attachments disappear.

Kafi-99

جند سولاندے وات نیں ڈترڑی برہوں برات نیں

“Life has become a bed of thorns. It is the blessing of love.”

What a blessing of love that life becomes a bed of thorns.

کڈیں ڈینہہ دکھاں داسرتے کڈیں غماں دی رات نیں

“The day of suffering encompasses me at times and at times the night of sorrow envelops me.”

He lives his life on the spectrum of sufferings and sorrows.

تول تلیندی بیج سڑیندی جلدیں تھئی پر بھات نیں

“The nuptial quilt scorches me and the nuptial bed keeps me burning till morning.”

The nuptial bed and quilt torch him without his beloved.

روندیں عمر وہانی ساری یار نہ پائیم جھات نیں

“My whole life has been spent in crying. My friend has not even shot a glance at me.”

He spends his life in crying for his unresponsive friend.

پنل ہے مسجود و لیس دا دین ایمان دی بات نیں

“Punnal (my beloved) is the object of my heart's adoration. It is my whole inward commitment.”

His heart adores his beloved with inward sincerity.

احد تے احمد فرق نہ کوئی واحد ذات صفات نیں

“There is no difference between Ahad and Ahmad.
The Essence and the Attributes are identical.”

The undifferentiated Reality (Absolute, Essence, Ahad) became differentiated (Infinite, Divinity, Names or Attributes), by virtue of the principle of Ahmad. Ahad or the principle of al-Ahadiyah and the principle of Ahmad are essentially the same since the Reality in the undifferentiated and the differentiated form is essentially the same. The Possibilities inhering in the Essence are internally transformed into Names or Attributes. The Essence (Dhat) and the Names or Attributes (Sifat or Asma al Husna) are identical. The metaphysical principle of unity in diversity enlightens us on the essential sameness of Ahad and Ahmad and the essential identity of the Essence and the Divinity.

حسن پرستی تے میخواری ساڈی صوم صلوٰۃ نیں

“The adoration of beauty and drunkenness is our
fasting and prayers (rituals).”

The enraptured adoration of beauty and the spiritual state of drunkenness are their rituals of Fasting (abstinence of otherness) and Prayer (witnessing the beloved).

نقر فنا داراہ اڑانگا ہن لکھ لکھ آفات نیں

“The realisation of one’s ontological nothingness and effacement is very intricate. There are countless tribulations (in the way).”

The effacement or the realisation of one’s ontological nothingness is not easy but intricately woven with countless tribulations. ‘To plunge into nonbeing, with the consciousness of being, is as difficult an act as to fly without wings.’

ٹھڈے ساہ تے ہار ہنجوں دے ڈٹے عشق سوغات نیں

“Love has sent these rare gifts of cold sighs and strings of tears.”

The rare gifts of cold sighs and strings of tears are identifiable as coming from the hands of Love.

ساڑے، سول فریدی سنگت درد کشالے سات نیں

“The company of Farid comprises burning afflictions along with pains and adversities.”

What a sweet company of burning afflictions, pains and adversities he has as a lover. Why the world should not feel envious of such a blissful company.

Kafi-100

جیں رمز راول جی بجھی تن کھے مشاہدہ رات دن

“The one who unravels the mystery of the beloved
does remain in the state of witnessing day and night.”

The one who unravels the mystery of love constantly
witnesses his beloved.

نہیں جاتھاں افیون دی نہ بھنگ نہ معجون دی
جنہاں سدھ لکھی بے چون دی نت مست رے پیتیں و تن

“Here, there is no scope of opium, hemp or electuary.
They keep a track of the Unique. They are enraptured
without wine.”

They have no need of opium, hemp, electuary or wine
(inducing psychic states). They are enraptured at the spiritual
plane without any psychic aid or support. (This also accounts
for the genuineness of spiritual experience).

رل وسدے لوکاں نال ہن پر اصل فارغ بال ہن
ہر آن غرق خیال ہن شاغل سمہن شاغل اٹھن

“They remain and dwell with the people but are
essentially free from the worldly strings (worldliness).
They are drowned in imagination at every moment.
They remain committed in sleep and remain
absorbed, while awake.”

They maintain a respectable distance from things and
events. ‘They live in the world like boats sailing in the widely
spread waters, which do not pour in. But when the waters
rush in then the boats sink.’ The friends of God do not let
the waters, sink their boats. They remain in a constant state of

contemplation. They remain attuned to the Reality in state of sleep and wakefulness.

خود توں خودی توں دور ہن سر مست جام طہور ہن
حق دے ہمیش حضور ہن اولیں وچوں بھولے بھن

“They are beyond themselves and ego hood. They are enraptured in Divine illuminations. They are permanently in the fold of Divine Presence. The worldly activity is for them a persona.”

They are enraptured in Divine illuminations. They go beyond themselves without any sense of egohood. They are always in the fold of Divine Presence in their state of nothingness. The worldly activity is for them a persona since the Divine acts through their mediums.

نہیں ملک ملک تے مال دے نہیں زال دے نہیں بال دے
ہن ذوق وجد تے حال دے گم کرگماں یک رور ہن

“They are not attached to property, dominion and wealth. They are neither attached to a wife nor to children. They belong to tasting, inspiration, and a mystic state. They thrust aside all doubts and remain meditative.”

They are detached from the world and its ties. They delve deep within themselves and experience tasting, inspiration and countless spiritual states. They doubtlessly remain meditative in absolute certitude.

سر ڈے لہن سر دالتا گئے محض مرنوں سر کا
ہو کر فنا پاؤن بقا سو سود نقصانوں کرن

“They witness the real mystery by sacrificing their head. They save their head from ordinary death. They attain subsistence by annihilating themselves. They reap countless benefits from one loss.”

They unravel real mystery by sacrificing everything for the sake of the beloved. They are saved from meaningless death.

They die before dying and earn immortality. They reap countless benefits from the one loss of passing away from this world.

ونج وٹھڑے دیں سہاگ دے سکھ روپ مانن بھاگ دے
بارہ مہینے پھاگ دے پاچین چٹھ سبجیں بہن

“They go and dwell in the nuptial city. They enjoy the destined forms of peace. Their twelve months are the season of spring. They sit, while mounting on the nuptial bed in the state of fulfilment.”

They go and dwell in the city of happiness. They enjoy the fortunes of peace. They constantly experience bloom all around. They remain in the state of realisation.

جیں من مندر پایا یا ڈکھ پاپ سارا مٹ گیا
تھی محو اثباتی تھیا رہند افرید فرید بہن

“The one who finds the beloved in his heart, it leads to the effacement of all his sufferings and sins. Farid remains without individuality by subsisting in the everlasting one (non duality).”

His finding of his beloved in the inmost chambers of his being leads to the effacement of all his sufferings (of separation and disunion) and all his sins (of duality). He ceases to be individual and becomes universal by attaining the ontological consciousness of his nothingness. He lives in the state of nonduality.

Kafi-101

در سن بن اکھیاں ترس رہیاں

“My eyes are thirsty of your vision.”

His eyes thirst for vision of his beloved. His thirsty plight is more precarious than the thirsty traveller, who is dying for want of a few drops of water in the scorching heat of the barren desert. It is only a drop of water that can save his life. If he is not given water to drink and instead is offered the whole treasures of the world, then how could he survive? Likewise, nothing can quench his thirst except the vision of his beloved.

سے سول سہاں بک سانگ سوا شکھ مڑ گئے، خوشیاں راکھ تھیاں

“I bear hundreds of afflictions and spearing desires (of union with my beloved). My peace has been burnt and my happiness has been reduced to ashes.”

The onslaught of afflictions and spearing desires burn peace and reduce happiness to ashes.

جی جلد اسینے اگ لگی دل بیکل ہنجر ڈوں ڈہلک پیاں

“My self is aflame and my chest is burning. My heart is anxious and the tears are flowing from my eyes.”

His embodied self tears from within and evokes flowing tears in his desolate eyes.

بٹھ سچ سڑی بٹھ تول تتی گیاں سینگیاں سرتیاں و سرتیاں

“I don’t care for the burning nuptial bed and I don’t bother about the parched nuptial quilt. My same age friends have forsaken me.”

The nuptial bed burns and the nuptial quilt parch in absence of any response of his beloved. He has no value of his nuptial belongings since his friends have also forsaken him.

گل کو جھے کانٹے خار چبھن تھئی چولی سالہوں سہنس دھیاں

“The ugly pointed thorns round my neck prick me.
My garments and the red shawl have been torn into bits.”

The jewellery around the neck seems ugly and pricks like pointed thorns. The beautiful dress has been torn into pieces.

کئی لہر لوڑھے کئی روہ زو لے کئی پھر دے بوئے بیٹ لیاں

“There are many who have been swept away in waves and there are many who are wandering in the mountains in a wretched state. There are many who are roaming amidst plants, marshes and riverine growth.”

The might of love has destroyed many a lovers and there are many who are on the verge of being destroyed. The intricacies of the path of love are opaque to ordinary consciousness.

دن بیت گئے سدھ بسر گئی ساجن نے برائیاں جوڑ کیاں

“My days are ended and my thoughtfulness has fled. My beloved has pointedly stated my imperfections.”

His ordinary understanding dwindles with the passage of time. His encounter with the perfect beloved mirrors his own imperfections.

ہے ناز، نہیں اعراض مُنڈھوں رکھ آس، نہ تھی غم واس میاں

“Do keep hope and do not remain immersed in sorrows. It is essentially pride and not avoidance (on the part of your beloved).”

It gives him a new understanding about the behaviour of his beloved. He solaces himself by the idea that the beloved does not shun him on account of his imperfections but has his own majestic way of responding to love.

بن یار فرید نہ عید ڈتھم کھل کھیداں ساریاں و سرگیاں

“Farid! I am not experiencing happiness without my friend. All playful things have gone away.”

How could he experience happiness without embracing his beloved? He distances himself from the whole world considering it as a child’s playful thing.

Kafi-102

دل عشق چائی اگ سائیں ڈکھ، سوزر چپارگ رگ سائیں

“Love has again intensified the fire, my master. My each and every vein has been the abode of suffering and passion, my master.”

Love intensifies fire from within. His every vein becomes pyre of passion and suffering.

گھر گھر مل گئے ہو کے قبلہ یار دی جھو کے
ایں جگ تے اوں جگ سائیں

“It has been proclaimed on the beat of the drum that my ultimate concern is the abode of my friend in the terrestrial world and in the hereafter, my master.”

His ultimate concern is the universal truth that the beloved dwells in his heart in this world and in the life hereafter.

دلبر دور سدھاناں ساڑاں تول وہاناں
جیواں کیندے لگ سائیں

“My beloved has gone away. I set aflame my bedding and pillow. With whose support should I live, my master?”

His beloved is his only support. He does not need outer supports. He transcends multiplicity to reach unity.

ہو رہیں کوئی باقی ایہا ذات صفائی
ہاں دلدار داسگ سائیں

“There has remained nothing except the Essence manifest in Attributes. I am the canine of my beloved, my master.”

There is nothing except ‘the One in multiple forms.’ It is the One in many. It is unity in diversity. There is no otherness. He is the canine of his beloved. He is loyal to him.

من مَنجھاتن ٹونڈے لنگ میلے سر بھونڈے
سول آون کروگ سائیں

“My self is in anguish and my body is in cramps. The parts of my body are untidy and my head is deformed. The afflictions are pouring in multitude, my master.”

The higher magnitudes of afflictions in the path of love adversely affect his embodied self.

برہوں روح حیاتی غم ہے یلی ساتھی
درداں دی ہم تگ سائیں

“Love is the life of my Spirit. Sorrow is my fellow and companion. The durable pains are intimate with me, my master.”

He considers love as the Spirit of his life in spite of bearing pains and sufferings. He understands the intricacies of love, the adversities of the way, and the sacrifices he has to make for the sake of his beloved. Sorrows become his fellows and companions, and the durable pains his intimates. Shouldn’t the world envy the lover for having such fellows, companions and intimates?

حال ”فرید“ خوارے دلڑی زار نزارے
کیٹم ہجر الگ سائیں

“Farid! I am in a disgraceful state. My heart is highly distressed. I have been isolated by disunion, my master.”

He experiences highly distressed states of his heart and the isolating affects of his disunion, which makes his condition so pathetic. All these deplorable states are so many positive signs in the path of love. These signs are indicative of the vast distance he as a lover has traversed on the straight but hazardous road to love.

آتم دیو مناؤں

اور سے کام فرید نہ میرو

Kafi-103

دل مست محو خیال ہے سر مو تفاوت نہ سہوں

“My heart is engrossed within imagination. I cannot bear any differentiation.”

‘Imagination (khayal) has the power to grasp God’s similarity (tashbih).

His heart is engrossed within imagination. It is unified with the undifferentiated imaginal reality.

اے خیال عین وصال ہے تے کمال ہے نہ کہ ہے جنوں

“My imagination is an immanent union. It is perfection and not lunacy.”

His imagination realises immanent union. It is not a psychic state but spiritual identity of knowledge and being.

اصل الاصول شہد تہ ہمہ سو بسو ہمہ کو بکو
چہ شہود عین بعینہ نہیں فرصت اتنی کہ دم بھروں

“I have openly witnessed the Supreme Principle in every nook and corner. The witnessing is so glaringly evident that I cannot disengage myself even for a moment.”

He witnesses the Supreme Principle in the modes of its manifestations. The ‘transparency of the phenomenon’ becomes so absolute that he finds it impossible to disengage himself from this witnessing.

جو مکاں تھا بن گیا لامکاں جو نشان تھا ہو گیا بے نشان

شده اسم و رسم زمن دواں اللہ اپنے آپ کو کیا کہوں

“The spatial turned spaceless. The sign turned without a sign. The names and customs of the ages have left me forlorn. My Allah! What should I call myself?”

He experiences the imaginal reality of space becoming spaceless and the signs ceasing as pointers. The dimension of quantity tied to the ordinary spatio-temporal order undergoes qualitative transformation. The habitual mode of perceiving the physical and the social world deserts him. His self identity remains in a state of flux.

نہ عیان ہے نہ نہان ہے نہ بیان ہے نہ دھیان ہے
نہ رہا ایہہ جسم نہ جان ہے کیہاں ڈوس ہوش حواس کوں

“There is neither openness nor hiddenness. There is neither speech nor a thought. My body has neither remained nor the life-impulse. How can I blame my sense and sensibility?”

He sees neither openness nor hiddenness. He has no speech or thought. He sees neither his body nor life. His senses and sensibility are radically transformed. The Divine takes over the human medium and acts through it.

شد عکس در عکس ایں بنا کہ فنا بقا ہے بقا فنا
باقی نماںد بجز انا کچھ اوتے توں کچھ ہاں تے ہوں

“There is double reflection. ‘Fana’ (extinction) is ‘baqa’ (subsistence) and ‘baqa’ (subsistence) is ‘fana’ (extinction). There is solely the ultimate, without any question of that and you (otherness)?”

The states of ‘fana’ (annihilation) and the states of ‘baqa’ (subsistence) at different levels are relative and complementary to each other. There is invert reflection by virtue of which, ‘fana (annihilation) is ‘baqa’ (subsistence) and ‘baqa’ (subsistence) is ‘fana’ (annihilation). The term ‘fana’

(annihilation) and the term 'baqa' (subsistence) are derived from the Qur'an: 'All that dwells on the earth is annihilated, and there subsists only the face of your Lord, the possessor of majesty and generosity' (55:27). 'Inasmuch as human beings are Not He, they are annihilated, but inasmuch as they are He, they subsist... Creaturely attributes have been annihilated and divine attributes subsist... But in truth it is God who acts, since the servant has been utterly effaced... Annihilation always means annihilation from some specific mode of lower consciousness and simultaneous subsistence through a specific mode of higher consciousness. One kind of awareness is given up to be replaced by a higher kind. Annihilation, in other words, is validated through the subsistence that accompanies it. That which subsists is the Real's self-disclosure, and that which is annihilated is the unreal---the limited self-awareness of the individual... Subsistence is your relationship with the Real.... But annihilation is your relationship with the engendered universe, since you say, "I have been annihilated from such and such." Your relationship to the Real is higher. Hence subsistence is a higher relationship, since the two are inter-related states. None subsists in this path except him who is annihilated, and none is annihilated except him who subsists. 'The one described by annihilation will always be in the state of subsistence and the one described by subsistence will always be in the state of annihilation.' There is solely the self-disclosure of the Reality without any trace of otherness.

کڈیں شور دے سطوات ہن کڈیں زور دے شطحات ہن
کئی قسم دے بکوات ہن ستوں دے بتوں، بتوں دے ستوں

"There are percussions and spiritual impositions at times and at times there are drives and antinomian utterances. There are so many types of prattling leading to meaningless discourse."

He undergoes percussions, pressures and drives in a state of spiritual drunkenness. He overflows with antinomian

utterances, prattling and meaningless speech. His modes of communication cannot be understood at the plane of psyche. He has no psychic control over any of these things originating from the spiritual source. His self dwindles in the wake of spiritual experience.

اٹھ گئی ”فرید“ ہوس مُنڈھوں نہ رہا ہئی وس ہک خس مُنڈھوں
کے کس ہو کس ناکس مُنڈھوں چپ چاپ فیل فسادتوں

“Farid! Lust has been uprooted. I have become incapacitated as a straw. You should be quiet for there will be tumult in determining, who absolutely merits or who does not merit.”

Lust has been completely uprooted with the withering of his self. His gnosis has made him absolutely incapacitated as a straw. He no more remains doer of his actions. He prefers to keep quiet in order to avoid tumult in determining as to whose actions are totally perpetrated by the Divine and whose actions are by dint of his self.

Kafi-104

ہن موت بھلی بے شک سائیں ڈکھاں سولاں کیتم لک سائیں

“I have been reduced to a straw by sufferings and afflictions, my master. Now, undoubtedly death is a boon for me, my master.”

The sufferings and afflictions undergone by her adversely affect her embodied being to the extent that she considers death as a boon.

پنل کیچ سدھائیم ولدی خبر نہ آئیم

رہیاں راہیں تک سائیں

“My Punnal went to Ketch. I got no news of his return. I kept waiting for him, my master.”

She suffers the transcendence of her beloved. She does not receive any indication of the moment of his immanence. She awaits her beloved.

گھولاں بھیڑی گھل کوں پوون تتی دے دل کوں

سو سو پور تے جک سائیں

“I sacrifice my detestable sleepiness. I am the inept one with countless worries and captivations distressing my heart, my master.”

Sassi detests her sleep during which Punnal went to Ketch. Her resolve to sacrifice sleep symbolises determination to overcome forgetfulness of God even that of a moment and to constantly remain in the state of wakefulness. Her heart is distressed by the devastating affects of separation from her beloved.

آئے سخت کروپ کشالے کون بندی دے ٹالے

جو لکھیا مستک سائیں

“Many stringent difficulties and adversities have befallen me. Who can erase the writings on the forehead of the slave maid, my master?”

The difficulties and adversities faced by her in the path of love are primordial.

ڈکھڑے درد ڈکھیندے جان جگر وچ پیندے
سوچو نہ ہی لکھ چک سائیں

“The sufferings and pains hurt me. They cause hundreds of pinches and countless bites on my embodied self, my master.”

Her embodied self is ravished by pains and sufferings.

بھاگ سہاگ گیو سے یار دلوں و سر یو سے
پک سائیں ہم پاک سائیں

“All my nuptial fortunes have vanished. My friend has erased me from his heart (forsaken me). It is the truth, my master. It is the truth, my master.”

She becomes so cowed down by the pressures of love that she comes to believe that the possibility of union has ended since her beloved has forsaken her.

ہجر ”فرید“ اجاڑیم سوز اندر دے ساڑیم
دلڑی ہم چک مک سائیں

“Farid! Disunion has ravished me. The inward passion has burnt me. My heart catches fire by rubbing, my master.”

He is ravished by disunion. The inward passion burns him. His heart catches fire in being rubbed by desires and longings of his beloved.

Kafi-105

ڈو کہ ڈھیر سکھ داویر ہے ریڑاں گھنیاں پیڑاں بہوں
رت روہنجوں نیراں وہن نک سیڑھتے سیڑھاں بہوں

“The sufferings are great adversaries of peace. There are a number of acute and continuous pains in my bodily joints. The bloody tears are flowing heavily from my eyes. My nose is oozing blood and is bleeding profusely.”

The intensity of sufferings reaches a height where even peace becomes her adversary.

جکھ جکھ کراں دھائیں بہوں ڈکھ ڈکھ کڈھاں آہیں بہوں
دو کہ دو کہ اوٹھن بھائیں بہوں اک چک پیاں دھیراں بہوں

“I am beseeching by rotting in suffering. I heave great sighs in encountering sufferings. The burning flame of sufferings is emitting smoke with a steady pace. All my efforts have dwindled into insignificance.”

Her efforts do not fructify in giving her peace, which is only possible by uniting with her beloved. The principle of effort, so sacrosanct in religiosity, is not of much efficacy in the spiritual realm. The decisive factor is the Grace of God.

سر بھونڈا جڑیا خاک ہے منہ دھوڑ سینہ چاک ہے
چو چک تھیا ہن چاک ہے موٹھی جھوک دل ویراں بہوں

“My deformed head is covered with a coat of dust. There is dust on my face and my chest is wounded. The daughter of Choochak has been reduced to a

maid servant. My dwellings are hapless and my heart is deserted.”

She gradually becomes devoid of being and having. Heer, born and nurtured in royal environment, is forcibly married and reduced to a maid-servant. She forsakes everything for her beloved, Ranjha.

سبھ لوک کردا نوک ہم لگی دل نیاڑی نوک ہم
ڈٹی برہوں ڈاڈھی چوک ہم چٹی درد دے تیراں بہوں

“All people are ridiculing me. My heart has been pierced in a novel way. Love has afflicted great prick. Numberless arrows of pain have targeted me.”

He has to repeatedly encounter ridicule, which makes him suffer a lot. He loses his social standing. His social consciousness becomes so traumatic. It is his absolute commitment with the beloved that provides him courage to stand against these onslaughts. He transcends his social self to the realm of the solitary, which is so vital in the path of love. Doesn't God turn evil into goodness?

بے پیر دل دیاں چالیاں سبھ بن اوپٹھیاں گالھیاں
پیتم نہ پیتاں پالیاں رور و کرے ریڑاں بہوں

“The moves of my rebellious heart have overturned. My beloved has not nurtured love. My heart cries with great wailing.”

A heart full of love is beyond the control of reason. It rebels against the normal notion of loving someone who reciprocates love. His move to keep on loving the beloved without his loving response is upturned. He wails while crying but of no avail.

کلی میں نہی ایہیں جول دی پھرے لکھ فرید ایہیں تولدی
دل بوڑدی دل رولدی سوہنیاں سسّیاں ہیراں بہوں

“I am not alone in realising this tradition. Farid! There are countless others who are immersed in this way. It is heart that drowns and it is heart that makes countless beautiful ‘Sassis’ and ‘Heers’ turn into the wretches of the earth.”

He is not the only one in realising the tradition of love. It has been realised by many lovers deeply immersed in love. Many lovers like ‘Sassis’ have drowned and many others like ‘Heers’ have become the wretches of the earth. The lover realises that he has to remain sincere to love without taking into account the consequences thereof including the behaviour of his beloved. He has to remain in love in all types of easy or stringent circumstances Love is unconditional. It is not hypothetical. It can be understood, in a certain sense, as ‘a categorical imperative’. The absoluteness of love requires absolute commitment.

Kafi-106

خوشیاں بھاونوں رہیاں ڈکھڑے پکھڑے آئیم

“Sufferings have been fallen to my lot. Joys have remained unappealing to me.”

Her perception of joy keeps on changing in the state of suffering. She realises at a certain stage the elusive nature of joy and remains content with her deplorable state.

سیاں کھیدن گیاں چاند نیاں راتیں برہوں راتیں

“The moonlit nights are the gifts of love. My friends have gone to play.”

The enlightened moments of contemplation are realisable in spiritual company.

رُل مل دھانوں پیّاں رُت سانوں دی مینہ برساتیں

“There is a rainy season with a heavy downpour. My friends are going together for bathing.”

Heavenly blessings, in the ambience of love, purify human souls.

پکڑ نہ کھیڑا بیاں صدقے کیتا نال نہ نیتا

“He renounced me and did not take me with him. O’ my adversary! Do not hold my arms.”

Heer feels herself renounced by Ranjha. But she still loves him from the core of her heart. How could she give in to the adversary bent upon winning her to his side? Rival is a displaced lover who does not understand the free nature of love. He tries to possess his ‘beloved’ as an object and

becomes possessed instead? How comic is the fate of the psychic lover?

روز ازل دا وارث ساڈا توں ہیں راںجھن سیاں

“My Ranjhan friend! You are my custodian ever since the primordial day.”

Love is essentially primordial. It is symbolically manifest in the forms of lovers and beloveds. Heer's primordial commitment of love with Ranjha is expressed in terms of symbolism.

وِسریم سارا راج بیاہ وِسریاں سیگنیاں سیاں

“All the regal status of my house has been fallen in oblivion. My same age friends have gone away.”

She sacrifices her being and having for the sake of her beloved.

سکڑے سوڑے خویش قبیلے سٹ کر پڑی تھیاں

“I discarded my blood-relationships, in-laws and kith and kin. I have come to absolutely belong to you (completely subjected myself to you).”

She transcends her primary and secondary ties and gives herself completely in the hands of her beloved.

سینگیاں سرتیاں شہر سہاون میں وت بوٹے لیاں

“My friends and intimate companions are enjoying in the city. I am wandering in the riverine growth.”

Her inner self stranded in psychic entrails intensify her sufferings and even more, while seeing her friends and companions realise happy union.

عشق ”فرید“ کوں خلوت ڈتری منہ، سر، بھٹّر چھیاں

“Love has infested Farid with the robe of honour. His face and head have been soiled with dust.”

Love infests him with a robe of honour, which
'dishonours' him in the social world. But doesn't the beauty
of love shine forth in his plight?

Kafi-107

ڈکھے ڈینہہ فرقت دے نہجھن مٹھے نین رو، رو، رت تھیون

“The days of separation are passing with great suffering. My miserable eyes are pouring tears of blood.”

She only gets peace in union with his beloved. The days of separation are the days of suffering.

ساتھی پنل گیا دور ہے سر درد قہر کلو رہے
تن چور من رنجور ہے شالہ سجن کولے دسن

“My companion Punnal has gone far away. My head is aching with terrible severity. My body has been crushed and my heart is sad. I pray that my friend dwells near me.”

She is weighed down by the transcendence of her beloved. She prays for the Grace of God to realise union.

ماہی مٹھل گیوں رول دے واہ ڈھول پڑے بول دے
ڈیکھاں ہیں کیندے کول دے دل ڈھانڈھ درداں دے بلن

“My sweet beloved! You have made me wretched. What happened to your commitments? I am eager to see with whom you are staying. The great fire of pain is burning in my heart.”

It is habitual with the lover to remind his beloved of the great commitments of love that he made, which have not been corroborated by his subsequent behaviour. He becomes miserable in assuming that his beloved has become oblivious of him due to engagement with someone else. It is a residue

of psychic love, which often creeps into the spiritual one although there is an isthmus between the two. The psychic love is highly possessive, which strives unsuccessfully to possess the beloved as an object of his desire. Freedom cannot be possessed. One's attempt to possess the other ends up in becoming possessed, instead. It frequently borders on lunacy. It is cosmically retributive to possess the freedom of a person. The divine cannot be possessed as an object. It belongs to the whole creation. It belongs to every one. It is never oblivious of any one. It does not care the one at the cost of the other. It responds to each one, according to the respective degree of preparedness, in simultaneity. There are no rivals in divine love. Love has no scarcity. The beloved overflows with love.

جیڑا ڈکھے جندڑی گلے دلڑی تپے سینہ جلے
اکھیاں ڈکھن دیداں سِکَن ہڈچم سڑے لوں لوں تلے

“My heart is aflame and there is burning in my chest. My self is suffering and my life is rotting. My flesh and bones are on fire and each and every pore of my body is on frying. My painful eyes are longing for his vision.”

The insatiable quest of union can ravish his embodied self but cannot deter it from love. How graceful are the eyes that become painful in longing for vision of his beloved.

چو گوٹھ سخت اجاڑ ہے مونس تے نہ غنوار ہے
مشکل نبھاواں رات دن پل پل غماں دی دھاڑ ہے

“I have no loving friend or anyone to share my sorrows. There is absolute desolation all around. The cries of sorrowfulness are emitting all the times. It is so difficult for me to bear these days and nights.”

One can share the whole world but one cannot share his sufferings. It is the uniqueness of his meaningful sufferings that they cannot be shared. The attempt at sharing

metamorphoses these as meaningless. There is no one to share the lover's cross of love. He has to carry it himself.

ڈٹھڑے سوا کیکر رہوں سنج بر پھروں ڈکھڑے سہوں
جتھ رچھ گھنے راکھس بہوں باندربلائیں بھوت جن

“How should I live without witnessing my beloved? I am bearing sufferings, while wandering in desolations and forests that are full of bears, and plenty of giants, monkeys, demons, evil spirits and fiery creatures.”

His inner attempt to witness his beloved is thwarted by the negative forces of his psyche. It is his struggle against these psychic forces, which gives him spiritual strength to continue in the path of love.

سید فرید سہی سبھے ماہی کچھے راہی تھئے
یا ونج ملے یارل موئے گئے ہن ڈکھاں نوں ساتھ گھن

“Syed, Farid, Sassi and others went in the tracks of the beloved. They either realised union or they died wretchedly. They went away along with their sufferings.”

Many lovers, belonging to different traditions, went in the tracks of the beloved with great sufferings. There were those who realised union in their lives while others died in states of wretchedness. The lucky ones united with their beloveds but the unfortunates ones died in the way. They all were inherently dignified as travellers in the path of love. They attained immortality but stopped short of attaining unison with their beloveds. It is only the beloved who knows the mystery of union.

Kafi-108

ڈکھے عشق دے ٹکھڑے گھائے میں سر بھڑا تر ٹڑے گائے میں

“Love-suffering bestows countless sufferings. It leads to head injuries and neck breaking.”

The violent sufferings crush her embodied self.

میں جاتا سوہنا یا رپنل رہی کول نہ ویسی کچھ ڈوں ول
ہن ول ول پور پور پور پل پل اکھیں نیر بنجوں فرڑائے میں

“I was under the impression that my beloved friend Punna will remain with me and will not go back to Ketch. Now, I am undergoing cyclic fits at each and every moment. The tears are flowing profusely from my eyes.”

She tends to take the immanence of her beloved as final. It is only when she is veiled from immanence that she comes to know about the reality of transcendence. Her cognition of love expands in breadth and becomes deeper. She becomes completely unnerved in discovering this fundamental aspect of the Real.

سبجھ اتے گل خار تھئے دھیاں ہار حمیلاں مار تھئے
جند جو کھوں تار و تار تھئے مٹھی دلڑی کرم گھائے میں

“My nuptial bed has become empty and flowers have turned into thorns. My necklace has broken into pieces and my neck ornaments have become snaky. My life is full of hardships. My hapless heart is undergoing great sufferings.”

The meaning of things becomes radically changed in the state of suffering. All those things, which seemed attractive, become repulsive. The ordinary meaning of things gives way to existential meanings. Things remain but their meanings change with the change of consciousness. Consciousness, in a certain sense, takes primacy over things. Isn't man free and thereby responsible in interpreting the contents of his consciousness?

برابر ہوں بری بیماری ہے ڈکھ پیڑتے نالہ زاری ہے
ڈھولے باجھ نہ ہرگز کاری ہے کوڑے شربت گھوٹے چائے نیں

“Love is hard and it is sickness-unto-death. There are sufferings, pains and lamentations. I have crushed and licked bitter forms of medicine but it is absolutely of no avail except union with my beloved.”

The sickness of love takes its toll on her. No medicinal measures can cure it without union.

بدوں باند ربو ز ادائیں ہن گڈ گینڈے گرگ بلائیں ہن
تھل مارو اوکھیاں جاہیں ہن سرڑائے سخت چکائے نیں

“There are wild boars, monkeys, black faced monkeys with long tails and the like along with hordes of rhinoceros wolves and demons. There are dangerous places in the deadly desert. There are noises of rusting leaves and the noisy cries of the animals.”

The psychic forces in the desert of the psyche offer resistance to her on the spiritual path of love. They ultimately prove to be the testing ground of love. She gains strength in the act of encountering these negative forces. She transcends the psychic realm to reach the spiritual one. They become the milestones of the way.

بھ والی والیاں بولتے آئے پیش تقی دے سولتے
پیریں چُجھن ہزار بولتے ہک ریت تقی بیابھائے نیں

“The earrings and nose jewellery are not a penny’s worth. The inept one has undergone many hard afflictions. There are innumerable burning thorns that are pricking my feet. There is burning sand and above that mark on my feet (due to burning in hot environ).”

Her perception changes in the state of suffering. The worth of precious things is ultimately determined by her consciousness, which does not give a penny’s worth to worldliness. Love excels in giving existential meaning to things. It establishes existential objectivity.

آئی روہاں جبلاں جال میری ممیں ڈینیں لہن سنبھال میری
رچھ راخس رکھدے بھال میری ڈینہہ رات فرید گپاٹے نیں

“I am spending my life in mountainous terrains. I am being nursed by man eaters and witches. The bears and giants are taking care of me. Farid! I am encountering uneven patches of land, day and night.”

Sarcasm notwithstanding, he strives against turbulent psychic forces in order to reach the realm of spirituality. These dark forces like opposing winds help him in soaring higher. They, in a certain sense, become his allies.

Kafi-109

ڈھولن ۾ی سک ڈھیر حم تانگھاں گھنیاں چاہیں بہوں
کھپ کھپ کراں آہیں بہوں تپ تپ اوٹھن بھاپیں بہوں

“My beloved! I am greatly desirous of you. I have immense longing and enormous fondness to be with you. I heave numberless cold sighs in an exhausted state. The sparks of love are enkindling increasingly.”

He expresses his love and communicates with his omnipresent beloved. He narrates the nature of his love and the ensuing suffering he undergoes.

کھسی دل مہیندے چاک ہے جیڑا سدا غمناک ہے
تن چور سینہ چاک ہے سر دھوڑ مونہہ پاپیں بہوں

“My heart has been grabbed by the shepherd of the herd. I remain in constant sorrowfulness. My body is ravished and my chest is wounded. My head is muddy and a heavy coat of (dung) dust has settled on my face.”

He recounts the moments of his falling in love and the hardships he encounters in the way.

لگا سخت ڈکھڑا روگ ہے بے پیر دل نوں جوگ ہے
تقی پی بھوگ یندی بھوگ ہے رور و کرے ڈھانہیں بہوں

“I am undergoing great suffering and malaise. My unruly heart craves for union. I am the inept one bearing so many ordeals. I am beseeching increasingly, while crying (to meet my beloved).”

She narrates her plight in encountering her unruly heart, which settles for nothing short of union.

ماہی پُنل دِلڑی لُئی دل لُٹ کے تھیاراہی پٹھی
رُل رُل تھکی پھر پھر ہئی بوٹے لیاں کا نہیں بہوں

“My beloved Punnal looted my heart. He retraced his steps after ravishing my heart. I have become tired in a fruitless search and fully exhausted myself wandering in great wilderness.”

She does not understand the moves of her mysterious beloved, who made her fall in love and then just left her in wilderness. Doesn't she consider herself as a goat, which has been butchered and just left there without being skinned and chopped?

جڈاں دل نوں بی چاہ تھی سٹ سیجھ تھل دے راہ تھی
سج برکلی بے واہ تھی 'آسرے واہیں بہوں

“My heart became fond of you. I left the nuptial bed and followed the way to the desert. I went alone in wilderness in a search of you without any help. I discarded numerous supports and ways.”

She recounts her sincere voyage of love or fondness when she left the comfort zone and heeded towards the perilous zones without seeking any help or banking upon any support or assistance. The way of love has to be traversed in solitariness, which implies freedom from psychic and social aid or assistance in order to strengthen her.

گذری فرید آخر عمر آئی نہ دلبر دی خبر
ڈھونڈاں جنگل جھر بر بحر تک تک رہا رہیں بہوں

“Farid! My entire life passed away, at last. I got no news regarding the whereabouts of my beloved. I searched for him in thick forests, land and sea. I remained waiting for him at so many entry points.”

His whole life has been spent in finding his transcendent beloved in every nook and corner without any result. It is the mystery of the Being itself that it may not reveal itself to an individual, community or an aeon. The basic vocation of Man is the search of transcendence with all that it implies. His search of the transcendent beloved in the tracks of immanence is one of the greatest mysteries in the tradition of love.

Kafi-110

ڈیہاں راتیں، سنجھ صبا حیں کنٹریں کان بجاؤم بین

“Krishan harps on the flute of love in my ears, day and night and in the hours of morning and evening.”

The beloved continually harps the tune of love in her ears.

قدسی بنی انہداز لوں رانجھن پھوک سناوم فضلوں

“Ranjhan harps on the perfect primordial divine flute by grace. It reflects the mode of unity.”

The beloved harps the primordial divine flute by his grace. It reflects unity in diversity.

اشنیت دی گئی علت عوج تھئی سبھ خفی ملت

سین بلا ل دایشک شین

“The illusion of duality has vanished. It has led to the establishment of the truthful tradition. The ‘sein’ (Bilal’s pronunciation in the call to ritual prayer) of Bilal is undoubtedly ‘sheen’ (the exact pronunciation in the call to ritual prayer).”

The illusion of duality vanishes by listening to the tune of unity. It establishes the truthful tradition of Oneness. Bilal’s call to ritual prayer in testifying that there is no reality except the Reality and Muhammad is the manifestation of the Reality is the whole truth. His manner of pronouncing an Arabic alphabet ‘sheen’ as ‘sein’ essentially makes no difference. His proverbial love of God and his Prophet takes precedence over any linguistic imperfection or mispronunciation as in the instant case. The universal language of love rises higher than

‘the words, their pronunciation and the methods of combining them used and understood by a community’. Religiosity finds it difficult to understand the Prophet’s sanctifying Bilal’s call to ritual prayer five times a day in spite of mispronunciation of an alphabet pertaining to witnessing or testifying. The difficulty arises because religiosity merely concentrates on outwardness and often at the cost of inwardness. It sees the form and is oblivious of the spirit beneath the form. The dimension of spirituality essentially concentrates on inwardness. However, it finds no contradiction between inwardness and outwardness. But if it has to choose between inwardness and outwardness in a situation, it will readily choose inwardness. The kernel, at times, takes precedence over the crust.

جو ہے مرد محقق موقن اوسدا تھیا شیطان بھی مومن
ملّ نخل کل قیم دین

“The one, who is verifier of truth with certainty, subjects his satanic impulses to the will of God. The principle of unity is manifest in all diversities.”

The one, who verifies truth with absolute certainty, succeeds in invoking obedience from his satanic impulses. It is symbolised as Satan being faithful to him. The sincere ones have authority over Satan and not the other way round. Didn’t Satan say that he had no authority over the sincere ones? The tradition of unity gets strengthened by embracing different shades of rightness.

دلڑی غیروں ویروں خالی صدر صدور ولایت والی
راخ مالک ملک یقین

“Their heart is free from otherness and animosity. Their word and deed are truly universal and beneficial. They live in the world of absolute certainty.”

The heart of these gnostics is free from otherness and thereby from animosity. Their word and deed is universal and beneficial for the whole creation. They do not live in the night of ignorance but live in the light of certainty.

یہاں توں تاروز حشر دے جو دوجو دثار فقر دے

دولت صحبت فخر الدین

“My being and having is reduced to ontological nothingness since the primordial day to the Day of Resurrection, by virtue of the priceless company of Fakhr-ud-Din.”

He values the invaluable company of his spiritual master. It is his blessings that have given him the ontological consciousness of his nothingness from the first to the last, that is from the primordial day to the day of resurrection.

ظلم جہالت کھیم پریرے کیتے عدل عدالت دیرے
آئی تمکین تے گئی تلوین

“The forms of oppression and ignorance have distanced themselves from me. Justice and equity have taken roots, instead. Fulfilment has dawned upon me and fickleness has disappeared.”

He is free of oppression and ignorance. He practices justice and equity. He achieves fulfilment without any fickleness.

بٹھ گھت اے تلبیس ابلیسی اے دل سکھ تدریس ادریسی
تھی وارث فاران تے سین

“Discard satanic viciousness. My heart! Learn the lesson of Idris (Prophet). Realise the heritage of Faran and Sina.”

One has to discard falsehood and learn the lessons of truth practised by the Prophet Idris, who was placed at a

higher station. One has to inherit Musa's tradition of justice (Sina) and Muhammad's tradition of love (Faran). Justice has to be rendered with love.

سو سو حمد تے لکھ شکرانے
یار فرید لدھو سے خانے
گئی تشویش تے آئی تسکین

“Farid! I found my friend within the depths of my being, I offer infinite praises and immense gratitude. Disquietude has been replaced by consolation.”

He offers infinite praises and immense gratitude to God, who blessed him with His vision in the inmost chambers of his being. The state of his disquietude gave way to fulfilment. Identity of knowledge and being gave him the sense of wholeness. Metaphysical realisation granted him absolute certitude. Religiosity cannot attain these supernal heights, which are only possible by virtue of spirituality.

Kafi-111

ڈینہ رات ڈکھاں وچ جالاں ونجیاں خوشیاں غم بیٹھی پالاں

“I spend my day and night in the state of suffering.
My joys have slipped away and I am just nurturing sorrows.”

She does not merely miss joy but has to encounter sufferings and sorrows for the sake of her beloved.

یار پُئل گیا کچ شہر ڈوں تھی راہی روہی تھل برڈوں
بیواہی کیوں آکر گھر ڈوں جگھ جگھ عمراں گالاں

“My friend Punnal went to the city of Ketch. I should become traveller of the deserts (rohi and thal) and desolations. Why should I return home without shelter and let my life rot in suffering?”

The transcendence of the beloved poses a great threat to her normal life. She prefers wilderness against the comforts of her home. She refuses to take any shelter except that of her beloved. Her beloved is her absolute concern. She is not concerned about anything else.

ڈیون ڈوڑے سول سہیلیاں بد طینت پٹھریاں تے دل میلیاں
سج بر سارے صحن حویلیاں سر ساڑاں جی جالاں

“My friends inflict double afflictions. They are vicious, irrational and impure of hearts. All the courtyards and the mansions are desolate and deserted. My head is aching and my self is burning.”

She starts distancing herself from her friends. Her friends being placed at a lower pedestal do not appreciate the

commitments of her higher consciousness. She essentially finds faults with them since they do not support her vocation of love. The courtyards and mansions are there but they seem desolated and deserted in her eyes. Her uniqueness lies in her existential perception. The objectivity of a thing remains but its meaning undergoes change by the perceiving consciousness. Her embodied self burns incessantly that adds fuel to the fire.

پیت پریندی روز سوائی و سرے خویش قبیلے بھائی
سٹ کرویرن بھینیں مائی سانول تینوں بھالائ

“My love of the beloved is on the increase each day.
My kith and kin have dwindled into insignificance. I
have discarded my brothers, sisters and my mother.
My beloved! I am just waiting for you.”

She increasingly loves her beloved in spite of so many contradictions. She becomes oblivious of her primary relationships. Her close relatives become distant. She frees herself of all distractions in order to fully concentrate on her beloved.

یار نہ پانواں پئی کر لائواں سو ہے سبجھ نوں بھا بھڑکاواں
پٹ پٹ رور و بار اٹھائواں وین کراں روہ ڈالائ

“I do not find my friend and I keep groaning. I set
the nuptial bed and colourful ‘dopatta’ to fire in order
to intensify the flames. I mourn and cry and take the
woods by storm. My wailing tears asunder the
mountains.”

The search of the transcendent beloved increases the magnitude of her suffering. One could imagine her state, in the situation of separation, in setting aflame the nuptial bed and colourful dopatta that symbolise union.

لگڑی جڑ کر چوٹ اندروچ آیم ڈوڑے ظلم تہروچ

اگر کلہری روہ ڈونگروچ ہوت نہ لہم سنبھالاں

“The injury has been perfectly struck within me. I am engulfed in multiple severe cruelties. I have been stranded alone in the difficult mountainous terrains. My beloved has not cared for me.”

The beloved has perfectly struck her being by leaving her alone without nursing her grievous open wounds. A ‘kind-hearted’ beloved could not do the job so perfectly.

یار فرید نہ لہند اساراں سہندی ساڑے سول ہزاراں
رت رورو کر رات گزاراں ڈکھ ڈکھ دیں ڈینہہ ڈھالاں

“Farid! My friend does not bother about me. I am bearing burnings, pains and countless afflictions. I spend my night by shedding tears of blood. I pass my day by bearing sufferings.”

He is constantly gripped with the idea of his beloved’s transcendence? He suffers to know that his beloved does not bother about him even in states of acute pains and sufferings. Isn’t it the Mercy of Allah and His Infinite Wisdom to increase the intensity of labour pangs for perfect rebirth? There is no ‘sizerin’ (scissoring) in love.

Kafi-112

رَتِ رُو سِر پاہ رنگا نو دیاں بُرے برہوں دے سگن سہا نو دیاں

“I am shedding tears of blood and dyeing my nuptial dress. I am realising the ritual of awful love.”

To dye one's wedding dress with tears of blood in order to realise the ritual of awful love signifies the heightened suffering undergone by her in separation from her beloved.

سب سینگیاں سرتیاں بھاگ لدھا سرگوڈڑے کھنتھ سہاگ لدھا
میں مٹھڑی مفت ڈھاگ لدھا ڈکھے ڈکھڑے بار اوٹھانو دیاں

“All my same age friends have found good fortune. They have found their wedlock by placing their heads on the leg joints of their husbands (symbolizing intimacy). I am the miserable one, who is undergoing misfortunes for nothing. I am carrying the burden of sufferings.”

She envies good fortune of her friends who have realised union. She suffers in her being in a state of misfortune. She does not feel jealous (a negative psychic emotion), but experiences a positive sentiment of envy in seeing her friends succeed in the path of love. Although, she feels sorry at her plight as compared to them but beneath her pensive mood there is an inspiration or hope of union.

کہیں سرخی کجلہ دہار ٹھہے کہیں چوڑہ ہار سنگار ٹھہے
کہیں نوریں داٹھمکار ٹھہے میں کجڑے سانگ رسانو دیاں

“The rouge and line of a collyrium are looking good at times. The set of bangles and make up is pleasing at times. The exquisiteness is manifest in the sound of anklets at times. I am the one who is exhibiting ugly forms (as compared to my friends).”

She envies her triumphant friends who are blooming with beauty as compared to her ugly forms.

کہیں جو بن جوش بہار سو ہے کہیں ٹول خوشی دے تار سو ہے
کہیں بانہہ سر اندی یار سو ہے ہک میں روندی غم کھانودیاں

“There is flowering of animated youth at times. There are plenty of collective joys at times. My friends are folding their arms beneath the heads of their beloveds at times. I am the one who is crying and is in sorrow.”

She visualises the matchless fruits of realisation borne by her friends in contrast to her who is stranded on the way.

ہجوں سیجھ نہالی تول چکے ہجو جیڈیاں سینسر بول چکے
منہہ پٹو گھر گھر پانودیاں میں موئی نوں کو جھاسول چکے

“My age group friends are wearing nose ornaments that are so beautiful. They are fondly enjoying mattresses and nuptial quilts. I am spiritless and meant for ugly affliction. I wander (crying) hither and thither, while covering my face.”

She keeps on envying her beautifully ornamented friends having joys of union. She is spiritlessly afflicted, on the other hand, with hideous afflictions and crying while wandering here and there. She may be spiritless at times but the comparison with her friends does reflect spirit of love. It ushers in a healthy spirit of competitiveness.

سوہی سیجھ سنجی اک لاندیاں سوہنے یار فرید نہ بھانودیاں
روبو چھن پاند پانودیاں تڑپھاندی رات نہ بھانودیاں

“Farid! I am unappealing to my lovely friend. I set to flames my wedding dress and the colourful nuptial bed. I spend my night in restlessness. I wet the corner of my ‘dopatta’ (head covering), while crying.”

He feels that he is not attractive to his friend. He sets to commit all his finer sentiments to flames. He cries and feels restless in ‘the dark night of the soul.’

Kafi-113

رت روندیں عمر نبھیاں ایہوداغ قبر وچ نیساں

“I will spend my life by shedding tears of blood. I will take these marks to the grave.”

She at times feels that her sufferings will never end during the span of her life.

لگا تیر جگر وچ کاری تھیا خون اکھیں توں جاری
میں مٹھڑی ڈکھڑیں ماری ہے کیندے ساگ جلیساں

“The arrow has pierced my self. The blood is oozing out from my eyes. I am the miserable one, who is a victim of sufferings. How shall I share my life with someone?”

She considers her life of suffering as a pawn in the hands of her beloved. She cannot share her inwardness with anyone else.

اتھر رہن نہ ڈیندیاں پیڑاں تھئے نیر ہنجوں نک سیڑھاں
ڈینہہ رات ڈکھاں دیاں بھیڑاں ہن موت داملک وسیاں

“The pains do not let me live here. The tears are flowing from my eyes and my nose is bleeding. The sufferings are flocking me, day and night. I shall go and populate the city of death.”

She wishes to die in order to get rid of her pains and sufferings.

سڑ سونیں دی گئی مہندی تھئی کنڈڑے سبجھ پھلیں دی
تتی قست رو دھے ڈیندی میں مٹھڑی کیڈے ویساں

“The henna of my marriage rite has faded out. The nuptial bed of flowers has become thorny. My misfortune keeps me in hardships. I am the miserable one having no knowledge about my future.”

Her plight increases with her decreasing awareness of future. She has no knowledge as to what the future has store for her. She does not know where to go. She finds no ‘door in the wall.’ She subsequently learns that she has not to carve a door but has to wait for the door to open. And she ultimately learns that there was neither a wall nor a door. It was all openness.

بھل کھید دے وقت وہانے
بھن چوڑا اگ اڑیاں
بٹھ پھلوں تول وہانے
بھن چوڑا اگ اڑیاں

“The times of playfulness have fled. I discard the flower carved pillows and bedding. I will break my necklace, neck ornaments, colour thread around my wrist (symbolising marital bond). I will break my set of bangles and commit these to flames.”

She interprets her past and future, while being stranded in the present. The glorious past in which, she had vision of her beloved remains no more inspiring. The very things connected with her union become instruments of torment. She cannot change her past but goes on changing its meaning in reference to her present project. Past is fixed but its contours are ever changing. Man, in a certain sense, is responsible for his past by virtue of freely interpreting it. Love is purely an act of free choice. There are no compulsions in love. The creeping of any compulsion correspondingly leads to ending of love.

ہڈ جالے تتریں آہیں
میں ویساں یار دے راہیں
تن گالے ٹھڈڑیں سہاں
وچ کچج فرید منیاں

“My bones have been burnt by the searing sighs. My body has been rotten by my cold sighs. I will follow

the way of my friend. Farid! I shall go to Ketch and spent my life over there.”

He has ravishing affects on his embodied self but still he is not cowed down by the vicissitudes of love. He resolves to follow the road of searching his friend till he triumphs in uniting with him forever. His resolve keeps him alive in the midst of deadness.

Kafi-114

روندی سنج صاحبیں

پنل آوم آ، گل لاوم پووم قبول دعائیں

“I cry, day and night. My Punna! Come and embrace me. I wish my prayers to be granted.”

She constantly prays for the Divine Grace in order to get united with her beloved.

یار بروچل پھیر نہ آیا اُجڑیاں جھوکاں جاہیں

“My beloved friend did not return. The places and dwellings have become deserted.”

The places and the dwellings become deserted in the absence of her beloved.

مارو تھل دے ڈکھڑے پینڈے سہنس ہزار بلائیں

“The paths of deadly desert are full of sufferings. There are hundreds and thousands of demons (calamities).”

The path of love is a deadly desert replete with sufferings. The unleashing of psychic forces play havoc with her. They oppose her from turning spiritual.

باجھ مٹھل دے باجھ نہ کائی سیجھ نہ ہر گز واہیں

“I have no shelter except that of my sweet beloved. There is no other option available to me.”

She finds no shelter except in her beloved.

روز ازل دی ایں جگ اوں جگ میں بانندی توں سائیں

“I am your slave and you are my master ever since the primordial day both in the terrestrial world and in the hereafter.”

The primordial commitment of love symbolised in the forms of master and the slave embraces both the worlds.

سہاڑاں بیور زیور تر یور بیناں سینسر باہیں

“I will put to fire my suiting, jewellery and apparel along with my forehead and nose ornaments and bracelets.”

She desperately desires to burn all her ornaments and adornments. They become torturous in reminding her of the happy days spend with her beloved. They cease to have any meaning in her search of transcendence.

کچی پیچی دے ہتھ و پیچی جندڑی سترے پائیں

“I have sold my life for a nominal amount in the hands of the deceiver of Ketch.”

She feels that she has been deceived in bartering her life for such a paltry price in the hands of her beloved. Isn't a smile of the beloved worth more than the whole treasures of the world?

عمر وہانی کانگ اوڈیندیں تھکڑی تک تک راہیں

“My life has been spent in shooin the ravens. I am tired of constantly watching the gateways (to my beloved).”

She spends her life in shooin ravens (omen of friend's return) but to no avail. She gets exhausted by constantly watching the entry points of her beloved's return. A strong person takes more time to exhaust and gets more exhausted in return. Isn't the exhausted one who finds the One?

کر کر یاد سجن دے رلے نکلن لکھ لکھ آہیں

“I heave countless sighs by recalling the moments of union with my beloved.”

The blissful moments of joyful union with her beloved torments her.

ڈھولن کارن جاوَن لادیاں لگڑیاں دِل نوں چاہیں

“My heart contracted love with my beloved ever since the primordial day.”

The heart contracted love ever since the pre-eternal covenant. It is the primordial possibility, which is realised in the human medium.

انگن فرید دے آلبیلا کر کرناز ادائیں

“O Lively one! Do come in the courtyard of Farid by making prideful and stylish moves.”

He anxiously awaits his lively beloved to unveil himself within the infinite depths of his being in prideful and stylish moves,

Kafi-115

روہی لگڑی ہے سانوئی ثرت ولاہوت مہاراں

“The rains have set out in the desert. My beloved!
Hasten to turn the reins of the camel back.”

Human self symbolised as desert is impregnated with infinite possibilities. The gradual deepening of human consciousness correspondingly opens up the hidden treasure hidden beneath its ordinary layers. It is symbolised as rain setting in the desert. The lover calls his beloved to quickly unveil himself within the desert of his being. The nearing moments of unveiling are so testing for the lover.

لھمنیاں لھمن رنگیلڑیاں رم جھم بارش باراں

“The lightning flashes are spreading colours. It is raining heavily.”

Heavy rain with flashes of lightning brings shine in his eyes.

سارے سگن سہاگڑے یارلم آیاراں

“All these are omens of union. My beloved! Do come to meet your friends.”

The omens of union signify meeting with his friend.

بدلے گوڑھے سانورے دچ برسات دیاں دھاراں

“The threading patterns of rain are visible in the thick and black clouds.”

The thick and black clouds of separation have given way to the threading patterns of rain of union.

کر دھدکارے گا جڑاں گاؤں برہوں دیاں دہاراں

“The clouds are singing songs of love in an act of thundering.”

The thundering of clouds are the songs of love.

مارو والیاں کھاڑے سبھڑے تھلڑے باراں

“Rain is pouring on deadly desert, plants and barren places.”

The spiritual opening is resurrecting inner deadness.

کارن مٹھڑی ماروی گل گلزار بہاراں

“There are flowers, orchards and springs for the sake of the miserable Marwi.”

The miseries of the lover Marwi have borne flowers, orchards and springs of love.

کارن مٹھڑے یاروے گل گلزار بہاراں

“There are flowers, orchards and springs for the sake of my sweet beloved.”

The beloved is manifesting in full bloom.

سختیاں سول سڑا پڑے سہندڑی ساریاں ماراں

“Life is bearing hardships, afflictions and tribulations and all forms of ravishing.”

Life is bed of thorns without his beloved.

شالا بھٹڑیں ریچڑیں توں سنگ ڈاگاں چاراں

“I pray that I rear the herd in lowly places and sand dunes in your company.”

He prays for a life of action in full contemplation of his beloved.

سجن سنجی دا کوئی نہیں دشمن سہنس ہزاراں

“I am the damned one, who has no one except foes in hundreds and thousands.”

He considers himself damned due to psychic and inimical forces working against him.

ڈوڑے ڈوہ ڈورا پڑے گلڑے کرن پچاراں

“There are multiple censures, sarcasms, complaints and objections against me.”

He faces inner and outer hostility just for the sake of his beloved.

اُٹھی اُٹھی نیندروں روندڑی سے سے سفنہ گارہاں

“I wake up from my sleep in tears. I narrate countless nightmares.”

He wakes up from his disturbed sleep and narrates his countless nightmares.

سن سن ہنس ہنس سینلیاں اولٹا کرن ویا راں

“My friends laugh at me, while hearing (my narrations). They unjustly develop animosity with me.”

His friends laugh at hearing his dream-interpretations. They do not understand him and develop animosity with him, instead.

اے ڈہر سلا بڑے ٹوبھے تار متاراں

“The sand dunes and low lying areas are flooded. The ponds are full of water.”

The heavy rainfall floods the desert and fills the ponds. The receptacles become recipients of divine blessings in proportion to their inner reach.

چھیڑن چھیڑو چھا نکڑاں نازو کرن تواراں

“The shepherds are rearing herds. They are harping on love tunes with priding.”

The lovers are realising their beloveds within the infinite depths of their selves.

مکل وادھ سواد ڈو روروواٹ نہاراں

“I am seeing towards the south west. I am crying, while awaiting my beloved.”

He sees towards the direction of the incoming clouds (entry point of his beloved) waiting and crying.

ڈسدایار پرو بھرا بیٹھی کانگ اڈاراں

“My friend seems so far away. I am shooing the ravens.”

He is shooing ravens as an omen to bring his distant friend in his lap.

ککڑے مکڑے ڈھانڈلے کن من مینہ پھنگاراں

“There are muddy brownish clouds, fast blowing winds with rain and drizzling.”

The ambience of unveiling is symbolised in the atmospheric changes.

طرفاں مَرخاں پھوگڑے لانی لایاں کھاراں

“The desert plants, trees and shrubs are blooming.”

Heavenly blessings resurrect the dead.

پورب ہیلیاں بھانو نیاں ٹھڈڑیاں مینگھ ملہاراں

“The soothing gusts of eastern wind and the cold drizzle of the clouds are very pleasing.”

He is pleased with the incoming messages of union.

کوئل اغن پیہیڑے وردوں کڈھن پکاراں

“The nightingales, cuckoos and crested cuckoos are singing with anguish of love.”

The birds sing with anguish of love in calling their mates. How could one's mate be called otherwise?

سوہنا عربی ساناورا آہو ساڈیاں ساراں

“My charming Arab beloved! Do come and take care of me.”

Love of God and His Prophet is the fountainhead of Islamic spirituality. Religiosity denies a direct contact with God (mar'ifa) and a direct contact with the Prophet (haduri). It fails to appreciate that spirituality is not merely a dimension of religion but is its essentiality. The negation of spirituality is the negation of the quintessence of religion. It leads to deadness of religion. A spiritual contact with God and his Prophet is exceedingly imperative for the resurrection of religious life. The Sufi tradition of Islam has envisaged the possibility of experiencing God and His Prophet. Religiosity shows religious respect to the Prophet but falls short of paying spiritual reverence to him. It does not understand the spiritual aspect of prophecy or the 'Substance of the Prophet.' The lover expresses his love of the Prophet. He beseeches his beautiful and charming Arabian Prophet to come and take care of him. The coming of the Prophet and his taking care of the lover is all by the power and leave of God. The Prophet has been vested with powers from God and he acts accordingly. The Reality has inherent powers and all other powers are derivative of its power. Allah is Power itself (Al-Qawi, Al-Aziz, Al-Matin) manifest in all forms of power. There is no power sharing since all power belongs to God. It is equally applicable to all His Names or Attributes (Asma al Husna). Traditionally speaking, it is God, in His Attribute of Power, who manifests in different mediums according to their respective capacity or receptivity. The presence of the

Prophet is essentially the Presence of the Divine in the medium of Muhammad. He understands this metaphysical truth. He requests the Prophet to take care of him so that he triumphs in uniting with his beloved.

مے باجھ فرید نوں ڈکھڑے تار و تاراں

“Farid is drowned in sufferings, without you.”

He implores the Prophet to bless him with his vision and presence (the Muhammadan Station); otherwise he will remain drowned in sufferings without him.

Kafi-116

ساری عمر گزاریم گڈ سائیں ہن ہوت پنل گیم لڈ سائیں

“I have spent my entire life with him, my master.
Now, my beloved Punna has gone away packing his
tents, my master.”

She after enjoying her life with her immanent beloved is at
a loss to understand his transcendence.

نہ کل یار سجن دی نارہ گئی جوہ جتن دی
نہ تڑتا ڈے ٹڈ سائیں

“There is no news of my dear beloved. There is no
way to reach him. There is no river bank (so that I
could search him across the waters) or temporary
habitation to be seen (where I could find him), my
master.”

She has no means to reach her transcendent beloved. Her
search for transcendence does not even find a starting point.

تھل مارو دیاں پیٹیاں ڈونگر اوکھیاں گھٹیاں
اپڑم توڑنہ سڈ سائیں

“The vast paths of the deadly desert, the mountains
and difficult passes make it impossible even for my
voice to reach him, my master.”

The paths of love are so intricate that she finds it
impossible even to communicate with her beloved.

سخت او یڑے پینڈے رڈ دے رچھ تے گینڈے
اوٹھ گئی آس تے تڈ سائیں

“The unintelligible paths are strenuous. There are shrieks of bears and rhinoceroses. All my hope and support has gone away, my master.”

It is so strenuous to traverse these unintelligible paths. The psychosocial forces instil fear and dread. She finds no one to bank upon. She loses all hope of union.

باندرا ررا خس گھاٹے کھڑ بن کھوب گپاٹے
قدم قدم تے کھڈ سائیں

“The monkeys and giants are there on the arduous passes. There are cavities, quagmires, uneven patches of land and ditches at each and every step, my master.”

The psychosocial forces obstruct the spiritual journey of the self to the Self. The paths are so hazardous that she faces the possibility of fall at every step. A single fall from one’s ‘ideal human nature’ is so spiritually ruinous.

درد ”فرید“ ستاوے اگ لاوے بھن کھاوے
پٹ پٹ ماس تے ہڈ سائیں

“Pain is vexing Farid. It is burning and grilling me. It is crushing my flesh and bones, my master.”

He is vexed with pain. It burns and grills him. It crushes his flesh and bones. Isn’t such an acute form of suffering an ideal state for the realisation of love?

Kafi-117

سانون مینگھ ملہاراں ترس پووی پنل آموڑ مہاراں

“The sky is overcast with thick clouds in the rainy season. My Punna! Have pity on me and turn the reins towards me.”

The moments of unveiling are setting in. She beseeches her beloved to have pity on her by unveiling himself.

ہنجڑوں ہاراں واٹ نہاراں بیٹھی کانگ اڈاراں

“I am shedding my tears waiting for you in the way. I am shooing the ravens.”

She is waiting for her beloved in the path of love. She is shooing ravens to know the moments of union. Ordinary knowledge fails her in ‘boundary situations.’ She banks upon her cultural understanding of things and events to face the vagaries of her love.

سجڑیاں راتیں پاواں فالان ڈینہاں ڈھالے ماراں

“I make omens in the early hours of night. I resort to superstitions in the morning.”

The ordinary modes of knowledge by dint of dry logic fail to engage the lover who spends her life on the spectrum of omens and superstitions. Her existential relatedness with them is opaque to rational consciousness.

توں بن کچ شہر داوالی اوکھی عمر گزاراں

“My beloved! The custodian of the city of Ketch! I pass a difficult life without you.”

Her life becomes so exacting during the transcendence of her beloved.

روز ازل دیاں لدھیم لاناواں ہن کیوں کر دیں عاراں

“I accomplished nuptial rites with you ever since the primordial day. Why do you avoid me now?”

She remembers the pre-eternal covenant (immanence) with her beloved. She is at a loss to understand the cause of his avoidance (transcendence) at this belated stage.

سُجڑیں & یں دلڑی مُوی وِسرے شہر بزاراں

“The barren sand dunes have captivated my heart. I have forgotten cities and bazaars.”

She becomes oblivious of outwardness and starts looking within .

ملک ملہیر و سائیم مولیٰ تھیاں چو گوٹھ بہاراں

“My Lord! Make the city of Malheer flourish so that there is spring all around.”

She prays for the spiritual life of her heart so that everything starts blooming.

تھل چترانگ ڈسیجن ندیاں رم جھم لاسوں تاراں

“The streams are visible in the deserts and plains. Rain has made these lines.”

Heavenly blessings start watering her dried self from within.

نیلیاں پیلیاں رتیاں پیگھاں مچھلی سہنس ہزاراں

“There are blue, yellow and red ransoms patterned like countless fishes (in the sky).”

The beauty of the self starts shining forth in different colours.

سرخ کرینہ تے چٹڑیاں بوٹیاں ساویاں لائیاں کھاراں

“There are red flowers and fruits, the white flowers and the green plants.”

She starts growing like a plant, laden with flowers and fruits.

جھوپڑ جھوپڑ لھبکن ٹیاں سُنہندیاں گھنڈ تواراں

“The sound of churning vessels is audible from huts. The tuning sounds of the herd and melodious songs of the shepherds are so enchanting.”

The deadness of life is resurrected. There is merriment and happiness all around.

گائیں بکریاں بھیداں چانگے چر دے جوڑ قطاراں

“The cows, goats, sheep and calves are lined up while grazing.”

The self gets integrated by virtue of the Spirit.

یار فریدِ علم دل بھاندا میلے ویس اُتاراں

“Farid! Meeting my friend will be so pleasing to my heart. I will change my shabby dress.”

His uniting with the beloved in the chamber of his heart, leads to a positive change in his human overlay. He discards the duality of his existence. He starts living in nonduality.

Kafi-118

سجنتوں بن نہ تھیاں میں گھڑی کیا پل نہ جیاں میں

“My beloved! I cannot live without you. I cannot live without you even for a moment. What to take of a little period of time?”

She reiterates her stance that she cannot live without her beloved even for a moment. Water constitutes the being of fish. How could a fish live without water?

گیا سولاں اندر سر گل سبھو مشکل تھبو سے حل
سسی سوہنی اتے مول انہاں وچ پئی گنیاں میں

“My life has been worn out due to these afflictions. It has resolved my problems. Now, I will be reckoned amongst Sassi, Sohni and Momal.”

She takes stock of her life and sees it worn out by afflictions. It finishes her anxiety of being caught between hope and despair. She now becomes absolutely clear that she will meet the tragic end of Sassi, Sohni and Momal.

توت ٹیک ڈکھاوے کرے وعدے تے نہ آوے
جے آئے نہ تال کھٹ کھاوے ناول سستی منیاں میں

“He takes to pride in his beauty every day. He falsifies his promise of returning to me. It is his sweet will to unite with me or not. Now, I am not going to patch up with him so easily.”

She analyses the causes of her beloved's indifferent behaviour towards her (one of the most beautiful cultural expressions of love). It mainly consists in the fact that the

beloved takes constant pride in his beauty. He knows that he is beautiful and therefore does not give due consideration to others. He falsifies his promise to meet her. She tries to detach herself by declaring that it is the sweet will of her beloved to unite with her or not. However, she resolves not to patch up with him so easily. It is again one of the most beautiful ways of dealing with transcendence of her beloved. She essentially is losing her grip on love but is trying to keep her face. However, she does understand the deeper intimacy of love and beauty. If love is dependent upon beauty then beauty too is dependent upon love. The most tragic thing that can happen to beauty is to remain unloved.

نہ سڈویندے نہ آندا ہے ڈینہو ڈینہہ روح ماندا ہے
تاجیون نہ بھاندا ہے ہلاہل جھول پیساں میں

“He neither calls me nor returns to me. My spirit is becoming weary day by day. My inept life does not give me fulfilment. I will take diluted deadly poison.”

She finds it very difficult to understand the behaviour of her beloved. The beloved neither makes her ascend to him nor descends to her level. Her spirit becomes constantly wearied by grappling with the problems of transcendence and immanence. She finds her life of unrealised love so miserable that she prefers death to it.

کئی ڈکھڑیں توں بچ بچ گئیاں کئی ورنال رچ رچ گئیاں
کئی سک سانگ مچ مچ گئیاں کراں کیس نال ریساں میں

“There were some who were saved from grief. There were some who united in love with their beloveds. And there were some who got burned in longing of their love. How can I compete with any one of them.”

She considers that she is no match with the ones who triumphed in love without any grief, the ones who became

united with their beloveds or remained burning in longing of their love.

دُنی سولاں نہ سہی ول	فرید آیا نہ ماہی ول
اجھو آج کل ہر ریاں میں	پیا ڈکھ ڈور پھاہی ول

“Farid! My beloved has not returned. My afflictions have given me no relief. Well, the noose of suffering has tightened around my neck. I may lose these days (the game of love).”

He gets no relief from afflictions caused by the absence of his beloved. The noose of suffering tightens round his neck. He fears that he might die soon without realising union with his beloved.

Kafi-119

سکھ ریت روش منصورى نوں ہن ٹھپ رکھ کنز قدورى نوں

“Learn the Mansurian tradition and its realisation.
Now, shelve ‘Kanz’ ‘Kanduri’ (books of
jurisprudence).”

The knowledge of jurisprudence remains tied to the formal aspects of religion. It is a rational stage in the development of religious life, which has to be finally transcended to the stage of spirituality. Religiosity remains stranded at the formal stage without any inkling of gnosis. Mansur Hallaj at the heights of gnosis said: I am the Truth. The Reality had completely taken over his human medium and was communicating through his tongue. The clerics did not understand the subtle reality and executed him. The Mansurian tradition is the tradition of Oneness. It is not merely theoretical but has corresponding means of realisation.

جو کوئی عشق مدرسے آیا فقہ، اصول داکراٹھایا
بے شک عارف ہو کر پایا رمز حقیقت پوری نوں

“The one who joined the academy of love, ceased to
bother about jurisprudence and its principles.
Undoubtedly, he attained gnosis and thereby fully
understood the clue to Reality.”

The one who joins the academy of love rises higher than jurisprudence and its principles. He is not involved in hair splitting. He understands the whole truth in the state of gnosis.

جو کوئی چاہے علم حقائق راز لدنی کشف دقائق
تھیوے اپنے آپ داشائق سٹ نزدیکی دوری نوں

“The one, who yearns for knowledge of realities, inspired knowledge and illumination of subtleties, should delve within his own self. He should cast away proximity and distance.”

The key to gnosis is delving within the infinite depths of one's being. It is deepening the layers of one's consciousness till one discovers the beloved in the infinite depths of one's consciousness. The gnostic comes to have inspired and illuminative knowledge of his self. The rational distinction between proximity and distance dwindles away. It leads to the identity of knowledge and being.

ہمہ اوست تے بھید نیارے جانن وحدت تے ونجارے
ہر ہر شے وچ کرن نظارے اصل تجلی طوری نوں

“The mysteries of Oneness of Being are remarkable. They are known by the dealers of Unity. They behold the real Sinai theophany in each and every existent.”

The mysteries of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud) are extraordinary. They entail wisdom of the ages. They are known by the gnostics who understand the principle of unity in diversity. They understand Reality's transcendence and immanence in simultaneity. They behold the theophany of the Reality in every existent. They see 'God Everywhere.'

بیدانو کھے پنتھ اوڑے ویڑھے وسدے رکھن بکھیرے
ہور نہ کوئی آپ نیڑے اپنی اکی، پوری نوں

“The forms of religiosity are novel and the modes of spirituality are unintelligible. Those who dwell in the same courtyard develop incongruities. There is no other but oneself who has to settle the accounts of ones own unsettled disputes.”

The forms of religiosity and the modes of spirituality come into conflict with each other due to their different perspectives. It is very strange that the votaries of the one Reality develop incongruities among themselves. They have

to resolve these differences themselves by appreciating different levels of understanding. The spiritual perspectives also come into conflict with each other. One has to bear in mind that there is not always a conflict between right and wrong. There are times when different shades of rightness also come into open conflict with each other. The votaries of the spiritual traditions have always to keep these things in mind, which are otherwise opaque to the religious consciousness.

لفظ ازل دا ویلہا آیا	فخر جہاں گر گیان سنایا
طبع سلیم فرید دی پایا	فہم لغات طیوری نوں

“It was the dawning of eternal bliss that Fakhr Jehan laid bare the principles of gnosis. The harmonious disposition of Farid understood the language of birds.”

It was the moment of primordial bliss when his spiritual master, Fakhr-i-Jehan, unravelled the Gnostic wisdom. His receptivity reached such heights and depths that he understood the language of birds (mysteries of gnosis in the universal language of love).

Kafi-120

ستریں ہوت سدھانے ناہیں ہک تل ترس جتن میں

“My beloved left me, while sleeping. There is not even an iota of pity in this camel rider.”

She considers the transcendence of her beloved as an act of cruelty.

گئے کرہوں قطاری بر، ڈو تھی پاندھی کچ شہر ڈو
کر زور ازور دھنگانے خوش و ٹھڑے ونج دیس وطن میں

“They took the caravan of camels in desolations towards Ketch with (my beloved) forcibly tied up. They started dwelling happily in their own land.”

The dimension of transcendence is still a delimitation of the Reality. The Reality cannot remain content for long at this level. It has to descend at times to the level of immanence.

تی کلہڑی تے ندرائی بیواہی مونجھ منجھائی
مونہہ بُسرائین کمانے ہوش نہ سر میں سرت نہ تن میں

“I am pitiable and alone with tiredness in my eyes. I am without support and drowned in anguishes. My face is covered with dust and my eyes are lustreless. I am mentally incapacitated and my body is out of control (my embodied self has lost contact with everydayness).”

She is in a pitiable condition in search of her transcendent beloved. She is condemned to live in a world that has been completely shattered.

بٹھ بے درداں دی یاری میں مٹھڑی لا کر ہاری
نت جھردی جھور جھرانے رہندی درداندہ محن میں

“I don't care for the friendship of those who are heartless. I am the miserable one, who contracted friendship and lost. I am always worrisome. I remain in pain and grief.”

Her suffering has brought her to such a desperate state that she has to say that she does not care for the friendship of her heartless beloved.

آپے یاری لائیں ول ویندیں نہ موکلائیں
سبھ رہ گئے حال پرانے دل دی دل میں من دی من میں

“He himself came and initiated friendship with me. He went away without bidding me a farewell. All good things of the past have been just left there in my heart. The things in my mind and heart are not fructified.”

She tries to make her point by referring to the initiation of love by her beloved and then his going away from her without adieu. The moments of love are still fresh in her mind and they start to haunt her. She is ‘dying of unburned life.’

ڈے ویرن ڈوہ ڈوراپے رکھ آس ملن دی آپے
موئیں جیندیں تھلڑے مانے نیتس پوری گور کفن میں

“My adversaries are passing censures and sarcasms against me. I am keeping to myself my hope of meeting him. I shall dwell in these deserts, while living and dying. I will accomplish my funeral rites.”

Her sufferings multiply by the attitude of her adversaries who leave no stone unturned in proving her wrong. It is not only ‘what’ they say but ‘how’ they say, which terribly pains her. She resolves not to disclose her hope of union and wait till end. It is so difficult for her to keep things to herself. She

would like to narrate the tale of her woe and misery even to a wall. Does she feel that she will die in holding her breath of love in case she does not breathe it out? And isn't her latest resolve to keep things to her own self akin to holding her breath? How difficult love is.

گئے جو بھن جوش بہاری گئی ہار سنگار دی واری
تھئے کجل موساگ نما نے والی وٹڑی سوہم نہ کن میں

“The spring of my animated youth went away. The times of my makeup are gone. My collyrium and twigs (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) lost their attractions. My earrings (including black thread in space reserved for earrings) lost their meaning.”

She recounts the gradual dwindling of her youthfulness along with its ornaments and adornments. Isn't the intensity of her painful realisation, in the fire of love, makes her ultimately worthy of her beloved?

ٹھگ باز بہوں دل کالے سئے پیچ کرن لکھ چالے
کر کوڑ فریب اکھانے ڈسدے پورب و سن دکھن میں

“These swindlers are black-hearted. They make hundreds of pretensions and countless dubious moves. They profit in their falsehood and deceptions. They live in the East but give their address of the West.”

She attempts to demean transcendence in failing to capture it. Aren't the ways of transcendence beyond human understanding?

سبھ سینگیاں ملک امن وچ اے چھوری بیت حزن وچ
کر بیٹھم جاہڑگانے سوز بدن میں دود دہن میں

“All my friends are dwelling in the city of peace. I am unaided, who is living in the house of angst. It is my

abode and dwelling. My body is in passion and the smoke is emitting from my mouth.”

She is condemned to live in the house of angst with all that it implies. It is only by living in this house for an uncertain period that she qualifies for dwellings with her beloved.

تھیاں خوشیاں آسے پاسے گئے دوسرے مزاخاں ہاں سے
کیا حسن جمال دے مانے بڑھڑی تھیم نوڑے سن میں

“Pleasures have dwindled away from me. My puns and laughter have gone away. Why I should have vainglory in my beauty and elegance? I have turned old in young age?”

Aren't the endings of happiness, puns and laughter; the casting off vainglory in one's beauty and elegance, and turning old in young age foretell the fruition of love?

اے غمزے ناز نہورے اے خوشیاں زورے تورے
ہن ڈاڈھے سخت سیانے ہر علم تے ہر فن میں

“There are enticements, pride, blandishments, joys and radiant might. They are perfect and highly accomplishing in all types of knowledge and in all forms of art.”

The beloved's mighty expressions of beauty and love ravish her heart. She has no defence to offer in face of her beloved's perfect knowledge and art of love.

لا، نیچھ ”فرید“ نہ پھر ساساں ایہو گھیر کلڑا گھر ساساں
اوہ جانے خواہ نہ جانے رہسوں ہر دم ہکڑے دن میں

“Farid! I will not betray my committed love. I will ferry across the unintelligible waters. He may realise it or not. I shall always remain sincere in my commitment.”

He resolves never to betray his commitment of love; face the vicissitudes of love and ever remain sincere in commitment to his beloved. He further resolves to leave it to his beloved to appreciate it or not. His resolve brings out essential elements in the metaphysics of love. He is essentially committed with love itself, polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved. It is the absoluteness of love that matters in the end. His sincerity is essentially to love. The behaviour of his beloved becomes accidental, in a certain sense, to his absolute and categorical commitment with love. It is precisely the reason that he remains sincere to love not only in the state of union but equally in the states of separation and disunion. The acts done, in consonance with the principle of love, do not smack of expediency. He essentially takes credentials from love itself and not from the beloved.

Kafi-121

سوہنیاں رمزاں تیریاں بھانودیاں سانوں لچھڑی چونک لائودیاں

“Your lovely antics are so pleasant. They deeply strike my heart.”

He finds the lovely expressions of beauty so pleasant. They deeply strike his heart.

چشماں جادو قہر قیامت ہوش حواس بھلاؤدیاں

“Your magical eyes are very striking and irresistible. They make us lose our sense and sensibility.”

The magical eyes of the beloved are spellbinding. He loses his sense and sensibility in face of vibrant beauty.

ابرو قوس تے مڑگاں کبر ظلمیں چوٹ چلاؤدیاں

“Your eyebrows are bows and the eye lids are arrows. They hurt so cruelly.”

The beauty of eyebrows and eyelids is so ravishing.

چڑھن شکار نہ مڑدیاں ہرگز زلفاں صید پھانودیاں

“They do not turn back in vain once they are on hunt. The locks of your hair succeed in hunting.”

The locks of hair are always triumphant in the game of hunt. They hunt the heart of the lover.

چالیں نازدیاں دل نوں موہندیاں حکمیں برہوں بچھانودیاں

“The prideful moves bewitch my heart. They coerce it to love.”